Daoist Mineral, Plant, and Animal Magic

The Secret Teaching Of Esoteric Daoist Magic

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THE STUDY OF THE REALM OF MINERALS

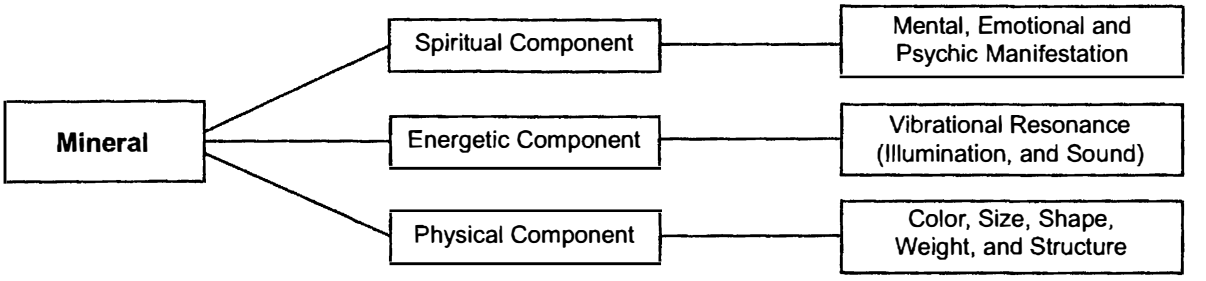


Figure 1.1. Each mineral has a unique physical, energetic and spiritual component within its structoral formation.

INTRODUCTION TO THE ALCHEMICAL TRANSFORMATIONS OF MINERALS

According to ancient records, the use of magical and medicinal rocks and minerals has a long history in China. Information about the magical and medical components of gems and minerals can be found dispersed throughout ancient texts written in all of China's various dynasties. This information focuses not only on the magic virtues of particular stones, but also the formation and individual powers of various minerals. In ancient China, these esoteric Daoist teachings were kept secret, and they were traditionally only passed down from master to disciple due to Confucianistic "ethics," which officially tried to suppress such magical training.

In ancient China, understanding, cultivating, and utilizing the hidden power contained within the Realm of Minerals was considered to be one of the most powerful levels of magic, because the energetic vibrations of minerals are the most direct external manifestations of the Earth's energetic field. The ancient Daoists also believed that each rock and mineral that was found in nature was also imbued with special qualities and magical powers developed from the various Elements that surrounded and sustained them. Therefore, each rock and mineral had a unique physical, energetic and spiritual component to its structural formation (Figure 1.1). For example, most rocks and minerals have a crystalline structure that can collect, store, and release electromagnetic energy. Through experimentation, modern scientists have discovered that a crystal will accumulate and concentrate the Qi of any given energy field in close proximity. When compressed, energy is released from the crystal (i.e. piezoelectric charges). While this expression is infinitesimal, electrons are emitted and then reabsorbed by the crystal, thus producing energy.

The nature of ancient Chinese alchemy is the manipulation of the divine spiritual and invisible Elemental components which are contained within all matter. The core essence of any material object is its Jing (reproductive essence or semen). In the first level of Daoist magic, the disciple is taught how to gather and cultivate this magical essence. Extracting and utilizing the Jing of an object seems possible in the realms of plants, animals, and humans. However, the energetic extraction of the metallic or mineral Jing is traditionally known only by a few adepts, and was considered one of the most powerful energetic and spiritual accomplishments by these ancient Daoist priests.

The powerful allure of magical stones (gems, crystals, stones, and minerals) has attracted humans for thousands of years. Minerals affect and influence the growth and energetic state of plants, water, air, animals, and humans. The ancient Chinese believed that certain magical stones could be used as a gateway into the energetic and spiritual realms, allowing the mystic access to increased psychic powers, miraculous healing ability, increased spiritual development, physical and spiritual protection, and divine guidance.

The ancient Daoist mystics believed that all minerals and crystals belong to the Elemental realm. This realm also encompasses the energetic activities of certain spirit entities and immortals that guard and influence the various quadrants of the Earth and the Heavens. Additionally, certain crystals were considered to be record keepers or storehouses of memories, and are believed to contain the knowledge of the Earth's energetic history.

The ancient Daoist priests used these magical rocks and minerals as mystical tools, energetic generators, communication enhancers, and healing instruments. Archeological digs confirm their ancient use as magical talismans for protection and good fortune.

HISTORY OF MAGICAL AND MEDICINAL ROCKS

Many historians believe that human civilization had its origin in the East, and that the peoples of these regions (China and India, in particular) were the first originators and masters of magic and medicine. Research reveals that the magical properties of minerals and crystals were recorded by the ancient Chinese more than 3,500 years ago.

Eventually, the various magical properties of medical rocks and herbs were compiled into manuals, and used to assist ancient doctors in their healing practices. The oldest Chinese book specializing in magical and herbal medicine, *Shen Nong Ben Cao Jing* (Divine Husbandman's Classic of the Materia Medica) was written in the period of the Eastern Han Dynasty (25-220 A.D.), and gives precedence to several medicinal minerals over prescriptions made from just animal and plant products. This ancient book states that the position of these medicinal minerals as drugs is simply higher and more energetically powerful than that of animals and plants. The *Baopuzi Neipian* written by the ancient Daoist Master GeHong states, "when roasted, all herbs turns to ash; but when cinnabar is burned, it turns to mercury, and if the mercury is mixed with sulphur and heated, it returns to cinnabar. Such cyclic behavior cannot be achieved by a plant."

The ancient Chinese have always used gems and special healing stones in clinical practice. In 1998, while I was in Beijing, China, a friend of mine presented me with a gift of a Chinese Healing Stone called "Sa Bin Fu Shi" (Sa Bin Floating Stone). The Floating Stones were believed to be volcanic rock and had energetic properties. She explained that in ancient China, these stones were originally used to treat individuals in a clinic. The mystic would emit Qi through the stones into the patient's body via the channel points in order to Tonify deficient conditions or breakup stagnant Qi. This ancient use of precious gems produced a miraculous effect within the body tissues. Later, as the population in China grew, the stones were eventually replaced with the insertion of metal needles in order to accommodate the larger patient load. Some Medical Qigong clinics in China still use the healing stones in their treatments today.

In ancient China, mineral remedies were included in the Daoist pharmacopoeia. Forty-six inorganic substances were commonly used, arranged according to three ranks, and categorized according to their importance in therapeutic value, for example:

- **First Rank:** These stones and minerals included alum, amethyst, various types of clays, cinnabar, copper carbonate, hematite, mica, mineral waters, quartz, saltpeter, stalactites, and steatite.
- **Second Rank:** These stones and minerals included actinolite, azurite, copper sulphate, felspar, magnetite, marble, mercury, orpiment, realgar, and sulphur.
- **Third Rank:** These stones and minerals included agate, arsenolite, fuller's earth, iron, iron oxides, lead carbonate, lead tetroxide, lime, salt, stalagmites, and tin.

With the passage of time, the number of medicinal minerals increased, growing from 46 to 83 entries for medicinal minerals used during the Tang Dynasty (618-907 A.D.) and eventually increasing to 133 entries in the source text used for Chinese medicine today.

The modern Chinese herbal pharmacopoeia includes as many as 5000 plant and animal species and other substances called "herbs" but which are actually derived from animals and minerals. Mineral substances, some of which are derived from animals, include oyster shell, talc, borax, dragon bone (fossil mammal bone), amber, and magnetite. These minerals are used to treat a wide variety of internal and external maladies.

Formation of Minerals and Crystals

Just as the physical body is constructed of the energetic components of cells which form tissues, organs, and organ systems, the Earth's energetic body is constructed of minerals and crystals which form the Earth's crust, rock formations, and mountain structures. These various mineral structures possess the ability to promote the physical, energetic and spiritual growth of animals, plants, and humans.

Crystals were created when the Earth formed, and have continued to metamorphose as the planet itself has changed. Crystals are considered the Earth's DNA, containing a chemical imprint of its many years of evolution. They are considered to be miniature storehouses containing the records of the development of the Earth and the powerful forces that shaped and transformed it.

Formed out of an array of minerals, a crystal is defined by its internal structure. While a number of crystals may be formed out of the same material or combination of minerals, each stone will crystallize differently. Because of chemical impurities, radiation, Earth and solar emissions, and the exact means of their formation, each type of crystal has a unique energetic pattern.

Broken down or disintegrated mineral particles combine with the elements of air and water to form the Earth's soil. Every particle in the soil still retains the original primordial energy force of the mineral realm, which interacts with the energy of the Divine.

The Earth is composed of three basic layers: the core, mantle, and crust. The most extreme heat is found in the center or core of the Earth. Less heat is found in the mantle, where internal temperatures are less concentrated. The coldest areas of the Earth are found within and on top of the crust. Magma (molten rock from the mantle) is pushed to the surface, cooled and mixed with water to create distinctive types of rock. Such rocks form as deposits of igneous rocks (formed by the solidification of molten rock), metamorphic rocks (formed by pressure, heat, and water), and sedimentary rocks (formed by water, wind, or glacier). Within the various structures of the Earth there are energetic and physical differences between rocks

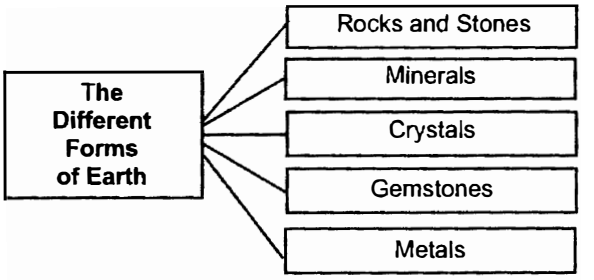


Figure 1.2. The Four different forms of Earth stones

and stones, minerals, crystals, gemstones and metals, described as follows (Figure 1.2):

- **Rocks and Stones:** These are combinations of minerals formed from a unique mixture of elements and environmental circumstances.
- **Minerals:** These are chemical elements with a homogenous constitution (i.e., salt, coal, sulphur, etc.)
- **Crystals:** This term often refers to clear quartz formations, yet there are numerous other types of crystals that contain small amounts of unique chemical elements which change its color and quality. Crystals are powerful energy conductors, containing various colors, shapes, and inclusions (foreign substances enclosed within the mineral), all of which influence how they magnify specific energies. Initially, there are seven categories of crystal formation. Each category has its own geometric structure, molecular similarity, imaginary axis of rotation and different angles at which the axes intersect. The lengths of the axes and the angles between them define the crystal's shape.

  The seven categories are described as follows: Isometric (cubic), Tetragonal (four-sided), Hexagonal (six-sided), Trigonal (three-sided), Orthorhombic (lozenge-shaped), Monoclinic (slightly inclined), and Trilinic (thrice inclined).
- **Gemstones:** These are described as semiprecious or precious materials based on their purity, color, availability, and mining requirements.
- **Metals:** These are described as containing certain metallic chemical elements such as copper, gold, silver, platinum, mercury iron and aluminum.

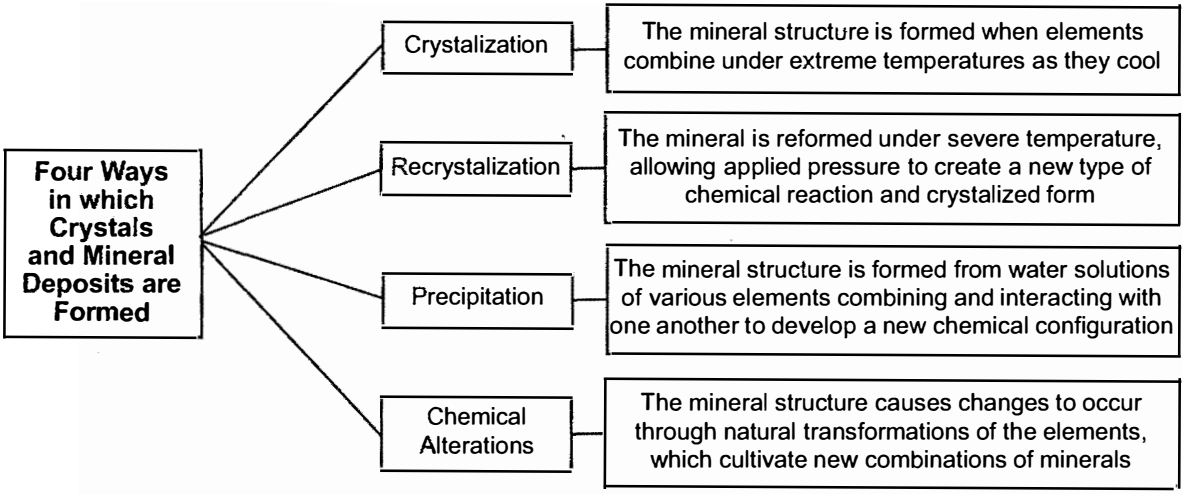


Figure 1.3. There are four ways in which crystals and mineral deposits are formed

Rocks and stones, minerals, crystals, gemstones and metals are all formed from a wide range of environmental influences. These Earth formations are blended through various chemical ingredients and temperatures that create specific geological deposits through the mechanism of plate tectonics (the movement of sections of the Earth's crust). Basically there are four ways these deposits are formed (Figure 1.3):

1. **Crystallization:** In this type of mineral structure, the elements combine under extreme temperatures as they cool.
2. **Recrystallization:** In this type of mineral structure, a mineral is reformed (a second time) under severe temperature, which allows the applied pressure to create a new type of chemical reaction, thereby generating a different crystallized form.
3. **Precipitation:** This type of mineral structure is formed from water solutions, in which the various elements mix and move (interacting with one another) in order to develop a new chemical configuration (i.e., an opal is formed in this manner).
4. **Chemical Alterations:** This type of mineral structure is formed from changes that occur through natural conditions of the elements, creating new combinations of minerals (e.g., Malachite is formed through the oxidation of copper).

MINERALS IN TRADITIONAL CHINESE PHARMACOLOGY

Certain crystals can act as resonators and transducers of electromagnetic energy. All solid matter is composed of atomic particles arranged in some form of organized crystalline structure called a "lattice" (i.e., its geometrical arrangement). The crystal lattice structure found in minerals provides the stone with great energetic stability and also facilitates the regularity of electromagnetic energy that flows through the stone. This allows certain stones the ability of transforming and/or amplifying other forms of energy.

The ancient Chinese believed that minerals possessed the ability to promote the growth of plants, animals, and humans, or to assist individuals in building up resistance to disease. Wild animals instinctively perceive the state of their own health, and eat earth and drink spring water to recondition themselves. Furthermore, when wounded, wild animals instinctively know which rocks are good for healing, and they rub their bodies against them and wait for their wounds to heal. Even animals bred in farm buildings will still lick stones and eat dirt when released into fields. They instinctively know that they need components from natural minerals for their bodies.

The following is a partial list of minerals used in Traditional Chinese Medicine; these are still being currently used in China because of their medicinal properties.

- **Ming Fan (Alumen) Alum:** This mineral enters into the Lung, Large Intestine, Liver, Stomach, and Spleen Channels. It relieves toxicity, kills parasites, drys dampness, alleviates itching, stops bleeding, clears heat, and expels phlegm.
- **Peng Sha (Borax):** This mineral enters into the Lung and Stomach Channels. It relieves toxicity, prevents petrification, clears heat, drys dampness, dissolves Phlegm, and transforms stones.
- **Qing Fen (Calomelas) Light Powder:** This mineral enters into the Liver, Kidney, and Urinary Bladder Channels. It relieves toxicity, kills parasites, expels water, and unblocks the bowels and Urinary Bladder.
- **Zhu Sha (Cinnabaris) Vermillion Sand:** This mineral enters into the Heart Channel. It is used to calm the spirit and treat restlessness, insomnia, and palpitations with anxiety.
- **Zi Shi Ying (Fluoritum) Purple Stone Radiance:** This mineral enters into the Heart and Liver Channels. It sedates the Heart and settles tremors and palpitations. It is used in conditions of disorientation, insomnia, palpitations with anxiety, or convulsions due to Heart Blood Deficiency or Liver Yang Rising.
- **Shi Gao (Gypsum) Calcium Sulfate:** This mineral enters into the Lung and Stomach Channels. It clears the heat from the body, drains Fire, and is used to treat high fevers.
- **Dai Zhe Shi (Haematitum) Red Stone From Dai County:** This mineral enters into the Heart, Pericardium, and Liver Channels. It calms the Liver, anchors floating Yang, clears Liver Fire, directs Rebellious Qi downward, cools the Blood and stops bleeding.
- **Mi Tuo Seng (Lithargyum) Elusive Reclusive Monk:** This mineral enters into the Liver and Spleen Channels. It absorbs fluids, reduces swelling, and stops bleeding.
- **Ci Shi (Magnetitum) Magnetic Stone:** This mineral enters into the Liver and Kidney Channels. It roots and calms the spirit, and is used to treat restlessness, palpitations, insomnia or tremors, especially in patients with Yin Deficiency and ascending Yang.
- **Qian Dan (Minium) Lead Elixir:** This mineral enters into the Heart, Liver, and Spleen Channels. It expels toxins, directs the Phlegm downward, and suppresses spasms.
- **Mang Xiao (Mirabilitum) Glauber's Salt:** This mineral enters into the Stomach and Large Intestine Channels. It is used to clear Heat and reduce swelling.
- **Hua Shi (Talcum) Slippery Rock:** This mineral enters into the Stomach and Urinary Bladder Channels. It is used to promote urination and drain heat from the bladder. The ancient Chinese believed that Talcum is born of the vapors of the Pole Star.
- **Fu Long Gan (Terra Flava Usta) Hidden Dragon Liver:** This mineral enters into the Stomach and the Spleen Channels. It is used to warm the Blood, stop bleeding, stop vomiting, and stop diarrhea.
- **Zi Ran Tong (Pyritum) Natural Copper:** This mineral enters into the Liver and Kidney Channels. It dispels Blood stasis and promotes the healing of the bones and sinews. It is also used for relieving swelling and pain.
- **Xiong Huang (Realgar) Male Yellow:** This mineral enters into the Heart, Liver, and Stomach Channels. It is used to relieve toxicity, kill parasites, dry dampness, and expel Phlegm.
- **Lu Gan Shi (Smithsonitum) Stove Sweet Stone:** This mineral enters into the Liver and Stomach Channels. It brightens the eyes and removes superficial visual obstructions such as red and swollen eyes, and drys dampness.
- **Liu Huang (Sulphur) Sulphur Yellow:** This mineral enters into the Kidneys and Large Intestine Channels. It relieves toxicity, kills parasites, tonifies Mingmen Fire, and strengthens the Yang.

Sulphur was used in ancient China to ward off the "Five Noxious Creatures." In ancient times, sulphur was also believed to be able to force women who have assumed the form of snakes to revert back to their original shape and human form. At the Feast of the Summer Solstice (which is also a day when ghosts and demons are considered to be active) powered sulphur is rubbed on the ears and nose of children to protect them from spirit oppression or possession. It is for this very same reason that sulphur is put into coffins.

MAGICAL PROPERTIES OF STONES

The ancient Daoists believed that minerals and stones were vehicles through which the Earth's energy was distributed. These priests saw minerals as being resonant cells that carried different frequencies of energy through the energetic body of the Earth. Some of these magical stones acted as regulators and were therefore used for balancing energy; other stones acted as tonifiers and were used for amplifying energy; still others were respected for their ability to purge and were therefore used for cleansing and purifying energetic fields.

When a mineral or stone is brought into contact with the body's energetic field, two things occur.

- First, the energetic frequency created by the stone will vibrate the body's energetic fields according to the "law of resonance." This is similar to placing a vibrating tuning fork next to another tuning fork of the same pitch and causing the second tuning fork to vibrate. This increases the energetic interaction between the body and the stone, creating a larger (third) energetic field of vibration. The body's nervous system then attunes itself to the subtle energetic shifts and transmits this new information to the brain. This stimulation of the brain, caused by the stone's subtle energetic frequencies, initiates biochemical shifts that affect the physical body and trigger emotional experiences. These subtle energetic experiences can be used to elevate the awakened conscious mind of a priest and allow him or her to experience higher states of spiritual insight and perception.
- The second thing that occurs is that tiny particles of minerals existing within the physical tissues begin to resonate with the particles of minerals within the stone. This causes the body to believe that it actually contains more of that mineral, and the tissues react accordingly with additional biochemical shifts. For example, if an individual is holding a calcium-based stone, the calcium particles in his or her tissues will be activated as they begin to resonate with the calcium particles inside of the stone. This increases the energetic interaction between the body and the stone, creating a larger (third) energetic field that carries a calcium based energy signature to the brain. As the brain receives this information (via the body's nervous system), it reacts by adjusting the body's biochemistry, causing it to act as if it had more calcium within its physical tissues. Therefore, the type of experience a priest has while holding a mineral or stone (i.e. the stone's effect on the priest's physical, energetic, and spiritual fields) is directly related to the strength and quality of that stone's energetic signature.

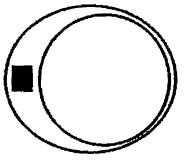


Figure 1.4. Magical Stone Ring

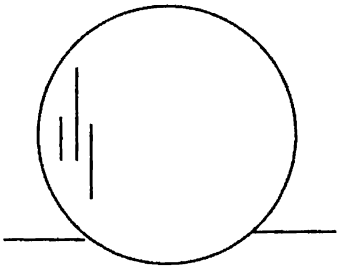


Figure 1.5. White Jade Ball Used for Scrying

MAGICAL USES OF STONES

Because the ancient Daoists understood that certain stones and minerals vibrated at a very high energetic frequency, they used these magical stones and minerals in order to amplify their body's Ling Shen (Magical Spirit). In ancient China, the Daoists priests established numerous esoteric uses for these magical stones, including: Magical Tools, Magical Rituals, Healing, Tinctures and Elixirs, Feng Shui, and Divinations. These magical uses are described as follows:

- **Magical Tools:** This category includes magical stones that are used for the purpose of enhancing the priest's personal energetic fields. A Daoist priest's magical tools included the use of stone talismans, stone amulets, stone rings (Figure 1.4), stone mirrors and scrying balls

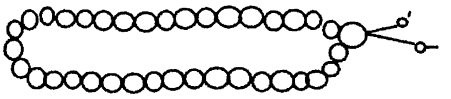


Figure 1.6. Prayer Stone Beads (Mala) Used for Protection

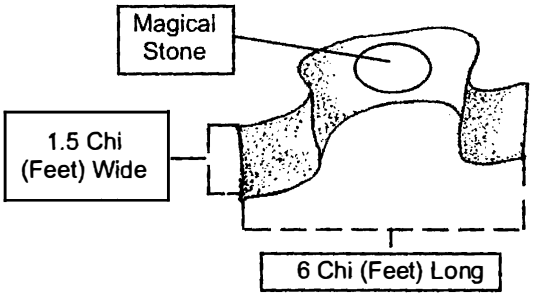


Figure 1.7. The One Character Hat (Yizi Jin) is one example of an ancient Daoist head-band that used the esoteric powers of a Magical Stone

(Figure 1.5), healing stones, stones used for protection (Figure 1.6), stones used as spiritual weapons, spirit stones (magical stones used to help connect the priest to a certain Immortal or spirit entity), ascension stones (magical stones used to induce dreams, clairvoyant states, visions, and out-of-body experiences), prosperity stones, and love stones.

One powerful type of Daoist magical tool is the Magical Stone Head-band (Figure 1.7). This ancient tool involved secretly placing magical stones into the Daoist priest's head-bands and ritual hats (usually over the Yin-tang or Baihui areas). These magical stones were used for increasing the priest's powers of intuition, perception, and Shen projection.

- **Magical Rituals:** This category includes magical stones that are used in rituals for summoning spirit entities and for affecting the Elements of nature (i.e. used in Weather Magic).

Additionally, in ancient China, certain Daoist rituals called for magical stones to be laid out in a circular Bagua pattern (Figure 1.8). This circular Bagua pattern was used in order to energetically surround any person, place, or thing that the priest wished to magically manipulate and influence. Sometimes the

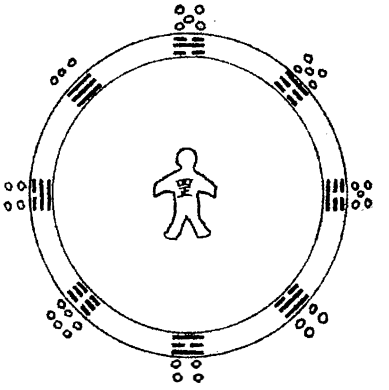


Figure 1.8. In certain ancient Daoist rituals, magical stones were laid out in the Bagua pattern

image of the person was represented by a rice or straw effigy. This effigy was then placed into the center of the magical stone circle. The energy created from this type of ancient ritual allowed the priest to either positively or negatively manipulate the life-force energy of that person, place, or thing.

Five Element Healing Rituals are sometimes performed by a Daoist priest by placing certain magical stones onto an individual's body (Figure 1.9). The placement of these magical stones (i.e., Wuji, Wood/Air, Fire, Water, and Earth) varies according to the patient's specific condition and the priest's desired result. For example, magical stones that represent the energetic properties of Wuji are sometimes placed above the patient's Upper Dantian (i.e., at the Baihui area) in order to draw the body's Qi and Shen upwards and reawaken their spiritual connection to life.

In patients suffering from an excess condition due to emotional trauma or a disconnection from their spiritual life, magical stones that represent the energetic properties of Earth can be placed onto the patient's Lower Dantian (i.e., at the Qi Hai area) in order to draw the body's Qi and Shen downwards. This technique is used to root the patient's Ethereal Soul back into his or her body and is traditionally used in magical rituals in order to "return the Hun."

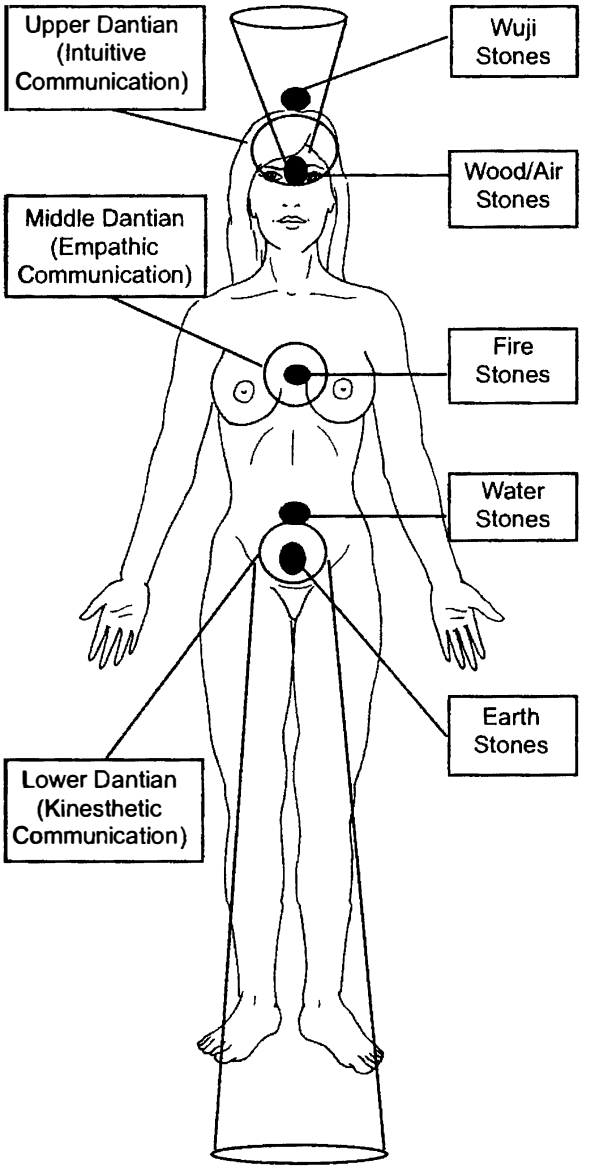


Figure 1.9. The placement of Magical Stones varies, according to the priest's intention.

- **Magical Healing:** This category includes magical stones that are used as powerful healing tools in order to boost the priest's natural healing powers. Because each geometric shape and cut of a crystal affects its energetic field and power, certain minerals and magical crystals were used as powerful conduits of healing energy (Figure 1.10).

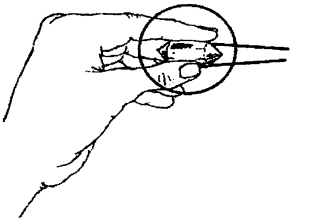


Figure 1.10. Emitting Qi from a Healing Stone

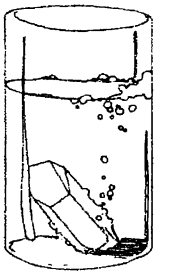


Figure 1.11. Magical Stones were used for creating Magical Tinctures and Elixirs

Magical stones can also be used to purge, tonify, or regulate the Qi and blood within body's internal organs, nervous system, endocrine system, circulatory system, digestive system, respiratory system, and reproductive system.

- **Magical Tinctures and Elixirs:** This category includes magical stones that are placed into purified water (i.e., stream, well, or rain) and used for creating alchemical tinctures or elixirs. The magical elixirs were then used to strengthen and enhance the priest's physical, energetic, or spiritual state (Figure 1.11).
- **Magical Energetic Fields:** This category includes magical stones that are used for creating a protective energetic grids. These powerful energetic grids can be used for purifying, healing, or protecting areas, and can also be used to create energetic fields that helped induce deep meditative states.

The Nine Palace Energetic Grid: The energy of the magical stones can be used to create a powerful magical canopy that envelops and protects any person, place, or thing (i.e., house, temple, etc.) existing within the magical grid's energetic boundaries. When creating

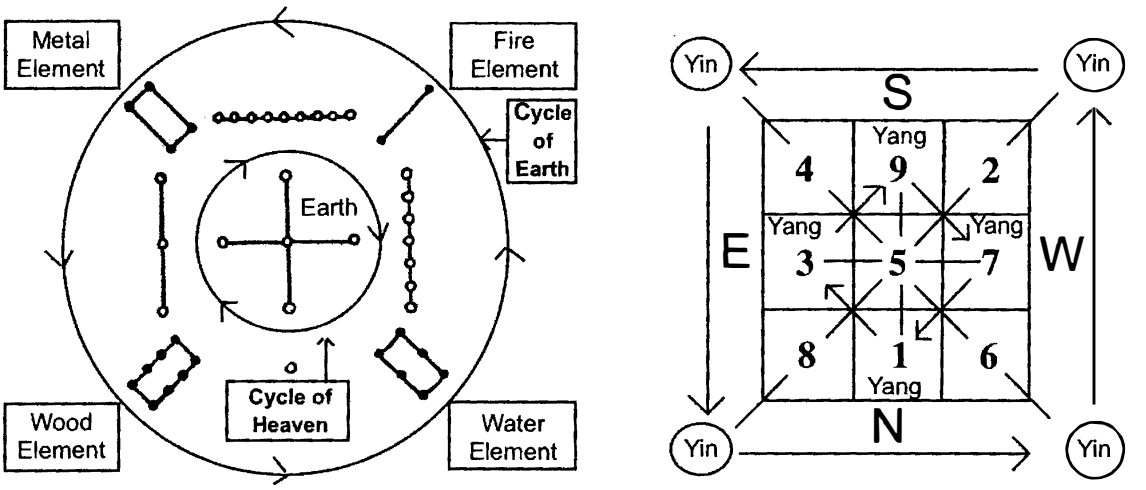


Figure 1.12. The energetic movement of the Nine Palaces of the Magic Square, according to the ancient Daoist design of the Luo River Graph

the protective Nine Palace energetic grid, nine pieces of either Fire Agate, Amber, Amethyst, Jade, or Jet were sometimes chosen as protective stones. These nine protective stones were then energetically imprinted as nine magical guardians. Each of the nine protective stones (i.e., nine pieces of Amethyst) were activated and then placed into one of the Nine Palace positions of the Magic Square, superimposed upon the property (Figure 1.12). The magical fields of the nine protective stones were then fused together and used in order to create an energetic net or magical fence. This magical fence was then fused to the Number Five position (also known as the Ming Tang or Bright Hall) on the property, which acted as the center pillar and Taiji Pole of the Magic Square. Next, the priest connected and fused the energy of the Number Five position to the celestial powers of the Heavens above, and rooted it to the Celestial Pole Star. The Number Five position was then anchored to the energetic field under the Earth, rooted to the Earth's center core (Figure 1.13).

These powerful energetic grids could also be used for purifying, healing, or protecting areas, and they could also be used to create an energetic field that helped induce deep meditative states.

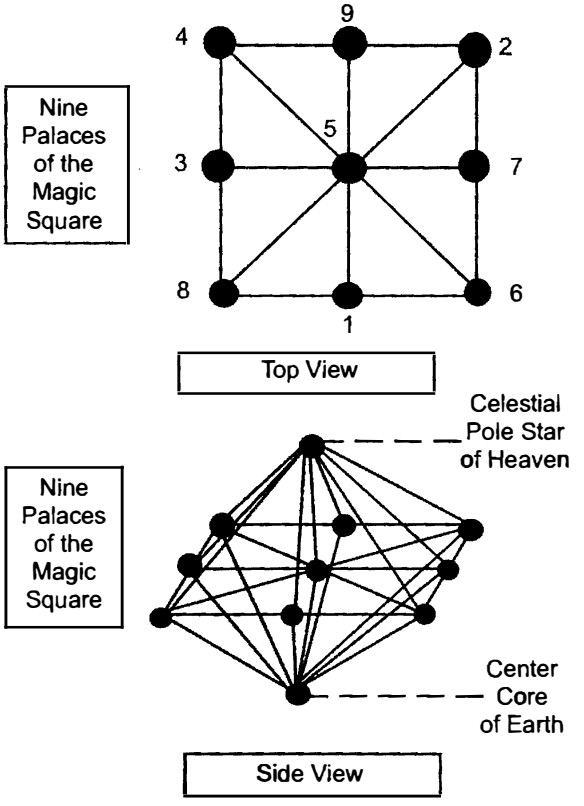


Figure 1.13. The energetic canopy of the Nine Palaces of the Magic Square

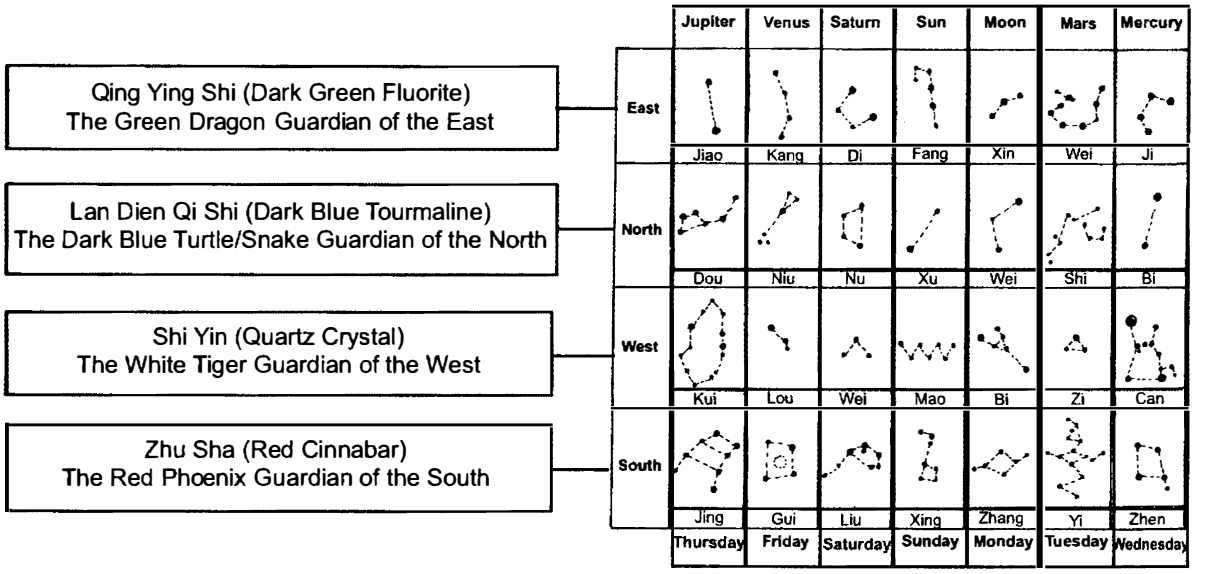


Figure 1.14. The Seven Divisions of the Twenty-Eight Star Constellations arranged according to the celestial energies of the Five Elements and the Sun and Moon

The Five Element Energetic Grid: When used as a protective energetic grid, the energy of the magical stones can be used to create five magical guardians that surround and protect any person, place, or thing (i.e., house, temple, etc.) existing within the magical stone's energetic boundaries. When creating the protective Five Element energetic grid, five magical stones are chosen to represent the magical power of the Five Elements. These Five Elements are then energized and placed on the property according to their assigned locations. Some examples of Five Element stones and their magical correspondences are described as follows:

Qing Ying Shi (Dark Green Fluorite): This magical stone is used to represent the Wood (Wood / Air) Element, and the Green Dragon Guardian of the East. The Guardian Dragon obliterates evil with its Celestial Wind that shreds spirit entities.

Zhu Sha (Red Cinnabar): This magical stone is used to represent the Fire Element, and the Red Phoenix Guardian of the South. The Guardian Phoenix consumes and destroys evil with its Celestial Fire and Divine Light.

Huang Bi Yu (Golden Yellow Jasper): This magical stone is used to represent the Earth Element, and the Golden Dragon Guardian of the Center. The central Guardian Dragon envelops and destroys evil with powerful rays of Divine Light emanating from the Celestial Pole Star.

Shi Yin (Quartz Crystal): This magical stone is used to represent the Metal (Wuji) Element, and the White Tiger Guardian of the West. The Guardian Tiger destroys evil with the powerful vibration of its Divine Roar.

Lan Dien Qi Shi (Dark Blue Tourmaline): This magical stone is used to represent the Water Element, and the Dark Blue / Black Turtle / Snake Guardian of the North. The Guardian Turtle / Snake envelops, consumes and dissolves evil with the power of its Celestial Waves.

After choosing five stones, the priest will then dedicate five sperate nights (one night per stone) for cleansing, purifying, imprinting, and activating each stone. This ancient practice is essential for activating and utilizing the magical power of each stone. During the ritual, each stone (i.e., Red Cinnabar) must be connected to a specific Element's magical power (i.e., Fire), a Guardian Animal (i.e., Phoenix), protective power (i.e., consume with Celestial Fire and destroy with

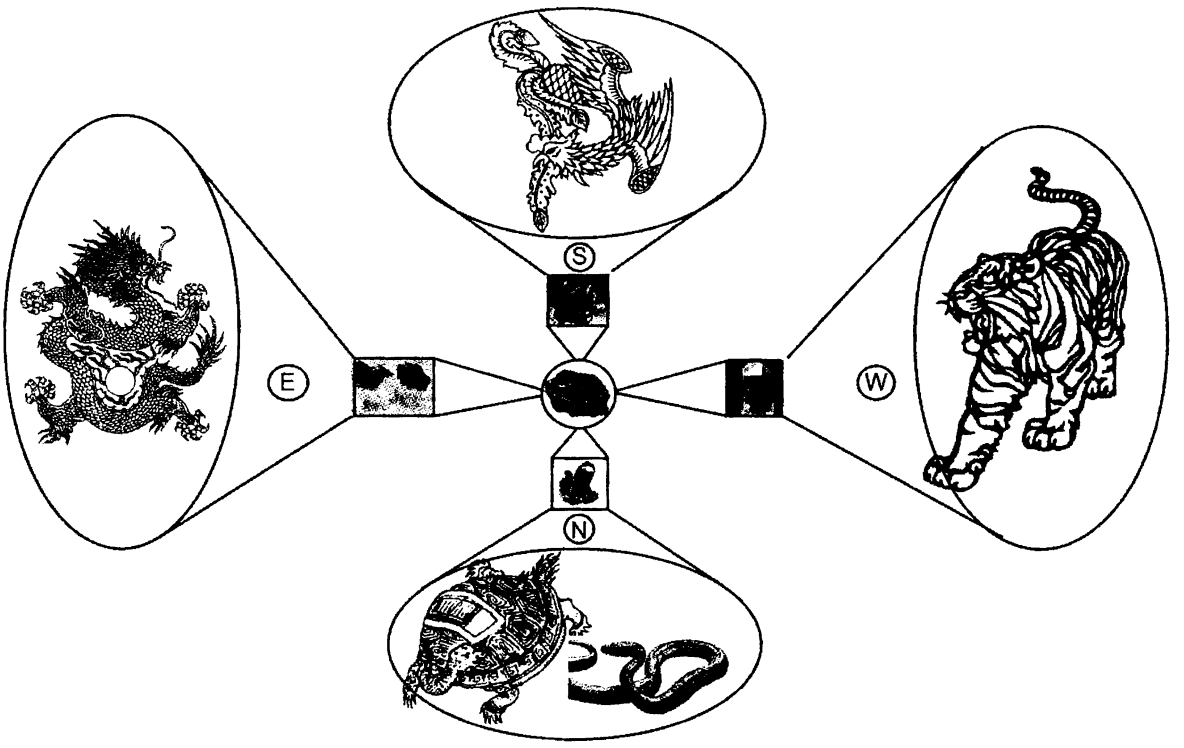


Figure 1.15. The Four Guardian Animals act as protectors of the property

Divine Light), Heavenly Direction (i.e., South) and Celestial Constellation (Figure 1.14).

After dedicating the magical stones, the priest will perform a summoning and protection ritual and then bury each magical stone at its corresponding directional location. Next, the priest will stand in the center of his or her property and connect all of the five guardians together, linking their magical powers with that of the center Golden Dragon. The center Golden Dragon acts as the priest's primary Guardian and the main guardian of the house and is energetically connected to the Celestial Pole Star and Big Dipper. The four directional guardians act as protectors of the property (Figure 1.15).

- **Divinations:** This category includes magical stones that are used for oracle casting (usually throwing 2 or 3 stones) in order to create the energetic patterns of the sixty-four hexagrams of the Yi-Jing. These resulting energetic patterns were then deciphered according to their specific trigram images.

Stones and the Five Elements

In ancient China, though sacred stones were seen as being part of the Mineral Realm, they were also believed to be physical manifestations of the Spirit Realm. The specific shape and design of every crystal, rock, and mountain formation was believed to correspond to the energetic structure and spiritual nature of one of the Five Elements. The understanding of these magical structures and their energetic influences created the ancient Daoist science of Feng Shui. This magical science is known to be the precursor to what is known in the West today as "Sacred Geometry" and "Geomancy."

The ancient Daoists believed that through the interaction of Wind, Fire, and Water, the formation of minerals and crystals were created in the womb of the Earth over millions of years. These rock formations were therefore believed to contain the life-force energy and magical powers of the Heavens and the Earth.

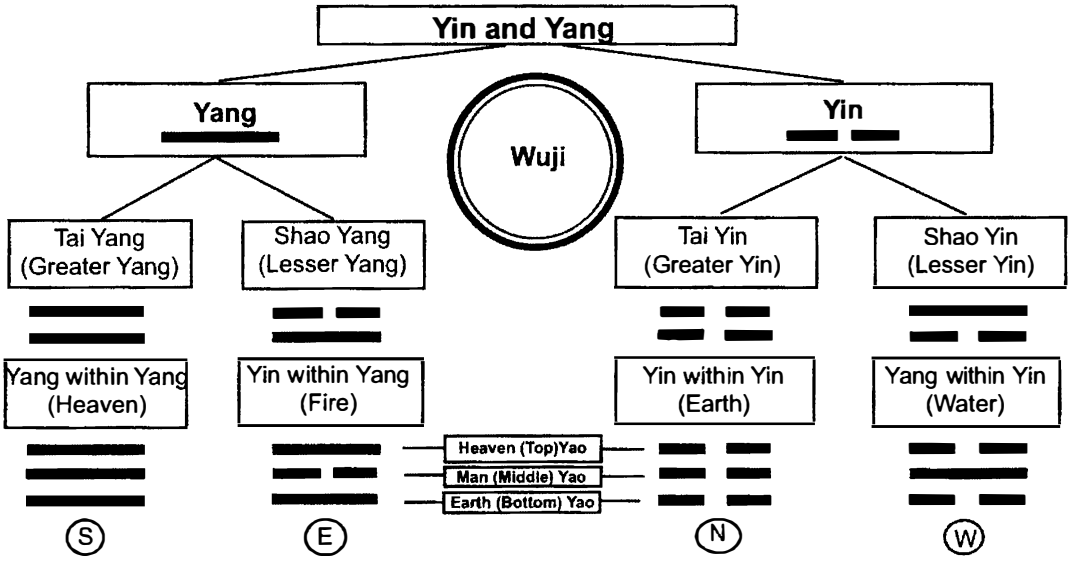


Figure 1.16. The Ancient Daoist Concept of Yin and Yang Expressing the Four Phases of Universal Energy

The ancient Daoists understood that the Dao creates Yin and Yang from the infinite space of the Wuji. Yin and Yang in turn give birth to four phases of universal energy: Great Yang, Lesser Yang, Great Yin, and Lesser Yin (Figure 1.16). These four phases of universal energy give birth to the eight natural forces of the Bagua (Heaven, Thunder, Water, Mountain, Earth, Wind, Fire, and Lake) symbolized by combinations of Yin and Yang lines (Yao).

Traditionally, a Yin line is represented as a broken line (- -), and a Yang line is represented as a solid line (---). A Yao Trigram is composed of three lines, constructed with either Yin Yaos, Yang Yaos, or a combination of both Yin and Yang Yaos. These eight prenatal and postnatal energetic actions act as a template for all creation and can be further combined in order to form the ever-changing energetic patterns of the 64 Hexagrams of the Yi-Jing.

The ancient Daoists also believed that all of creation took place due to the combination of the Five Elements, and that through these Elements "the ten-thousand things" were sustained. Each of these Five Elements permeates an individual's entire physical, energetic, and spiritual matrix.

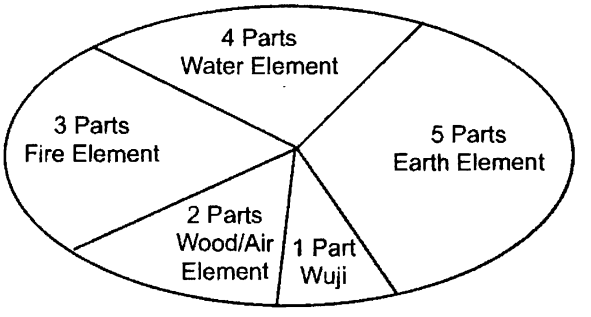


Figure 1.17. Within the creation of the Physical Body, the Five Elements can be organized in order of energetic progression, totaling 15 in number, which is the ancient Chinese number used to depict Man (as expressed in the Magic Square):
1 Part Infinite Space (Wuji),
2 Parts Wood/air (Feng) Element,
3 Parts Fire (Huo) Element,
4 Parts Water (Shui) Element,
5 Parts Earth (Di) Element.

For example, within the creation of the physical body, the Five Elements are organized in order of energetic progression; from the most subtle and refined vibrational states to the slower and denser vibrational states. Traditionally, the Five Elements are believed to be organized within the human

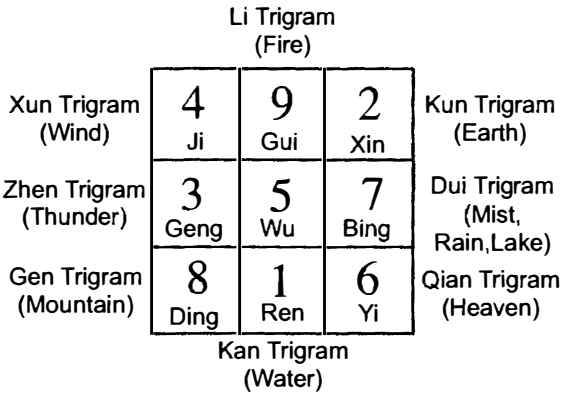


Figure 1.18. The Lou Shu Magic Square. Each of the four corner Yin squares correspond to Earth (20); Each of the center Yang squares correspond to Heaven (20); each line drawn through the Magic Square corresponds to Man (15).

body as follows: 1 part Infinite Space (Wuji), 2 parts Wood/Air, 3 parts Fire, 4 parts Water, and 5 parts Earth (Figure 1.17). The sum total of these Element number combinations is 15, which also corresponds to the Chinese number used to depict Man, as expressed in the ancient image of Lou Shu Magic Square (Figure 1.18).

The ancient Five Element Theory sees the Elements as stages in a vast energetic continuum in which each successive Element is derived from its predecessor. This energetic template is described as follows (Figure 1.19):

1. **The Wuji (Metal-Space):** The first Element to evolve from the Dao is associated with the infinite space existing within all matter, and is known as the Wuji. This is the most subtle of the Five Elements and is considered to be the energetic space or spiritual matrix in which to house Qi. This Element is simultaneously considered to be the energetic field from which everything within the universe manifests and the energetic space in which all events occur.

   The energetic and spiritual nature of the Wuji is all pervading, limitless, and motionless. It controls the energetic space surrounding the organs and tissues and is also believed to be the conveyor of sound.

   The infinite space of the Wuji diffuses the movements of light (physical, energetic, and

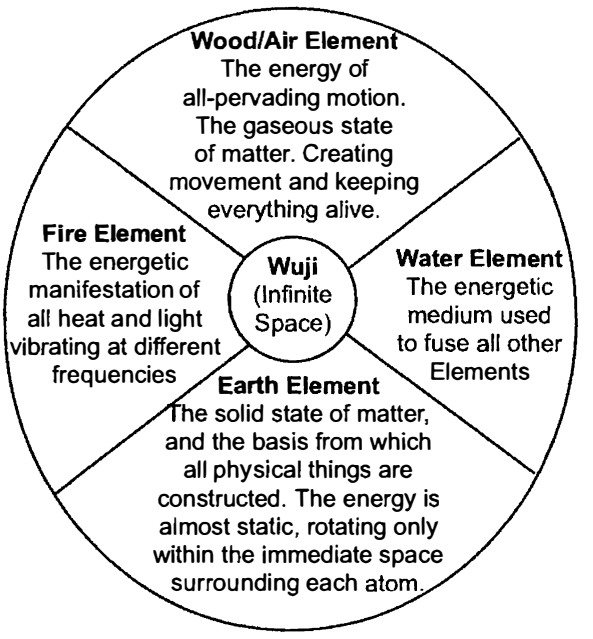


Figure 1.19. In Daoist Rituals used for empowering magical stone tools, the priest uses the powers of the four Elements in order to imprint the energetic matrix of the stone.

spiritual) simultaneously in all directions. Therefore, when a priest has mastered the energetic and spiritual nature of this Element, his or her mind has the ability to transcend beyond time to perceive the past, present, and future.

2. **The Wood/Air Element (Yang):** As the energy inherent within the infinite space begins to vibrate, movement is created, and the next Element emerges in the form of Wood/Air. The energetic particles of the Wood/Air Element have greater movement; therefore, the Wood/Air Element is seen as an Element of all-pervading motion. The Wood/Air Element is also associated with the gaseous state of matter, creating movement and keeping everything alive.

   The Wood/Air Element manifests as kinetic energy in all its diverse forms (organic, electrical, and chemical). Through expansion and contraction, the innate energetic movement

of the Wood/Air Element stimulates and controls the energetic functions of the body's various internal organ systems.

Therefore, when a priest has mastered the energetic and spiritual nature of the Wood/Air Element, he or she will have the ability to extend his or her perceptions beyond the limitations of the five physical senses and discern the subtle sensations of the higher spiritual realms. Such expanded perceptions include the movements of subtle energetic flows occurring within and around the priest's three bodies (physical body, energetic body, and spiritual body).

3. **The Fire Element (Yang):** As the energy of the Wood/Air Element continues to move, the excess motion generates heat, and the next Element emerges in the form of Fire. The Fire Element is associated with the heat and light of an energetic substance, however, it has no physical form.

   When the Fire Element arises as light, it is considered to be first obvious (easily perceivable) form of energetic manifestation. Light is energy vibrating at different frequencies, which can be perceived as various colors. Therefore, the Fire Element represents the energetic and spiritual quality that gives definition, color, and form to the various types of Qi manifestations occurring within the Wood/Air Element.

4. **The Water Element (Yin):** The Fire Element's movement of energy is less active than that of the Wood/Air Element. This decrease of motion enables the Fire Element to dispel part of its radiant heat, and it cools to form the next Element, which emerges in the form of Water. The Water Element is associated with the liquid state of matter, and it provides the cohesive medium that enables the other Elements to fuse. However, with the birth of the Water Element, the complete freedom of movement of the Wood/Air Element and the partial freedom of movement of the Fire Element are lost, since the particles of these Elements are now confined within a definite space (now only moving within a small radius).

   The Water Element can be described as a vast quantity of intensely active matter that has begun to emerge out of the Fire Element. However, since the atoms and molecules resonating within the Water Element are still in a state of chaos, this type of matter has not yet begun to gather into cohesive and separate bodies.

5. **The Earth Element (Yin):** The last Element to form evolves out of a further decrease in energetic vibration, which causes the Water Element to solidify into the Earth Element. Within the Earth Element, even the limited movement of the Water Element is lost. Each particle of the Earth Element has its own assigned place, and any vibration within this Element is confined to the specific space it occupies. The Earth Element is associated with form and the solid state of matter, and it is the basis on which all physical things are built.

   The lower frequency of the Earth Element provides stability. The energy within this state appears almost static, rotating only within the immediate space surrounding each atom. At this energetic state, Qi manifests as matter, whether in its solid, liquid, or gaseous form.

THE THREE PRIMARY LAWS

The study of the Five Elements centers around understanding the "Three Primary Laws." These three laws govern the Five Elements and give the priest access to the magical template of creation.

In order to understand the Three Primary Laws, it is important to first understand that the energetic pattern of each of the Five Elements is held together through the conscious will of the Divine Mind, which takes the primary role in the formation of matter.

According to ancient Five Element theory, the continuous interaction of the energy (Qi) of these Five Elements manifests through two opposite and interdependent energetic forces called Yin and Yang. These two energetic powers create and manifest a duality of energetic interactions within each Element (Figure 1.20).

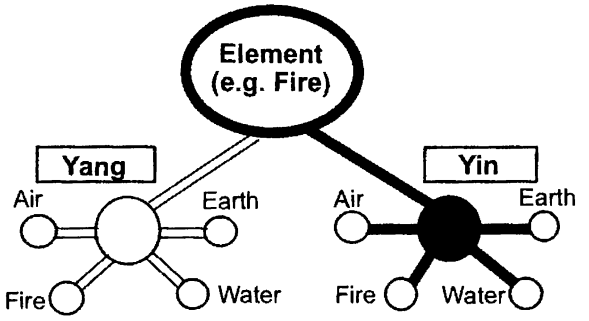


Figure 1.20. Each Element includes two equal parts; the second part of each Element is further divided into four equal parts for a total of eight energetic manifestations.

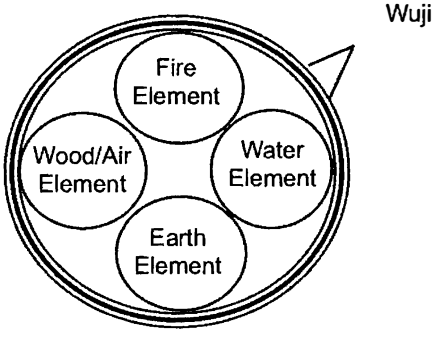


Figure 1.21. Each Element Stands Alone

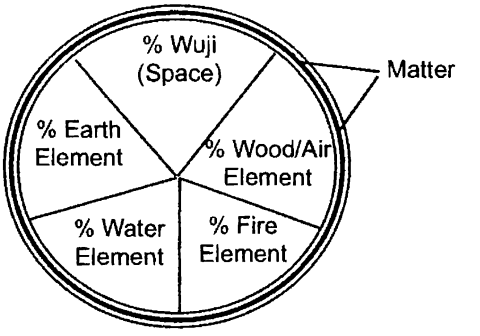


Figure 1.22. Everything Contains Each of the Five Elements

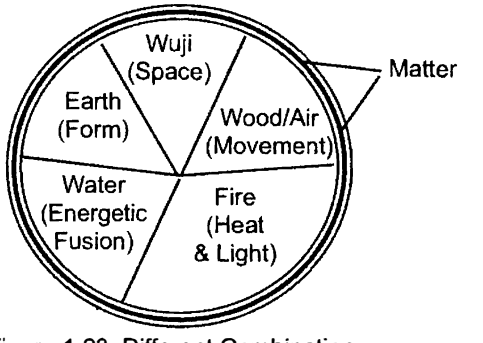


Figure 1.23. Different Combinations Produce Different Manifestations

The ancient Daoists believed that by mastering these Five Elements, they could bind (contain and control), release (free), or transmute (alchemically transformation matter into energy, and energy into spirit) all things in nature. This could be done spiritually, energetically, or even physically, according to the priest's magical skill and ability. The Three Primary Laws of the Five Elements are described as follows:

1. **Each Element Stands Alone:** Each individual Element contains specific powers and patterns the are unique to that Element. This includes specific physical, energetic, and spiritual properties characteristic to each individual Element's manifestation (Figure 1.21).
2. **Everything Contains Each of the Five Elements:** Each substance, whether material or immaterial, is composed of varying proportions of each of the Five Elements (Figure 1.22).
3. **Different Combinations Produce Different Manifestations:** The differences in the textures and compositions of all material or immaterial things are due to differences in the specific Element combinations that form, create, and maintain that item's spiritual, energetic, and physical matrix. The predominance of the Fire Element, for example, gives an item heat and light and makes it active (Figure 1.23).

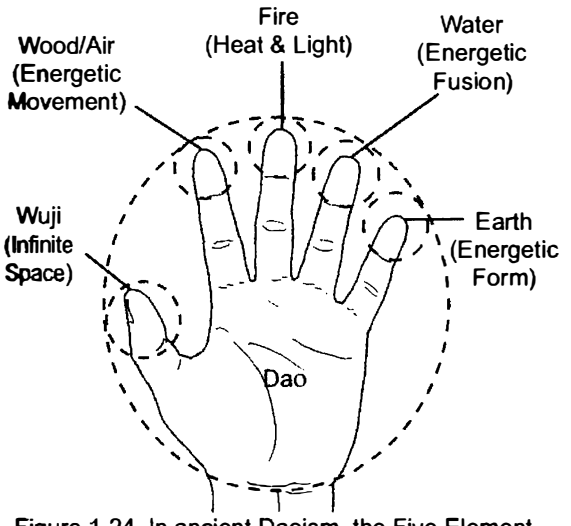


Figure 1.24. In ancient Daoism, the Five Element Hand Seal was commonly used in order to access and command the various ancient Elements

COMBINING THE FIVE ELEMENT PATTERNS

As previously stated, the ancient Daoists used the Five Element Theory in order to explain the energetic transformations that occurred within the various stages of all life. They observed, that the differences in the textures and compositions of all material or immaterial things were due to the differences in the specific Element combinations that formed, created, and maintained that item's spiritual, energetic, and physical matrix.

When performing certain magic rituals, the priest could choose to utilize his or her left Five Element Hand Seal, in order to represent the subtle states and energetic combinations contained within the esoteric matrix of all creations (Figure 1.24).

When necessary, the Daoist priest could also use both left and right Five Element Hand Seals in conjunction with each other, in order to create 36 separate magical patterns. For example:

Right Hand - Dao & Left Hand - Dao
Right Hand - Dao & Left Hand - Wuji
Right Hand - Dao & Left Hand - Wood / Air
Right Hand - Dao & Left Hand - Fire
Right Hand - Dao & Left Hand - Water
Right Hand - Dao & Left Hand - Earth

Right Hand - Wuji & Left Hand - Dao
Right Hand - Wuji & Left Hand - Wuji
Right Hand - Wuji & Left Hand - Wood / Air
Right Hand - Wuji & Left Hand - Fire
Right Hand - Wuji & Left Hand - Water
Right Hand - Wuji & Left Hand - Earth

Right Hand - Wood / Air & Left Hand - Dao
Right Hand - Wood / Air & Left Hand - Wuji
Right Hand - Wood / Air & Left Hand - Wood / Air
Right Hand - Wood / Air & Left Hand - Fire
Right Hand - Wood / Air & Left Hand - Water
Right Hand - Wood / Air & Left Hand - Earth

Right Hand - Fire & Left Hand - Dao
Right Hand - Fire & Left Hand - Wuji
Right Hand - Fire & Left Hand - Wood / Air
Right Hand - Fire & Left Hand - Fire
Right Hand - Fire & Left Hand - Water
Right Hand - Fire & Left Hand - Earth

Right Hand - Water & Left Hand - Dao
Right Hand - Water & Left Hand - Wuji
Right Hand - Water & Left Hand - Wood / Air
Right Hand - Water & Left Hand - Fire
Right Hand - Water & Left Hand - Water
Right Hand - Water & Left Hand - Earth

Right Hand - Earth & Left Hand - Dao
Right Hand - Earth & Left Hand - Wuji
Right Hand - Earth & Left Hand - Wood / Air
Right Hand - Earth & Left Hand - Fire
Right Hand - Earth & Left Hand - Water
Right Hand - Earth & Left Hand - Earth

Each of these Five Element Hand Seal Combinations also correspond to a special Five Element Sound (Incantation), Color, and Deity.

FIVE CATEGORIES OF MANIFESTATION

When focusing on the magical power and influence of minerals and stones, their energetic effect can be divided into five categories, described as follows:

- **Physical:** The physical level of a stone's vibration is governed by the Earth Element
- **Energetic:** The energetic level of stone's vibration is governed by the Water Element

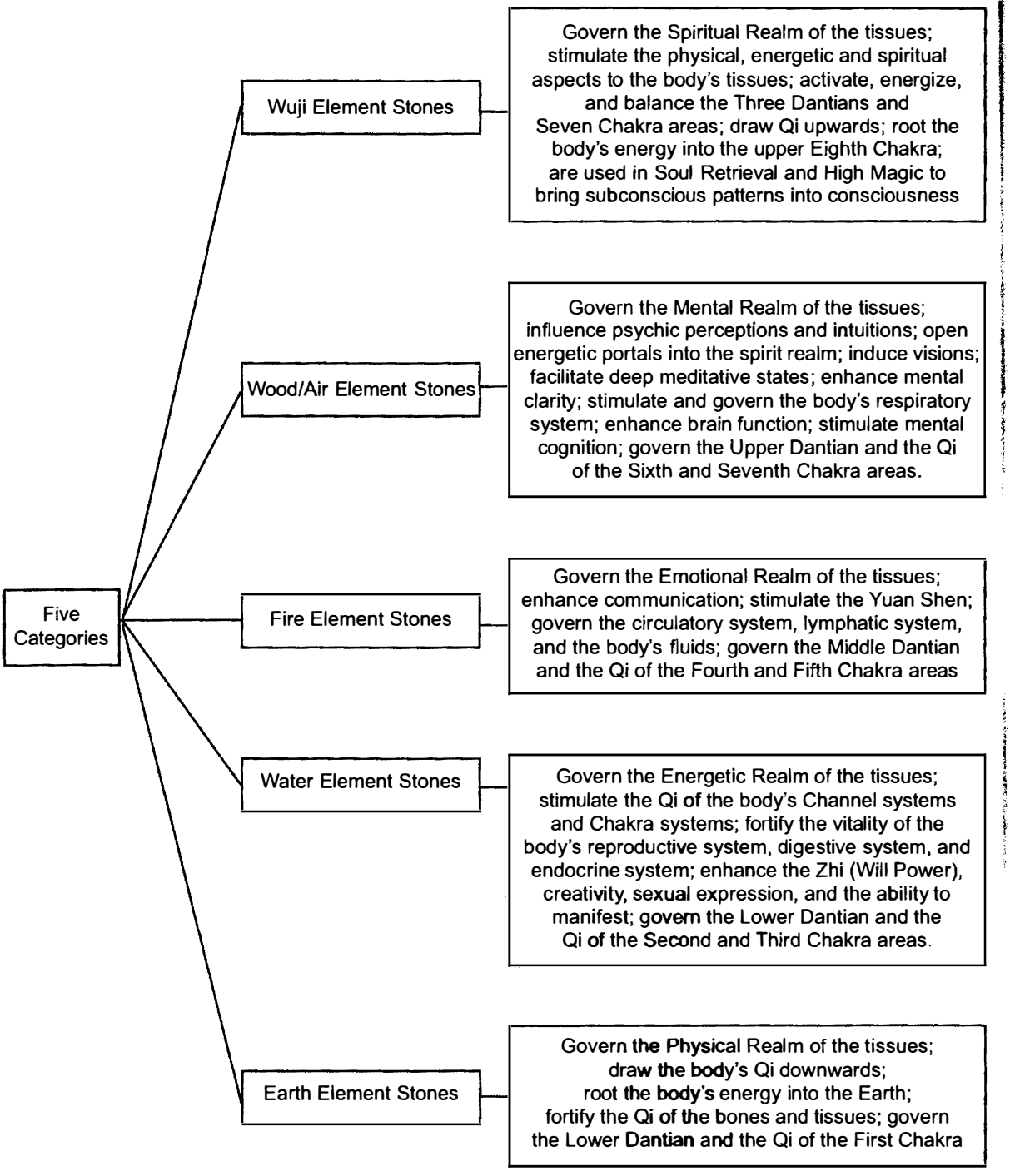


Figure 1.25. Five Categories of Manifestation

- **Emotional:** The emotional level of stone's vibration is governed by the Fire Element
- **Mental:** The intellectual level of stone's vibration is governed by the Wind Element
- **Spiritual:** The spiritual level of the stone's vibration is governed by the infinite space of the Wuji

The following are some examples of some of the energetic influences through which the various Five Element stones manifest, and some of the energetic centers that they stimulate (Figure 1.25):

- **Earth Element Stones:** These magical stones stimulate and balance the energy of the body's Lower Dantian and First Chakra (located at the base of the perineum). Earth Element stones are also used in order to draw the body's energetic field downward, rooting the Qi into the lower Ninth Chakra (Earthly Transpersonal Point) located below the bottom of the feet (about a foot underneath the ground). On a more physical level, Earth Element Stones fortify the vitality of the body's bones and tissues.
- **Water Element Stones:** These magical stones stimulate the energy of the body's channel system (Eight Extraordinary Vessels and Twelve Primary Channels), and they fortify the vitality of the body's Chakra system. On a physical level, Water Element Stones fortify the vitality of the body's reproductive system (used for treating sexual dysfunctions, enhancing fertility, and inducing passion), endocrine system (used for balancing hormones and treating glandular dysfunctions), and the digestive system (used for treating the body's metabolism). Water Element Stones enhance the energetic ability of how to use the Zhi (will power), creativity, sexual expression and the ability to manifest. The Water Element governs the energy of the Lower Dantian, the Second Chakra (located at the navel area), and the Third Chakra (also known as the Yellow Court, located at the Solar Plexus area). Water Element Stones are sometimes used in order to treat the lymphatic system and the fluids of the body, and for treating fear induced sleep deprivation.
- **Fire Element Stones:** These magical stones enhance communication and stimulate the energy of the body's Yuan Shen. The natural expression of the Yuan Shen is the spiritual communication of the True Self (Eternal Soul). On a more physical level, Fire Element stones stimulate and govern the body's circulatory system. The Fire Element governs the energy of the Middle Dantian, the Fourth Chakra (located at the heart area), and the Fifth Chakra (located at the throat area). Fire Element Stones are sometimes used in order to assist in maintaining emotional balance as well as for alleviating depression.
- **Wood/Air Element Stones:** These magical stones govern psychic perceptions and intuitions, and they are often used in order to open energetic portals into the spirit realm. Wood / Air Element stones are used to induce visions, facilitate deep meditative states, and enhance mental clarity. On a more physical level, Wind Element stones stimulate and govern the body's respiratory system, enhance brain function, and stimulate mental cognition. The Wood / Air Element governs the energy of the Upper Dantian, the Sixth Chakra (located at the Third Eye), and the Seventh Chakra (located at the top of the head).
- **Wuji Stones:** These magical stones are considered to be a synchronistic combination of the energetic powers and vibrational frequencies to the other four Elements. Wuji stones stimulate the physical, energetic, and spiritual aspects to the body's tissues, and can be used in order to stimulate any of the Three Dantians or Seven Chakra areas. These magical stones are particularly known for their ability to stimulate and balance the energy of the body's Upper Dantian and Seventh Chakra (located at the top of the head). Wuji stones are also used in order to draw the body's energetic field upward, rooting the body's Qi into the upper Eighth Chakra (Heavenly Transpersonal Point) located about a foot above the top of the head (Figure 1.26). Commonly used in Soul Retrieval and High Magic, Wuji stones can also be used in order to assist the priest

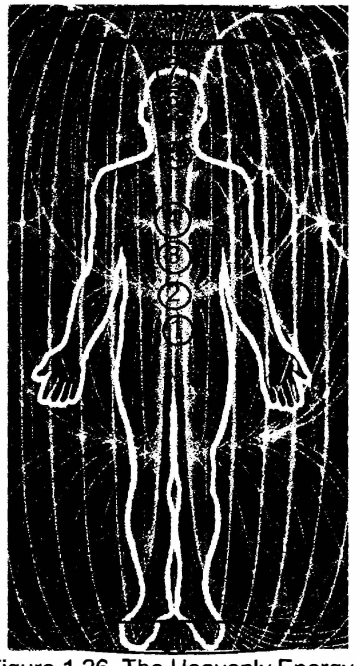


Figure 1.26. The Heavenly Energy is received through the Eighth Chakra.

in bringing deep seated subconscious patterns into the light of conscious awareness. Because of their immense power, Wuji stones are generally only used for short periods of time in order to induce radical states of transformation (energetic, emotional, or spiritual), to cleanse, or to balance.

Stones and Colors

Each of the Five Elements is energetically present, in varying degrees, within each of the body's internal organs, tissues, and cells. In order to stimulate the energy within the body's tissues and cells, specific colors and Elements are sometimes introduced into a individual's energy field via a magic stone. Through focused intention, a priest can project his or her energy through a specific colored stone into the tissues and influence the energetic movement of the body's Qi.

For example, Fluorite is a Wood / Air Element stone and can be used in order to govern the Mental Realm of the tissues. However, the actual energetic influence it will have on the body's internal organs and tissues depends on the specific color of Fluorite that is used and the area on the body where it is introduced. Examples of how different colors of the same stone (in this case Fluorite) can be used to affect the body include the following:

- Purple Fluorite can be used in order to stimulate the Wind Element inside of the Kidneys and Urinary Bladder organs. When placed on the Upper Dantian and Third Eye area, it can be used as an energetic amplifier to enhance psychic perceptions and intuitions, stimulate the Upper Dantian, enhance brain function, induce visions, and facilitate deep meditative states. For healing, Purple Fluorite can be placed onto the Lower Dantian and Mingmen areas in order to treat the kidneys, bones, and bone marrow disorders.
- Green Fluorite can be used in order to stimulate the Wind Element inside of the Liver and Gall Bladder organs. It can also be used to ground excess Qi and dissipate emotional trauma (i.e., anger and hostility released from the Liver). For healing, Green Fluorite can be useful for relieving stomach pains and cramps caused from the Qi stagnation (i.e., as a result of Liver Qi attacking the Spleen).
- Pink Fluorite can be used in order to stimulate the Wind Element inside of the Heart and Small Intestine organs. It can be used to cleanse and heal the emotions, harmonize the heart with the mind, and activate the "seat of the soul" (located deep within the Heart, Middle Dantian, and Taiji Pole area).
- Yellow Fluorite can be used in order to stimulate the Wind Element inside of the Spleen and Stomach organs. This stone is especially used for improving intelligence and awakening the memory (in Chinese medicine, the energy of the spleen organ in associated with memory). For healing, Yellow Fluorite is useful for releasing toxins from the tissues, and it was used in ancient China to aid the energetic movement of Liver Qi.
- White or Clear Fluorite can be used in order to stimulate the Wind Element inside of the Lungs and Large Intestine organs and to govern the body's respiratory system. This stone is especially useful for cleansing the spirit, stimulating the Qi of Upper Dantian, and energizing the body's Wei Qi fields. White or Clear Fluorite is sometimes used to calm the Po and

harmonize the Shen (mind and the emotions), thereby allowing the Yuan Shen (Original Spirit) to settle into a state of quiescence.

TYPES OF COLORED STONES

According to ancient Daoist teachings, the color of an animal, plant, or stone was believed to reveal its secret magical characteristics and attributes. The following are some examples of treatment stones and the T.C.M. organs that respond to their energetic Influence (Figure 1.27):

- **Green Gemstones:** This category corresponds to the beginning of new life. It was believed that the mysterious substance that makes all plant life green was derived from the supreme source of life, and is reflected in such stones as green jade, emerald, peridot, tsavorite, chrome tourmaline, chrome diopside, and other natural green gems. The green colored gem stones can be used to treat the tissues of the Wood Element orb (tendons, ligaments, small muscles, peripheral nerves, eyes, vision, tears, bile, nails, and external genitalia), as well as the liver and gall bladder organs and channels.
- **Red Gemstones:** This category corresponds to the "fire of life," and includes such stones as rubies and other natural red gems. The deep red colored gem stones are believed to be powerfully impregnated with "soul-substance," and can be used to treat the tissues of the Fire Element orb (blood vessels, complexion, perspiration, and the tongue), as well as the heart, small intestine, pericardium, and triple burners organs and channels.
- **Yellow Gemstones:** This category corresponds to the Earth (Yellow-Brown), and the vital energy of the Sun (Golden Yellow). It includes such stones as yellow sapphires, topaz, citrine, heliodor, and other flawless yellow gems. The light yellow or golden colored gem stones can be used to treat the tissues of the Earth Element orb (large muscles, lymph, saliva secretions, mouth, lips, and taste), as well as the spleen and stomach organs and channels.
- **White Gemstones:** This category corresponds to the Heavens (Clear and Transparent), and the vital energy of the Clouds, the Moon, and Stars (White). It, includes such stones as clear diamonds, quartz crystals, zircons, goshenites, white topaz, white sapphires, and other colorless gemstones with clear transparency. The white or clear colored gem stones can be used to treat the tissues of the Metal Element orb (skin and mucous membranes, body hair, nose, and the sense of smell), as well as the lungs and large intestine organs and channels.
- **Black or Dark Blue Gemstones:** This category corresponds to the colors of both the sky and water. It includes such stones as onyx, blue sapphire, blue spinel, tanzanite, indicolite, iolite, amethyst and other natural blue to violet gems with transparent clarity. The black, dark blue or violet colored gem stones can be used to treat the tissues of the Water Element orb (brain, inner ear, hearing, spinal cord, cerebrospinal fluid, bones, bone marrow, ovaries, testes, head and pubic hair, anus, urethra and sexual fluids), as well as the kidneys and urinary bladder organs and channels.

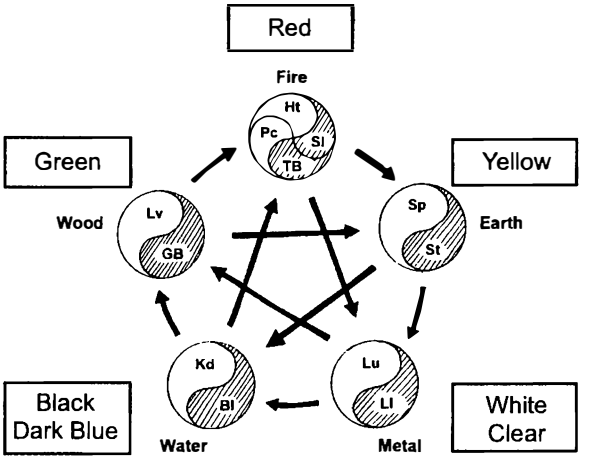


Figure 1.27. The Five Precious Gems of the Five Elements

COLORED STONES AND IMPERIAL RANK

The following are some examples of colored stones and precious metals used in ancient China in order to indicate imperial rank. According to the ancient insignia of Imperial Rank, the official classification and division of imperial position within the Chinese empire was organized as follows:

1st Rank: The superior division of 1st Rank was recognized by the officials Red Ruby button and hat insignia jewel (which was later changed to opaque red glass). The clasp that the officials wore was ornamented jade, set with rubies.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a white crane;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Qilin (unicorn).

2nd Rank: The superior division of 2nd Rank was recognized by the Red Coral button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to opaque red glass) with the Chinese character "Sou" (meaning a wise old man) engraved in its center. The clasp that the officials wore was ornamented gold, set with rubies.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Golden Pheasant;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Indian Lion.

3rd Rank: The superior division of 3rd Rank was recognized by the Blue Sapphire button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to clear blue glass). The clasp that the officials wore was ornamented gold.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Peafowl;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a North China Panther.

4th Rank: The middle division of 4th Rank was recognized by the Blue Lapis Lazuli button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to opaque blue glass). The clasp that the officials wore was ornamented gold, with a silver button.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Wild Goose;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Manchurian Tiger.

5th Rank: The middle division of 5th Rank was recognized by the Clear Quartz button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to clear glass). The clasp that the officials wore was plain gold, with a silver button.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Silver Pheasant;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Black Bear.

6th Rank: The middle division of 6th Rank was recognized by the White Adularia (also White Jade or Moonstone) button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to opaque white glass). The clasp that the officials wore was mother-of-pearl.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with an Eastern Egret;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Mottled Bear.

7th Rank: The lower division of 7th Rank was recognized by the plain Gold button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to a gold plated orb). The clasp that the officials wore was silver.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Mandarin Duck;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Tiger-Cat.

8th Rank: The lower division of 8th Rank was recognized by the ornamented Gold button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to gold plated orb) with the Chinese character "Sou" (meaning a wise old man) engraved in its center. The clasp that the officials wore was clear horn.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Quail;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Seal.

9th Rank: The lower division of 9th Rank was recognized by the ornamented Silver button and hat insignia jewel. The clasp that the officials wore was buffalo-horn.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a long-tailed Jay;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Rhinocros.

LAPIDARY: THE SECRET POWERS OF ROCKS AND GEMS

The ancient Chinese were among the first to understand and record the subtle energetic powers of precious stones and attribute magic virtues to them. Historically, understanding how to use the magical powers contained within each stone was generally kept hidden from the public and passed on only from the tribal shaman to his or her acolytes. This esoteric information and experience was then shared among shamans of different tribes, at periodic intertribal gatherings.

Ancient Chinese folklore contains many stories that have been uncovered and reconfirmed by historians regarding the magical powers of stones and the incredible feats accomplished by the Daoist priests who wielded them. These magical properties remained imprinted within the conscious and subconscious minds of the priest's disciples. The mysterious techniques of these esoteric properties were eventually handed down to future generations in the course of time (sometimes in writing). These mystical writings or esoteric manuals are considered "lapidaries."

A "Lapidary" is a secret list of power-stones that a priest uses as his magical tools. It is considered to be his or her personal workbook, containing important formulas for gem elixirs and certain magical incantations that activate the specific powers of each stone.

The priest's lapidary is generally divided into specific categories that deal with each stone's magical qualities and it's manifold properties (e.g., the stones specific healing, martial and/or spiritual natures). According to the times in which they were written and the nationality of their authors, each lapidary may differ, varying in length, scope of intention and practice, and in structural criteria. In terms of content, each lapidary will generally be inspired by esoteric works, magic, the occult sciences, or medicine.

The Eastern lapidaries (primarily those of China or India), are fundamentally magical, even though they also consider the intrinsic qualities of the stones, such as their commercial value, their fine points (clarity, color, etc.), and their defects (inclusions, impurities, etc.).

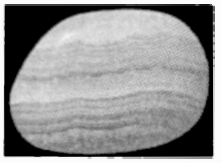
MAGICAL STONES USED IN DAOIST ALCHEMY

Back in the early 1970's, when I first began studying the energetic properties of Chinese medical herbs and minerals, one of my teachers, Dr. Yao, explicitly detailed the various reasons why I should also be studying American herbal therapy and the specific herbs and minerals indigenous to the area where I was living. He explained,

"Johnson, you don't live in China. If you want to be a powerful healer, you must first study the energetic and spiritual properties of the animals, plants, and minerals of where you live. The sickness that exists in the mountains is different from the sickness that exists by the ocean; the energy within the animals, plants, and minerals living within the mountains are different from the energy within the animals, plants, and minerals living by the ocean. As a healer, you must learn how to observe, gather, and utilize the natural energetic properties of the animals, plants, and minerals existing within the surrounding environment, and within the specific area where you live."

In Daoist Magic, when a priest is constructing a particular herb or mineral formula for blessing (e.g., gathering a specific type of energy, money, land or position of power, healing, etc.) or cursing (e.g., destroying a specific type of energy, binding and restricting, bringing bad-luck, sickness, or death) he or she will generally follow the magical rule of correspondence that states "like attracts like." Therefore, the priest will sometimes choose various colored stones to represent the magical correspondence of certain Elemental powers. For example, a bright and translucent stones can sometimes be used in order to bring healing light and clarity into someone's life; additionally, specific types of dark stones can also be chosen to bring darkness or "shadow spirits" into someone's life. The determining factor is the priest's intention.

The following is an alphabetical list of some of the most commonly used magical gems and minerals found in several ancient and modern Chinese and Western magical traditions. The compilation of this lapidary is meant to educate the reader as to the many energetic potentials ascribed to these magical stones.



Water Element

Figure 1.28. Blue Laced Agate (Lan Dai Ma Nao)

Fire Element

Figure 1.29. Fire Agate (Huo Ma Nao)

AGATE (MA NAO)

The swirling, luminescent Agate can be brownish red, orange, blue or green in color. Agates, generally known as Ma Nao in China, are considered to be stones of lower energetic intensity, that resonate at slower vibrational frequencies then other magical stones. They have a stabilizing and strengthening effect on the body's energetic fields. Each of the various colors have different magical powers.

- **Blue Laced Agate (Lan Dai Ma Nao):** This stone is connected to the Water Element, and it stimulates the Fifth Chakra (throat). Lan Dai Ma Nao (also known as Blue Laced Agate) is banded in intricate patterns of light blue and white (Figure 1.28). Working in a slow and steady manner, Blue Laced Agate is believed to be a wonderful healing stone. It enhances deeper spiritual connection and allows for deeper brain connections (i.e., the more primitive levels of the brain that enhance neural connections relating to modes of expression, quicker decisions and more expressive information transfer).

  By activating and healing the Fifth Chakra (throat), Blue Laced Agate can be used to assist with the verbal expression of thoughts and feelings, and it is commonly used with spoken affirmations (e.g., it amplifies the power of the priest's spoken intention via the Qi of the throat).

  Blue Laced Agate is sometimes placed on the Third Eye to soothe and calm an overactive mind, and counteract mental stress. In the clinic, Blue Laced Agate has been used to treat inflammation of the throat (i.e., hyperactive thymus or thyroid glands, sore throat, laryngitis, and swollen glands).

  Couples should meditate with Blue Laced Agate for 15 minutes just before communicating over delicate topics of conversation. This will allow for more clarity and for easing relationship difficulties.

  Recharging Lan Dai Ma Nao: As the moon begins to wax (increase in size), use moonlight to recharge Blue Lace Agate.

- **Fire Agate (Huo Ma Nao):** This magical stone is connected to the Fire Element (Figure 1.29), its ruling planet is Mars, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian (First and Second Chakras), Middle Dantian, and Yellow Court (Third Chakra) areas. Favored for its iridescent appearance, some priest's believe Huo Ma Nao (also known as Fire Agate) contains the essence of fire, and is the physical manifestation of the absolute spiritual flame. Fire Agate is used to stimulate and strengthen the body's Three Fires: the Imperial Fire located in the heart, the Mingmen Fire located between the kidneys, and the Common Peoples Fire located at the base of the perineum.

  The ancient Chinese believed that the blood of evil demons gives rise to the red color in Fire Agate. Therefore Fire Agate was used by the ancient Chinese to amplify the magical power of incense burning and candle magic.

  Fire Agate that is Brownish-Orange in color is credited with protective powers that fight against all kinds of evil. The orange and red glow in Fire Agate is believed to be the most powerful energetic projection of the magical stone.

  Fire Agate has a deep connection to the Earth and its energy is used for protection and building an energy field around the body. It is believed that the red fire inside the Agate provides a protective shield that banishes evil creatures and spirit entities, sending them back to their source. Fire Agate clears the energetic blockages inside the physical body and naturally purges the body's three Wei Qi fields. It also stimulates sexual energy, increases stamina and blood circulation, and is sometimes used to treat sexual imbalances.

It resonates with the Triple Burner channel (responsible for digestion and elimination) and can be used to bring the Triple Burner channel into balance. Holding onto Fire Agate encourages introspection, effortlessly bringing up one's problems for emotional and mental resolution.

Fire Agate is considered to be a master enhancer of all flower essences and a master healing stone when used in conjunction with color therapy. It benefits the entire endocrine system and stimulates tissue regeneration by restimulating cellular memory. It stimulates appropriate mitosis and longer cell division.

Recharging Huo Ma Nao: Pass Fire Agate through the flame of the left red altar candle in order to recharge its energy.

- **Moss Agate (Qing Tai Ma Nao):** This stone is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.30), and it stimulates the Lower Dantian (First Chakra) and Middle Dantian (Heart and Fourth Chakra) areas. Qing Tai Ma Nao (also known as Moss Agate) can be used as a talisman for increasing the effectiveness of the Yi (Intention). For example, when meditating on Moss Agate, the priest can project the image of a completed project or goal into the stone, the stone will then magnify the energy of the priest's intention resulting in manifesting the desired goal. Because of its ability to accelerate the growth in plants, it is sometimes used in Plant Magic to increase the priest's ability to understand the magical properties of herbs, flowers, and trees.

Moss Agate is strongly connected to Earth energy, nature, and the spirit realm, and is commonly used by priests to stimulate psychic contact with Elementals (spirits entities that dwell within the Air, Water, Fire and Earth) and Nature Spirits (spirits of mountains, forests, rivers, trees, and rocks). Because of its magical connection to the spirit realm, and its ability to open up energetic portals, Moss Agate is often used in Weather Magic in order to create storms, for "cloud busting," to help stabilize weather patterns, and is sometimes associated with rain and fog.

In Daoist magical rituals, Moss Agate was sometimes used by ancient priests in rites of

Earth Element

Figure 1.30. Moss Agate (Qing Tai Ma Nao)

prosperity, in order to contact the Three Star Gods to request long-life, wealth, and position. It is also used to remove spiritual blockages and bring peace and stability to the Energy Body. As an elixir, Moss Agate can be used in order to tonify the immune system, cleanse the circulatory system and elimination system, and reduce swelling within the lymph nodes.

Moss Agate benefits the colon, circulatory system, lymphatics, pancreas, and the pulses. It improves capillary action, and increases elimination of unnecessary proteins. It can be used for treating lymphatic swelling and an overabundance or increase of plasma. Clinically, it has been used for easing anorexia nervosa, and treating lymphoma, Hodgkin's disease and blood sugar imbalances (i.e., diabetes and hypoglycemia). It can be used for the retention of (or rapid loss of) body fluids, to ease allergies, kidney disorders, liver problems, pulmonary edema, and to increase the ability to absorb nutrients into the cells. It inter-links the emotional and mental bodies to function as a single unit, and can be used to balance left-brain (mental) priorities with the emotions, as well as ease depression.

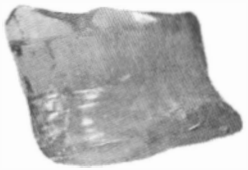
Recharging Qing Tai Ma Nao: Place Moss Agate overnight inside the center foliage of a healthy plant in order to recharge its energy.

Spiritual Properties: All Agate stones have strong grounding powers and can be used for support in difficult times.

Martial Properties: Agate stones can be used to protect an individual against psychic attacks by creating a protective shield around the body. It can be also used to banish hostile spirits, create storms, and to return a curse back to its source.

Healing Properties: Agate stones can be used for healing the stomach, nervous system, endocrine system, and circulatory system.

AMBER (HU PO)



Earth Element

Figure 1.31. Amber (Hu Po)

Hupo (meaning the "soul of a tiger") is also known as Amber. Its name originated from the ancient Chinese belief that when a tiger dies, its spirit enters into the ground and becomes transformed into a mineral. Therefore Amber is popularly regarded as a symbol of courage, being imbued with the powerful qualities of that fierce animal.

Amber is not a true mineral, but a solidified and fossilized resin. It is said tha the sap of the pine tree turns into Amber when the tree was a thousand years old.

The opaque or transparent resin of Amber can be either golden brown or yellow in color. It will sometimes contain insects or vegetation that has been trapped inside. In ancient China, Amber was believed to contain the souls of many tigers and the power of many Suns.

A variety known as Blood Amber is primarily used in Chinese medicine as an aphrodisiac. Another belief claimed Blood Amber to be the precious drops of petrified dragon's blood.

Amber, like Jet, has the property of becoming electrically charged when rubbed with wool or silk. Therefore, many priests and witches wear necklaces made out of both Amber and Jet.

Amber is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.31), and it stimulates the Yellow Court (Solar Plexus and Third Chakra) and Third Eye (Sixth Chakra) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Amber can be used as a gateway into other spiritual realms, magically creating a doorway of golden radiance through which to travel. Amber also stimulates the intellect, clears depression, and attracts compassion and understanding. It is used to help short-term memory, stimulate the Lower Dantian, and help ground and root the body's Qi.

Martial Properties: Amber has been held in high regard as a powerful protective talisman for thousands of years. It is considered a powerful protector that links the conscious-self to the higher spiritual-self. Amber purifies the body's physical, energetic, and emotional fields, absorbing negative energies and transmuting them into clear, positive forces that stimulate the body to heal itself.

Amber also protects against psychic attacks released from sorcery or witchcraft, and it relieves nightmares. It is also used as a magical amplifier, and, because of its purification ability, Amber is sometimes used by priests when traveling into the lower spiritual realms of the Underworld.

Healing Properties: Amber is considered to be a form of solidified sunlight and is therefore sometimes used as a powerful Chakra cleanser. On the physical level, it imbues the body with vitality and has the power to draw disease out of the tissues. Amber resonates with the throat, and is therefore used for treating goiters and other throat problems. It is also used to treat the stomach, spleen, kidneys, bladder, liver, and gallbladder.

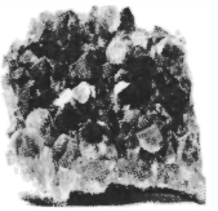
In certain traditions, Amber is used to alleviate joint problems and strengthen the mucous membrane. It is also believed to "draw out disease," particularly afflictions of the brain, inner ear, thyroid gland, lungs and spleen. When used as an elixir, Amber is an excellent natural antibiotic, and can protect against indigestion, loss of teeth (if held in the mouth in powdered form), deafness, and the spread of infection. It is also used to treat whooping cough, asthma, and erysipelas. In ancient China, Amber was sometimes worn around the throat in order to prevent nasal congestion, hay fever, and asthma.

Clinically, Amber is used to strengthens the thyroid gland, inner ear, stimulate all neurological tissue, stimulate the DNA processes, and aid in cellular mitosis. It can be used to treat diseases of the brain and central nervous system, memory loss, inability to make decisions, eccentric behavior, and anxiety.

Recharging Hupo: Choose sunlight to recharge Amber, placing it outside at high noon for several minutes, rather than choosing moonlight.

Caution: Because of its natural ability to absorb toxic Qi from the body, you should clean Amber every time you use it. Additionally, since Amber is a centering and grounding stone, it should not be worn all the time.

AMETHYST (ZI SHUI JING)



Wood/air Element

Figure 1.32. Amethyst (Zi Shui Jing)

Zi Shui Jing (also known as Amethyst) can be found in deep purple to transparent lavender color. Prized for its beauty and its legendary energies, Amethyst is a pointed crystal that can come in various sizes (i.e., as a geode, cluster, or single point). Amethyst is believed to be more powerful when it is in its natural state (i.e., unpolished). Amethyst is connected to the Wood / Air Element (Figure 1.32), its ruling planet is Jupiter, and it stimulates the Upper Dantian, Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), Seventh Chakra (Baihui), and Eighth Chakra (Heavenly Transpersonal Point) areas.

The Chinese have been wearing Amethyst for more than 8,000 years. It is a powerful healing, cleansing and protective stone, that enhances higher states of consciousness and is used to improve and enhance meditation. It is a natural tranquilizer and encourages calmness. Amethyst that is violet-lavender in color has a particularly high vibration, and the double-terminated lilac crystals facilitate dropping the mind into a theta wave state of consciousness.

One ancient Chinese Love Ritual used to prevent infidelity required the Daoist priest to tie a Amethyst geode to a couples bottom bed-post with a red rope while speaking a binding incantation. This magical ritual was used to safeguard both the husband and the wife from infidelity.

Spiritual Properties: Amethyst is one of the most spiritual of stones, promoting divine love and giving insights into the true nature of the core self. It accelerates the development of intuition and is used in order to enhance psychic abilities. This is an excellent stone for meditating and scrying and can be placed on the Third Eye (Sixth Chakra) to stimulate its awakening. Sleeping with Amethyst facilitates out of body travel and brings about intuitive dreams. It transmutes the body's lower energies to the higher frequencies of the energetic and spiritual realms. Amethyst is also said to bring contentment and sincerity, prevent drunkenness, and keep its owner from falling in love foolishly.

Amethyst should be carried by mourners in order to bring them comfort in their time of loss. It should also be placed beside the bed of terminal patients in order to help them transition from this world into the next.

Martial Properties: Amethyst is a powerful psychic enhancer. It can be used to energetically effect the Plant, Animal, and Human realms. It can also be used to recharge other crystals with magical powers, and can offer some protection against radiation.

Amethyst clears the body's energetic fields of negative influences and attachments. It can be used in order to create a protective energetic shield or "bubble of violet flame light." When creating a protective energetic force field, one popular combination used by priests is to mix Amethyst with Moldavite. The Amethyst will naturally create a protective energetic field, while the moldavite stone will naturally raise the priest's vibrational frequency to a higher energetic level. This higher energetic level will make it easier to ward off negative spirit entities who are attracted to and feed off lower energetic frequencies.

Ancient legends state that Amethyst can be used to protect against nightmares, thieves, storms, hail, locusts, plagues, and infidelity. It also has been used in order to guard against psychic attacks, and it changes brightness when near poisoned foods.

Healing Properties: Amethyst is extremely beneficial to the mind as it turns thoughts away from the mundane and deepens spiritual understanding. Mentally it helps the individual become less scattered, and it assists in focused concentration and spiritual insights. Amethyst balances emotional highs and lows and promotes centering. It dispels anger, rage, jealousy, fear, and anxiety, and it alleviates grief and sadness.

Amethyst boosts the production of hormones and is used to balance the endocrine system and metabolism, and to strengthen the immune system. Amethyst was used in ancient China for strengthening the Yang organs (responsible for eliminating waste). It is used to reduce bruising and swelling, and to treat hearing disorders, as well as diseases of the respiratory track, digestive track, lungs and skin. Amethyst is used to treat headaches, toothache, gout, neuralgia, nerve trouble, and help maintain the body's blood-sugar balance.

Clinically, Amethyst can be used to balance the metabolism, augment the activity of the pancreas, pituitary, pineal, thymus, and thyroid glands. Because it eases left/right brain imbalances, Amethyst can be used to treat such conditions as autism, dyslexia, epilepsy, neurological discharge, physical coordination problems, and certain visual problems.

Amethyst can also be used to treat diseases of the pituitary gland, diseases involving immune system collapse, and diseases influencing blood sugar levels (i.e., diabetes and hypoglycemia).

Recharging Amethyst: Choose one of the three days of the Full Moon to recharge Amethyst rather than sunlight. It is also advised to clear Amethyst by holding it under running water two to three times a week. Because Carnelian connects more strongly with the physical body, it counteracts the energy of Amethyst.

Caution: Although Amethyst can stabilize psychiatric conditions it should never be used in cases of schizophrenia or paranoia.

AMETRINE

This stone is a combination of both amethyst and citrine. It is a transparent stone that is purple and yellow in color. Ametrine is connected to the Wood/Air and Fire Elements (Figure 1.33), its ruling planet is Mercury, and it stimulates the Yellow Court (Solar Plexus and Third Chakra), Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) of the Upper Dantian.

Spiritual Properties: Ametrine facilitates and protects an individual during Soul Travel. It is a stone that combines the energetic qualities of the Wind Element (stimulating spiritual power and clarity) with that of the Fire Element (stimulating action and orientation). This combination allows for the connection to the spiritual realm to receive divine instruction and guidance. Once this connection has been established, the priest's Zhi (Will) and Yuan Shen (Original Spirit) connect the divine inspiration to the energetic fields of the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) and Upper Dantian area.

Figure 1.33. Ametrine

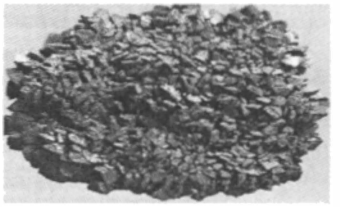
Wood/air and Fire Element

Ametrine is said to increase the priest's divination ability and promote healing. It calms the Shen (thoughts and emotions), clears stress and tension from the head, and brings greater focus to meditation. It harmonizes the body's Yin and Yang, and connects the physical realm with the higher realms of consciousness. Ametrine also facilitates spiritual transformation, releasing emotional blockages (including negative programing and expectations). It can be used in moonlight in order to visualize energetic portals that lead into other dimensions.

Martial Properties: Ametrine is fast and effective in its action and is used to relieve psychic attacks. It is sometimes used in magical rituals to make contact with spirit entities and Power Animals.

Healing Properties: Ametrine has a powerful cleansing property which disperses negativity from the body's energetic field, and expels toxins from the body. It is an exceptional blood cleanser and energizer. It is used to purge the physical, energetic, and spiritual bodies, is also used to tonify the physical body and strengthen the immune system. It tonifies the autonomic nervous system, stabilizes the DNA/RNA, and oxygenates the body. Ametrine is used to heal chronic fatigue syndrome, depression, lethargy, tension headaches, gastric disturbances and ulcers.

Recharging Ametrine: Choose one of the three days of the Full Moon in order to recharge Ametrine (begin at sunset).



Wood/air Element

Figure 1.34. Azurite

Wood/air and Fire Element

Figure 1.35. Beryl

AZURITE

This is a deep blue stone that contains shiny crystals. It is said that no other stone has a purer embodiment of the dark-blue energy than Azurite, allowing it to be used as a stone of inner vision. Azurite is connected to the Wood/Air Element (Figure 1.34), its ruling planet is Jupiter, and it stimulates the Upper Dantian, Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Azurite is considered to be a stone of inner vision and psychic awareness. It facilitates development of psychic powers and intuitive perception, urging the soul towards enlightenment. Azurite cleanses and stimulates the Upper Dantian and Sixth Chakra areas, attunes spiritual guidance, raises consciousness, assists in past-life recall, and enables the priest to Soul Travel. Azurite increases the ability to enter the trance state, and helps bring on prophetic dreams. It is especially powerful when placed on the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye).

Martial Properties: In ancient times, Azurite was considered the most potent of psychic stones. Because of its energetic potential for connecting the priest's mind to various spirit deities, the secret of using its magical power was known only to the high priests and senior abbots. It can be used to strengthen the Energy Body and Spirit Body, making them less vulnerable to psychic attacks or attachments from parasitic spirit entities. Azurite can also be used to seal holes in the body's aura field, alleviating energetic fatigue.

Healing Properties: Azurite is a powerful healing stone that increases and facilitates the energetic effect that the Shen (mind and emotions) has on the body's Jing (essence and tissues). Azurite is used to clear the physical body of the energetic charges caused from stress related discharges. It can be used to clear away worry and grief, and to transmute fear and phobias by bringing about and understanding of how and why such fears originated. It increases the flow of Qi throughout the body, oxygenates the blood, and repairs brain cells.

Traditionally Azurite is used to treat arthritis and joint problems, align the spine, treat throat problems and restore any blockages or damage to the brain. It is also used to heal Kidney, Spleen, Liver, and Gall Bladder problems as well as treat the thyroid, bones, teeth, and skin. In ancient times, Azurite was used to treat brain damage, and to encourage the development of the embryo within the womb.

Recharging Azurite: Place Azurite in the starlight, outside for several hours, after sunset during a New Moon in order to recharge its power.

Caution: Azurite may sometimes induce palpitations therefore the mystic should proceed with caution. Azurite is rather soft and cleaves easily. Therefore, care should be used when wearing Azurite as jewelry, as it is not durable enough for every day wear. Also, since Azurite is nearly always found in combination with Malachite (which is poisonous), extreme care should be taken if using Azurite to create internal elixirs.

BERYL

This is a prismatic and pyramidal crystal that may either be transparent or occur in shades of pink, golden, yellow, green, blue, and white. Beryl is connected to the Fire and Wood/Air Element (Figure 1.35), and it stimulates the Yellow Court (Solar Plexus and Fourth Chakra), Upper Dantian, and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas.

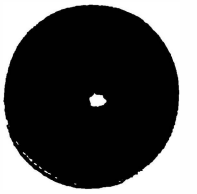
Spiritual Properties: Beryl strengthens the pituitary gland. Almost all colors of Beryl, including

Golden, are said to increase psychic awareness. It has the power to increase the wearer's attractiveness to the opposite sex, as well as to promote love. It opens and activates the Yellow Court and Upper Dantian. In ancient times Beryl was used to reawaken the love in individuals who were once married but felt rejected and alone.

Martial Properties: Beryl is said to protect the wearer from psychic attacks, or from being manipulated telepathically. In ancient times, Golden Beryl was considered a powerful magical tool. It was traditionally cut into spheres for scrying and was considered superior to Clear Quartz. Beryl also strengthens the Lower Dantian and awakens Yang (masculine) energetic qualities.

Healing Properties: Beryl is said to energize the body in a general way and to boost the immune system. Beryl is traditionally used to treat the glands, eyes, liver, heart, stomach, and spine, and to heal concussions. An elixir of Beryl can be used to treat throat infections. Golden Beryl is a good stone to use for exhaustion or depression, nausea, diarrhea, ulcers, constipation, and obesity. It tonifies the Yang organs (the organs of elimination), strengthens the pulmonary and circulatory systems, increases the body's Righteous Qi, and alleviates any cardiovascular disease (especially deterioration of cell walls, atherosclerosis, or hemorrhaging). Beryl completely restores the elasticity of the tissues. In ancient times, elixirs constructed out of Beryl were used to treats symptoms caused from the Bubonic plague.

Red Beryl strengthens the First Chakra, legs, knees, feet, and the minor chakras located in the soles of the feet at Kidney 1. It also generates a feeling of energetic connection flowing between the bottoms of the feet and the top of the head.



Earth and Fire Element

Figure 1.36. Bloodstone (Tie Shi Yin)

BLOODSTONE (TIE SHI YIN)

Tie Shi Yin (also known as Bloodstone) is a deep dark forest green form of Bi Yu (Jasper) spattered with specs of blood red. Bloodstone is probably the most famous of the Jasper family. It was revered by the ancient Chinese who saw it as a symbol of the setting Sun (Heavenly Yang) casting its fiery red over the green ocean (Earthly Yin). Bloodstone is connected to the Earth Element and Fire Element (Figure 1.36), its ruling planet is Mars, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian and First Chakra (Perineum) areas.

Spiritual Properties: An elixir created from Bloodstone can be used to strengthen the spirit body so that it can integrate more gracefully with the physical body.

Bloodstone has magical properties of controlling the weather, and is used in ancient China for Weather Magic (i.e., creating storms). It stimulates dreaming and was also believed to be an "audible oracle," giving off sounds as a means of guidance. According to ancient Chinese legend, Bloodstone has the power to detect changes in the Heavens. The ancient Chinese believed that Bloodstone was a heliotrope (a stone that turns towards the Sun) and that it could detect solar eclipses (indicating the presence of the Moon as it approaches the Sun). Therefore, ancient tradition claims that it

can be used in weather magic to call forth storms, thunder, and also enable the wearer to read omens from the sounds of thunder and rain.

Martial Properties: Bloodstone is an intense healing stone and in certain magical traditions considered to be the "Stone of Courage." It is excellent for invigorating the body and raising all energy levels. Bloodstone can be used to dispel states of bewilderment and obscure thought. Aligned with solar forces and sacred powers of healing, it is a useful crystal to work with energizing and protection.

Bloodstone can also be used to increase the power of the priest's magical incantations. In ancient China, it was believed that a bat engraved on Bloodstone will give the wearer power over demons. Also in ancient times, it was believed that Bloodstone could bestow the power of invisibility onto its owner when rubbed with the juice of the heliotrope plant. When a priest was thinking of casting a spell during an eclipse, he or she would traditionally include the use of Bloodstone in the ritual.

Healing Properties: Bloodstone is used as an energy cleanser, purifying and dispelling negative influences from the Wei Qi field. It tonifies the immune system, increasing the body's Righteous Qi in order to fight against acute infections. It also stimulates the flow of the lymph glands and the body's metabolic processes. In ancient China, Bloodstone was connected with the blood and the circulatory system and used to treats all blood disorders. It was traditionally ground into powder and mixed with honey in order to shrink tumors and to stop hemorrhaging.

Bloodstone was thought to stop the flow of bleeding, clear bloodshot eyes, cure hemorrhoids and protect the bearer from poison. It has also been used to aid in the rectification of failing eyesight, lung congestion, and rashes. Bloodstone purifies the blood and is used to detoxify the Liver, Spleen, Intestines, Kidneys and Urinary Bladder. In certain traditions, it was ground up and taken in an elixir as an aphrodisiac.

Clinically, Bloodstone is used to benefit the bone marrow, spleen, heart, testicles, ovaries, cervix and uterus. It also benefits the hemoglobin, capillary action, cell mitosis, and penetration of blood fluids into the ductless gland system.

An elixir created from Bloodstone can also be useful with biofeedback. Because it spiritually generates higher states of consciousness, it can be used to connect the conscious mind directly to the body's circulatory flows, increasing one's capacity to mentally send the blood to specific parts of the body.

Recharging Tie Shi Yin: Place Bloodstone in sunlight (i.e., place outside at high noon for several minutes) or in running water (i.e., place it in a stream for several minutes two to three times a week) in order to recharge its power.

Caution: Once the Bloodstone has been used for energizing the body and energetic protection, it is believed that a permanent link between the stone and the priest is made. Therefore, a personal stone (one worn next to the skin) is never discarded, and is always guarded and kept away from the public.

CALCITE (FAN JIE SHI)

Fan Jie Shi (also known as Calcite or limestone) is a common, very soft, translucent and waxy mineral which comes in a rainbow of colors (black, clear, red, orange, golden yellow, green, blue, blue/gray, and pink). It may be completely transparent in its crystalline state, or opaque as in limestone and marble. All Calcite are attributed to the Fire Element (Figure 1.37), and are excellent at moving Qi through the energetic channels (i.e., the Twelve Primary Channels and Eight Extraordinary Vessels) and the body's Chakra system.

Fire and Wood/air Element

Figure 1.37. Calcite (Fan Jie Shi)

- **Black Calcite (Hei Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element and Wood/Air Element, and it stimulates the body's three Dantians. Thought to be a "record keeping" stone, Black Calcite is used for regaining memories. It returns the soul body after trauma and is a useful companion during soul retrieval healing.
- **Blue Calcite (Lan Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element and Wood/Air Element. It stimulates the Fifth Chakra (throat), and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas. Blue Calcite helps remove blockages in the Third Eye and can aid in developing innervision, clairvoyant skills and telepathy. It is believed to have calming properties, able to soften the impact of projected psychic attacks. Blue Calcite lowers blood pressure and soothes the nerves, releasing negative emotions. It can also be used to absorb energy, transform it, and return it back to benefit its sender.
- **Clear Calcite (Tou Min Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element and Wood/Air Element, and it stimulates the body's three Dantians and all seven chakras. It can be programmed to amplify the effect of the priest's thoughts and intention, helping to enhance clarity and focus, bring energetic manifestation into the physical world. Clear Calcite is colorless and transparent (similar to clear quartz), and is considered to be a "cure-all" when taken as an elixir, dissolving energetic stagnation and restoring proper Qi flow. It is a powerful detoxifier and acts as an antiseptic. At a subtle level, Clear Calcite clears and aligns all of the body's chakras.
- **Golden Yellow Calcite (Huang Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element and Wood/Air Element, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Yellow Court, Third Chakra (Solar Plexus), Upper Dantian, and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas. This is an excellent stone for meditation as it increases intellect and wisdom, and can assist in Soul Projection. Yellow Calcite can be used to help the priest understand how to place Divine inspiration and guidance into action. When placed on the Lower Dantian, it instills mental alertness and grounds the Yuan Shen (Original Spirit) into the physical realm.
- **Green Calcite (Qing Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element and Water Element, and it stimulates the Fourth Chakra (Heart) area. Green Calcite is considered to be an emotional cooling gemstone, and it can be a powerful support to people in transition, bringing joy, emotional balance, and clarity to the decision making process. Green Calcite can be used to improve the quality of meditation, helping to still the "monkey mind." It is said to heal infections, and aid the lungs and heart. Green Calcite is a powerful tonifier for the immune system and is especially useful in

protecting a person or place from toxic energy. It is also helpful in treating arthritis and assisting the tissue construction of muscles or ligaments. In ancient China, Green Calcite was used to cool fevers, burns and inflammation.

- **Orange Calcite (Chenghuang Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, Second Chakra (Navel), Yellow Court, and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) areas. Orange Calcite stimulates the physical body and is highly energizing, especially for the Lower Dantian and the Second Chakra areas and is sometimes used as a mineral aphrodisiac. It is also considered a stone of wisdom, especially for those in charge of other's fates, and is thought to be helpful in all new beginnings, including creating new projects. In ancient China, Orange Calcite was used to treat the reproductive system, Gall Bladder, and intestines, as well as to remove phlegm from the body. It is also used to balance emotions, remove fear, overcome depression, support endocrine and hormonal balance, aid the digestive system and support the body's metabolism.
- **Pink Calcite (Fen Hong Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element, and it stimulates the Fourth Chakra (Heart) area. Considered to be a "stone of forgiveness," Pink Calcite is used to release fear and grief trapped within the heart due to trauma. It is a gemstone that brings hope in despairing times, and is thought to improve diplomatic skills. Pink Calcite enhances the body's Wei Qi fields and can be used in order to support the body's ability to regenerate tissue (especially after heart surgery or traumatic injury to the heart). It can also be used to aid circulation and treat heart disease.
- **Red Calcite (Hong Fan Jie Shi):** This stone is connected to the Fire Element and Earth Element, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Upper Dantian, and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas. Red Calcite is used to increase Qi and strengthen the body's life force energy. It is used to remove stagnation and dissolve blockages, balance hormones, heal broken bones, treat bone loss, and activate the endocrine system and the lymphatic system. Red Calcite is also used for supporting reproductive health, pregnancy, and birth.

Spiritual Properties: Considered to be a mental stone, Calcite enhances the intellect, improves wisdom, and increases mental harmony. Therefore, it is also often recommended as a study aid. Due to its ability to amplifying energy, many religious structures have been composed of marble and limestone. Because calcium carbonate is excreted by living creatures, it was believed to mystically increase the power of prayer and rituals.

Martial Properties: Because of its energetic properties as a psychic amplifier, Calcite is thought to double the intention of its wearer. It is also used as a memory booster and to bring clarity to decision making.

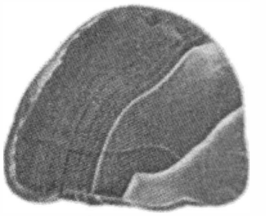
Healing Properties: Calcite removes stagnant energy and clears the Yang organs (organs of elimination). It encourages calcium intake within the bones in order to strengthen the joints and skeletal structure. However, it is also used to dissolve calcifications. Calcite is used to treat conditions of the large intestines or skin, as well as to stimulate blood clotting and tissue healing. As an elixir composed of Calcite can be applied to the skin, ulcers, warts and suppurating wounds.

Recharging Fan Jie Shi: Place Calcite in a stream for several minutes in order to recharge its power.

Caution: Because Calcite is extremely soft, it should not be worn every day. Extreme caution should be used when cleaning and recharging this mineral, as it is easily broken down by most solvents.

CARNELIAN

This small translucent stone can be red, orange, pink, or brown. Carnelian is a powerful stone that has the ability to cleanse other stones. Carnelian is connected to the Fire Element (Figure 1.38), its ruling planet is the Sun, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Second Chakra (Navel), Yellow Court, and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) areas.



Fire Element

Figure 1.38. Carnelian

Spiritual Properties: Powered Carnelian was believed to fill the heart with happiness. It ensures friendship, banishes fear, and gives self-confidence. Carnelian is a stabilizing stone with high energy. It is excellent for restoring vitality and motivation. It sharpens concentration, dispels mental lethargy and is used in removing extraneous thoughts which arise during meditation and prevents daydreaming. Therefore, Carnelian is said to root and ground the wearer into the present reality.

Martial Properties: Carnelian is associated with "Karma" and the "Law or Return." It brings reckoning and acceptance. It can also be a powerful protector, especially when used as a defence against toxic emotions such as envy, rage and resentment, projected from other people. It is also said to protect against evil, impure thoughts, and lightning. Carnelian was believed to give its wearer courage in battle and help the timid to speak boldly. In ancient times, Carnelian was used to protect the dead on their journey through the afterlife.

Healing Properties: Because Carnelian is full of life force energy, it vitalizes and tonifies the body's metabolism. It activates the Lower Dantian and influences the female reproductive organs, increasing fertility. In ancient times, Carnelian was used to overcome frigidity and impotence as well as to heal lower back problems, rheumatism, arthritis, neuralgia and depression. It regulates the body fluids and balances the kidneys, accelerating healing within the bones and ligaments. Carnelian is also used to improve the absorption of vitamins and minerals and to ensure a good supply of blood to the body's organs and tissues.

It can also be used to increase oxygenation and general tissue regeneration, improve capillary action, cause greater elasticity of the blood vessels, and strengthen the respiratory system. Clinically, Carnelian can be used to treat anorexia nervosa and ease overexposure to radiation (from the sun and from x-rays). It can also be used to alleviate atherosclerosis (particularly when there is also evidence of brain damage), ease apathy, and balance the Emotional Body.

Recharging Carnelian: Because it will fade in the sunlight, place Carnelian in running water (i.e., place it in a stream for several minutes two to three times a week) in order to recharge its power. Also, store Carnelian in a closed container to prevent it from absorbing negative environmental energies.

Caution: Because Carnelian connects more strongly with the physical body, it counteracts the energy emitted from Amethyst.

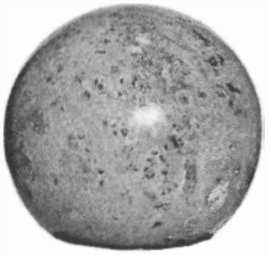
CHRYSOCOLLA

Chrysocolla is a soft, vibrantly colored semi-precious gemstone sometimes referred to as Gem Silica. It is an opaque green and blue colored stone that can be found in various sizes with colorful bands or inclusions. Chrysocolla is connected to the Water Element (Figure 1.39), its ruling planet is Venus, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Yellow Court, Fourth Chakra (Solar Plexus), Fifth Chakra (throat), and the area of the medulla oblongata.

Spiritual Properties: Chrysocolla calms, cleans and reenergizes all of the body's chakras (especially the Heart Chakra) and aligns them with the Divine. When placed on the third eye it helps to open and increase psychic vision. This stone helps in meditation and spiritual communication. Chrysocolla is believed to improve psychic ability, aiding in prophetic dreaming, attaining trance states and communicating with the spirit world. It was traditionally used by musicians for its ability to ease expression and give greater beauty to the singing voice.

Martial Properties: Chrysocolla is used to draw off all types of energy. It can be helpful in invoking great inner strength. It also amplifies sensitivity to aid in understanding what is spoken, as well as what is unspoken. Chrysocolla governs all aspects of sound healing, whether through words or sound frequencies. Therefore, priests who chant, sing, or speak mantras are strongly encouraged to wear or carry Chrysocolla, especially Gem Silica (a crystallized form in which the Chrysocolla is infused in Quartz).

Chrysocolla can be used during Qi Gong breathing exercises to help the priest develop more control over spiritual forces.



Water Element

Figure 1.39. Chrysocolla

Healing Properties: Chrysocolla strengthens the lungs, thyroid, coccyx and medulla oblongata. It is used to treat arthritis, bone disease, muscle spasms, digestive track disorders, ulcers, and blood disorders. It detoxifies the liver, kidneys, and intestines. It re-oxygenates the blood and is used in rebuilding the cellular structure of the lungs, facilitating greater capacity for respiratory functions. Chrysocolla regenerates the pancreas, regulates insulin and balances the blood. It strengthens the muscles and alleviates muscle cramps and is also used for treating infections, especially those within the throat and tonsils. Because of its cooling action, Chrysocolla is often used to lower blood pressure and to soothe burns. It is also used to relieve arthritic pain, strengthen the Thyroid and tonify the metabolism. In ancient times Chrysocolla was used to treat PMS symptoms such as menstrual cramps. It also eases stress and hypertension.

Recharging Chrysocolla: To recharge Chrysocolla, place it on the Earth Altar in the copper Altar Dish during the purification ritual, and leave it overnight.

Caution: Because Chrysocolla is a hydrous or wet gemstone, it must be protected from heat and harsh chemicals which will cause the stone to dry and crumble.

CINNABAR (ZHU SHA)

Zhu Sha (also known as Cinnabar), is sometimes written as "cinnabarite," which is the name used to describe red mercury sulfide, or native vermilion, the common ore of mercury. Cinnabar is a vermilion red or brownish red colored crystal that often forms around volcanic vents and hot springs. It may also occur in sedimentary rocks associated with recent volcanic activity.

Cinnabar is believed to be at the head of all magical minerals and metals, and is said to be capable of transmutation. It is connected to the Fire Element (Figure 1.40), and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Second Chakra (Navel), Upper Dantian, and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas.

To the ancient Daoists, the term Zhu Sha ("Cinnabar") has always been used in alchemical practices. The Lower Dantian for example, was sometimes referred to as the "Cinnabar Field."

In ancient Daoist magical practices, ink paste composed of Cinnabar was traditionally used to officially fuse talismanic paper with the magical spirit of the priest's will, and the spiritual power and authority of his or her monastery. Cinnabar ink paste was made by mixing cinnabar, seal oil, and moxa fibers. A wooden or stone chop was then placed into the red paste while speaking a magical incantation. The talisman was then stamped and energetically "sealed" with the cinnabar ink.

In ancient China, transforming the physical body to that of an Immortal Body was the primary goal of the practitioners of alchemy. These ancient priests hoped to internally transmute the highly toxic Cinnabar into the magical elixir of immortality. The use of Cinnabar in Daoist alchemy arose of out homological thinking that sought to connect the Cinnabar's red color with blood, and its transformation into liquid mercury "quicksilver" with the vitality of human semen, the source of new life. The ancient Daoist master Ge Hong (261-341 A.D.) wrote the alchemical text called Baopuzi (*The Book of the Master Who Embraces Simplicity*), which provides recipes for the transmutation of alchemical Cinnabar into the elixir of immortality.

Fire Element

Figure 1.40. Cinnabar (Zhu Sha)

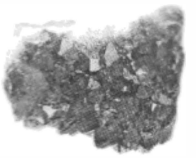
However, by the end of the Tang Dynasty (618-907 A.D.), the esoteric formulas that required the use of Cinnabar powder in Wai Dan had declined and eventually died out, as Daoist adepts began to realize the extreme toxicity of the metals they were experimenting with.

Spiritual Properties: Cinnabar stones are considered to be magical talismans of alchemical transformation, stimulating the flow of Qi in the body and allowing for greater insight into the underlying energy of creation. In ancient China, it was used in order to help perceive the infinite power of the Dao through sexual union.

Martial Properties: Cinnabar has the ability to manifest energy into physical form and was used by ancient priests and spiritual alchemists in the practice of shape-shifting, magical manifestation, and other forms of energetic transformation.

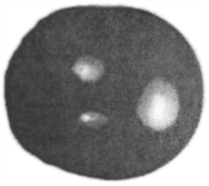
Healing Properties: Cinnabar is an excellent stone for treating deep-seated or systemic infections (viral or bacterial). It can help stimulate the body's immune system and to purify the blood. Although Cinnabar is known to be highly toxic, it was nevertheless used in ancient China in powdered form as part of medicinal formulae. It can be mixed with water and sometimes prescribe on the basis of "using poison to cure poison." Used internally, Cinnabar is believed to clear away "heat" and tranquilize the mind. It is also used as a tonic to reduce the incidence of heart palpitations, restlessness, and insomnia, and to treat sore throats and cold sores that occur in the mouth and tongue. In addition, Cinnabar is applied externally to treat certain skin disorders and infections.

Caution: Because mercury is a toxic material, caution should be used when handling Cinnabar.



Fire Element

Figure 1.41. Citrine



Water Element

Figure 1.42. Coral (Shan Hu)

CITRINE (XITE LIN)

This rare transparent yellow, yellowish brown, or smoky gray-brown crystal is often obtained as a geode, point, or cluster. Citrine is connected to the Fire Element (Figure 1.41), its ruling planet is Mercury, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Second Chakra (Navel), Yellow Court, and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Citrine awakens the higher mind and is particularly useful for individuals who are sensitive to environmental and other outside influences. It has the ability to cleanse the chakras, especially those located in the Lower Dantian and Yellow Court areas. Citrine also activates the Upper Dantian, and stimulates the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye). It opens intuition, and is commonly used to cleanse and balance the spiritual body by aligning it with the physical body. Citrine increases the powers of concentration and revitalizes the mind, promoting inner peace so that true wisdom can emerge. It can be used during meditation to rejuvenate the physical body and also eliminate toxic thought forms.

Martial Properties: Citrine absorbs, transforms and dissipates negative energy, and is therefore extremely protective for the environment. As an aura protector it acts as an early warning system so that action can be taken to protect oneself.

Healing Properties: Citrine is a powerful cleanser and regenerator, and is traditionally used for reversing degenerative diseases. It stimulates digestion and tonifies the spleen and pancreas. It negates infection of the kidneys and urinary bladder, helps eye problems, increases blood circulation, detoxifies the blood, activates the thymus and balances the thyroid gland. Its warming effect tonifies the nervous system. An elixir made from citrine is helpful for treating menstrual problems and menopausal symptoms (such as hot flashes), balancing the hormones and alleviating fatigue.

Citrine is used clinically to benefit the heart, kidneys, liver and muscles. It stimulates general tissue regeneration and is sometimes used to remove toxemia from the body, as in conditions such as a appendicitis, when there is gangrene or for intestinal toxemia (when the body has turned on itself and become toxic).

Recharging Citrine: To recharge Citrine, place it in the sunlight from sunrise to noon.

Caution: When cleansing and recharging Citrine, do not frequently overexpose it to intense sunlight, as it may start to crack.

CORAL (SHAN HU)

Shan Hu (Coral) is found in all the oceans of the world, and is connected to the Water Element (Figure 1.42). In ancient China, Coral was revered for its medicinal qualities, as well as for its beauty. It occurs in all colors, but is most commonly found in black, blue, pink, red, or white forms. The specific healing qualities of each type of Coral vary according to color.

Coral is included as one of the Eight Treasures, (also known as the "Eight Precious Things" and the "Eight Auspicious Treasures"), which are the coin, Ruyi, coral, lozenge, rhinoceros horn, silver ingot, stone chime, and the flaming pearl.

Coral resembles deer antlers and deer are symbols of longevity. Therefore, Coral also symbolizes longevity and official promotion. As a symbol of longevity, the Chinese have traditionally believed that coral represents an "iron tree" ("Tieshu") that grew under the sea and blossomed only once every hundred years.

Red coral is considered particularly auspicious because the Chinese believe the color red signifies good luck, good fortune, and happiness.

Coral is also a symbol of official promotion because a coral button on the hat identified one of the nine grades of government officials.

Since the period of the Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.), coral had been an extremely valuable commodity in China. The ancient histories of the Later Han, give a detailed description of how coral was collected from the sea. Also mentioned were the revered many-branched red coral trees, twelve or thirteen feet high, which ornamented the garden of the Han Palace, that had been the gift of the ruler of Vietnam.

- **Black Coral (Hei Shan Hu):** This type of coral is believed to both absorb and transform negative energy when worn, carried, or taken internally as an elixir. Black Coral is used to foster tranquility, and is used to energetically elevate an individual's creative intentions. It can also be used to dispel the fear of darkness and bring hidden matters to the forefront. In certain ancient traditions, Black Coral was considered to be a stone of regeneration and purification, and it was used in the treatment of disorders relating to the internal organs, skin, pores, and digestive system.
- **Blue Coral (Lan Shan Hu):** This type of coral is used to clear the Second Chakra. It is also used to activate and energize the Fifth (throat) Chakra, treat throat ailments, and cleanse and purge the mucoid systems. Blue Coral has been used to illuminate the Third Eye and enhance the priest's psychic awareness. It is also been used to tonify the liver, pituitary gland, pineal gland and circulatory system.
- **Pink Coral (Fen Hong Shan Hu):** This type of coral is used to stimulate and activate the Fourth (heart) Chakra and enhance the intuitive aspects of love. Pink Coral has also been used for emotional healing, and in the treatment of disorders of the heart, breast, stomach, and reproductive organs.
- **Red Coral (Hong Shan Hu):** This type of coral was used in ancient times to balance the physical and spirit realms, further aligning the priest with the divine source of all wisdom. It both opens and activates the Lower Chakra and is believed to protect the individual from depression and despair. Red Coral has been used to treat hiccups, colic, and heartburn, and to stimulate the metabolic process and release impurities from the muscular system. It can also be used in the treatment of disorders of the kidneys, bladder, or parathyroid gland. In ancient times, Red Coral was scattered on fields in order to shield crops from storms, blight, and locusts. It was also used to protect ships and houses from storms.

  Red Coral was commonly used in ancient China in Sea Rituals, in Fertility Charms, Sex Magic (where brighter shades of red are used to attract passionate lovers), and for the creation of talismans used for initiating psychic invisibility.
- **White Coral (Bai Shan Hu):** This type of coral is used in different cultures to open and clear the Upper Dantian. It is also used to align the major Chakras of the body with the subtle energies of the spirit realm, helping to dissipate energetic blockages in the physical body and to fill any holes in the body's second Wei Qi field (aura). It is used clinically to facilitate the renewal of the cellular structure of the brain and olfactory system. White Coral is also believed to stimulate clairaudient abilities, open the door to the subconscious mind and induce vivid dreams when placed under the pillow.

Spiritual Properties: Coral enhances the mental processes, creates emotional openness and enthusiasm, and pacifies the mind. Because it is constructed of many generations of living organisms, Coral is considered to be an energetic gateway to the past. It also facilitates intuition and visualization, helping to enhance the priest's psychic abilities.

Martial Properties: In ancient China, Coral was believed to be able to calm the ocean and was commonly worn as a magical amulet or pendant. Coral loses its hue when the wearer's health declines (e.g., turning pale when the wearer is ill).

Healing Properties: Coral supports the growth of bones, cleanses the blood, and strength-

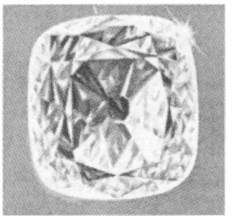
ens the circulatory system. It supports and balances the Heart, circulatory system, digestion, and metabolism. Coral can also enhance fertility, balance the body's Fire and Water energy, increase stamina and vitality, and ease internal pains. The ancient Chinese believed that Coral could be used to prevent nightmares, epilepsy, and sterility in women. They also used it to cure fits and whooping cough in babies, and for the treatment of ulcers and sores. When rubbed on the gums, Coral was believed to strengthen the teeth. Coral was used in ancient times to stimulate tissue regeneration and has been used in modern times to nourish the blood cells, and to treat disorders of the spine, nervous system, and thymus gland. Moonlight was believed to intensify its healing power.

Recharging Coral: To recharge Coral, sprinkle it with seawater and then place it under the moonlight during the time of the Waxing Crescent Moon.

DIAMOND

This stone is generally considered to be the highest and purist of all gemstones, and was sometimes known as the "King of the Crystals." Diamonds have long been valued for their magical properties. The ability of the diamond to refract light into flashing multicolored prisms enhances its ability to increase the power of other minerals. Diamond is connected to the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements (Figure 1.43). It energetically stimulates the Middle Dantian, Fourth Chakra (heart), Upper Dantian, Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), Seventh Chakra (Baihui), and Eighth Chakra (Heavenly Transpersonal Point) areas.

Spiritual Properties: The diamond is a stone of manifestation, attracting abundance (the larger the diamond the more the abundance). Ancient priests believed that diamonds aid intuition. Diamonds crystals are energetic transducers and can assist in activating the prefrontal lobes of the brain, the seat of most paranormal abilities and visionary consciousness. In ancient times, placing a diamond onto the Sixth Chakra was said to open doors to psychic powers, enhance inner-vision, and facilitate psychic intuition.



Wuji Element

Figure 1.43. Clear Diamond

Martial Properties: Diamonds are one of the few stones that never need recharging. They are superb in conjunction with other stones because they amplify the properties of other gems. Diamonds are also known to imbue courage, feelings of invincibility, and fearlessness. They were sometimes used in ancient times against feelings of fear or actions of cowardice. Certain traditions believe that a diamond will provide its owner with protection from evil spirits, fire, poison, snakes, and illness.

Healing Properties: Diamonds are considered to be master healer stones. It is believed that the unique blue light of a diamond is helpful to treat eye conditions such as Glaucoma. Clear diamonds are known to stimulate the brain, adjust the cranial plates, clear emotional and mental pain, reduce fear, and bring about feelings of new beginnings. Diamonds are also believed to provide a link between the intellect and the higher mind. On the subtle level, diamonds are believed to fill and reenergize the body's energetic Wei Qi fields (aura). In ancient times diamonds were traditionally used to counteract poisons. Because they promote greater strength and harmony in the body's Water Element, diamonds were used in ancient times to treat diseases of the kidney and reproductive organs.

As a healing stone, a Diamond can be used to remove Toxic Qi from most diseased areas. Its energy acts as a general cleanser of all the subtle energy bodies. It can be used to remove blockages in the Seventh chakra (Baihui area), stimulate the Second (Lower Dantian) and Sixth chakras (Third Eye), and totally cleanse the 12 major channels with little effect on the acupuncture points. A large diamond is excellent for blocking pathogenic Qi.

Clinically, Diamond Elixirs can be used to treat many forms of brain diseases, including

brain fever, brain tumors, difficulties with the pituitary and pineal glands, diseases of the midbrain extending into the cerebellum, atlas, cranium, and medulla oblongata; as well as hemorrhaging, inflammation and left-right brain disorders such as autism, dyslexia, epilepsy, neurological discharge, physical coordination problems and visual problems. It can also be used to increase synapse activity between individual neurons and stimulate the cranium.

Recharging Diamonds: Diamonds are one of the few stones that never need recharging. When used with an Herbal Elixir, it does not amplify or unify a particular herb and mineral combination, however, it is extremely powerful in removing blockages and negativity that can interfere with these vibrational remedies. Therefore, it can be used with other elixir remedies in order to draw toxicity out of the physical and subtle energy bodies. It can also be used to keep other elixir remedies from becoming weakened in the cleansing process (elixir remedies are better able to recharge their properties with the presence of a diamond).

Caution: Because diamonds will increase the power and intensity of an individual's emotional and energetic state, any negative state of mind will also be amplified.

EMERALD

Emerald is a form of green beryl that crystallizes in the structure of prismatic crystals. It is sometimes observed as being vertically striated and terminated by small pyramid-like faces. Emerald is connected to the Water Element (Figure 1.44), and it stimulates the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Emeralds are stones of wisdom, and they provide inspiration, intuition, mental clarity, discernment, and truth. They are known for their ability to strengthen the memory and inspire deep inner knowing. The Emerald stone can be used in order to stabilize the priest's spirit body, and generally increase psychic and clairvoyant faculties. Emeralds are also known to open the Fifth Chakra (heart) and have a calming effect on the emotions, balancing the physical, emotional, and mental equilibrium. At one time,

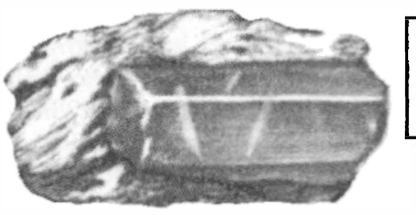


Figure 1.44. Green Emerald

Emeralds were believed to assist the priest in foretelling the future.

Martial Properties: Emeralds are believed to eliminate negativity and bring in positive actions. They can be used to focus intention, raise consciousness, enhance psychic abilities, increase clairvoyance, and stimulate the ability to gather wisdom from the spiritual realm. Traditionally an emerald was believed to protect from enchantment and the psychic attacks of other priests, as well as banish nightmares and night phantoms. In ancient times, it was believed that an emerald could detect poison when worn as a ring. It was believed that the Emerald ring would change color and fade, or become hot and vibrate when around toxic substances. Emeralds were also said to bring victory in court cases and turn enemies into friends. Emeralds have long been used in order to protect sailors and fishermen from the perils of sea.

Healing Properties: The emerald is considered a stone of the heart, offering healing benefits on the physical and emotional planes. Emerald Elixirs can be created to treat conditions of general paranoia, schizophrenia, and any form of severe mental illness.

An Emerald can be used to strengthen the heart, kidneys, liver, and pancreas; as well as enhance certain parts of the spinal vertebrae associated with these areas. It is commonly used to aid recovery after infectious diseases. Emeralds are used to alleviate diabetes, treat problems of the spine, back and skeletal system, lungs, heart, liver, eyes, and treat mental and emotional stress. Emerald has been used as an antidote for poisons. When worn around the neck, the emerald was believed to ward off epilepsy. In ancient times, the

emerald was used for treating faintness, curing loss of memory, easing pain in childbirth, controlling blood pressure, and treating nervous disorders. It was also used to treat epilepsy, dysentery, sores, and ulcers. Emerald relieves eyestrain and eye inflammation and is said to protect the wearer against blindness and eye diseases. The ancient mystics believed the emerald to be able to negate the harmful effects of certain types of snakebites.

Recharging Emeralds: To recharge an Emerald, place it under the moonlight during the time the moon begins to wax (increase in size). It is also advised to clear the energies of an Emerald by holding it under cold running water two to three times a week.

Caution: It is important not to wear emeralds all the time as its super positive force will start to reverse.

FLUORITE (YING SHI)

Ying Shi (also known as Fluorite) is a transparent crystal, that comes in a rainbow of colors (yellow, blue, green, violet and purple, white or clear, and rainbow) and can be obtained in either cubical or octahedral shapes. Because of its softness, ancient Chinese carved vases and tea cups from Fluorite and considered them to be valuable treasures. Drinking herbal tea out of Fluorite cups, for example, enables one to also absorb the stone's magical properties. Fluorite is connected to the Wood / Air Element (Figure 1.45). The different colored properties of Fluorite will have various affects on the physical, energetic and spirit bodies, described as follows:

- **Black Fluorite (Hei Ying Shi):** This stone is considered to be the ultimate cleanser in removing energetic toxins (i.e., negative thought patterns or spiritual parasites) from the body. Black Fluorite is also used to treat mental imbalances, arrest nightmares and stop certain energetic forms of psychic attacks.
- **Blue Fluorite (Lan Ying Shi):** This stone enhances creativity, orderly thoughts and clears mental communication. It is considered a "dual-action stone" because it both calms the emotions and revitalizes the body's life force energy. Blue Fluorite is especially good for opening the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye)

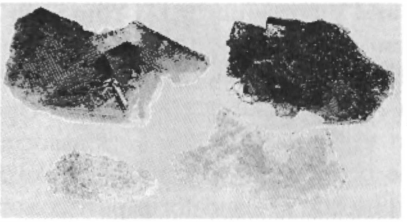


Figure 1.45. Fluorite (Ying Shi)

and ensuring psychic clarity. It amplifies the mystic's healing potential by tightly focusing the brain activities so as to invoke a spiritual awakening. Blue Fluorite is also used to stimulate both the physical and energetic bodies. In healing, Blue Fluorite is effective for treating eyes, ears, nose and throat problems.

- **Golden Yellow Fluorite (Huang Ying Shi):** This stone is especially used for improving intelligence and awakening the memory. Yellow Fluorite enhances creativity and stabilizes group consciousness. It is particularly helpful as an aid for combining the psychic powers of several priests, channeling the projected Qi and Shen into one single pointed endeavor. On the physical level, Yellow Fluorite releases toxins and was used in ancient times to aid the liver.
- **Green Fluorite (Qing Ying Shi):** This stone grounds excess Qi, and is used to dissipate emotional trauma, particularly negative environmental energies. Green Fluorite brings information up from the subconscious mind and accesses higher intuition. It is sometimes used in magical elixirs in order to increase the power of the herbs.

  Green Fluorite is effective in clearing infections and is also used for clearing the body's energetic fields, Chakras and Shen (mind and emotions). It is sometimes used to relieve stomach pains and cramps within the intestines.
- **Pink Fluorite (Fen Hong Ying Shi):** This stone is used to cleans and heal the emotions and harmonize the heart with the mind. Pink Fluorite activates the "seat of the soul," located deep within the Middle Dantian and Taiji Pole area.

- **Purple and Violet Fluorite (Zi Ying Shi):** The more common Violet and Purple Fluorite are energetic amplifiers. It stimulates the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) and opens the Upper Dantian to the mystical powers associated with the upper realms of magic. Violet and Purple Fluorite is used to impart common sense to psychic communication and is an excellent meditation stone. For healing, Violet and Purple Fluorite is useful for the treatment of bones and bone marrow disorders.
- **Rainbow Fluorite (Cai Hong Ying Shi):** The multicolored banded variety of Rainbow Fluorite is sometimes called the "Philosopher's Stone." The ancient Daoists believed that Rainbow Fluorite had special powers that could assist the priest in the process of internal and external alchemy, increase telepathic abilities, and aid in shape-shifting. Rainbow Fluorite is considered to be one of the best overall energy cleansers and is sometimes used to repair energetic holes in the Wei Qi (aura) field.
- **White Fluorite (Bai Ying Shi) or Clear Fluorite (Tou Min Ying Shi):** White and Clear Fluorite are said to help cleanse the priest's spirit. They stimulate the Upper Dantian and energize the body's Wei Qi fields. White and Clear Fluorite both harmonize the mind and the emotions, allowing the spirit to settle into a state of quiescence. They can also be used to align all of the body's chakras, clear obscure visions, and enhance the effects of other crystals during healing.

Spiritual Properties: Fluorite cleanses and stabilizes the body's energetic fields by naturally drawing off negative energy. It grounds and supports the body's spiritual energies and is said to give the spirit safe journey on soul projections and forays into the spirit world. Because it heightens intuitive powers, Fluorite gently opens the door to the subconscious mind and is excellent for advancing greater concentration, meditation, and spiritual awakenings. It links the Yuan Shen (Original Spirit) with the Shen Xian (Eternal Soul). Fluorite also helps one grasp higher, more abstract concepts, facilitates inter-dimensional communication, and balances the Yang (positive) and Yin (negative) aspects of the mind. Fluorite is used to purify and detoxify both the body's spirit and living places. It is often recommended to reduce stress and relieve negative forces. Natural Healers associate Fluorite with concentration, as it is supposed to bring balance to mental-emotional energies and reduce chaotic and misguided energies.

Martial Properties: Because of its pyramid-like cleavage planes, Fluorite is considered to be a highly protective stone, especially on the psychic level. It is most commonly associated with protection against psychic manipulation and antagonistic mental influences. It is used to foster the intellect and advance the mind from one mental reality to the next. Fluorite also aids in fighting mental disorder and gaining spiritual awakening. It helps to increase the assimilation of Qi into the body, and is said to give form and structure to thoughts (i.e., energies, ideas, and concepts), helping them manifest within the material world. Because Fluorite can be used to increase focused concentration, it is traditionally used to assist the priest in working with large amounts of energy.

Healing Properties: Fluorite is a powerful healing tool that works with chakras and has various energetic attitudes according to color of stone. It can be used to help remove infections, repair DNA damage, regenerate the skin and mucus membranes, particularly in the respiratory tract. It can also be used to heal ulcers, help in healing wounds, strengthen the teeth and bones, and improves absorption of vital nutrients. Fluorite is also beneficial for dissolving adhesions, tonifying the blood vessels and spleen, and for alleviating pain caused from rheumatoid arthritis, and spinal injuries. It grounds excess energy, heals the skin and helps remove blemishes. When taken as an elixir, Fluorite is a powerful agent used against viruses.

Recharging Ying Shi: Place Fluorite in the moonlight, during the three days of the Full Moon, or in running water (i.e., place it in a stream for several minutes) in order to recharge its power.

Caution: Because Fluorite is rather soft and cleaves easily, care should be taken when wearing any form of jewelry, as it is not durable enough for every day wear.

GARNET (SHI LIU SHI)

Shi Liu Shi (also known as Garnet) is found in four types of magical stones, described as follows (Figure 1.46):

Earth and Fire Element

Figure 1.46. Garnet (Shi Liu Shi)

- **The Almandine Red Garnet:** This is a deep orange-red to purplish red colored stone. This stone is connected to the Earth Element, its ruling planet is Mars, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Middle Dantian, and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas. The Almandine Red Garnet allows for the manifestation of one's heartfelt desires to materialize within the physical realm. It is also an excellent "grounding" stone, and because of its relative dense energies (used for rooting the energetic body and spirit body). It can also be used as a stone of psychic protection, making it more difficult for negative spirit energies to attach themselves. The Almandine Red Garnet is a strong regenerative healing stone, building strength and stamina.
- **The Pyrope Red Garnet:** This is a deep red to reddish black colored stone. This stone is connected to the Earth Element, its ruling planet is Mars; and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Middle Dantian, Fourth Chakra (heart), Upper Dantian, and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas. The Pyrope Red Garnet stabilizes, strengthens, and protects the bodies three external Wei Qi (aura) fields by aligning the powers of the Lower Dantian with the subtle creative forces of the Middle and Upper Dantians.
- **The Rhodolite Red Garnet:** This is a wine colored stone, varying from rose red to pale violet. This stone is connected to the Earth Element, its ruling planet is Mars, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Middle Dantian, Fourth Chakra (heart), Upper Dantian, and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas. The Rhodolite Red Garnet combines the energies of all three Dantians in order to simultaneously facilitate physical, energetic and spiritual fusion. It encourages its owner to both receive and radiate the frequency of Divine love that is constantly flowing from the eternal light of the Dao. It realigns and balances the body's external and internal energetic fields, cleanses and expands the body's Wei Qi (aura) field, and opens the priest's psychic vision.

  Clinically, a Rhodolite Red Garnet is used to Increase capillary action, especially within the lung tissue. It also increases nutritional assimilative properties of the internal villi of the intestinal lining, provides greater flexibility in the skin's tissue, and alleviates general nausea during detoxification. Rhodolite Red Garnet has mild anticarcinogenic properties when used for treating precancerous conditions, but should not be used on patients who have cancer.
- **The Spessartine Red Garnet:** This is a brownish red to yellowish orange red colored stone. This stone is connected to the Earth Element and Fire Element, its ruling planet is Mars, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Second Chakra (Navel), Yellow Court, and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) areas. The Spessartine Red Garnet is a powerful stone of attraction and manifestation. It increases the Qi of the Lower Dantian (increasing creativity and sexuality). It can be used to enhance charisma or attract a person or thing into one's life. It also stimulates the Yellow Court and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) area, increasing power to one's Zhi (Will). During meditation, Spessartine Red Garnet can be used to stimulate the spiritual essence of interpersonal relationships.

  Clinically, a Spessartine Red Garnet is used to strengthens the heart, liver, kidneys, and thyroid. It alleviates liver and heart diseases, especially various types of anemia, increases plasma and hemoglobin.

Spiritual Properties: Garnet is said to aid those interested in astral projection. Because it helps to align the emotional body to the spiritual body, sleeping with it will help you remember your dreams. Garnet is said to perpetuates friendships, as it helps the wearer to be firm and steadfast in commitment yet aids in patience and persistence. It also helps to balance the body's energetic fields, stimulate desires, uplift mental attitudes, and enhance the imagination. It has a strong affinity with the Lower Dantian and the transformation of Jing to Qi. Therefore Garnet is sometimes used to increase creative energy and sexual appetite. In ancient times, Garnet was used to stimulate the controlled rise of energy flowing up the Conception Vessel and Taiji Pole, and also to aid sexual potency. It stimulates expanded awareness and past life recall and clears away negative chakra energy.

Martial Properties: Garnet is believed to have the power to strengthen the will (Zhi) and are used by priests as magical tools for making the products of his or her creative imagination manifest in the world of matter. In ancient times, it was believed that an oath sworn over a Garnet was nearly impossible to break. Garnet is said to ward off demons, night phantoms, and nightmares. It activates and amplifies the energetic effects of other crystals and is used in order to reinforce magical oaths.

Garnet was said to change color when danger approaches, and in ancient times it was carried as a talisman in order to ward off danger, protect against lightning, thieves, and repel flying insects. In ancient times is was also believed that anyone who unlawfully obtained Garnet would bring a curse upon its wearer until it was returned to its original owner.

Healing Properties: Garnet is a powerful reenergizing stone. It cleans and reenergizes the chakras, stimulates the pituitary gland, and strengthens the bloodstream. Energetically, it vitalizes, purifies, and balances the Qi. Garnet is thought to be an antidote to fevers, and to ward off inflammatory diseases. It stimulates the body's metabolism and assists in the assimilation of minerals and vitamins. Garnet is used to treat spinal and cellular disorders, and to regenerate the body's DNA. It is also used to purify and energize the blood, heart, and lungs, as well as to .

Earth Element

Figure 1.47. Red Hematite (Dai Zhe Shi)

Garnet comes in many colors and different varieties are associated with different healing abilities. The blood-red varieties are often associated with blood diseases. Since it is the color of menstrual blood, it is believed to be a stone of fertility. Women were known to wear it around their waist to help with the menstrual cycle. The pink Grossular varieties is said to soothe a stressed nervous system and are used by healers for stress-related diseases, such as anorexia, mistrust, and people needing comfort. The browner varieties are used by healers to draw out stress.

Recharging Shi Liu Shi: Place Garnet outside in the moonless light of a New Moon, or in the dark energetic field of a cloudy night in order to recharge its power.

HEMATITE (DAI ZHE SHI)

Dai Zhe Shi (also known as Red Hematite) is a black silvery red stone, and is quite heavy. In its raw form, Hematate is a "brain-like" black, reddish gray structure. When polished, it is sometimes known as a black diamond, and was used in ancient China as a Magic Mirror. It was also believed to have the power to reflect back psychic attacks and all forms of negativity. Hematate is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.47), its ruling planet is Mars, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian and First Chakra (perineum) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Hematate has long been associated with psychic awareness, and some people believe that it assists in spirit travel, soul travel, and scrying. When used as a talisman, Hematate is said to ensure for the wearer a favorable hearing of petitions addressed to the celestial

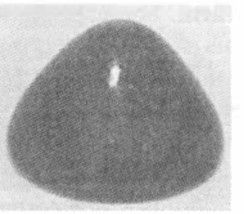
kings and good fortune in the area of lawsuits and other judgements. In addition, it is also considered a grounding stone, which makes it useful for those people who have difficulty concentrating on the "here-and-now." Hematate brings a greater attunement, harmonizes the body with the mind and spirit. It eliminates emotional and spiritual disassociation, strengthens the intuition, and promotes common sense.

Martial Properties: Hematate is considered to be a stone of protection. Priests use it to protect the soul and ground it back into the body after soul travel. In ancient times, warriors rubbed their bodies with the stone before battle, believing it protected them and made them invincible. A seal of Hematate was thought to enable a man to destroy his enemies. By strengthening the physical and energetic bodies, it also energizes, vitalizes, and enhances personal magnetism, optimism, will, and courage.

Healing Properties: Hematate has a strong Yang influence and is used to balance the body's channels. Priests historically have believed that when placed over the location of an illness, Hematate, will draw the "spirit" of the illness out of the patient and into the stone itself. Hematate is used for treating swollen and inflamed eyelids, headaches, blood disorders and hysteria. Because it has a positive effect upon the bloodstream, it can be used for lowering high blood pressure and treating cases of anemia. Hematate is a principal blood purifier among stone healers. It can be placed anywhere on the body for this purpose, or worn as a ring, pendant or necklace for continuous healing. Hematate helps circulate oxygen throughout the body and is good for treating kidney and spleen diseases. It assists the kidneys in cleansing the blood and stimulates the absorption of iron in the formation of red blood cells. Hematate is used to treat leg cramps, anxiety and insomnia, and it aids spinal alignments and fractures. It can also be used as an elixir for the treatment of fevers.

Recharging Dai Zhe Shi: Place Hematate over the Earth Altar's incense smoke in order to recharge its power.

Caution: Hematate should not be used where inflammation is present or for long periods of time.



Earth Element

Figure 1.48. Jade (Yu)

JADE (YU)

More information is available on the ancient Chinese use of Yu (also known as Jade) than is available on any other material (Figure 1.48). For example, in ancient China food bowls were made out of Yu in order to energize the food with Qi.

The word "Jade" comes from the Spanish word "piedra de hijada," meaning "stone of the flank," because it was used to treat kidney disease. In China, where Jade has been venerated for thousands of years, over a hundred different names are in use for the equally numerous varieties of color and quality.

In ancient China, the Dark Green variety of Yu known as "Dragon Jade" was considered to be the semen of dragons. According to legend, dragons, like certain fish, do not ejaculate inside their female counterparts but on them. The females are then impregnated by absorbing the semen through their gills and scales. Any semen that is not absorbed by the female dragon falls to Earth and congeals becoming Dragon Jade.

The toughness of Jade made it a favored stone for making axes, war clubs, knives, and other various weapons. For many centuries, it was believed to strengthen the body's Qi during life and protect its owner's Shen (spirit) after death. As China's great civilization expanded, Yu was eventually used for both tools and ornamentation (e.g., jewelry, incense burners, musical instruments, beads, talismans, religious icons, etc.), and even worn as magical amulets and symbols of power.

According to ancient Daoist belief, there are nine virtues that make Jade precious. These nine virtues are the reasons why the rulers of ancient China appreciated and valued Jade, and used it for making auspicious seals. The Nine Virtues of Jade are described as follows:

- Jade is warm, agreeable, and enriched with favors, this may be called its "benevolence"
- Its lines run back and forth close to each other, communicating systematically, this may be called its "wisdom"
- It is hard, but not over-compacted (Zu), this may be called its "righteousness"
- It is sharp, but its angles are not hurtful, this may be called its "conduct"
- It is fresh and bright, but cannot get dirty, this may be called its "purity"
- It can be broken but not bent, this may be called its "courage"
- Its cracks and spots all appear on the exterior. This may be called its "refined quality," as it does not try to cover up its weak points.
- Its flourishing, shining, agreeable lights reflect each other but do not trespass upon one another, this may be called its "tolerance."
- Upon being struck, it gives a clear, faraway and pure sound, not screaming, this may be called its "gentleness."

Jade is connected to the Earth Element, its ruling planet is Venus, and occurs in two primary mineral forms: Jadeite (Sodium Aluminum Silicate) and Nephrite (Calcium Magnesium Iron Silicate).

- **Jadeite:** The Jadeite variety is generally considered more rare and expensive, especially the naturally occurring lavender and emerald green Jadeite. It is a metamorphic mineral with a hardness of 6.5 - 7. Jadeite that is semitransparent to translucent green is traditionally called "Jade." The most common Jadeite colors are white to green, and white with greenish spots. Less common colors are pink, lilac, lavender, emerald green (known as "Imperial Jade"), lime green, silvery white, reddish brown, and brown with red. The most valued is the pink or lilac Jadeite. Jadeite's value as a gemstone increases with the level of transparency, color, and flawlessness.
- **Nephrite :** The Nephrite variety usually appears more fibrous and is a deeper, richer green than its Jadeite counterpart. Tremolite is actually Nephrite in a less compacted form. Nephrite is an amphibole mineral of tremolite and actinolite with a hardness of 5 - 6. Green Nephrite with semitransparent to translucent characteristics is also referred to as "Jade." The Chinese recognize nine kinds of Nephrite Jade, described as follows:

1. **Fen:** the color of clear water
2. **Bi:** the color of indigo blue
3. **Bi:** the color of moss green
4. **Fu:** the color of kingfisher feathers
5. **Gan:** the color of yellow
6. **Jiong:** the color of cinnabar red
7. **Men:** the color of blood red
8. **Xie:** the color of lacquer black
9. **Zha:** the color of opaque white

The gemstones value increases with the level of transparency, intensity, evenness of color, and flawlessness. The search for the raw material was surrounded by an atmosphere of particular sacredness and was solely in the hands of women.

Spiritual Properties: In ancient China, pieces of Jade were always the most appreciated minerals, and were laden with particular symbolic significance and authentic celestial energy. The ancient Daoists believed that the sacredness of "Jade" was such that it conferred upon its owner sovereignty, as well as magical and healing powers; Jade was also said to nourish the spirit and have the capacity of assuring immortality. Traditionally, Jade was placed on the eyelids or in the mouth of a dead person in order to bring back their spirit to another life on Earth.

Jade is considered one of the most important symbols of purity and serenity. It is also revered as an ancient symbol of love and as a stone that brings luck, especially specimens that are dark olive-green in color. The ancient Chinese felt that Jade helped inspire the mind to make quick and precise decisions. Ancient traders would often hold this gem in the palm of their right hand while he engaging in business transactions. It is also said

that wearing Jade while gardening will improve the health of the plants.

Martial Properties: Ancient Daoists used Jade in amulets to turn hostile psychic attacks back onto their senders, therefore Jade is worn for protection during defensive magical workings. Similarly, small pieces of Jade can be energized and buried along the houses perimeter for the purpose of creating magical stone "guardians." In ancient times, Green Jade was believed to be able to bring rain. Although it was commonly placed in the mouth of a corpse to protect the soul, necromancers often used it to raise the soul of the dead.

Healing Properties: Jade has been called "colic stone," "spleen stone" and the "stone of the loins." Its healing ability corresponds to the particular color of the stone. Wearing Jade is said to aid the body in its healing process, while simultaneously working on the underlying energetic problems that caused the disease in the first place. For example, in ancient China it was believed that Jade tied to the arm could help expel kidney stones, whereas Jade worn around the neck (and not removed) could ward off infantile disease. Bracelets constructed of Jade were also worn to promote a long life, and Jade ornaments or jewelry were worn as charms to prevent eye infection.

Jade assists in healing digestive ailments, and it makes a good healing talisman for the kidneys, urinary bladder, heart, spleen, digestive and immune system. It is believed to help cleanse blood, increase longevity and fertility, avert epilepsy, and treat eye disorders and female problems.

A powerful emotional balancer, Jade is also said to prevent nightmares. The ancient Chinese believed that pure Jade radiates divine, unconditional love, dispels negativity, promotes clarity, modesty, courage, justice, peace and wisdom. It was considered to be the concentrated essence of love.

Recharging Yu: Place Jade in running water (i.e., place it in a stream for several minutes), or over the Earth Altar's incense smoke in order to recharge its power.

Earth Element

Figure 1.49. Jasper (Bi Yu)

JASPER (BI YU)

Jasper (also known as Bi Yu) occurs in patterns of various colors of the rainbow (black, brown, red, yellow, blue, green, and purple); however, Red (Fire) and Green (Water) Jasper are the most magically important. Jasper is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.49).

- **Black Jasper (Hei Bi Yu):** This stone is used for scrying, and it facilitates deeper altered states of consciousness as well as bringing about prophetic dreams and visions.
- **Blue Jasper (Lan Bi Yu):** This stone connects the individual to the spirit world. It balances the body's Yin and Yang energy and stimulates the body's energetic fields. In ancient times, Blue Jasper was used to sustain energy during long periods of fasting. When placed on the Middle Dantian, it is used for spirit travel. Blue Jasper also heals degenerative diseases and balances mineral deficiencies.
- **Brown Jasper (Ka Fei Bi Yu):** This stone stimulates the Fifth (throat) and Sixth (Third Eye) Chakras, creating clearer articulation and greater contact with visionary capacities. It also brings stability, balance, and centering, facilitating deep meditative states. It is used in past life regression, revealing karmic causes, and encourages spirit travel. Brown Jasper stimulates the psychic faculties and soul recall, and can be useful for past-life recall of traumatic events affecting one's present life. Brown Jasper improves night vision, heals the skin, and boasts the immune system by clearing toxins from the body and cleaning internal organs. It is also used to alleviate environmental pathogens.

Clinically Brown Jasper can be used to stimulate the kidneys, thymus gland and the entire immune system. It benefits the surface of the skin, as well as stimulates the neurological tissues associated with the kidneys and thymus. It can be used in order to treat premature aging and skin blemishes (also certain types of allergies).

- **Golden Yellow Jasper (Huang Bi Yu):** This stone is used for protection during spiritual work and spiritual travel. Yellow Jasper gathers and releases positive energy, energizes the endocrine system, stimulates the yellow court, and releases toxins. It is also used for healing digestive and stomach problems.

  Clinically, Yellow Jasper is used to stimulate general tissue regeneration throughout the entire endocrine system (with a particular focus of the thymus and pancreas areas). It is also used to activate the parasympathetic ganglia, which stimulates the entire endocrine system.
- **Green Jasper (Qing Bi Yu):** Like Green Jade, Green Jasper is used in weather magic to bring rain. It is also used to release the body from emotional obsession and to stimulate the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) area. Green Jasper mildly aligns all the chakras, which stimulates telepathy and clairvoyance, and it assists in balancing the healer's auric field.

  Clinically, Green Jasper promotes healing on all levels. Because it activates general tissue regeneration, it can be used as a general tonic in tissue massage. It combines well with massage oils and can be used to break up toxins and minor tumor formations growing within the muscle tissue. Elixirs constructed out of Green Jasper can be used to restore flexibility and oxygenation throughout the entire capillary system (particularly in the skin's tissue) and can be used to stimulate tissue regeneration after overexposure to radiation.

  Green Jasper reduces toxicity and inflammation, and is sometimes used to treat skin disorders, dispel bloating, and treat diseases of the digestive tract. To recharge Green Jasper, place it in the seawater.
- **Purple Jasper (Zi Bi Yu):** This stone is used to stimulate the Upper Dantian and Baihui area.
- **Red Jasper (Hong Bi Yu):** This stone can be used to stimulate to Fifth (throat) chakra, increase spiritual insight into things, and activate the body's Yang Qi. It is traditionally used in magical rituals of evocation practised in order to retain the control of summoned spirits, and to contend with the shadowy and dangerous side of the magical realm. Of all the Jaspers, the red verity is considered to offer the most powerful form of energetic protection against physical threats and psychic attacks. Red Jasper is used to return negative energies back to the sender.

  Red Jasper also calms the emotions, and when placed under the pillow, it helps dream recall. It stimulates the Lower Dantian, increases the body's Qi, assists in spiritual re-birthing, cleanses the stabilizes the body's Wei Qi field, and strengthens energetic boundaries. Red Jasper helps activate sexuality and is commonly used in Sex Magic. It also strengthens and detoxifies the circulatory system, blood and liver, specifically dissolving blockages within the liver or bile ducts. Pass Red Jasper through the flame of the left red altar candle in order to recharge its energy.

Spiritual Properties: Jasper represents the Earth Element. It can be use after completing a ritual to help the priest regain his or her center and become grounded. Jasper is stabilizing, and is said to help reduce insecurities, fears, and guilt, and to de-crystallize illusions. It brings about tranquility and wholeness, unifying all aspects of an individual's life. Because it aligns all the chakras, Jasper can be used for balancing the chakras and for spiritual attunement. It is also used to facilitate spirit travel and dream recall. Jasper balances the body's Yin and Yang energy and aligns the physical, energetic, and spiritual bodies with the energetic realm of existence.

Martial Properties: Jasper is used for protection, for absorbing negative energy, and for grounding the body's Jing and Qi. In ancient times, it was used to bring about courage, stimulate the imagination, transform ideas into action. Jasper is one of the classic amulet stones and is worn in magical rituals of evocation in order to retain the control of summoned spirit entities, and to conjure rain

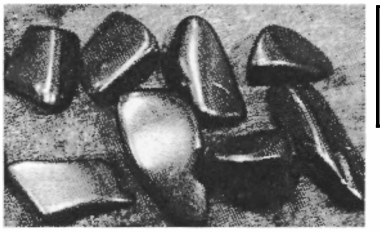
storms. It is often worn to protect the wearer against supernatural evil and psychic attacks by dispelling destructive magic created by hostile priests, driving away aggressive spirit entities. Jasper has a strong reputation as a rain-bringer, and for this reason it is regularly used in weather magic.

Healing Properties: Jasper is often water-worn and known as the "supreme nurturer." It is considered to be a powerful healing stone, with a strong impact on physical body. It also works with the chakras according to the specific color of the stone. Jasper is an excellent stone for healers as it enhances and purifies the blood, lessens pain, stops bleeding, helps the anemic, vitalizes brain tissue, stimulates hormone balance, and prevents digestive pains. It strengthens the liver, gall bladder, and urinary bladder. It also tonifies the body's circulatory system, digestive system and reproductive organs. Jasper is used to balance the body's auric field, balance the mineral content of the body, and is sometimes used for treating epilepsy, cancer, and wasting diseases.

JET (MEI JING)

Jet (also known as Mei Jing), is a soft, opaque black gemstone, easily identified because it is very, very lightweight. It is composed of carbonized wood (lignite coal). Like amber, Jet has the property of becoming electrically charged when rubbed with wool or silk. It is sometimes referred to as "Witches Amber," because Wiccan High Priestesses are said to wear necklaces of alternating Amber and Jet. Considered to be a very potent defense against all kinds of supernatural evil, in the 16th Century, Jet was universally used by the Catholic church to make rosaries because of its protective qualities. Mei Jing is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.50), its ruling planet is Saturn, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian and First Chakra (perineum) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Jet is considered to be a link between the physical and the spiritual realms, and is therefore used to balance the emotions. It cleanses the Lower Dantian and stimulates the rise of the body's life-force energy (i.e., when placed on the Middle Dantian it directs the energy towards the Upper Dantian).



Earth Element

Figure 1.50. Jet (Mei Jing)

Martial Properties: Jet is used to ward off evil, especially psychic attacks, and is used to protect its owner from demon or spirit possession. It was also believed to be able to absorb any illness or negative energy, and remove fears and depression. Jet was important to the ancient Chinese. It was commonly used as a protective talisman against illness, protecting its owner from the energetic and spiritual harm of psychic and physical attacks. Jet provides protection during spirit travel, and was also believed to offer protection from thunderstorms. In ancient times, burning powered Jet as an incense was believed to be an effective way of breaking a very strong curse delivered from a hostile priest. The smoke created from the Jet was believed to banish all of the destructive energies.

Healing Properties: In ancient times, Jet was used to repel plague, fever and negativity. It acts as an energetic filter for germs and aids in healing migraine headaches, toothaches, stomach diseases, goiter, edema, epilepsy, hysteria and hallucinations caused by fever. It was used in treating women's discomforts, especially during labor. In ancient times, Jet was powdered and mixed with bees wax, and applied to tumor formations. It also diminishes glandular and lymphatic swelling and heals stomach pain.

Recharging Mei Jing: Place Jet in the Earth overnight (i.e., bury it in a sacred spot, surrounded by healthy foliage) in order to recharge its power.

Caution: It is important to note that several cultures also believe that Jet worn next to the skin will absorb some of the person's soul essence, therefore personal Jet was always carefully guarded to avoid giving someone else power over the original owner. Also, because Jet is considered one of the most powerful absorbers of negative energy, it should be frequently cleansed by exposure to sunlight.

Lapis Lazuli (Chin Jing Shi)

Chin Jing Shi (also known as Lapis Lazuli) is cobalt blue in color, flaked with gold, and permeated with magical powers and sacred vibrations. It has been greatly appreciated and sought after ever since ancient times. The ancient Chinese believed that the blood of Zhang Hong forms Lapis Lazuli in the space of three years. Lapis Lazuli is connected to the Wood / Air Element (Figure 1.51), its ruling planet is Jupiter, and it stimulates the Fifth Chakra (throat), Upper Dantian, and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas.

Wood/air Element

Figure 1.51. Lapis Luzuli (Chin Jing Shi)

According to the ancient Chinese insignia of Imperial Rank, the middle division of 4th Rank was recognized by the blue Lapis Lazuli button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to opaque blue glass). The clasp that the officials wore was ornamented gold, with a silver button.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Wild Goose;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Manchurian Tiger.

Spiritual Properties: Lapis Lazuli is a visionary stone. In ancient times, Lapis Lazuli was used as a key to spiritual attainment, allowing the priest to communicate with the spirit realm and invoke divine inspiration. As a psychic stone, Lapis Lazuli is believed to harmonize the body on the physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual level. It stimulates the Upper Dantian, opens up the Third Eye, enhances dream work, Spirit Travel and Soul Travel, increases psychic abilities, and facilitates enlightenment.

Martial Properties: Lapis Lazuli is used in all forms of Night Magic. It is a powerful thought amplifier that stimulates the higher faculties of the mind, encourages creativity and focuses intention. It has been used since ancient times as a protective stone that contacts spirit guardians and blocks psychic attacks, returning the energy of any psychic attack back to its source. Lapis Lazuli is also used to increase the power of the spoken word (incantation) and can reverse curses or diseases caused from having not spoken out in the past.

Healing Properties: Lapis Lazuli alleviates pain, especially that of migraine headaches. When worn as a necklace it cures epilepsy, skin troubles, lung disorders, and poor blood. It relieves the pain of neuralgia, alleviates eye inflammation, tonifies the respiratory and nervous systems, and strengthens the throat, larynx, thymus and thyroid glands. Lapis Lazuli cleanses the internal organs, strengthens the bone marrow, counters depression, overcomes hearing loss, purifies the blood, strengthens the immune system, and increases the body's Righteous Qi. It is also used for treating insomnia, vertigo, high blood pressure, and activating certain sections of the vertebrae connected to the parasympathetic ganglia.

Clinically, Lapis Lazuli has been used to effectively treat inflammation such as: tonsillitis, inflammations in the esophagus, larynx, upper bronchial passages, and minor inflammations in the atlas. It invigorates the thymus, pituitary and thyroid glands, as well as the lymphatic system. It is also used to treat diseases involving the spleen, lungs, lymph, throat, and thymus, as well as Hodgkin's disease and cancer of the larynx.

Recharging Chin Jing Shi: Place Lapis Lazuli in starlight (i.e., place outside several hours after sunset during a New Moon) in order to recharge its power.

Caution: Avoid rinsing Lapis Lazuli, it dulls the polish. Instead, wipe it with a soft cloth two to three times a week. Do not where Lapis Lazuli (which stimulates and activates the Shen) with Blue Lace Agate (which relaxes and sedates the Shen).

MALACHITE (KONG QUE SHI)

Kong Que Shi (also known as Malachite) is a heavy, green striped, banded, or swirled colored stone. Certain traditions believe that placing Malachite in copper will increase and accent the stone's magical powers. Malachite is connected to the Fire Element (Figure 1.52), its ruling planet is Venus, and it stimulates the Yellow Court, Third Chakra (Solar Plexus), Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas.

Fire Element

Figure 1.52. Malachite (Kong Que Shi)

Spiritual Properties: Malachite is a stone of transformation. When placed on the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), it will activate inner-vision and psychic vision. It can be used for scrying or to access the internal or external dimensions of other worlds. Malachite amplifies the body's Yin and Yang Qi and it grounds the spiritual energy by rooting the Shen.

When placed on the Yellow Court, Malachite facilitates a deeper emotional healing by releasing the negative experiences of old traumas and bringing suppressed feelings to the surface. When placed on the Yellow Court, it can also be used to balance the energy that flows from the Heart and Middle Dantian towards the Lower Dantian. Malachite is useful in treating psychosexual problems, especially those caused by traumatic experiences. It is also useful in assisting spiritual rebirthing and transformation. It stimulates dreams, brings memories vividly to life, and also absorbs negative energy.

Martial Properties: Malachite can be used to amplify the priest's intent, and is considered to be a powerful weapon of Protective Magic. In ancient times, Malachite was believed to protect children from evil spirits, psychic attacks, and other magical spells issued from evil priests and witches. It was also believed to protect the wearer against injuries caused by falling. The ancient Chinese believed Malachite could protect against lightning. This stone has a strong connection to Nature Spirits and Celestial Immortals. The northern Mongolians believed drinking from a cup made out of Malachite would give them power to understand the language of animals.

Healing Properties: Malachite is an extremely versatile healing stone, and can help restore anyone who is suffering from "burnout." It is often used by midwives for the treatment of women's problems, such as menstrual cramps and facilitating childbirth. Malachite lowers blood pressure and is used to treat asthma, arthritis, epilepsy, fractures, swollen joints, motion sickness, vertigo, tumors, optic nerve damage, and sexual diseases. It tonifies the pancreas, spleen and parathyroid gland, and stimulates the liver to release toxins. Malachite aligns the body's DNA and cellular structure and enhances the immune system. It was also used to treat diabetes when worn around the waist as a belt. The ancient Chinese believed Malachite could protect against rheumatism and cholera, and it was also used to treat colds and diarrhea.

Clinically, Malachite is used to promote complete tissue regeneration, strengthen the heart, pineal gland, pituitary gland, circulatory system, and increase capillary action. It removes toxicity in the fatty tissue, expels plutonium, and rejuvenates the neurological tissues. It can be used to treat autism, dyslexia, epilepsy, neurological discharge problems, physical coordination disorders and visual problems, as well as mental illness, radiation-induced illness and systemic toxicity. People who live near nuclear power plants, nuclear storage facilities, or who are constantly exposed to radiation should usually wear Malachite, keep pieces of the stone in the house, and sometimes ingest Malachite elixirs for increased protection. Malachite elixirs are also good to ingest while fasting.

Recharging Malachite: Malachite should always be cleansed before and after use by placing it in a Quartz cluster in the Sun for 30 minutes. Never use salt to clean Malachite, it will damage the stone's surface. Be aware that Leu Song Shi (Turquoise) dampens the energy of Malachite.

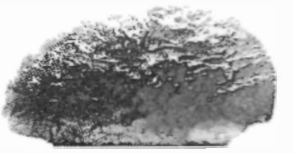
Caution: Use extreme caution in cleaning Malachite, as it is easily broken down by some solvents. Avoid rinsing Malachite in water, it dulls the polish. Instead, wipe it with a soft cloth two to three times a week.

Malachite requires extra care, in that it amplifies whatever energies are already existent within the environment. It can sometimes cause slight Heart palpitations when placed on the Middle Dantian, and therefore must be use with discretion. Also, Malachite is toxic in raw mineral form (avoid breathing its dust) and should only be used after it has been polished. When creating an elixir use only the indirect method.

MOLDAVITE

This dark green transparent stone is often glassy in appearance, and is sometimes referred to in China as "old Jade." It is formed when a giant meteorite strikes the earth. The heat of the impact changes and transforms the surrounding rocks, creating formations of Moldavite crystal. It is therefore considered to be a fusion of both celestial and terrestrial energies. Moldavite is connected to the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements (Figure 1.53). It energetically stimulates the Middle Dantian, Fourth Chakra (heart), Upper Dantian, and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Moldavite is a powerful magical stone that dramatically enhances the priest's ability to shift in and out of different dimensions. It can activate each of the Three Dantians and all seven chakras, and it is considered to contain its own celestial Ling Shen (Magical Spirit). It allows the priest access to the immortal realm and celestial messengers. This stone has an extremely high vibration that transforms consciousness, and enables the priest to access his or her divine purpose (Zhi Yi Tian) and destiny (Ming). Moldavite accelerates spiritual growth and takes the priest to the highest spiritual dimensions. It facilitates time travel (whether to the future or to the past), and allows for past



Wuji Element

Figure 1.53. Moldavite

life recall. Throughout the centuries priests have used Moldavite to "download" information from the infinite knowledge of the Wuji into the spirit body. This information must then be processed and brought into consciousness in order to accelerate spiritual growth and raise the body's resonate vibration. Moldavite has also been used since ancient times as a talisman and amulet for promoting psychic ability, gathering good fortune, and ensuring fertility.

Martial Properties: Moldavite can greatly increase the power and magically enhance the effects of other crystals. Using Moldavite in conjunction with other crystals brings out the other magical stone's highest power and manifests its greatest potential.

Healing Properties: Moldavite is considered a potent healer, especially for brain and nervous system disorders. It is generally used as a tool for diagnosing, making one aware of the cause and source of a disease. It strengthens the energy flows throughout the spleen channel, cleanses the lung channel, and energizes and cleanses the acupuncture points throughout the sinuses and forehead area.

Recharging Moldavite: In order to recharge its power, place Moldavite outside in stormy weather, particularly when lightning is flashing.

Caution: Moldavite is a fragile stone and should not be cleansed with salt, as it will scratch the stone's surface. Additionally, Moldavite is said to be so powerful that only seasoned adepts and highly trained priests should use the stone. Symptoms caused from increasing the body's energetic field before the priest has had chance to adjust to the stone's higher frequency can range from headaches, hot flashes, dizziness, to nausea.

MOONSTONE

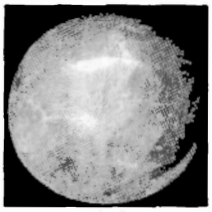


Figure 1.54. Moonstone

Wood/air and Water Element

Called Moonstone for its resemblance to the silvery moon. This milky, translucent stone comes in white, gray, peach, pink, yellow, and pure white with blue fire (called Rainbow Moonstone) colors. A priest's Moonstone is said to be white and lustrous, and may have a pearly or opaline shimmer of other colors when exposed to the light. Moonstone is said to change color with the phases of the Moon. Moonstone is connected to the Wood / Air Element and Water Element (Figure 1.54), its ruling planet is the Moon, and it stimulates the Upper Dantian, Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Moonstone is known as the "stone of new beginnings." It promotes intuition and empathy and is most commonly associated with foretelling the future during the time of the full or waning moon. Moonstone is also known as a psychic mirror, associated with lucid dreaming and divination. To increase clairvoyance, answer questions, and determine a proper course of action, a Moonstone is placed in the mouth before bed during a waning Moon. The answer is said to come in dreams during the night. In ancient times, Moonstone was worn as a pendant to encourage the disciple to accept and access his or her psychic gifts. When placed on the Yellow Court it is used to draw out old emotional patterns so that they can be understood and resolved. Drinking Moonstone Elixirs are believed to help develops psychokinetics and clairvoyant powers.

According to the ancient Chinese insignia of Imperial Rank, the middle division of 6th Rank was recognized by the White Adularia (also White Jade and Moonstone) button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to opaque white glass). The clasp that the officials wore was mother-of-pearl.

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with an Eastern Egret;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Mottled Bear.

Martial Properties: Moonstone plays an important role in magical rituals that require the use of the celestial powers of the Moon. At night, the stone is believed to absorb the celestial powers of the Moon and transfer them into the ritual area. As the light and power of the Moon waxes (grows), the stone becomes more powerful, until it reaches its peak during the Full Moon.

Moonstone is also believed to protect travelers from danger, especially those who journey at night and on the sea. Moonstone is said to protect children from night terrors and help children establish a regular healthy sleeping pattern.

Healing Properties: Moonstone is connected to the pineal gland and balances the body's hormonal system. It stabilizes body fluids and balances and harmonizes the individual's biorhythms. It is believed to alleviate fevers, and to cure consumption, edema, and kidney troubles. Moonstone is helpful in treating problems of the digestive tract and in alleviating degenerative conditions of the hair, eyes, skin and fleshy organs. It is used to treat the liver and pancreas and to aid in the elimination of toxins and the assimilation of nutrients. Moonstone is excellent in the treatment of reproductive disorders, gynecological conditions such as PMS and obstetric conditions of conception, pregnancy, childbirth and breastfeeding. Moonstone can be used in cases of shock, and can also be used to calm hyperactive children. As an elixir, Moonstone is traditionally used to treat insomnia and prevent sleep walking.

Clinically, Moonstone is used to strengthen the abdomen, spleen, pancreas, pituitary gland, and intestinal tract. It weakens abdominal ulcers, realigns abdominal walls, and improves the digestion of food. It is commonly used to treats any type of disease that causes ulcer formations. It energetically opens the Third (Yellow Court) Chakra and releases abdominal tension.

Recharging Moonstone: In order to recharge its power, place Moonstone outside in the light of a Full Moon (i.e., leave it in a crystal cluster from moonrise to moonset).

Obsidian (Hei Yao Shi)

Hei Yao Shi (also known as Obsidian) is a shiny, opaque, glass-like gemstone. Sometimes known as volcanic glass, Hei Yao Shi is created when a volcanic flow is cooled very quickly. Hei Yao Shi energetically works extremely fast and with great power, and it comes in a variety of colors ranging from black, mahogany, red-black, green, green-blue, blue, electric-blue, silver-sheen, golden-sheen, and rainbow. All Hei Yao Shi is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.55), and it stimulates the Lower Dantian and First Chakra (perineum) areas.

- **Black Obsidian:** This stone is often referred to as the "Wizard's Stone," as it opens the gates to the Underworld yet also provides protection from misuse. It roots and grounds the soul and spiritual forces into the physical plane and brings them under the direction of the conscious will, making it possible to manifest spiritual energies within the physical realm. It highlights hidden factors and brings the shadow qualities of one's dark side to the surface for release. Black Obsidian affects an individual's past life and ancestral lineages. It reverses previous misuse of power and addresses power issues on all levels. It is used for protection, repels negativity, disperses evil intentions, and can be used to remove energetic cords and spirit entities that have attached to the Wei Qi field.

  Black Obsidian is a stone of prophecy that amplifies magical powers. Spheres of Black Obsidian are used as powerful meditation tools, enhancing the gift of prophecy and aiding the priest in scrying. Black Obsidian was used in ancient shamanism to remove physical disorders. It relieves pain and improves circulation.
- **Blue Obsidian:** This stone assists in spirit travel, facilitates divination, and enhances telepathy. It opens up the body's three Wei Qi fields by allowing the tissues to receive healing energy. It activates the body's fifth chakra and supports communication skills.

Earth Element

Figure 1.55. Obsidian (Hei Yao Shi)

  Blue Obsidian is used to treat speech defects, eye disorders, Alzheimer's disease, schizophrenia, and multiple personality disorders.
- **Electric-Blue Obsidian:** This stone facilitates divination, trance states, spirit travel, psychic communication, and past life regression. It is an intuitive stone that opens the third eye and assists in inner journeys. Electric-Blue Obsidian is used for treating spinal misalignment, impacted vertebra, and circulatory disorders. When used as an elixir it heals the eyes.
- **Golden-Sheen Obsidian:** This stone is particularly effective for scrying, allowing the mystic to access the future and the past. Golden-Sheen Obsidian is used to impart knowledge of spiritual direction and balance an individual's energetic fields. It can be used to purge, clear, and stimulate the Yellow Court and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) areas of negative energies.
- **Green-Blue Obsidian:** This stone assists in Qigong healing and is used to balance the body, mind and spirit. It activates the Fifth Chakra and supports communication skills. Green-Blue Obsidian improves the assimilation of vitamins A and E, and enhances night vision.
- **Green Obsidian:** This stone opens and purifies the Middle Dantian, Heart and Throat Chakras. It removes energetic cords that are attached to the body from other people, places and things. Green Obsidian is traditionally used to treat Gallbladder and Heart diseases.
- **Mahogany Obsidian:** This stone has a much gentler energy than Black Obsidian. It is used

for grounding and protecting the body's energetic field, eliminating energetic blockages, and strengthening the internal organs and tissues. Mahogany Obsidian can be used in body layouts (placed on the tissues) to stimulate the energetic connection between the First Chakra (perineum) and the Second Chakra (navel) areas to purge unconscious memories of guilt, shame and humiliation. It also be used to stabilize and strengthen a weak energetic field, relieve pain, and improve circulation.

- **Rainbow Obsidian:** This stone has strong protective properties and is connected to the spirit realm. It releases energetic cords that are attached to people, places and things, and it replenishes the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra's (heart) energetic field. Rainbow Obsidian spheres are highly prized for their ability to enhance scrying, and are commonly used in all transformational rituals as well as for Night Magic. Worn as a pendant, Rainbow Obsidian will absorb negative energy from the body's Wei Qi fields and strengthen prophetic abilities.
- **Red-Black Obsidian:** This stone raises the body's life-force energy, promotes vitality, and tonifies the body's Jing. Red-Black Obsidian is used to treat fevers and chills.
- **Silver-Sheen Obsidian:** This stone is a perfect crystal for scrying. Silver-Sheen Obsidian enhances meditation and is helpful when journeying out of the body as it connects the spirit body with the physical body and is used to bring the soul back into physical incarnation.

Spiritual Properties: The more opaque Obsidian is, the more concentrated its powers. Obsidian polishes to a shiny mirror surface, which lends itself to many spiritual uses (especially in scrying, as an alternative to a Crystal Ball) and was utilized in numerous ancient civilizations. It provides deep soul healing, and is sometimes used to facilitate going back to heal past-life traumas. It can be used to protect against negative energy and psychic attacks, remove negative spirit influences, and dissolve blocks in the body's physical and energetic fields. Obsidian revitalizes the soul's purpose in life, anchors the spirit into the body, stimulates growth on all levels, and assists in supporting the life purpose. In ancient times Obsidian was used to help the priest face his or her dark side and teach how to integrate it and control its energetic potential.

Martial Properties: All Obsidian is considered extremely protective and said to allow no negative energy or negative spirit to enter. In ancient times, it was believed to drive out demons. Hence it is often used as a grounding stone for spirit and soul projection and the training of other psychic skills. Obsidian is used to provide protection from psychic attacks cast by other priests, as well as to provide protection from negative or impish spirits. It can be used to provide a grounding cord from the Lower Dantian into the center of the Earth to absorb any negative energies from the environment. Obsidian can be very useful in blocking geopathic pathogens (the subtle energetic emissions that stem from underground waterways, powerlines and negative earth energetic lines).

Healing Properties: Obsidian is said to aid and promote digestion, detoxify the body, and dissolve energetic blockages in the physical and energetic bodies. It reduces the pain of arthritis, joint problems and cramps. Placing Obsidian by the bed or under the pillow can draw out mental stress and tension and have a calming effect on the body and mind. Used as an elixir it is beneficial for the treatment of shock, and can sometimes be used to shrink an enlarged prostate gland.

Clinically, Obsidian is used to treat and balance the Qi of the stomach, the entire intestinal tract, and muscle tissue. It alleviates bacterial and viral inflammations, and strengthen the channels and acupuncture points.

Recharging Obsidian: In order to recharge its power, place Obsidian outside in the sunlight.

Caution: Because of its enhancement of personal powers, Obsidian is considered to be a one person stone, and is generally not given as a gift.

OPAL (DAN BAI SHI)

Dan Bai Shi (also known as Opals) come in a variety of colors including white, black, blue, pink and clear. Traditional, Dan Bai Shi usually have various colors that flash their light across the surface of the stone. The various types of Dan Bai Shi have different energetic properties. However, in Chinese culture, the milky background and multicolored fire of the White Opal is considered to be the most prized. The White Opal is connected to the Water Element (Figure 1.56), its ruling planet is the Moon, and it stimulates all Three Dantians, and all seven chakra areas.

Water Element

Figure 1.56. Opal (Dan Bai Shi)

Spiritual Properties: White Opals have intense, fast-acting powers. They are associated with the gift of prophecy, and are believed to aid in spirit and soul projection. The primary use of a White Opal is in visionary work: it is used to stimulate the visionary senses, heighten scrying, and to intentionally shift in and out of lucid dream states. It enhances spiritual consciousness and induces psychic and mystical visions. The ancient Chinese believed the wearer must be pure of heart in order to receive the energetic and spiritual gifts of the stone.

White Opals are sometimes used in Sex Magic. However, they are said to impart bad luck on those who stray in love or attempt to use the power of the stone for selfish or evil purposes.

Martial Properties: White Opals are considered to be a protective stone and when energetically activated, it is believed to be able to renders the wearer invisible. White Opals will turn pale if in the presence of poison, and lose their shine if the owner dies.

Healing Properties: White Opals are used in the treatment of infections and fevers as well as Parkinson's disease. It purifies the blood and kidneys, regulates insulin and is beneficial to the eyes.

Recharging White Opals: Because the stone absorbs the emotions of its owner, in order to recharge its power, place or sprinkle the White Opal with Holy Water often.

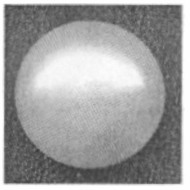
Caution: Because White Opals are basically wet rocks, with water trapped in their crystal structure, giving the stone its beautiful iridescence. They must be protected from harsh chemicals, sunlight, and heat to keep the water from escaping. Opals are often stored in glycerin or water between wearing, or kept in a black silk bag when not in use. Even with the best of care, Opals will sometimes disintegrate over time.

PEARL (ZHEN ZHU)

The formation of a Zhen Zhu (also known as Pearl) begins as a coating secreted over an irritating grain of sand inside of a fresh or salt water mollusk shell (oyster). Pearl occur in a wide range of colors, including pink, violet, black, gray, tan, gold, silver, and white. Pearl is connected to the Water Element (Figure 1.57), and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, Second Chakra (Navel), Upper Dantian, and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas.

Pearl were believed to be magical items imbued with Yang Qi. According to ancient funereal rites, Pearl were one of the primary objects placed into the mouth of the dead (i.e., feudal lords). Pearl were used in this manner to either facilitate corpse revival, or to retard the decomposition of a corpse (it was believed that the traveling soul could return to its body, especially if it found that its flesh and blood were still in a state conducive for re-occupation). For example, during the Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.), it was also believed that certain Pearl could be useful in recalling to life those individuals who have already died, or are at the point of dying.

There are many ancient stories during the Han Dynasty time period surrounding special Pearl that were so full of Yang Qi that they emitted rays of light. These magical Pearl were often called "Night-Shining Pearls" ("Ye Ming Zhu"), "Bright Moon Pearls," "Flaming Pearls," and "Pearls of Fire." These beautiful names were given to the pearls because they glimmered with a thread of light when held against the Sun on a



Water Element

Figure 1.57. Silver/White Pearl (Zhen Zhu)

fair day, (not because the pearls shone in the dark of night). These magical pearls were also placed into the mouths of the dead in order to provide light to the wandering soul, so that it could safely find its path in the dark Underworld.

Dragons are often depicted as chasing a "pearl" like jewel object. The pearl may be thought of as a metaphor for perfection and enlightenment, particularly if the dragon represents the emperor.

The pearl also resembles the Moon. As a dragon devours the pearl, less and less of the pearl is seen and the pearl appears as a waning moon. As a dragon disgorges the pearl, more and more of the pearl is seen and the pearl therefore appears as a waxing Moon. The dragon and pearl thus symbolize the endless cycle of transformation.

Frequently, the "pearl" is shown with flames which symbolizes magical powers and may represent the wish-granting pearl of Buddhism.

The pearl (flaming pearl) is one of the Eight Treasures. The pearl can also refer to riches, pure intentions and genius in obscurity.

- **Black Pearl (Hei Zhen Zhu):** There is an ancient Chinese story that says that the Full Moon produced so much Heavenly Dew from the discarded dreams and memories of men that it fell into the sea. Oysters came to the surface of the ocean and opened their shells to receive the light of the Moon and ingested the discarded Heavenly Dew, which fell inside and hardened into Pearls. The Black Pearls are all the sad thoughts that have been transformed into beauty and hope by the Moon Goddess Heng O. Therefore, Black Pearl is associated with the dark of the Moon.

  Black Pearl is considered to be very magical for women, enabling them to contact their deeper core-self. It helps control mood swing and adjusts the physical body to a deeper form of sexual harmony.

  Choose the time of the New Moon in order to recharge Black Pearl. It can also be recharged by placing the perals onto a dark pointed Amethyst cluster overnight.
- **White Pearl (Bai Zhen Zhu):** Although pearls are available in many colors, to the ancient Chinese, the white and silver colored pearls are considered to be the best. White and silver pearls were believed to be the essential powers of Yin, water and the Moon. They represented modesty and wholesomeness and were worn as symbols of perfection and purity. The White Pearl were considered to be the most "Yang within Yin" (i.e., the captured and condensed light of the Full Moon), and they were valued for their magical ability.

  In order to recharge a White Pearl, begin at sunset and place it in the moonlight during one of the three days of the Full Moon.

Spiritual Properties: Pearl act as a clear channel for receptive spiritual guidance. They increase spiritual as well as romantic love. Pearl harmonize the body's rhythms with those of the natural cycles of the Moon and the seasons.

Martial Properties: Pearl help to amplify the body's energy. In ancient times it was believed that the wearing of Pearl would protect an individual from the harmful effects of Moon afflictions. The Pearl is also used to ward off evil, and it can forecast danger, sickness, or death by the way it losses its luster.

Healing Properties: In ancient China, Pearls have long been cherished, both for their medicinal qualities and for their use as a beauty aid. Pearls are excellent in the treatment of stress-related illnesses and are especially good in the treatment of stomach aches, ulcers, hypertension, headaches, and fatigue. Pearl powder supports and balances the assimilation of nutrients, enhances fertility and procreative energy, and reduces Excess Heat in heart and brain. Pearls have also been used in order to treat madness, jaundice, and snake and insect bites. They also cure gastric disorders, asthma, breathing troubles, and lung disorders.

In ancient China, Pearls were sometimes used in creating love potions, and the ancient mystics believed that sleeping with a Pearl beneath the pillow will help a childless couple to conceive.

Cautions: Like Jet and White Opal, Pearls should only belong to one person. Each Pearl is unique, and the energy of one pearl will not necessarily blend with the energy of another. White Pearls are environmentally sensitive and pick up the energetic vibrations emitted from the individual who is wearing them. It retains those feelings (either positive or negative) and later emanates that energy into the environment. Therefore, if the owner is feeling sad or in a bad mood, they should remove their pearls immediately so as to avoid unknowingly imprinting them with a negative, toxic energy. The more the pearl is exposed to chaotic emotional discharge, the more powerful the influence will be on the individual's thoughts. In the same token the owner is never to loan their pearls to another.

In certain traditions, pearls are unlucky for brides. There is an ancient saying that goes, "Pearls in an engagement ring will bring tears to the marriage." Also, the flat type pearls should never be worn.

Keep Pearls away from all forms of heat and dryness. Frequently polish them with a silk cloth (it absorbs any emotional energy that may have attached to the Pearls).

PERIDOT

Peridot (also known as Chrysolite or Olivine) is an opaque clear crystal, usually light transparent green to yellow-green in color (not the deep green of an emerald). It is found in meteorites and in deep rock that may have been brought to the surface during volcanic activity. Peridot was one of the twelve magical stones associated with the power of creating miracles. The magical powers of Peridot are believed to be doubled if the stone is set in gold. Peridot is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.58), its ruling planet is Venus, and it stimulates the Yellow Court, Third Chakra (Solar Plexus), Middle Dantians, and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas.

Earth Element

Figure 1.58. Peridot

Spiritual Properties: Peridot is a visionary crystal that helps the mystic understand his or her destiny and spiritual purpose. It is a powerful cleanser, releasing and neutralizing toxins on all levels. It purifies the energetic and spiritual bodies and activates the Middle Dantian and Yellow Court areas. It promotes psychological clarity and well being. One ancient legend states that Solomon drank "soma" from cups carved of peridot in order to gain wisdom.

Martial Properties: Peridot is believed to drive away evil spirits and madness, and protect against nightmares, enchantment, and psychic attacks. In certain ancient cultures, it was believed that a vulture engraved on a Peridot talisman would give the mystic the power to control demons, and that no demon would be able to be in the same place as the gemstone. Healers use Peridot to provide a protective shield around the entire body and remove energetic parasites (the darker shades of Peridot). The lighter colors of Peridot are believed to be excellent in assisting the priest in contacting Nature Spirits and communicating with the Mineral, Plant, and Animal realms.

Peridot can also be used in order to successfully remove toxic people from an individual's personal life. Peridot is traditionally used as a magical charm in the following manner:

- **Light Green Peridot:** Light Colored Peridot is used to remove people (with hidden agendas) from one's Inner Circle.
- **Dark Green Peridot:** Dark Colored Peridot is used to remove people (with hidden agendas) from one's Outer Circle.

Healing Properties: One legend states that any medicine drunk from a goblet carved out of Peridot will have magical healing powers. Peridot naturally has a tonifying effect on the body and is used to heal and regenerate the body's tissues. It strengthens the metabolism, benefits the skin and aids the heart, thymus, lungs, gall bladder,

spleen, and intestines. Peridot is also used to treat ulcers, cool fevers, strengthen the eyes, and to treat speech impediments such as removing stutters. Its energy is said to balance Bi-Polar disorders and is sometimes used to overcome Hypochondria.

Clinically, Peridot is considered to be a "Master Healer." It can be used to strengthen the heart, pancreas, and spleen. It stimulates tissue regeneration in the entire physical body, and gradually removes all toxicity from the tissues. Because it energetically aligns all of the subtle bodies, information from the higher self is more easily received.

When Peridot is combined with any magical elixir formula, the vibrational remedy will tend to work more effectively. It is especially useful when performing healing meditations and using creative visualization techniques. It can be used to increase the priest's psychic gifts (i.e., clairvoyance) and augment his or her spirit body.

Recharging Peridot: Choose the moonlight of one of the three days of the Full Moon in order to recharge Peridot (begin at sunset).

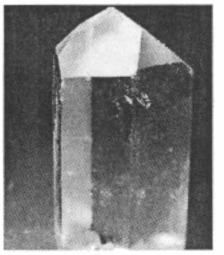
QUARTZ CRYSTAL (SHI YIN)

Shi Yin (also known as Quartz Crystal) is a clear, milky, or striated, transparent stone. Quartz Crystal is often referred to as Rock Crystal and is the crystal clear transparent variety of crystalline Quartz. It is found in long, pointed crystal structures. All of the various forms of Quartz Crystal offer protection against radiation.

In ancient China, Quartz Crystal was sometimes regarded as the essence (Jing) of the celestial dragon (the dragon represents the powers of celestial creation), and was considered to be pure, concentrated Qi. The Japanese revered Quartz Crystal as the crystallized breath of the White Dragon.

The ancient Daoists believed that Quartz Crystal was congealed water that had transformed into solid matter during the course of a thousand years. Thus, the entry ways to several ancient temples were decorated with Quartz Crystal to allow the magical light contained within the place of worship to be absorbed.

- **Clear Quartz (Tou Min Shi Yin):** Clear Quartz is considered to be pure Yang energy that is connected to the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements (Figure 1.59). Its ruling planet is the Sun, and it energetically stimulates all Three Dantians and all seven chakra areas. Clear Quartz is considered to be the most versatile of all crystals. It can be energetically used for healing, energizing, or protecting. In ancient Daoism, Clear Quartz was used to absorb energy from sunlight, moonlight, minerals, plants, trees, animals, and humans. This energy was then stored, concentrated, and released in magical rituals.



Wuji Element

Figure 1.59. Clear Quartz Crystal (Tou Min Shi Yin)

Clinically, Clear Quartz can be used to benefit the stomach, pituitary gland and the entire intestinal tract. It also offers protection against background radiation and can be used to treat intestinal tract problems, abdominal ulcers, and leukemia and the bubonic plague.

Clear Quartz stimulates glandular secretion from the pituitary gland, and can be used to augment the Third, Sixth, and Seventh Chakras, as well as balance the creativity of the Second Chakra with the sensitivity of the Third Chakra to give feeling to the expression.

According to the ancient Chinese insignia of Imperial Rank, the middle division of 5th Rank was recognized by the Clear Quartz button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to clear glass). The clasp that the officials wore was plain gold, with a silver button.

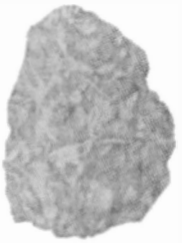
The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Silver Pheasant;

The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Black Bear.

Recharging Tou Min Shi Yin: In order to recharge and remove all energetic imprinting, leave Clear Quartz in the midday sunlight among greenery.

Wuji Element

Figure 1.60. Phantom Quartz (Gui Shi Yin)



Fire and Water Element

Figure 1.61. Rose Quartz (Meigui Shi Yin)

- **Phantom Quartz (Gui Shi Yin):** This magical stone is created when the growth of the Quartz Crystal is interrupted and a shadowy, smaller crystal appears inside its structure. It connects the priest to his or her spirit guides and enhances deeper meditational states (Figure 1.60). Phantom Quartz facilitates accessing the energetic fields of the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements. Its ruling planet is the Moon, and it energetically stimulates the Upper Dantian, Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas. Because Phantom Quartz takes the priest into the inner dimensions of the energetic and spirit realms, it is a popular tool for "ghost hunters." The priest will look through the Phantom Quartz in order to see benign ghosts. Phantom Quartz can also be used for scrying and other divination work.

  Recharging Gui Shi Yin: In order to recharge and remove all energetic imprinting, place Phantom Quartz in a steam bath created from boiling purifying herbs in water for several minutes.
- **Rose Quartz (Meigui Shi Yin):** This pinkish stone purifies and opens the heart at all levels and brings deep inner healing and self-love. Rose Quartz is connected to the Fire and Water Elements (Figure 1.61), its ruling planet is Venus, and it stimulates the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas. It is used to strengthen empathy and sensitivity, and to enhance positive affirmations. Rose Quartz is calming, reassuring, and excellent for recovering from emotional trauma or crisis. Used in emotional healing, Rose Quartz Yin releases unexpressed emotions, alleviates heartache, and soothes internalized pain. Rose Quartz is also used in both Sex Magic and Fertility Magic.

  Clinically, Rose Quartz can be used to augment the genitals, heart, kidneys, liver, lungs, and parasympathetic ganglia. It increases tissue regeneration in the kidneys and increases fertility (especially in the male). Rose Quartz eases most sexual disorders and circulatory difficulties, particularly in the constriction of the blood vessels. It stimulates the Fourth and Fifth chakras & strengthens the body's channels and acupuncture points.

  Recharging Meigui Shi Yin: In order to recharge and remove all energetic imprinting, place Rose Quartz in a steam bath created from boiling rose petals for several minutes.
- **Rutilated (Angel Hair) Quartz:** This clear or smoky colored stone has golden brown, reddish or black long thin strands. Rutilated (Angel Hair) Quartz is connected to the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements (Figure 1.62). Its ruling planet is the Sun, and it energetically stimulates all Three Dantians and all seven chakra areas. The gold strips within the Rutilated Quartz were believed to be crystallized sunlight, which contain the "cosmic" light that acts an illuminator for the soul, promoting spiritual growth and facilitating contact with the celestial Immortals. Rutilated Quartz removes negative energy, cleanses and energizes the body's Wei Qi fields, aids in Spirit Travel,

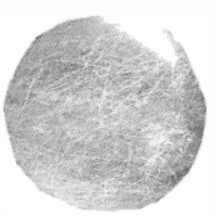


Figure 1.62. Rutilated Quartz

increases telepathy and clairvoyance, and is used in scrying and psychic projection. It is commonly used for protection against psychic attack.

Clinically, Rutilated Quartz can be used to stimulate the tissue regeneration of the entire physical body (on the bio-molecular level), and helps assimilate the life force back into the tissues. Because it offers increased protection against background radiation, Rutilated Quartz can be used clinically to effectively treat any type of radiation-related disorder. Rutilated Quartz is also believed to reverse the aging process and is commonly used for treating disorders associated with a lowered immune system. Rutilated Quartz aligns all the chakras and subtle bodies and it strengthens all the body's channels and acupuncture points. It increases clairvoyance, and stimulates inactive (or unused) parts of the brain, such as when there is brain damage.

Recharging Rutilated Quartz: In order to recharge and remove all energetic imprinting, place Rutilated Quartz Crystal on a sacred spot inside a Magic Circle for thirty-six minutes, buried in the Earth.

- **Smoky Quartz (Mao Yan Shi Yin):** This brownish to black (sometimes dark yellow) stone is one of the most effective grounding and rooting stones, while it simultaneously raises vibrations during meditation. Smoky Quartz is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.63), its ruling planet is the Saturn, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian and First Chakra (perineum) areas. This protective stone gently neutralizes negative energetic fields and blocks Sha Qi (geopathic pathogens such as subtle energetic emissions that stem

Figure 1.63. Smoky Quartz (Mao Yan Shi Yin)

from underground waterways, powerlines, and negative earth energetic lines). Smoky Quartz alleviates nightmares and facilitates the dream-state. It relieves pain, soothes headaches, and tonifies the reproductive system, adrenal glands, pancreas, kidneys, muscles, nerves, and heart. It also aids in assimilation of minerals and regulates the minerals within the body.

Smoky Phantom Quartz aligns the mental, emotional, and spirit bodies (the alignment between the First, Second, and Third Chakras), and is sometimes used to assist the priest in identifying and reconnecting with individuals of his or her "soul group" (a group of kindred spirits that incarnate together).

Clinically Smoky Quartz can be used to benefit the abdomen, kidneys, pancreas and sexual organs (i.e., it increases fertility in both sexes and augments the adrenal glands). It can also be used to treat certain heart diseases, muscular deterioration and neurological disorders.

When Smoky Quartz is taken as a magical elixir, it will cleanse the body's Wei Qi fields (aura).

Recharging Mao Yan Shi Yin: In order to recharge and remove all energetic imprinting, place Smoky Quartz on a sacred spot inside a Magic Circle for thirty-six minutes, buried in the Earth.

- **Quartz Clusters:** All varieties of Quartz Crystal are known to occur in large or small cluster formations. The energetic properties of these cluster formations have been used by numerous shamans and priests throughout the centuries in order to purify and energize other stones.

Spiritual Properties: Quartz Crystal has a long history of being used in conjunction with both shamanism and mysticism. It has been used throughout the centuries to foretell the future and commune with spirit entities, especially Nature Spirits and Celestial Guides. The stone's ability to align one's psychic self with the cosmos is often ascribed to the stone's piezoelectric properties (the ability to become electrically charged under pressure). Quartz Crystal is not only piezoelectric, but it is also pyroelectric (i.e., heating quartz also charges the stone electrically). The correspondences of water infusions contained within Quartz Crystal allow this magical stone to be used in Weather Magic in order to bring rain.

Martial Properties: Quartz Crystal is said to be a powerful amplifier of psychic energy. Because of its ability to hold on to magical energy, it was traditionally used to assist specific talismans in containing and holding on to energetically imprinted charges. It can also be used to multiply the power of Qi and Shen emission, enhance meditation, and facilitate access to the hidden knowledge within the infinite space of the Wuji. Quartz Crystal opens clairaudience and is used in order to connect with a spirit guide. It is also believed to have protective qualities, especially against night spirits.

Healing Properties: Quartz Crystal is a master healer and can be used for any condition. It is commonly used in order to increase the body's natural healing abilities, stimulate the immune system, soothe burns, and remove aches and pains.

Caution: It is important to note that once Quartz Crystal has been energetically energized and imprinted, it should never be exposed to direct sunlight unless you intend to erase its charge.

RUBY (HON BAO SHI)

Hon Bao Shi (also known as Ruby) is a type of corundum that crystallizes in the form of tubular and rhombohedral prismatic crystals. Its colors range from pink, crimson red, to orange red. In ancient China, Hon Bao Shi was considered a stone of nobility and a harbinger of health and happiness. The ancient Chinese Emperor Kublai Khan was said to have offered an entire city in exchange for a huge Ruby. Hon Bao Shi is connected to the Earth Element and Fire Element (Figure 1.64), its ruling planet is Mars, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian and First Chakra (perineum) areas.

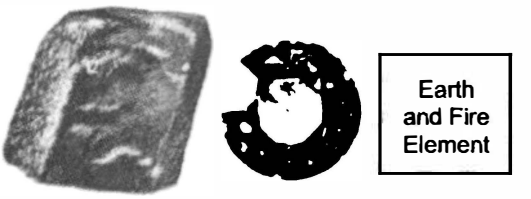


Figure 1.64. Ruby (Hon Bao Shi)

According to the ancient Chinese insignia of Imperial Rank, the superior division of 1st Rank was recognized by the officials Red Ruby button and hat insignia jewel (which was later changed to opaque red glass).

- The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a white crane;
- The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Qilin (unicorn).

The clasp that the officials wore was jade, set with rubies.

Spiritual Properties: Ruby promotes prophetic dreams and clear visions. It also stimulates the pineal gland and are said to bring joy and bliss.

Martial Properties: Ruby is a stone of courage. One ancient legend states that inserting a Ruby into one's flesh would make the individual invulnerable. In ancient China, it was believed that any fading of a Hon Bao Shi warned its owner of impending problems. Hon Bao Shi is an energetic amplifier that magnifies any energy that is present. It is valued for its ability to replenish drained Qi and restore its owner to peak levels of vitality, strength, and stamina. Hon Bao Shi is a powerful shield against psychic attack and energetic vampirism of the Fourth Chakra (heart).

Healing Properties: Ruby affect the First Chakra (perineum) and fill in and repair energetic holes in the body's Wei Qi field (aura). It is also said to eliminate energetic blockages in the reproductive system. Hon Bao Shi have been used clinically to detoxify the body, blood, and lymph systems, and to tonify the thymus gland, spleen,

adrenal glands, kidneys, and reproductive organs. They can also be used to treat fevers, infectious diseases, and stimulate the circulatory system.

Clinically, Ruby can be used to stabilizes the heart and Fourth Chakra areas, treat heart and circulatory diseases, enhance the Heart Channel, and strengthen the neurological tissues associated with the heart.

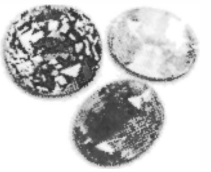
Recharging Hon Bao Shi: Wipe the Ruby with a dark red silk cloth and recharge its energy by placing it outside under the stars at night during the New Moon.

Caution: The energetic amplification of Ruby is extremely intense. It magnifies the individual's energetic field, whether positive or negative. Its intense red color can quickly give rise to feelings of passions of romance and sexual desire, as well as amplify feelings of anger and rage.

SAPPHIRE (LAN BAO SHI)

Lan Bao Shi (also known as Sapphire) are known as "stones of wisdom," with each color having its own particular form of energetic insight. Sapphires develop in a wide range of colors, including black, blue, green, pink, purple, royal, star, white, and yellow. Most Sapphires are connected to the Fire Element (Figure 1.65); however, one exception is the Bai Bao Shi (White Sapphire) which is connected to the Wood / Air Element. Its ruling planet is Saturn.

- **Black Sapphire (Hei Bao Shi):** This Sapphire is a protective stone. It provides protection and balances both the body's external and internal energetic fields. Black Sapphire also absorbs toxic energy and draws turbid Qi away from the body's tissues.
- **Blue Sapphire (Lan Bao Shi):** Blue Sapphire stimulate the Fifth Chakra (throat) and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas. It can be used in order to assist in communication and enhance insight. It is believed that using a Blue Sapphire when training increases the priest's access to esoteric knowledge, intuitive insights, and psychic perceptions. Certain Blue Sapphire are recognized as record keepers containing the ancient knowledge of civilizations that existed long ago. A dark blue stone



Fire or Wood/air Element

Figure 1.65. Sapphire (Lan Bao Shi)

is considered to be a powerful tool for deep meditation. It helps avoid negative energy and can be used to remove pathogenic Qi from the body as well as from the environment. It also amplifies the magical power of the voice and can be used to increase the power of the priest's incantations. The light blue stone is considered a stone of inspiration, bringing new ideas and thought patterns to mind.

Blue Sapphire should be worn only after a trial. It is also believed that Blue Sapphire dims in the presence of evil, and will only keep its rich coloring if worn by someone in love.

According to the ancient Chinese insignia of Imperial Rank, the superior division of 3rd Rank was recognized by the blue sapphire button and hat insignia jewel (later changed to clear blue glass). The clasp that the officials wore was ornamented gold.

The civil official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a Peafowl;

The military official wore a mandarin square embroidered with a North China Panther.

- **Golden Yellow Sapphire (Huang Bao Shi):** The Yellow Sapphire (also known as Oriental Topaz) is a stone of knowledge, inner knowing, and trust. It can be used to enhance memory and the retention of knowledge. It is also used as a stone that brings wealth and the fulfillment of one's ambition. It was used in ancient times to protect its owner from poverty and snakebite. It can be used to treat the Yellow Court and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) areas, as well as disorders of the spleen, stomach, liver, and gallbladder. Gem Elixirs made from Yellow Sapphire are traditionally used in order to remove toxins from the body.

- **Green Sapphire (Qing Bao Shi):** This Sapphire is sometimes known as an "Oriental Emerald." It is sometimes used to help support vision. It also stimulates the Fourth (heart) Chakra and has also been used to help a priest to vividly remember his or her dreams.
- **Pink Sapphire (Fen Hong Bao Shi):** The Pink Sapphire is used to help the individual cooperate and harmoniously integrate with others. It stimulates the Fourth (heart) Chakra and is a fast acting stone that teaches its owner how to master his or her emotions, clearing and integrating emotional blockages.
- **Purple Sapphire (Zi Bao Shi):** Sometimes known as the "Stone of Awakening," the Purple Sapphire (also known as Oriental Amethyst) is considered to be a stone of spiritual insight and understanding. It was used in ancient times as a tool for contemplation and meditation as its energetic nature stimulates the Upper Dantian and Crown Chakra.
- **Star Sapphire (Xing Bao Shi):** Star Sapphires combine the vibrational properties of Sapphires and Rutile, which makes this stone the most energetically active of all Sapphires. Star Sapphires focus and reflect spiritual energies in the same ways that they respond to light. They are strongly associated with clairvoyance, clairaudience, scrying and prophecy. In certain traditions, the Star Sapphire was believed to facilitate contact with the celestial immortals of the planetary realms and manifest Divine knowledge and light into the physical realm (Figure 1.66). The most popular colors of Star Sapphires are black, blue, pink, purple, and yellow.
- **White Sapphire (Bai Bao Shi):** The White Sapphire is a stone of self protection. If facilitates spiritual clarity, and focus and direction of attention. It also stimulates the Upper Dantian, Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) and Seventh Chakra (Baihui) areas. It opens the esoteric powers of the mind by stimulating the pineal and pituitary glands and strengthens the ability to energetically communicate with the spirit realm.

Fire Element

Figure 1.66. Star Sapphire (Xing Lan Bao Shi)

Spiritual Properties: Sapphire helps to clear the mind and focus the intention towards spiritual and mystical interests. It strengthen faith and enhance wisdom, discernment, and divine knowledge. It also spur philosophical thinking and improve comprehension and objective understanding. Sapphire engenders a positive mental disposition, aids in overcoming depression, and generates a bright and positive outlook. It is also known to help bring new possibilities and light, overcome doubts, develope trust, and create optimism, contentment, peace and happiness.

Martial Properties: Sapphire naturally increases all psychic and spiritual powers. It can also be used to free oneself of depression and spiritual confusion and stimulate focused concentration.

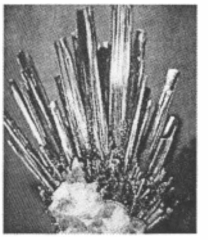
Healing Properties: Sapphire is used to treat disorders of the blood, stop excessive bleeding, and strengthen the walls of the blood vessels and veins. In the clinic, Sapphire has been used to treat cellular disorders and bring about cellular healing. It stabilizes and strengthens the nervous system, upholds the integrity of the body's physical and energetic structure, strengthens the skeletal system, and supports spinal alignment. Sapphire gives health to bones, nails, and hair, relieves headaches, preserves sight, strengthens and stimulates the Heart, and reduces stress, tension, anxiety, worry, insomnia, and fear.

Recharging Sapphire: To recharge Sapphire, place it in the sunlight from sunrise to noon. It is also advised to clear its energetic field by holding it under running water two to three times a week.

Caution: Sapphire tend to focus, emanate, and radiate energy without its owner's conscious initiation. Therefore, do not wear large stones too frequently, as they can begin to drain the body's Qi. The healing energy of the large stones will cause a mental discharge of unprocessed emotional baggage which could sometimes lead to mental dissociation (spacing out).

Water and Wood/air Element

Figure 1.67. Sodalite



Earth Element

Figure 1.68. Stibnite

SODALITE

Sodalite is an opaque, navy blue semiprecious gemstone, usually with characteristic white streaks. This is a stone of logic, rationality, and efficiency. It is also known as a stone of truth, as it unites logic with intuition, opens spiritual perception, and brings information from the Yuan Shen (Original Mind) to the conscious awareness of the Shen Zhi (Acquired Mind). Sodalite is connected to the Water Element and Wood/Air Element (Figure 1.67), Its ruling planet is the Moon, and it stimulates the Upper Dantian, and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Sodalite is said to stimulate the pineal gland and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), facilitate spiritual growth, psychic vision, and assist in deepening one's meditative state. It increases intelligence, knowledge, and learning, and can unite the logical mind with the spiritual mind. Sodalite is believed to bring an energetic realm of calmness to its wearer, and is also said to have a strong feminine (Yin) polarity.

Martial Properties: Sodalite is a stone of insight and pattern-recognition and can be used to achieve hypnotic or deep trance states. It has a balancing effect on one's emotions and mental state, and is said to be effective in combating toxic electromagnetic fields, increasing one's confidence, and enhancing creativity.

Healing Properties: Sodalite is a cooling stone, that is said to help balance the metabolism and prevent diabetes. It is useful in the treatment of digestive system disorders, and in the treatment of the throat, vocal cords and larynx. It also helps to strengthen the lymphatic system, improve cellular hydration, boost the immune system, cool fevers, lower blood pressure and stimulate the absorption of body fluid. It has been used in certain cases to treat attention deficit disorder (ADD).

Clinically, Sodalite is used to strengthen the lymphatic system and treat lymphatic cancer (i.e., ease lymphatic swelling due to exposure to radiation).

Recharging Sodalite: In order to recharge its power, place Sodalite in the Earth overnight (i.e., bury it in a sacred spot, surrounded by healthy foliage) during the time of a Full Moon. Sodalite absorbs the gases released by plastic, therefore it should be kept away from all forms of this synthetic material.

STIBNITE

This crystal is a grey to black colored mineral. It forms in masses, aggregates, columns, blades, radial groups of column-type crystals, needlelike crystals, and prismatic crystals with vertical striations, sometimes exhibiting well-developed faces. In meditation it is used to help keep away intrusive energies. Stibnite facilitates an undistracted entry into deep meditative states and is used to protect against spirit entities. Stibnite is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.68), and it stimulates all three Dantians and all seven chakra areas.

Spiritual Properties: Stibnite is considered a stone that carries the power of the Underworld. It is used to enhance intuitive knowing and manifest Divine Light into the physical realm. Stibnite can enhance Soul Travel and stimulates endurance. It was used by ancient mystics to lead the Spirit Body into the inner realms of deep magic, as well as to provide access into the spiritual dimensions of the animal realm.

Stibnite elixir are known for their ability to improve communication with one's guides, and to be more easily influenced by them.

Martial Properties: Stibnite can be used to remove spirit parasites and unwanted entities that have attached to the body's second Wei Qi field. It enhances the body's external energetic field and acts as an impenetrable barrier fortifying the Wei Qi field. Stibnite is also used to eliminate the physical presence of hostile energetic forces emitted from both animals and people.

Healing Properties: Stibnite can be used to treat disorders of the esophagus and Stomach, as well as to relieve rigidity and stiffness. Because of its ability to purify energy, Stibnite can also be used to treat infections in cuts or wounds, herpes, cold cores, boils, and other lesions.

When meditating with Stibnite, some strengthening of the First, Third, and Ninth Chakras have been noted. There are also some energetic stimulation of the acupuncture points located within the knees and elbows joints.

Caution: Stibnite is a stone of manifestation and its energetic power that must be purposely directed. Therefore, when using Stibnite in summoning rituals, it is important to keep the mind directed and intently focused onto the specific purpose and function of the magical invocation. Otherwise, the priest may experience unexpected and undesired results.

TEKTITE (BO SHUN SHI)

Bo Shun Shi (also known as Tektite) are black or dark brown, glassy, densely translucent stones that are created when a meteorite strikes the Earth (melting both the meteorite and the Earth's surface to create glass). The brown/black variety is generally the stone that is referred to as a Tektite. It is usually brought from Tibet and is considered to be helpful in past-life regression. The clearest and best gem quality variety of the Tektite stone is called Moldavite. This powerful stone is generally coke-bottle green with ripples (sometimes called Vltava), and it has been used in ancient magical jewelry for at least 25,000 years. Tektite is connected to the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements (Figure 1.69). Its ruling planet is Jupiter, and it energetically stimulates all three Dantians and all seven chakra areas.

Wuji Element

Figure 1.69. Tektite (Bo Shun Shi)

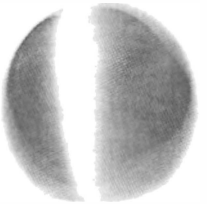
Spiritual Properties: Tektites are powerful stones. In ancient China, they were associated with the gods of thunder and lightning, and were used as powerful talismans in Daoist sorcery. More than 2,000 years ago, the ancient Chinese Daoist master Liu Sun gave Bo Shun Shi the name "Lei Gongmo," meaning "Ink-stone of the Thundergod."

Placed over the chakras, Tektites balance the energetic flow and can be used to reverse the damage to a chakra. When placed over the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) area, it can facilitate the opening of the Crystal Chamber and increases the powers of telepathy and clairvoyance. Tektites were used in ancient times to assist priests in communicating with spirit entities in other energetic and spiritual dimensions.

Martial Properties: Tektite can be used to strengthen the body's three Wei Qi fields. These powerful stones are often considered to be transmitters of messages from other places, other planes, and other dimensions. Holding Tektite in the hand is said to make one receptive to these subtle messages.

Healing Properties: Tektites are used to reduce fevers, aid the capillaries and facilitate the proper circulation of Qi and blood. It also prevents the transmission of diseases. Certain magical traditions use Tektite in psychic surgery.

Recharging Bo Shun Shi: In order to recharge its power, place Tektite outside in stormy weather, particularly when lightning is flashing.



Wood/air and Water Element

Figure 1.70. Tiger's Eye

TIGER'S EYE

This is usually a variety of Quartz that resembles the image of a tiger's eye due to the presence of inclusions of straight fibers of asbestos. Tiger's Eye occurs in a broad range of colors, according to the various properties of the minerals contained within its formation. Tiger's Eye is connected to the Wood / Air Element and Water Element (Figure 1.70), and it stimulates the Yellow Court, Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) and Fourth Chakra (Heart) areas.

Spiritual Properties: Tiger's Eye is used to clear the Third Eye, increase intuition, heighten perception, elevate the power of discrimination, and increase interest in the mystical aspects of life. In ancient times, Tiger's Eye was used to alleviate survival fears, anxiety and fear of death, reduce and transform worry, diminish clinging to the past, and aid in releasing emotional tension.

Martial Properties: Tiger's Eye has the ability to naturally create an energetic field of protection. It protects from accidents and ensures protection from and victory over enemies. Tiger's Eye facilitates penetrating insight into the fear of death (both physical and emotional), activates creative psychic energies, and neutralizes "fevers of the spirit" (Shen Disturbances) that lead to fanaticism or obsession. It is sometimes used for scrying, and for increasing intuitive and clairvoyant powers.

Healing Properties: Tiger's Eye protects against all diseases of the chest and throat, cures asthma, soothes the nerves (especially the facial and sciatic nerves) and relieves headaches and pain associated with the nervous system. It is said to assist in the treatment of fevers, intestinal disorders, and skin diseases. Tiger's Eye is also used to strengthen eye sight and improve on one's concentrative abilities.

Wuji, Earth, Water, or Wood/air Elements

Figure 1.71. Tourmaline (Dien Qi Shi)

Recharging Tiger's Eye: Place Tiger's Eye in starlight, outside several hours after sunset during a New Moon, in order to recharge its power.

TOURMALINE (DIEN QI SHI)

Dien Qi Shi (also known as Tourmaline) is a striated, shiny stone, opaque or transparent, and often hexagonal in shape. It is one of the most significant mineral groups used in metaphysical practices. Tourmaline can become electrically charged, creating a positive and negative end, through either heating (pyroelectricity) or rubbing (piezoelectricity).

Tourmaline comes in a myriad of colors: pink, black, brown, red, yellow, blue, green, purple-violet, watermelon, multicolored, and colorless. Its magical property and energetic effect on the body's Three Dantians and seven chakra systems is dependent on its specific color.

- **Black Tourmaline (Hei Dien Qi Shi):** Black Tourmaline (Schorl) is connected to the Earth Element (Figure 1.71), and it stimulates the Lower Dantian and First Chakra (perineum) areas. It is a powerful stone used for protection and purification, and can be used against external pathogens and spirit parasites, as well as psychic attacks and spells cast by ill-wishing priests. Black Tourmaline connects to the energy of the Lower Dantian, can be used for grounding and rooting the energy and is used for increasing physical vitality. When placed with the point pointing away from the body, Black Tourmaline draws off negative energy. It is used in the treatment debilitating diseases, to purify the body of toxins and wastes, to strengthen the immune system, to treat dyslexia and arthritis, and to provide pain relief.
- **Black Tourmaline With Quartz (Hei Dien Qi Shi Shi Yin):** Tourmaline Quartz is connected

to the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements. It energetically stimulates all three Dantians and seven chakra areas. Tourmalinated Quartz is thought to combine the spiritual properties of Quartz with the spiritual properties of Tourmaline. This is a powerful stone for promoting inner strength and change, as well as for neutralizing psychic attacks. Black Tourmaline (Shorl) is considered one of the strongest protectors and removers of negativity. Tourmaline crystals act as energetic "ramps" that can magically propel the mystic out of his or her physical body. Therefore it is said that, with proper concentration, Tourmaline crystals can facilitate spirit and soul projection. Tourmaline is also thought to enable the mystic to bring about changes in things that were previously believed to be beyond his or her control. It is also thought to grant the mystic the power and wisdom necessary to free him or herself from ruts and seemingly immovable situations. The crystals of this stone are sometimes believed to provide internal confidence, providing the individual with the strength to find his or her own personal power.

- **Blue Tourmaline (Lan Dien Qi Shi):** Blue Tourmaline (Indicolite) is connected to the Water Element and the Wood/Air Element. It stimulates the Fifth Chakra (throat), Upper Dantian, and Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) areas. It aids in the development of psychic awareness, promotes visions and spirit communication. It facilitates the spiritual attributes of the body's Prenatal Wujing Shen, and awakens the original spirit to divine compassion, order, truth, integrity, and wisdom. Blue Tourmaline is an excellent stone for healers because it prevents negative energy from sticking to the body's Wei Qi fields. It is used as an aid to meditation and in the expansion of spiritual consciousness. It benefits the pulmonary and immune systems, as well as the brain, kidneys, and urinary bladder. Blue Tourmaline regulates fluid imbalances and tonifies the thymus, thyroid, lungs, esophagus, and the eyes. It is helpful in cases of insomnia, night sweats, sinusitis, and bacterial infections. In ancient times it was used to treat burns and prevent scarring. Dark blue tourmaline is especially helpful to the eyes and brain and is generally made into an elixir.
- **Brown Tourmaline (Hese Dien Qi Shi):** Brown Tourmaline (Dravide) is connected to the Earth Element. It stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Middle Dantian, and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas. Brown Tourmaline is an excellent grounding tool and is used to root the body's energetic field into the Earth. It clears the body's energetic field and aligns and protects the energetic body. Brown Tourmaline is used to treat intestinal disorders and skin diseases as well as to stimulate the regeneration of the body's tissues. It is sometimes used for blood purification and for clearing and healing the body's lymph system.
- **Golden Yellow Tourmaline (Huang Dien Qi Shi):** Yellow Tourmaline is connected to the Water Element, and it stimulates the Yellow Court and Third Chakra (Solar Plexus) areas. Yellow Tourmaline is used to repair energetic damage to the Yellow Court. It promotes clear thinking, goal-setting, problem-solving, and enhances personal power. It is also said to help a timid individual find the courage to confront unavoidable obstacles. In ancient times, Yellow Tourmaline was used to open up a spiritual pathway and benefit intellectual pursuits. In healing, it is placed on the Yellow Court in order to treat the liver, gall bladder, stomach, spleen and kidneys.
- **Green Tourmaline (Qing Dien Qi Shi):** Green Tourmaline (Verdelite) is connected to the Water Element, and it stimulates the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas. It is one of the premier healing stones used for treating the heart. It transforms negative energy into positive energy and rejuvenates and inspires creativity. Green Tourmaline is sometimes used as an energetic gateway to psychically connect with Nature Spirits. It has an energetic effect on the plant realm and is

sometimes used with healing plant remedies. Green Tourmaline aids sleep, quiets the mind and fortifies the nervous system. It is also used to treat brain, eye, thymus, heart and the immune system. It is used as a detoxifier and heals constipation and diarrhea.

- **Pink Tourmaline (Fen Hong Dien Qi Shi):** Pink Tourmaline is connected to the Water Element, its ruling planet is Venus (for lighter shades) and Mars (for darker shades), and it stimulates the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas. Pink Tourmaline varies in shade (from pale pink the deep red), the redder the stone, the more powerful its energies. It is sometimes used as an aphrodisiac to energetically attract love in both the material and spirit worlds. Pink Tourmaline enhances physical pleasure, disperses emotional pain, and synthesizes love with spirituality.

  Because of its effectiveness in blocking negative energy and powerful psychic attacks, Pink Tourmaline was a favorite crystal of the last Empress of China Zi Xi. When the Empress Zi Xi died, her head was supported by a pillow made of Pink Tourmaline.

  Pink Tourmaline can be used to repair energetic holes in the body's Wei Qi fields. It is excellent to use for children because it provides a calming and centering type of energy. When placed on the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas, it can be used to balance a dysfunctional endocrine system and treat the heart, lungs and skin.
- **Red Tourmaline (Hong Dien Qi Shi):** Red Tourmaline (Rubellite) is connected to the Water Element and Earth Element, and it stimulates the Lower Dantian, First Chakra (perineum), Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas. Red Tourmaline energizes the heart, increases levels of creativity and helps the mystic to connect with the physical realm. It is used to increase stamina and endurance and to give vitality to the physical body. Red Tourmaline is used in the treatment of diseases of the heart, digestive system, reproductive system, circulatory system, and muscle spasms.
- **Watermelon Tourmaline (Xigua Dien Qi Shi):** Watermelon Tourmaline (Pink enfolded in Green) is connected to the Water Element, and it stimulates the Middle Dantian and Fourth Chakra (heart) areas. Watermelon Tourmaline is considered to be a super activator of the heart, working simultaneously with the Jing (physical), Qi (energetic), and Shen (spiritual) components of the heart organ. It is sometimes used in order to reconnect the mystic to his or her higher self, shifting the consciousness from the head to the heart. Watermelon Tourmaline treats emotional dysfunction and releases old pain. It encourages the regeneration of nerves and is used in the treatment of paralysis and multiple sclerosis.

Spiritual Properties: Tourmaline has a strong connection to Nature Spirits, especially Plant Spirits. It can also be used for scrying. It roots and grounds the Shen (Spirit), cleanses and balances all of the body's chakras, and creates a stronger Wei Qi field. Tourmaline is an excellent stone when used for balancing the body's energetic channels and connecting the body's energetic field to all of the chakras.

Martial Properties: Tourmaline protects against psychic attacks and provides a protective energetic shield around the body. In ancient times, Tourmaline was used to form a protective seal around the body and was commonly used for protection during summoning rituals.

Healing Properties: Tourmaline is a powerful mental healer and is used for balancing the left and right hemisphere of the brain. It enhances the body's energy and can also be used to remove energetic blockages. Tourmaline is used in treating paranoia, overcoming Dyslexia and improving hand to eye coordination. It cleanses, purifies and transforms dense Qi into lighter vibrations. Each of the different colors of Tourmaline has it own unique healing abilities.

Recharging Dien Qi Shi: In order to recharge its power, place Tourmaline outside in the sunlight during the sunset for three consecutive nights.

TURQUOISE (LEU SONG SHI)

Leu Song Shi (also known as Turquoise) is a Blue-Green colored stone. The name turquoise means "Turkish stone" as it first traveled to Europe along the Silk Route from Turkey (Figure 1.72). The ancient Chinese believed that Leu Song Shi was a representation of the Earth and sky.

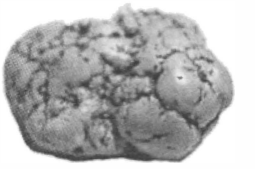
In the ancient Bon tradition of Tibetan magic, Turquoise stones were considered to be seats of the La (Shadow Soul), and were used in the magical rituals of La Gug (Summoning the Shadow Soul) in order to return the wandering soul back to the body.

- **Turquoise (Leu Song Shi):** Leu Song Shi is connected to the infinite space of the Wuji and contains the combined powers of the Wind, Fire, Water, and Earth Elements. Its ruling planet is Venus, and it energetically stimulates the Fifth Chakra (throat) area.

  Turquoise is used extensively in "cloud busting." In certain Shamanic traditions, it is thrown into a river or held under running water in order to initiate rain.

  In order to recharge its energy, pass Turquoise through the flame of the left red altar candle, or smudge the stone by placing it over the Earth Altar incense burner while reciting purification incantations.
- **Chinese Turquoise (Zhang Guo Leu Song Shi):** Chinese Turquoise is often greener than the variety found in the Middle East and in the Americas. It is known for its ability to slightly increase a priest's psychic gifts. Chinese Turquoise is also excellent for creating psychic dreams, and is sometimes used in Sex Magic and Fidelity Magic. Because it is "softer" in power than ordinary Turquoise, it is sometimes used as talismans and amulets for protecting babies and young children.

  In order to recharge its energy, place Chinese Turquoise in the Moonlight (under an early waxing moon), or smudge the stone by placing it over the Earth Altar incense burner while reciting purification incantations.



Wuji Element

Figure 1.72. Turquoise (Leu Song Shi)

Spiritual Properties: Turquoise is a spiritual stone that inspires and uplifts; it literally elevates the energy of the Chakras. When placed on the Third Eye, it promotes spiritual attunement and enhances communication between the physical and spirit worlds. Turquoise opens the Fourth "heart" Chakra, allowing one to connect with others in a loving way.

Martial Properties: Because of its ability to absorb all forms of negative energy, Turquoise is commonly used as a protective stone, and has also been used in magical amulets to ward off evil and release negative emotions from the body. According to certain traditions, Turquoise is believed to change color to warn of danger and to indicate infidelity.

Healing Properties: Turquoise can aid the body in the absorption of nutrients and help to stimulate the regeneration of tissues. It can also be used as a "drawing stone" to purge toxic Qi from the body. It can be placed upon an area of affliction for quick pain relief. It is especially helpful for alleviating headaches.

Clinically, Turquoise is considered to be a "Master Healer." Because it stimulates tissue regeneration, it can be used to strengthen the entire body, ease all types of disease, and increase Qi and Blood circulation to muscular tissue (especially when there are torn tendons and ligaments). Turquoise can also be used in nutrient deficient diseases such as anorexia nervosa.

Caution: Because Turquoise projects an individual's energy into the environment, discretion should be used when wearing it. Additionally, avoid any overexposure to the Sun, as Turquoise fades in sunlight and from exposure to oils.

Figure 1.73. The following Magical Bagua Graph is used by Daoist priests for energetically Imprinting and spiritually Activating a special magical tool, talisman, Holy Water, stone/mineral, mineral formula, herb, herbal prescription, sachet, Dream Pillow, Power Elixir, etc. This Magical Bagua Graph can also be used in Daoist Alchemy in order to magically initiate the energetic transformation of an individual (i.e., self, disciple, or patient). The item is first placed inside the center of the circle (within the Yin/Yang). It is then energetically imprinted and activated through breath incantations and special magical rituals. Depending on the goal of the magical ritual (e.g., creating an item for protection, initiating a healing, or increasing an individual's psychic powers, etc.), sometimes special elixirs are rubbed onto the exterior surface of the item, or internally ingested by an individual prior to beginning the ceremony. The energetically imprinted item is then left inside the center of magical circle for an extended period of time. During this important time period, the priest's will and intention is energetically infused inside the item's physical, energetic, and spiritual matrix, along with the celestial powers of the Four Guardians, the magical powers of the Eight Trigrams, and sacred creative powers of the Divine Mind.

SUMMERY

It is important to note, that, During the Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.), most of the minerals used for compounding magical elixirs were specifically chosen for their symbolic and magical corresponded qualities. For example:

- **Cinnabar:** The transforming color of spiritualized blood,
- **Gold:** The captured color of the Sun,
- **Malachite:** The balanced color of Wood (green - symbolizing the Hun) and Metal (white - symbolizing the Po),
- **Mica:** The combined Five Element colors. Because Mica holds the verious colors of the rainbow, and does not burn or rot, it was choosed to enhance the energy of the disciple's spirit.
- **Orpiment:** Also known as "Female Yellow"
- **Realgar:** Sometimes known as "Male Yellow"

In ancient Daoist alchemical practices, certain magical elixir ingredients were specifically "created" by the priest. For example, in order to create a certain longevity elixir, the disciple was encouraged to feed red meat and Cinnabar powder to an unfledged young bird. This would create red feathers when the plume grew out. These special red feathers, along with the dried flesh of the bird, was then ground into a fine powder and mixed with other ingredients. When ingested, this special magical formulae granted the disciple an additional 500 years of life.

Many times, these esoteric preparations were only passed down secretly, from master to disciple. Consequently, many of the secret Daoist elixirs have become forever been lost to history.

The following two charts (Figure 1.73 and Figure 1.74) are included as a summery of the previous magical stones, categorized according to their various Elemental influences. These charts can be use by Daoist priests, in order to choose which types of magical stones will be best suited to create magical elixirs, herbal formula, or magical oils that are applied directly to the body during special ritual practice.

Wuji Element Stones	Governs the Spiritual Realm of the tissues; stimulates the physical, energetic and spiritual aspects to the body's tissues; activates, energizes, and balances the Three Dantians and Seven Chakra areas; draws Qi upwards, roots the body's energy into the upper Eighth Chakra; is used in Soul Retrieval and High Magic to bring subconscious patterns into consciousness Diamond, Moldavite, Quartz (Clear), Quartz (Phantom), Tektite, and Turquoise
Wood/Air Element Stones	Governs the Mental Realm of the tissues; influences psychic perceptions and intuitions, opens energetic portals into the spirit realm, induces visions, facilitates deeper meditative states, and enhances mental clarity; stimulates and governs the body's respiratory system, enhances brain function, and stimulates mental cognition; governs the Upper Dantian and the Qi of the Sixth and Seventh Chakra areas. Amethyst, Ametrine, Azurite, Beryl, Fluorite, Lapis Luzuli, Moon Stone, Selenite, Sodalite, Tiger's Eye, Tanzanite and Tourmaline (Blue)
Fire Element Stones	Governs the Emotional Realm of the tissues; enhances communication, stimulates the Yuan Shen; governs the circulatory system; governs the Middle Dantian and the Qi of the Fourth and Fifth Chakra areas Agate (Fire), Bloodstone, Carnelian, Cinnabar, Citrine, Red Garnet, Malachite, Ruby, and Sapphire,
Water Element Stones	Governs the Energetic Realm of the tissues; stimulates the Qi of the body's channel systems and Chakra systems; fortifies the vitality of the body's reproductive system, endocrine system, and digestive system; enhances the Zhi (Will Power), creativity, sexual expression, and the ability to manifest; governs the Lower Dantian and the Qi of the Second and Third Chakra areas. Agate (Blue Laced), Chrysocolla, Coral, Emerald, Opel, Pearl, Tourmaline (Watermelon), Tourmaline (Dark Blue), Tourmaline (Yellow),
Earth Element Stones	Governs the Physical Realm of the tissues; draws the body's Qi downwards, rooting it into the Earth; fortifies the Qi of the bones and tissues; governs the Lower Dantian and the Qi of the First Chakra Agate (Moss), Amber, Garnet, Hematite, Jade, Jasper, Jet, Magnetite, Obsidian, Peridot, Quartz (Rose), Quartz (Smokey), Stibnite, Tourmaline (Black), Tourmaline (Brown)

Figure 1.74. Summery of the Five Element Magical Stones

GEM STONE REMEDIES

The following is a modern example of various gem stone remedies that are currently being used in clinics throughout the world. This short list is in no way exhausted, as each of the various cultures have their own unique beliefs and mineral combinations that are used to treat patients in order to ease their physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual suffering and pain.

DIGESTIVE-METABOLISM PROBLEMS

- **Bacterial Infection:** Anhydrite, Malachite
- **Bowels:** Lepidolite
- **Colic:** Amber, Boji Stones
- **Constipation:** Ruby, Smoky Quartz, Black Tourmaline
- **Diabetes:** Chrysocolla, Citrine, Jade, Malachite, Sodalite
- **Diarrhea:** Malachite, Smoky Quartz, Black Tourmaline
- **Digestion:** Amber, Citrine, Sodalite, Red Tourmaline
- **Gout:** Labradorite, Prehnite
- **Heartburn:** Orange Calcite, Red Coral, Peridot
- **Nausea:** Green Calcite, Golden Calcite, Peridot
- **Pancreas:** Herderite, Smoky Quartz
- **Stomach:** Green Fluorite, Jet, White Pearl, Peridot, Stibnite, Sunstone
- **Ulcer:** Ametrine, Chrysocolla, Emerald, White Pearl, Peridot, Sunstone
- **Vomiting:** Lapis Lazuli

ENDOCRINE- IMMUNE SYSTEM PROBLEMS

- **Adrenal Glands:** Red Calcite, Kyanite, Ruby, Sugilite, Black Tourmaline
- **Allergic Reactions:** Bloodstone, Hematite, Muscovite
- **Chronic Fatigue Syndrome:** Ametrine, Ruby
- **Detoxification:** Malachite
- **Endocrine Glands:** Cavansite, Pietersite, Topaz, Green Tourmaline
- **Goiter:** Amber
- **Herpes Simplex #1 (Shingles):** Kyanite, Stibnite, Black Tourmaline, Green Tourmaline
- **Herpes Simplex #2 (STDs):** Jade, Lapis Lazuli, Stibnite
- **Hypothyroidism:** Aquamarine, Blue Tourmaline
- **Immune System:** Beryl, Bloodstone, Green Calcite, Cinnabar, Herkimer Diamond, Brown Jasper, Malachite, Rutilated Quartz, Brown Tourmaline, Green Tourmaline
- **Infections:** Chrysocolla, Cinnabar, Citrine, Green Fluorite, Malachite, White Opal, Rhodochrosite, Ruby, Sodalite
- **Inflammations:** Chrysocolla, Garnet, Green Jasper, Pyrite
- **Laryngitis:** Stilbite
- **Mumps:** Aquamarine, Topaz
- **Meniere's Disease:** Dioptase, Diopside
- **Parathyroid Gland:** Angelite, Red Coral, Kyanite, Malachite
- **Pineal Gland:** Cavansite, Blue Coral, Indigo Kyanite, Moonstone, Pietersite, Sodalite, Sugilite
- **Pituitary Gland:** Cavansite, Blue Coral, Garnet, Iolite, Pietersite, Sugilite
- **Prostate Gland:** Orange Calcite, Zincite
- **Reproductive Organs:** Orange Calcite, Orange Tourmaline, Ruby, Red Tourmaline
- **Thymus Gland Balancing:** Blue Laced Agate, Citrine, Coral, Lapis Lazuli, Peridot, Prehnite, Blue Tourmaline, Green Tourmaline
- **Thyroid Gland Balancing:** Blue Laced Agate, Angelite, Citrine, Eudialyte, Halite, Kyanite, Lapis Lazuli, Rhodochrosite, Blue Tourmaline
- **Vitality:** Garnet, Sunstone, Vanadinite

GYNECOLOGICAL PROBLEMS

- **Birthing:** Peridot
- **Bleeding (Decrease in Menses):** Bloodstone, Malachite, Sodalite, Sapphire
- **Breast Milk:** Carnelian, Chalcedony, Chiastolite, Moonstone, Turquoise
- **Childbirth:** Hematite, Malachite, Moonstone, Ruby, Bloodstone, Opal
- **Conception:** Red Calcite, Carnelian, Moonstone, Rhodochrosite,
- **Cramps:** Lepidolite , Hematite
- **Fertility (improving):** Garnet
- **Hormone Production:** Amethyst, Moonstone, Pietersite
- **Hot Flashes:** Citrine, Chrysocolla, Gem Silica, Moonstone
- **Infertility:** Rose Quartz
- **Lactation:** Carnelian, Chalcedony, Chiastolite, Turquoise
- **Menopause:** Carnelian, Moonstone
- **Menstrual Cramps:** Carnelian, Citrine, Cuprite, Hematite, Labradorite, Malachite, Moonstone
- **Miscarriage (Prevention):** Aquamarine, Carnelian, Ruby
- **Miscarriage (Recovery):** Chrysocolla

- **Morning Sickness:** Red Jasper, Malachite, Moonstone, Sodalite
- **Pre-Menstrual Cramps:** Chrysocolla, Hematite, Jade, Kunzite, Moonstone, Turquoise
- **Water Retention:** Chrysocolla, Cuprite, Moonstone

Heart-Blood Problems

- **Anemia:** Bloodstone, Garnet, Hematite,
- **Blood Purifying Disorders (Circulation):** Ametrine, Chiastolite, Garnet, Malachite, Ruby
- **Blood Pressure (Balancing):** Blue Calcite, Chiastolite, Malachite, Rhodochrosite, Ruby
- **Blood Circulation:** Ametrine, Bustamite, Lapis Lazuli, Rhodochrosite, Ruby, Tektite, Red Tourmaline
- **Heart Attack:** Pink Calcite, Garnet
- **Heart Disease:** Dioptase, Garnet, Green Obsidian
- **Hypertension (High Blood Pressure):** Chrysocolla, Hematite, Labradorite, White Pearl, Sodalite
- **Leukemia:** Chrysocolla
- **Varicose Veins:** Amber, Blue Lace Agate, Bloodstone

Internal Organ Problems

- **Gall Bladder:** Carnelian, Citrine, Emerald, Malachite, Green Obsidian, Peridot, Yellow Sapphite, Green Tourmaline
- **Intestines:** Peridot, Brown Tourmaline
- **Kidney and Urinary Bladder Diseases:** Cuprite, Jade, Prehnite, Smoky Quartz
- **Liver:** Danburite, Opal, Imperial Topaz

Lungs-Respiratory Problems

- **Asthma:** Amber, Cat's Eye, Malachite, White Pearl, Rhodochrosite, Vanadinite
- **Breathlessness (Dyspnea):** Amber, Vanadinite
- **Bronchitis:** Aquamarine, Amazonite, Aventurine, Chrysocolla
- **Cough:** Aquamarine, Chrysocolla, Turquoise
- **Lungs:** Bustamite, Garnet, White Pearl, Pyrite
- **Pneumonia:** Fluorite
- **Respiratory System:** Agate, Amber, Coral, Lapis Lazuli, Rhodochrosite, Tigers Eye, Topaz, Zircon
- **Tuberculosis:** Morganite
- **Whooping Cough:** Blue Lace Agate, Amber, Topaz

Muscle-Tendon-Bone Problems

- **Arthritis:** Golden Yellow Apatite, Azurite, Boji Stones, Green Calcite, Chrysocolla, Lapis Lazuli, Malachite, Imperial Topaz, Black Tourmaline
- **Backache:** Amber, Green Tourmaline, Double Terminated Quartz
- **Bone Marrow:** Lapis Lazuli, Malachite
- **Broken Bones:** Axinite, Calcite, Malachite, Topaz, Green Tourmaline, Selenite
- **Bursitis:** Blue-Lace Agate, Amber
- **Fibromyalgia:** Blue Lace Agate, Amethyst, Aventurine, Citrine, Quartz Crystal, Rose Quartz
- **Hip Pain:** Jade
- **Joint Soreness:** Green Calcite, Hiddenite, Malachite
- **Leg Cramps:** Jadeite, Lepidolite
- **Muscle Aches:** Diopside, Jadeite, Lepidolite
- **Osteoporosis:** Amazonite, Calcite, Cooper, Selenite
- **Rheumatism:** Boji Stones, Copper, Hematite, Labradorite, Malachite, Imperial Topaz
- **Sciatica:** Kyanite, Smoky Quartz , Green Tourmaline
- **Sprains:** Aventurine, Green Calcite, Pink Calcite, Red Calcite, Double Terminated Quartz, Sphene, Red Tourmaline
- **Spine:** Green Calcite, Pink Calcite, Labradorite, Magnetite, Selenite, Tigers Eye

Nervous System Problems

- **Degenerative Nerve Disease:** Azurite, Citrine, Blue Jasper, Lapis Lazuli, Malachite, Phenacite, Rhodochrosite, Sapphire, Sodalite, Watermelon Tourmaline
- **Multiple Sclerosis:** Amethyst, Eudialyte, Lapis Lazuli, Moonstone, Blue Sapphire, Sodalite, Watermelon Tourmaline
- **Neuralgia:** Amber, Carnelian, Lapis Lazuli, Phenacite
- **Parkinson's Disease:** Eudialyte, White Opal
- **Stroke:** Herderite, Watermelon Tourmaline

Skin Problems

- **Blisters:** Anhydrite, Rose Quartz
- **Burns:** Boji Stones, Chrysocolla, Blue Tourmaline
- **Eczema:** Blue Sapphire
- **Itching:** Chrysocolla
- **Measles:** Turquoise
- **Psoriasis:** Green Tourmaline, Rhodochrosite
- **Skin Rash:** Angelite, Blue Calcite, Green Jasper
- **Skin Rash (from Poison Ivy):** Serpentine

MISCELLANEOUS PHYSICAL PROBLEMS

- **Altitude Sickness:** Hematite, Jet
- **Cataracts:** Green Apophyllite
- **Colds/Sinusitis:** Amethyst, Azurite, Blue Fluorite, Kyanite
- **Earache:** Amazonite, Amber
- **Eye Problems:** Emerald, Eudialyte, Jade, Lapis Lazuli, Malachite, Obsidian, Opal, Peridot, Tigers Eye, Topaz
- **Fevers:** Brazilianite, Cat's Eye, Hematite, Jade, Red-Black Obsidian, White Opal, Peridot, Pietersite, Ruby, Sodalite, Tektite
- **Gum Problems:** Agate (all varieties)
- **Headaches:** , Aquamarine, Chrysocolla, Hematite, Herderite, White Pearl, Smoky Quartz, Turquoise, Sodalite, Blue Tourmaline, Turquoise
- **Hearing Loss:** Amethyst, Lapis Lazuli
- **Heat Stroke:** Sunstone
- **Jet Lag:** Hematite, White Pearl, Black Tourmaline
- **Migraine Headaches:** Aquamarine, Chrysocolla, Hematite, Iolite, Lapis Lazuli, Lazulite, Rhodochrosite, Sodalite, Blue Tourmaline, Turquoise
- **Nail Problems:** Apatite
- **Nosebleed (Chronic):** Carnelian
- **Pain:** Amber, Jet, Peridot, Smoky Quartz
- **Sight (Improve):** Jade, Obsidian, Opal, Tigers Eye, Topaz
- **Sinus Problems:** Blue Lace Agate, Azurite
- **Skin, Nails and Hair Problems:** Bustamite, Lepidolite
- **Smell (Improving):** Hessonite Garnet
- **Sore Throat:** Blue Lace Agate, Angelite, Blue Calcite
- **Surgical Recovery:** Amber, Angelite, Chrysocolla, Chrysoprase, Jasper, Smoky Quartz
- **Swelling:** Aquamarine, Emerald, Peridot, Sapphire, Sodalite, Green Tourmaline
- **Teeth (Strengthen):** Calcite, Selenite, Sphene
- **Throat:** Blue Lace Agate, Citrine, Turquoise
- **Trauma:** Blue Lace Agate, Aventurine, Citrine, Malachite
- **Tumors:** Bloodstone, Malachite, Smoky Quartz
- **Urinary Tract Infection:** Kyanite, Blue Sapphire
- **Vertigo:** Cuprite, Lapis Lazuli, Malachite, Elestial Quartz

MENTAL PROBLEMS

- **Alzheimer's Disease:** Blue Chalcedony, Eudialyte, Fluorite, Blue Obsidian
- **Anorexia:** Golden Calcite, Malachite, Rose Quartz, Thulite
- **Attention Deficit Disorder:** Azurite, Fluorite, Selenite, Sugilite
- **Bi-Polar Disease:** Kunzite, Peridot, Rutilated Quartz
- **Creative Blocks:** Golden Calcite, Orange Calcite, Chiastolite, Sugilit
- **Dyslexia:** Sugilite, Black Tourmaline
- **Epilepsy:** Golden Beryl, Carnelian, Coral, Emerald, Red Jasper, Lapis Lazuli, Malachite, Selenite
- **Focus (Improve):** Celestite, Blue Fluorite, Sugilite
- **Insomnia:** Amethyst, Celestite, Labradorite, Hematite, Moonstone, Muscovite, Smoky Quartz, Blue Tourmaline
- **Intellect (Improve):** Hiddenite, Imperial Topaz
- **Learning Difficulties:** Azurite, Fluorite, Sugilite
- **Memory Problems:** Black Calcite, Emerald, Golden Yellow Fluorite, Labradorite, Sugilite
- **Mental Confusion:** Apophyllite, Bayleyite, Celestite, Danburite, Black Fluorite, Blue Fluorite, Sugilite
- **Psychiatric Disorders:** Diopside, Blue Obsidian

EMOTIONAL PROBLEMS

- **Abuse:** Rose Quartz, Thulite, Pink Tourmaline
- **Addiction:** Avalonite, Crysocolla with Cuprite, Malachite-Azurite, Peridot
- **Alcoholism:** Avalonite, Golden Calcite, Crysocolla with Cuprite, Peridot, Phenacite
- **Anger:** Chrysocolla, Peridot, Black Tourmaline
- **Anxiety:** Amazonite, Amethyst, Aventurine, Pink Fluorite, Rose Quartz
- **Assertiveness:** Golden Calcite, Chrysoprase, Tigers Eye
- **Burnout:** Garnet, Ruby, Zincite
- **Calming:** Angelite, Rose Quartz
- **Communication (Improving):** Amazonite, Blue Calcite, Turquoise
- **Confidence (Improving):** Golden Calcite, Orange Calcite, Malachite
- **Confusion:** Celestite, Charoite, Fluorite
- **Courage (Improving):** Golden Calcite, Charoite, Chrysoprase, Sunstone, Tigers Eye

- **Depression:** Amethyst, Angelite, Golden Beryl, Lepidolite, Smoky Quartz, Sugilite
- **Drug Abuse:** Jet, Rutilated Quartz, Smoky Quartz, Tigers Eye
- **Eating Disorders:** Avalonite, Rose Quartz, Thulite
- **Emotional Healing (Wounded Heart):** Chrysoprase, Danburite, Green Fluorite, Kunzite, Thulite
- **Fatigue:** Barite, Golden Beryl, Red Calcite, White Pearl, Zincite
- **Fear:** Angelite, Golden Yellow Calcite, Orange Calcite, Jet, Kunzite, Lepidolite, Sunstone, Tigers Eye
- **Forgiveness:** Angelite
- **Grief:** Angelite, Jet, Kyanite, Smoky Quartz, Sugilite
- **Grounding:** Hematite, Jasper, Obsidian, Smoky Quartz
- **Hysteria:** Hematite, Obsidian, Smoky Quartz
- **Impotence:** Orange Calcite, Garnet, Red Jasper
- **Incest Recovery:** Avalonite, Malachite, Rose Quartz, Thulite
- **Irritability:** Amethyst, Turquoise
- **Jealousy:** Peridot
- **Joy:** Blue Sapphire, Sunstone
- **Loneliness:** Thulite
- **Love:** Golden Beryl, Rose Quartz, Thulite
- **Nervousness:** Barite, Sodalite, Watermelon Tourmaline
- **Nurturing:** Thulite, Rose Quartz
- **Obesity:** Avalonite, Heulandite
- **Peace:** Angelite, Blue Calcite, Celestite, Kyanite
- **Rape Recovery:** Chrysocolla, Lapis Lazuli, Malachite, Black Tourmaline
- **Relationships (Improving):** Kyanite, Peridot, Rose Quartz
- **Relaxation:** Blue Lace Agate, Turquoise
- **Self-Esteem & Self-Worth (Improving):** Golden Calcite
- **Self-Sabotage:** Avalonite, Golden Calcite, Rose Quartz, Thulite
- **Shock:** Bloodstone, Sunstone
- **Shyness:** Golden Calcite, Orange Calcite, Hessonite Garnet
- **Stage Fright:** Aquamarine, Amethyst, Golden Calcite
- **Stress:** Amethyst, Angelite, Aventurine
- **Trust (Improving):** Axinite, Hiddenite, Lepidolite

Spiritual States

- **Divination:** Emerald, Moonstone, Blue Obsidian, Rainbow Obsidian, White Opal, Phantom Quartz
- **Dreamwork:** Deep Blue Apatite, Bustamite, Celestite, Chrysocolla, Herkimer Diamond, Garnet, Black Jasper, Lilac Kunzite, Blue Kyanite, Indigo Kyanite, Lapis Lazuli, Lazulite, Malachite, Muscovite, Black Obsidian, Blue Obsidian, White Opal, Phenacite, Pietersite, Prehnite, Green Sapphite, Sodalite
- **Intuition (Increasing):** Amethyst, Azurite, Cavansite, Celestite, Chrysocolla, Citrine, Blue Coral, Blue Fluorite, Rainbow Fluorite, Herderite, Iolite, Indigo Kyanite, Labradorite, Lazulite, Moonstone, Muscovite, Black Obsidian, White Opal, Peridot, Phenacite, Pietersite, Blue Sapphite, Pink Sapphite, Star Sapphite, White Sapphite, Selenite, Sodalite, Blue Tourmaline
- **Meditational States (Entering Deeper):** Amethyst, Blue Calcite, Golden Yellow Calcite, Green Calcite, Chrysocolla, Violet and Purple Fluorite, Herderite, Iolite, Black Jasper, Brown Jasper, Lilac Kunzite, Lapis Lazuli, Lazulite, Moonstone, Muscovite, Black Obsidian, Blue Obsidian, Silver-Sheen Obsidian, Phenacite, Pietersite, Prehnite, Phantom Quartz, Dark Blue Sapphite, Pink Sapphite, Star Sapphite, White Sapphite, Selenite, Sodalite
- **Past-Life Regression:** Clear Apophyllite, Azurite, Black Calcite, Brown Jasper, White Kunzite
- **Balancing the Body's Yin and Yang Polarity:** Blue Jasper, Kunzite, Malachite, Rutilated Quartz, Sugilite
- **Prosperity:** Angelite, Golden Yellow Apatite, Blue Sapphire, Yellow Sapphite, Citrine, Varascite
- **Protection:** Amber, Azurite, Chiastolite, Citrine, Emerald, Garnet, Hematite, Red Jasper, Jet, Labradorite, Malachite, Moonstone, Muscovite, Black Obsidian, Rainbow Obsidian, White Opal, Peridot, Prehnite, Rutilated Quartz, Smoky Quartz, Black Sapphite, White Sapphite, Seraphinite, Stibnite, Sugilite, Black Tourmaline, Turquoise
- **Psychic Development:** Azurite, Clear Apophyllite, Blue Coral, Emerald, Blue Fluorite, Golden Yellow Fluorite, Herderite, Iolite, Lilac Kunzite,

Black Kyanite, Lazulite, Malachite, Muscovite, Blue Obsidian, Phenacite, Rutilated Quartz, Blue Sapphite, Pink Sapphite, Star Sapphite, Selenite, Sodalite, Sugilite, Tektite, Blue Tourmaline

- **Psychic Vision (Increasing):** Clear Apophyllite, Blue Calcite, Cavansite, Diamond, Eudialyte, Violet and Purple Fluorite, Hematite, Herderite, Iolite, Labradorite, Lapis Lazuli, Lazulite, Moldavite, Muscovite, Phenacite, Pietersite, Rutilated Quartz, Star Sapphite, White Sapphite, Selenite, Sodalite, Sugilite, Blue Tourmaline
- **Scrying:** Golden Beryl, Iolite, Black Jasper, Lazulite, Malachite, Black Obsidian, Golden-Sheen Obsidian, Rainbow Obsidian, Silver-Sheen Obsidian, Phantom Quartz, Rutilated Quartz, Star Sapphite
- **Soul Travel:** Angelite, Deep Blue Apatite, Golden Yellow Calcite, Cavansite, Celestite, Garnet, Hematite, Herderite, Blue Jasper, Brown Jasper, Green Kyanite, Labradorite, Lapis Lazuli, Lazulite, Moldavite, Muscovite, Blue Obsidian, Silver-Sheen Obsidian, White Opal, Pietersite, Prehnite, Rutilated Quartz, Selenite, Seraphinite, Stibnite, Sugilite
- **Spiritual Development:** Amethyst, Apophyllite, Azurite, Celestite, Eudialyte, Epidote, Blue Fluorite, Golden Yellow Fluorite, Rainbow Fluorite, Herderite, Iolite, Lazulite, Moldavite, Muscovite, Blue Obsidian, White Opal, Peridot, Phenacite, Pietersite, Rutilated Quartz, Blue Sapphite, Star Sapphite, Selenite, Sugilite, Tektite, Turquoise
- **Spirit Entities (Contacting):** Angelite, Brookite, Cavansite, Celestite, Chrysocolla, Kunzite, Blue Jasper, Green Kyanite, Phantom Quartz, Star Sapphite, Scolecite, Tektite, Green Tourmaline
- **Telepathic Communication:** Clear Apophyllite, Azurite, Celestite, Chrysocolla, Violet and Purple Fluorite, Herderite, Blue Kyanite, Lazulite, Blue Obsidian, Prehnite, Rutilated Quartz, Star Sapphite, Selenite, Tektite, Blue Tourmaline
- **Telepathic Communication With Animals:** Green Apophyllite, Atelestite, Julienite, Prehnite, Clear Topaz
- **Wisdom and Encouragement:** Apophyllite, Avalonite, Violet and Purple Fluorite, Jade, Oregon Opal, Rutilated Quartz, Star Sapphite, Yellow Sapphite, Sodalite

PURIFYING AND IMPRINTING THE MAGICAL STONE

In order to help establish a powerful spiritual defence, the Daoist priest will sometimes teach the disciple how to charge a special stone, mineral, crystal, or gem, and imbue it with magical intention. After the stone has been imprinted and charged with Ling Shen (Magical Spirit), the disciple can then begin his or her esoteric work in Daoist mysticism. Each time the imprinted stone is uncovered and brought forward, the disciple is immediately surrounded by the stone's magical power and can begin practicing Healing Magic, Defense Magic (counter-attacking curses), or spiritual enlightenment, depending on how and why the stone was imprinted.

In ancient Daoism, before performing a ritual to energetically activate any magical talisman, magical tool, herbal formulae, or magical stone, a priest would usually proceed as follows:

- Designate an auspicious day on which to perform the ceremony. Sometimes the first or fifteenth day of the Chinese Lunar calendar month was chosen.
- During this time period, the priest was prohibited from eating goose, eel, or dog meat.
- The priest also stayed away from the public, in a secluded area, in a state of quiet contemplation. This quiescent state of mind was needed in order to insure that the priest's focus of attention and power was at its peak during the Cleansing, Imprinting and Activation process of the ritual.
- It was also important that the priest abstain from any form of sexual contact for at least seven days before magically Imprinting the Daoist tools.
- Additionally, female priests were not allowed to Imprint any of their magical tools during their time of menstruation, or if they were pregnant.

On the auspicious day of the magic ritual, the priest showered and purified himself before proceeding to the altar area.

CARE AND CLEANING

In order to help retain their vitality and power, it is important for the priest to provide adequate care and cleaning for all of his or her magical tools. Each magical tool works as an energetic extension of the priest's Qi and Shen.

A magical stone used for healing purposes can assist a priest in releasing many forms of energetic impurities and blockages stored within an individual's tissues. However, some of these released energies will cling to the surface of the stone. If these toxic energies are allowed to accumulate, they will eventually inhibit the stone's ability to work at peak capacity. Therefore, regular cleaning purges the accumulated toxic energies and restores the magical stone back to its natural vibrant state.

The following are some basic guidelines used by priests in order to protect the energetic integrity of their magical stones, and to assure their maximum powers:

- When regularly using a magical stone tool (i.e., scrying ball or bowl, ring, Mala, necklace, cluster, "wand," or stone), clean it twice to three times a week.
- When not in use, place the cleansed magical stone tool inside a black silk container or pouch, and store it in a drawer or cabinet away from the public.
- Be sure that the thread is completely dry before wearing or storing magical stone Malas or necklaces. For example, if you rinse a Mala (prayer bead) or magical necklace before you go to bed, leave it to dry (flat) within three feet from your body while you sleep.
- Do not store magical stone tools (or any magical tool) near strong electromagnetic fields. Electrical appliances such as televisions and computers can energetically disrupt and altar the stone's subtle energetic field.
- Avoid exposing any magical stone to X-rays (i.e., via the dentist office, hospitals, airport security stations, etc.). The X-rays will be absorbed into the energetic field of the magical stone and later released into the priest's Wei Qi (aura) fields.

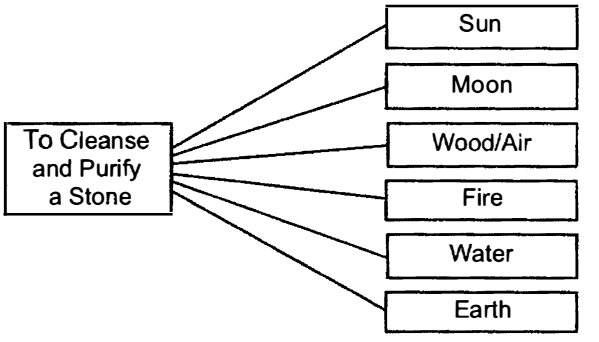


Figure 1.75. Six popular ways to cleans and purify a magical stone

- Avoid wearing magical stones in chlorinated swimming pools or hot tubs. Chlorine weakens the natural-fiber thread of certain stones and adversely affects the surface structure of these stones.

CLEANSING METHODS

The following methods are used to clean a magical stone from toxic energy that may have contaminated its energetic matrix. Because of their Elemental natures, each of the various magical stones require different methods of cleaning.

Some of the most popular methods are described as follows (Figure 1.75):

- **Sun:** One popular method of cleaning a stone is to leave it in the sunlight for half a day (from sunrise to high noon). This allows the Sun's rays to burn away any negative imprinting. Avoid excessive exposure to the Sun. The Sun is considered to be the primary source of energy for all things on the Earth. However, its Yang power is so great that it will overwhelm most other energies, especially those that have to do with the Yin spiritual level of existence. This is why ghosts and other spirit entities rarely appear when the Sun is above the horizon. Any working using solar energies specifically can be charged by exposing the item to the direct rays of the Sun (especially during the two months after the Spring Equinox, when the Sun's magical energies are at their highest).

However, when working with other planets, the item should be shielded from the sunlight, as the solar force will tend to de-consecrate the item's energetic and spiritual powers. This is especially true when working with Lunar Magic.

- **Moon:** Because the Moon generates spiritual tides that are precisely equivalent to the physical tides of the ocean, it is one of the most important influences on the Earth's spiritual realm. Objects exposed to moonlight will pick up a spiritual charge that mirrors the Moon's influence (especially at the specific time of its exposure). Therefore, any preparation exposed to moonlight will take on its energies, especially if it contains lunar stones (Moonstone, Pearls, etc.) or lunar herbs (Passion Flower leaf, Uva Ursi leaf, etc.).

  Performing a spell or creating a Gem Ens Elixir at the optimal time in the lunar cycle will maximize your magical power. Each lunar cycle begins with a new phase of the moon. Depending on the type of stone and the specific intentions for using for it, certain masters will leave the stones within the energetic field of their altar space for several days when beginning the cleansing ritual. The stone is placed in the center of the altar table for three nights, during the time of the waning moon (when the moonlight continues to decrease). The waning moon is a time of draining energies, and is the best time for any type of Banishing Magic. The theory is that as the moon wanes, so will any residual energies in the stone. It is important to place the stone where it will be in view of the Moon for most of the night. After the three days have passed, the incantations are spoken and the cleansing ritual is completed.

  When using the celestial influence of the Moon, a priest will utilize the magical powers of the Moon as follows:

  The Full Moon: to help bring his or her desires into fruition.

  The Waning Moon (from Full to New): for decreasing types of magic (such as destroying, banishing, dispersing, etc.).

  The New Moon: for darker, more introspective types of magic (such as divination).

  The Waxing Moon (from New to Full): for working with increasing types of magic (such as creating, acquiring, generating, etc.).

- **Wood/Air:** Wind can be used to purify and cleanse a Wood/Air Element stone of impurities. Traditionally, Daoist priests will pass the magical stone through the incense smoke (Wood/Air Element) rising from the incense burner. The smoke from the incense is used to purify the ritual space, alert the gods that a ritual is about to be performed, and draw the celestial deities to the altar. Incense smoke is believed to resemble the swirling patterns of cloud-like energies underlying all matter. As such, the incense smoke infuses both the Daoist altar and the body of the priest with sacred energy.
- **Fire:** Fire can be used to purify and cleanse a Fire Element stone of impurities. Both fire and light are powerful tools used in communicating with the Spiritual World. Traditionally, Daoist priests would pass the stone through the red candle flames on the Earth Altar, or through the incense smoke (Wood/Air Element) rising from the incense burner.

  The candles represent the light of the Sun and Moon (the eternal light of the Dao, and the Yin and Yang of Heaven); they also represent the eyes of the human body (the windows of the eternal soul). They play a very important role Daoist rituals because their combined light is the symbol of life. They are called "guiding lights," and they illuminate the path of visiting gods to the place where the ritual is being conducted.

Together, the Daoist mystic, candles, and Altar table all symbolically form a trinity of power representing the emergence of Heaven, Earth and man within the infinite space of the Wuji. This is an essential esoteric key of ancient Daoist symbolism needed in order to enter the spiritual world.

- **Water:** Water can be used to purify and cleanse a Water Element stone of impurities. The ancient Daoists believed that water is the essence of the entire Heavens. It is considered to be the original essence of the Ancestor of the North. The magical power of water carries and maintains its spiritual significance throughout all generations. Holy Water, for example, is water that has been impregnated with divine light and thus contains condensed Heavenly power and the "magic that transforms."

  Water can be used as a condenser (collecting and retaining energy), and can also be used as a powerful energetic eraser. Running water, in particular, is considered to be the ultimate magical eraser (i.e., any magically charged object immersed into running water will lose its power). This erasing technique works especially well with cold water. For example, one technique used in ancient times to throw hostile spirits and spells off of one's track was to cross a cold stream.

  When rinsing a magical stone, it is advisable to alternate hot and cold running water (for 5-10 second intervals) to gently shock the stone into releasing its accumulated energies. In order to avoid cracking the stone, it is important that the hot water not be scalding.

  One popular method is to leave the stone in a stream or any form of moving water (i.e., the ocean) for 30 minutes. It is important to make sure that the stone is enclosed in some type of netting or device to ensure that it is not washed away. This process allows the water to wash away any impurities and recharges the stone as well.
- **Earth:** Earth can be used to purify and cleanse an Earth Element stone of impurities. One common purification method using the energy of the Earth involves burying the stone in the soil for three days. This allows the energetic field of the Earth to drain away any negative imprinting left within the stone.

  One other method is to use plant life as a form of purification and revitalization. Plants generate living energy that can be absorbed, and can be used to transform the disharmonious energy we release daily. At the end of each day, the priest can place the magical stone, power necklace or Mala, around the base of a healthy house-plant (or lay them in its branches). If possible, place the plant within three feet from the bed in order to maintain the stone's energetic connection with your Wei Qi field. During the night, the stone will be cleared of any accumulated energies. The stone can also be placed outside underneath or within the branches of a shrub or tree for several days.

  Placing the stone in the grass during a rainfall for several hours or overnight will also thoroughly cleanse and recharge them.

RITUAL CLEANSING

Normally, the energetic clearing of a sacred altar space of unwanted influences is the first act of any magical ritual. The priest will create three magical circles within which to perform this ritual.

The ritual cleansing is also used to create a sacred space for the celestial deities and Four Powers to inhabit, and it requires the priest to first fill the altar room or area with divine light before performing any type of evocation ritual.

As the priest creates a sacred space of divine light by drawing the three magical circles, he or she also magically creates the infinite space of the Wuji (manifested through the image of the circle). The action of creating a magical circle also facilitates a divine sanctuary through which to evoke the four powers of the Four Directions, and the creative powers of the Four Elements: Air (incense), Fire (candle flame), Water (Holy Water), Earth(stone). This act of creating a magical sanctuary should always be performed before all acts of magic, spirit projection, soul projection, and deep meditation.

After creating a Circle of Light, the Daoist priest then sanctifies the altar room. This quiets the chaotic Qi surrounding the altar table and creates a realm of peace within the infinite space of the magical circle. Only then will the priest "create, imprint, and activate" his or her magical tools.

ACTIVATION RITUAL

In order to perform the Activation Ritual needed to create magical tools (i.e., creating, imprinting, and activating a magical stone), the Daoist priest proceeds through a six stage process described as follows (Figure 1.76):

- Purifying the Altar Room
- Summoning the Celestial Immortals
- Using Breath Incantations to Open the Stone
- Imprinting the Stone
- Activating the Stone
- Ending the Ritual and Closing the Magical Ceremony

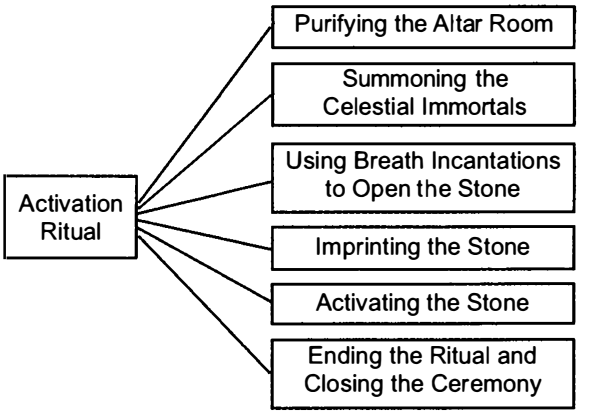


Figure 1.76. The Six Stages of the Activation Ritual

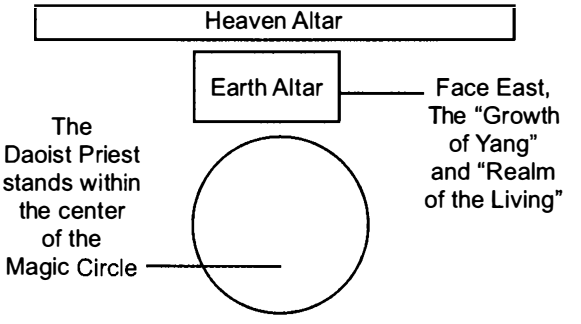


Figure 1.77. Face the East and stand before the Earth Altar

(1) PURIFYING THE ALTAR ROOM

The more you use your altar, the more powerful your spells and incantations will be. In order to purify the altar, begin as follows:

1. Begin by facing the Earth Altar. The Earth Altar should be facing East. This is the energetic direction attributed to the "Growth of Yang" and the "Realm of the Living" (Figure 1.77). Certain Daoist schools will sometimes face the Southern direction, considered to be the realm of "Pure Yang."
2. After performing the "One Through Ten Meditation" and the "Three Invocations," imagine the divine healing light flowing through the center core Taiji Pole into the lower abdominal area, and gathering within the Lower Dantian.

3. Begin to visualize a powerful ray of divine white light rising from the Lower Dantian, moving upward to the center of your solar plexus and Yellow Court area. Focus on the combined energies of the Prenatal Wu Jing Shen (Hun, Shen, Yi, Po, and Zhi) transforming the Qi of the Yellow Court into a bright indigo light. Focus on this light and transform it into a bright indigo pearl. This indigo pearl continues to grow brighter and hotter, until it transforms into a bright red ball of flame. The vibrant red flame then travels up the Taiji Pole and enters into the Upper Dantian, immediately activating all nine chambers.
4. Next, visualize the left eye as a bright Sun, and the right eye as a bright luminous Full-Moon. Roll both eyes to the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) area and imagine that both luminous orbs combine with the red flame in the Upper Dantian area, forming a single white flame that immediately bursts out the Baihui area at the top of the head. Focus your mind on feeling the powerful divine light emanating as a white flame positioned above your head (Figure 1.78).
5. Imagine and feel the energy of the spiritual white light descending around your body in a clockwise circular rotation, surrounding your body in a six foot circumference.

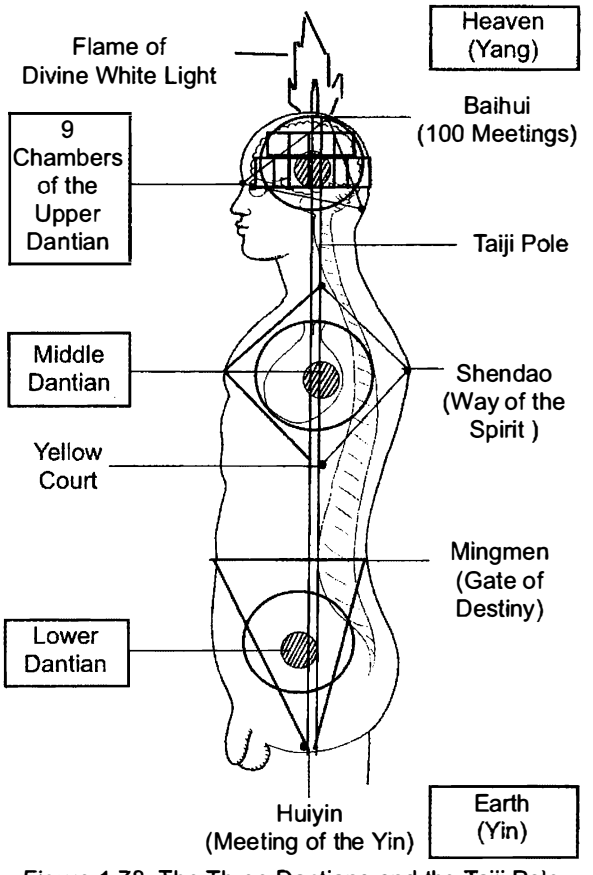


Figure 1.78. The Three Dantians and the Taiji Pole

All of the ancient magical circle patterns used in Daoist mysticism utilize the hidden powers of three secret energetic circles. These three circles act as a magical barrier of protection for the priest, and represent the energetic manifestation of three states of matter (Jing, Qi and Shen), and correspond to the "Stars of Three Terraces." The combined energies of these three circles create the fusion of the Celestial Yang of Heaven with the Terrestrial Yin of Earth, resulting in the formation of the divine wall of Celestial Fire. This divine energetic wall is essential for the protection of the Daoist priest, and is used when he or she

practices advanced meditations of alchemic cultivation or performs esoteric summoning rituals (Figure 1.79).

- Before casting the magical circle, first visualize the energetic boundary that you are going to create as a three dimensional bubble that surrounds you and not as a flat circle. The center of the circle represents the infinite space of Divine creation.
- Then, begin and end your circle facing the East (Green Dragon). The energetic pattern of the Magic Circle should be drawn either in a clockwise direction to attract something or increase the priest's magical power, or counterclockwise in order to banish something or dispel Evil Qi. Traditionally, the Daoist priest will use the Thunder Block, Magical Sword, or Immortal Sword Hand Seal in order to draw the Magical Circle
- The Magic Circle should be drawn three times. The first circle is drawn with the magical tool pointing outward and/or upward, and is used to delineate the circle's basic shape and consecrate its infinite space to the celestial power of the Dao. The first circle represents the Realm of Matter, where energetic solidification takes place.
- The second circle is drawn in order to purify its energetic space. It represents the Realm of Qi, where the energetic components of the mind takes form.
- The third circle is drawn in order to purify its spiritual space. It represents the Realm of Shen, where subconscious creation is manifested.
- When drawing the Magic Circle, it is important to say the following incantation:

"I conjure this Magic Circle,
a space between the 3 Worlds
of Heaven, Earth, and the Underworld!

That it be a guardian
of the powers that I shall raise
In the name of ----------
According to Heaven's Law,
Quickly, Quickly, Manifest Now!"

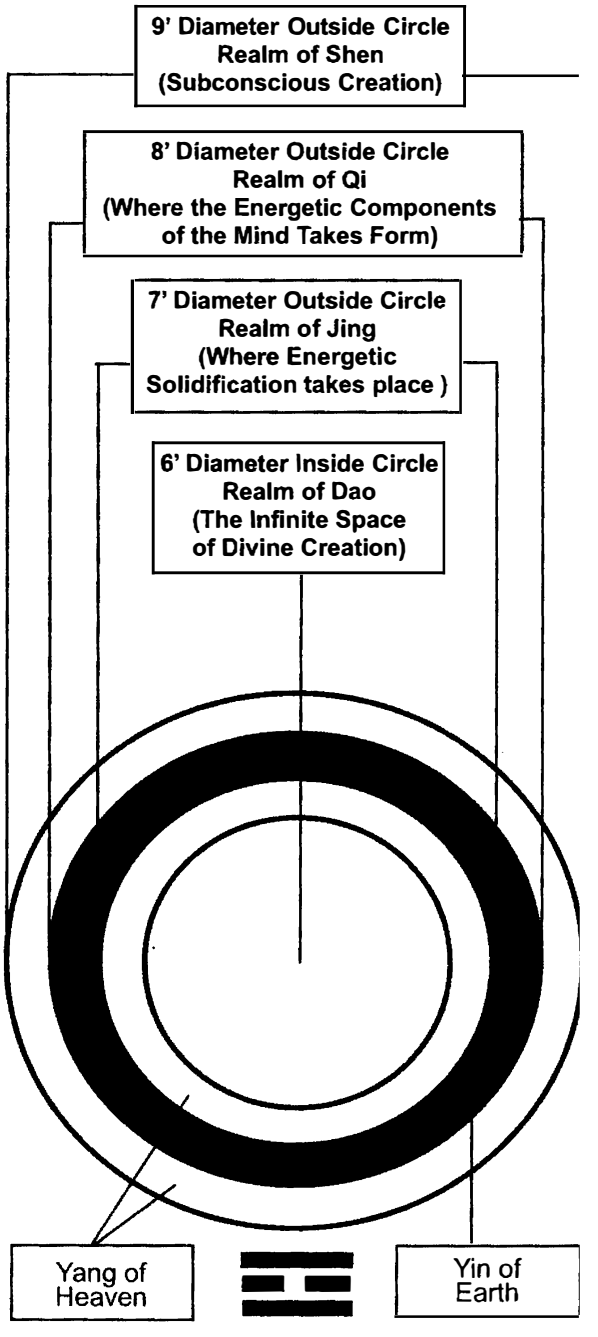


Figure 1.79. The Daoist Magical Circle

Imagine and feel the energy of this divine white light drilling and penetrating deep into the ground. This image represents the power of the Eternal Divine active within the infinite space of the circle. Imagine and feel this protective circle descending several feet into the Earth.

6. Next, extend your arms in front of you (palms facing outward), and again begin to redirect your focus onto the divine white light flame burning above your head. Focus and concentrate on the divine flame, and slowly begin to emit golden light from your palms. Imagine and feel the divine white light and projected golden light fusing in front of your body, forming a powerful energetic wall (Figure 1.80). Imagine, see, and feel this magical wall immediately forming and becoming activated behind the Heavenly Altar (the altar closest to the wall).
7. Begin to turn in a counterclockwise rotation (180 degrees), and visualize a powerful magical wall of divine white light forming from beyond your palms, following the outlined altar walls. In your mind's eye, see this wall constructing itself out of the divine white light from the top of your head and golden sparkles emitted from your palms. This image represents the creation and activation of a spiritually empowered wall, one that has been constructed out of white divine light and golden (Yang) light. Imagine and feel this powerful energized wall extending along the walls of the altar room as you move your hands along the circumference of the magic circle. After completing one-half of the circular rotation, and creating half of the energized wall, you should be facing the Western direction. This is the energetic direction attributed to the "Growth of Yin" and the "Realm of the Dead." Certain Daoist schools will end facing the North, considered to be the realm of "Pure Yin."

- Immediately form the Two Thunder Fists (Figure 1.81), and circle rotate the Lower Dantian three times, gathering its Jing, Qi, and Shen

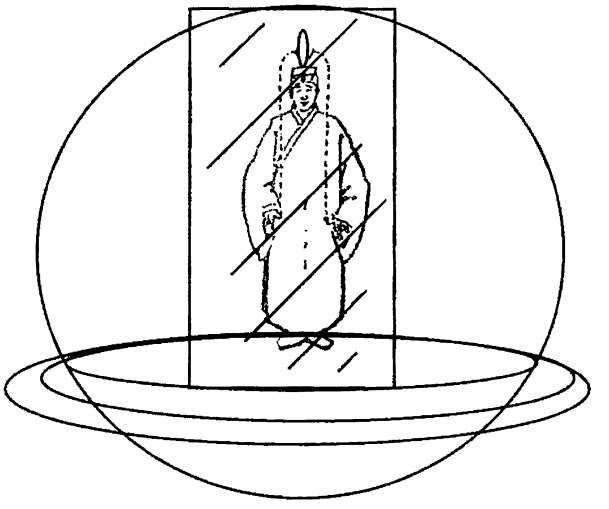


Figure 1.80. Begin to create an energetic wall constructed of white and golden light

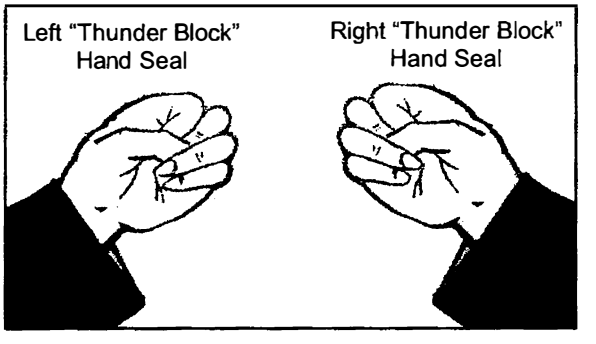


Figure 1.81. The Left and Right "Thunder Block" Hand Seal.

(Figure 1.82); next circle rotate the Middle Dantian three times, gathering its Jing, Qi, and Shen (Figure 1.83); then circle rotate the Upper Dantian three times, gathering its Jing, Qi, and Shen (Figure 1.84).

- Then, after circulating the two Thunder Fists above your head, stamp your right (Yin) foot and then your left (Yang) foot and shout

"Yi Kai Sha Gui"
(Away Evil Ghosts!)

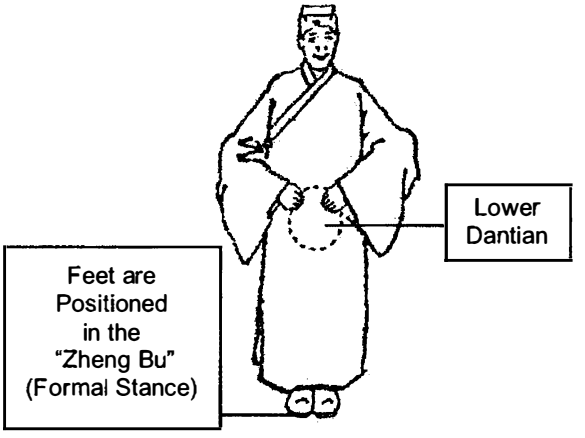


Figure 1.82. Using The Thunder Block
To Circle The Ancestral Palace (Lower Dantian)

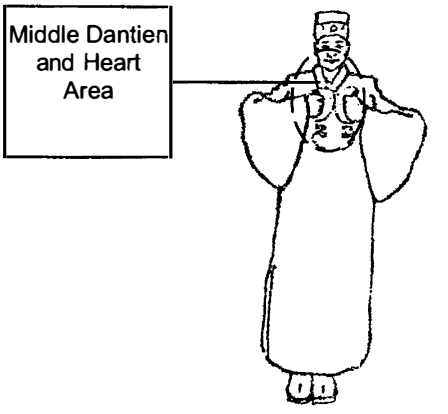


Figure 1.83. Using the Thunder Block
To Circle the Five Qi of the Chest

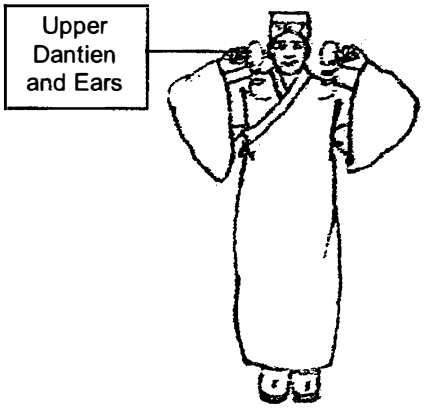


Figure 1.84. Using the Thunder Block
To Circle the Ears and Hear the Sound of Thunder

Through years of practice, the priest will eventually say the Breath Incantation in his or her mind, and the stomping of the feet will eventually progress to a slight compression of the heels within the shoes.

- As you proclaim the banishing charge, know that through the internal strength of your Eternal Soul (which is intimately connected to the divine light), you are magically banishing all undesirable and toxic forces from your magical altar area.

8. Next, again extend your arms in front of your body (palms facing outward), and again focus and visualize the divine white light flame above your head. Begin to emit golden light from your palms and imagine the white light and golden light fusing and creating a powerful energetic wall. Finish by continuing your counterclockwise circle to face the Earth Altar, having imagined the magical wall has now completely surrounded the altar area.
9. Perform one Pulling Down the Heavens, and then raise your hands once more. This time imagine that the white light flame above your head is expanding outwards and radiating 360 degrees within the circle. As the energy of the divine white flame expands outward, visualize and imagine rivers of vibrant blue light (representing pure energy) with silver sparkles (representing the Yin) emitting from your hands. Imagine the white light and blue light fusing and creating a powerful energetic medium that fills the entire area within the golden and white light wall completely (like blue water filling the space between the golden walls of an aquarium). This image allows the energetic space within the altar room to become impregnated with powerful magic.

- This completes the creation and formation of the magic circle and the purification of the altar room. At this time, the priest will begin the process of energetically activating of the altar room, described as follows:

(2) Summoning the Celestial Immortals

The ritual used to gather the specific powers needed in order to activate the Daoist tools is called Summoning the Celestial Immortals. In this ritual, the priest first summons and pays respect to the Three Pure Ones, and then contacts and invokes the Four Element powers, described as follows:

- Begin by first lighting the altar candles. First light the Red candle positioned on the left (Celestial Yang) of the altar table, then light the Red candle positioned on the right (Celestial Yin) of the altar table (Figure 1.85). This ceremony is known as "lighting the eyes of the altar," and it is used to summon the Celestial Immortals, inviting them to observe and assist the priest's actions within the physical realm.
- Next, light three incenses and bow 3 times in front of the Earth Altar, giving respect to the "Three Pure Ones," represented in the Heavenly Altar. In order to summon the Three Pure Ones to the altar, it is important to repeat the following magical invocation. While reciting the above incantation, imagine and visualize the presence of the Heavenly Daoist Masters and Celestial Immortals descending to the altar in vibrant luminous light:

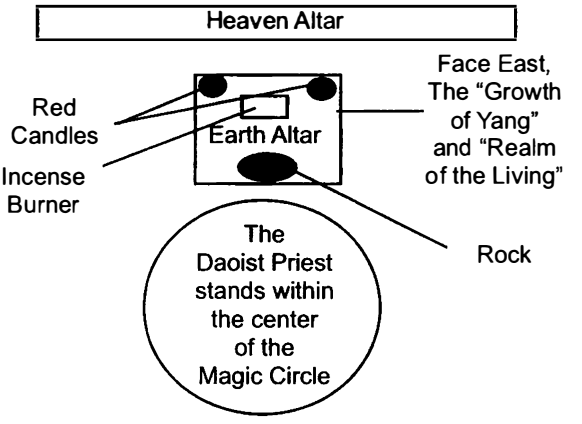


Figure 1.85. Face the East and stand before the Earth Altar

"The Heavens approve! The Earth Approves!
Where is the spirit of God?
Your disciple --------,
who lives in ----------,
beckons you to come to the Earth Altar.

Today I hold three sticks of incense,
Transform them to make a
hundred million fragrant clouds!
Shake the Heavens and move the Earth!
Summon the Wind and invoke the Rain!
Emitting numerous flowers with five rays
of bright numinous clouds!

I invite the Lord of Jade Clarity,
the Lord of Upper Clarity,
and the Lord of Great Clarity,
together with the host of Celestial Immortals.

Stepping on clouds,
Approach to protect and suppress,
the Ten Direction of the World,
Above and below devoid of emptiness,
East, West, South, and North,

The Omnipresent is everywhere,
There is no place that cannot be reached!
Respectfully invite all
Heavenly Daoist Masters and Celestial Immortals,
Draw quickly and approach immediately!

Today your disciple ----------
beseech all Celestial Immortals
to draw quickly and approach immediately!

To sit and suppress,
Bestow upon your disciple
The effective divine power
to create this powerful magical tool.

Spread the Law of the Dao
to help those in distress,
protect, bless and confer good fortune,
so that your disciple can be
extremely powerful and effectively able
to lead other to salvation!
I bow three times
and invite the Divine for help."

- Repeat this incantation three times. Each time you complete the incantation stomp your right foot on the ground.
- After giving respect to the "Three Pure Ones," begin to summon the Four Element Powers and the Celestial Guardians of the Four Directions, and elicit their help in imprinting the energetic matrix of the stone (Figure 1.86 and Figure 1.87).

  This is accomplished by turning counter-clockwise to face the direction of the Kun (Earth) Trigram, and the direction of the North. With your right side positioned to the Earth Altar, bow 3 times with the incense to pay respect to the energy of the Earth Element, and the power of the Celestial Guardian of the Northern Direction, Mo Lei Shou. The Earth Element is associated with the solid state of matter, structure, shape and formation. It is the basis from which physical things are constructed. The Earth Element energy provides stability and allows for the growth of energy.
- Then continue turning counter-clockwise and face the Kan (Water) Trigram, and the direction of the West. With your back positioned to the Earth Altar, bow 3 times with the incense to pay respect to the energy of the Water Element, and the power of the Celestial Guardian of the Western Direction, Mo Li Hai. The Water Element provides flexibility, and energetic fusion. It is the cohesive medium for all other Elements to unite, blend, and fuse.
- Then continue turning counter-clockwise and face the Qian (Heaven) Trigram, and the direction of the South. With your left side positioned to the Earth Altar, bow 3 times with the incense to pay respect to the energy of the Wood / Air Element, and the power of the Celestial Guardian of the Southern Direction, Mo Li Hung. The Fire Element is associated with heat and light, and it is the vibrational frequency through which Qi manifests its power.
- Then turn counter-clockwise towards the altar and face the Li (Fire) Trigram, the direction of the East and the Earth Altar. Bow 3 times with the incense to pay respect to the energy of the Wood / Air Element, and the power of the Celestial Guardian of the Eastern Direction, Mo

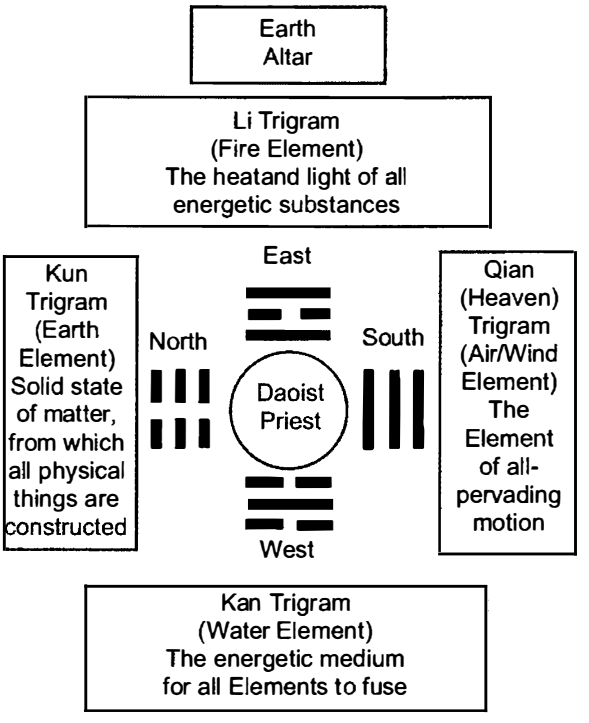


Figure 1.86. Summon the Four Powers of the Elements and elicit their help in imprinting the energetic matrix of the stone.

Li Chung. The energetic particles of the Wood / Air Element have greater movement, therefore the Wood / Air Element is seen as an Element of all-pervading motion. The Wood / Air Element is also associated with the gaseous state of matter, creating movement and keeping everything alive.

- Place your mind on understanding that all four Element powers evolve from the Divine and are therefore associated with the infinite space (Wuji) of the Dao and exist within energetic matrix of all matter. These four unique powers of the Dao are now active within the infinite space of the magical circle in which you stand. This magical circle is considered the energetic matrix in which to gather and mold Qi. It is the energetic field from which everything within the universe is manifested and the space in which all events occur. Therefore, bow three last times with the incense, and then place the incense with your left hand into the incense burner on the Earth Altar.

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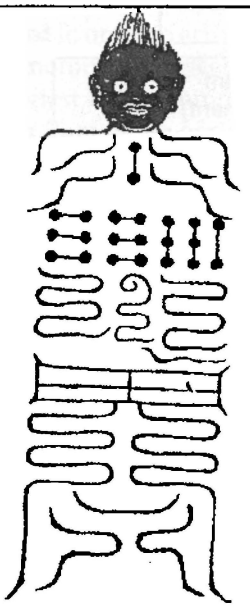
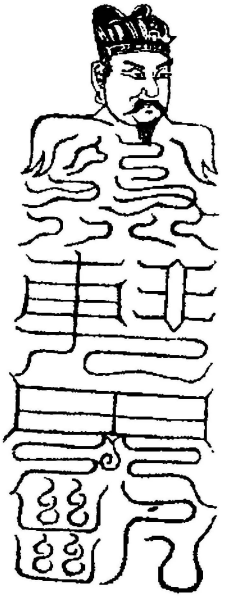
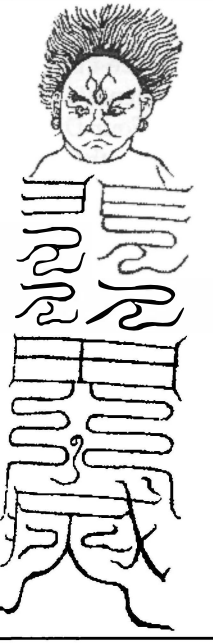
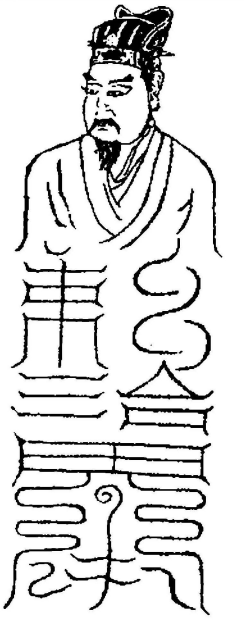
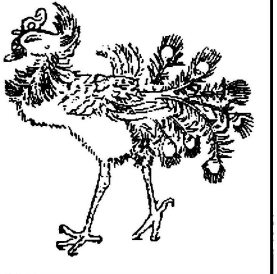
Talisman Used to Summon the Protection of the North	Talisman Used to Summon the Protection of the West	Talisman Used to Summon the Protection of the South	Talisman Used to Summon the Protection of th East
			
			
Black Turtle/Snake (Guardian of the North) Zhiming the Mysterious Dark General - holds the bright light behind me! The Black Snake spits out Fire Qi and all evil spirits hide!	**White Tiger (Guardian of the West)** Jianbing the White Tiger commands the celestial soldiers and protects me on the right! The Tiger is prowling! His teeth are sharp as knives, and they swallow spears whole!	**Red Phoenix (Guardian of the South)** The magical light of Lingguang the Red Phoenix is in front of me! The Red Phoenix has six heads, and spit fire! He reveals his magic power to suppress all evil ghosts!	**Green Dragon (Guardian of the East)** "Mengzhang the Green Dragon protects me on the left with his bold and powerful laws! The Dragon is prowling! His teeth are sharp as knives, and they swallow spears whole! The Poisonous Dragon also has six heads, and spit fire!

Figure 1.87. The Celestial Guardians of the Four Directions

Now that the purifying and summoning rituals are completed, the priest can begin to imprint, program, and activate his or her magical stones. This energetic imprinting and activation process is described as follows:

(3) USING BREATH INCANTATIONS TO OPEN, IMPRINT, AND ACTIVATE A MAGICAL STONE

In ancient China, the use of Breath Incantations and the release of the "Ancestral Breath" was essential in the construction of all magical tools (i.e., talismans, stones, elixirs, etc.). The Yellow Court (sometimes known as the "secret court") was considered by the ancient Daoists to be the place from which the "Ancestral Breath" (sometimes known as the "Ling Qi") originates and is released. Without the use of the Ancestral Breath from the Yellow Court, it was believed that the magical charm or tool would have no effect, and that the magical weapon would prove powerless in the spirit world.

In order to transform an inert mineral or stone into a powerful magical tool, it is important that the priest first visualize and invoke the stone's hidden powers. This is accomplished by internally observing and mentally comprehending the stone's energetic power, size, shape and position; then writing it down on a blank piece of paper.

Next, it is important to write down the stone's purpose and function, and to become completely aware of why the stone is being energetically imprinted. For example:

- What is its specific energetic function?
- Will this stone be used for healing, protection, or defence?
- Will this stone be used for increasing the priest's psychic powers?
- What types of energetic imprinting will it require (colors, sounds/mantras, etc.)?
- What are its energetic potentials (strengths and weaknesses)?
- What will trigger or activate it?
- How long will it last?
- Will this stone only be used for by the priest, or is it being created by the priest for another individual (i.e., as in a healing stone for a patient)?

All of these questions must be addressed before starting the ritual, seeing, feeling, and experiencing exactly how the magical stone will be energetically active. After understanding, experiencing and feeling the stone's energetic function, the construction of a magical "tool" can begin.

(4) OPENING THE MAGIC STONE

After the above questions have been answered, the priest proceeds to Open the magical stone. This Opening ritual is later followed by a ritual used for Imprinting, Charging, and Activating the Magic Stone. One common Daoist ritual used for Opening a magical stone proceeds in eighteen stages, described as follows:

1. The stone should be placed in the center of the Earth Altar before beginning the ritual. After completing the purifying and summoning rituals, the priest will pick up the stone in his right (Yin) palm, and cover it with the left (Yang) palm. This is a symbolic representation of the recreation of the Earth Altar (Yin-Moon) being surrounded by the Altar Room (Yang-Sun). The circular form of the priest's cupped hands symbolize the infinite space of the Wuji and the living energy of the Divine.
2. Next, raise the stone upward in front of the Earth Altar three times, each time presented as an offering to the "Three Pure Ones" and the "Jade Emperor."
   - During the first offering, imagine and feel that the physical structure of the stone dissolves, so that all that remains is the energetic and spiritual matrix of the stone.
   - During the second offering, imagine and feel that the energetic structure of the stone dissolves, so that all that remains is the spiritual matrix of the stone.
   - During the third offering, imagine and feel that the spiritual structure of the stone dissolves, so that all that remains is the infinite space contained within the divine matrix of the stone.
3. After the third offering of the stone, place it on the center of the Earth Altar and leave both palms suspended at the right and left of the stone. Then mentally connect with the Divine and pull an energetic cord form the Heavens

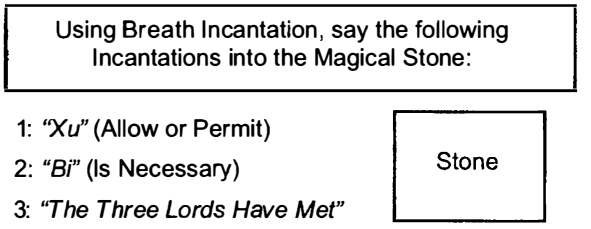


Figure 1.88. "Openting" the Stone #1

into your Lower Dantian. Imagine and feel the divine light flowing through your Taiji Pole into the Lower Dantian.

4. Begin to visualize a powerful ray of divine white light rising from the Lower Dantian up into your Yellow Court. Focus on the combined energy of the Wu Jing Shen transforming the Qi of the Yellow Court into a bright golden mist.
5. Next, focus on the energetic matrix of the stone and exhale a Breath Incantation through the mouth by sounding the seed word *"Xu"* (allow or permit), while envisioning a golden yellow ray of light diffusing over the surface of the stone and impregnating its energetic structure.
   - Then inhale this golden yellow vapor into the body through the nose. Feel its energetic power reach and connect with the Yellow Court, located at the solar plexus. This energetically attaches the priest's Qi and Shen to the energetic matrix of the stone.
6. Then focus on the energetic matrix of the stone and exhale a Breath Incantation through the mouth by sounding the seed word *"Bi"* (is necessary), while envisioning a golden yellow ray of light diffusing over the surface of the stone and impregnating its energetic structure.
   - While inhaling the energy of the second incantation through the nose, combine the magical powers of both golden mists. The combined energies will be gathered and blended within the priest's Yellow Court.
7. Next, focus on the energetic matrix of the stone and exhale a Breath Incantation through the mouth by sounding the magical incantation: *"The Three Lords have met"* (Figure 1.88).
8. Once the incantation has been sounded, immediately inhale and imagine the three vapors joining

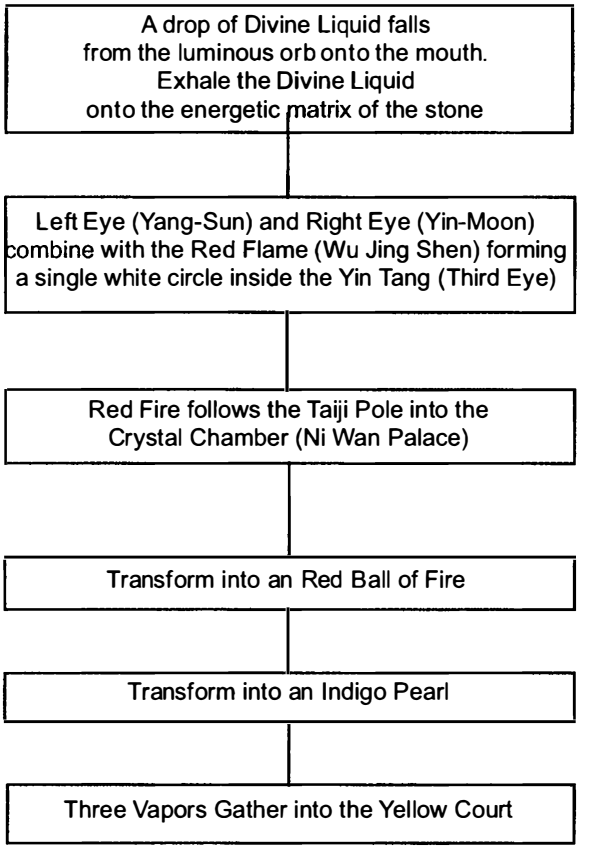


Figure 1.89. "Openting" the Stone #2

together inside the Yellow Court and form this energy into a small indigo pearl. This small indigo pearl will begin to vibrate, heat and glow brighter, until it transforms into a ball of red flames.

9. The red flames will then shoot upwards following the Taiji Pole, past the internal organs, straight to the Ni-Wan Palace (located in the Upper Dantian), energizing the Crystal Palace and Nine Chambers of the Upper Dantian.
10. Then imagine that a drop of divine liquid falls from the luminous orb into your mouth. With the exhale, release the energetic vapor of divine liquid onto the energetic matrix of the stone. This represents the releasing of the energetic transformational power of the Dao within the infinite space of the Wuji (Figure 1.89). While exhaling, use the right Sword Fingers to energetically draw a magical

circle around the stone, and speak the magic incantation *"Kai"* (Open). This is initiated in order to make the stone ready for the energetic imprinting (Figure 1.90).

11. Using the right Sword Fingers, place an energetic dot in the center of the circle on the stone and recite the following magic incantation: *"The One Primordial Breath of the Prior Heavens, by ordered stages, rules the myriad spirits"* (Figure 1.91).
12. Then draw a second circle in order to seal the incantation into the stone.
13. A second and final energetic dot is drawn on the stone at the center of the second circle. This second dot represents the transformational energetic nature of Yin and Yang, and symbolizes the awakening of the full power of the Taiji Pole. It is important to note the Taiji Pole of an object is not the physical center of the object, but is the center core of all molecules existing within the energetic space of that item (person, place, or thing). Therefore, awakening the Taiji Pole allows the priest to gain access into the energetic molecules that create and sustain the energetic formation of the stone (Figure 1.92).
14. As the second energetic dot is placed in the center of the circle, place your imagination into the center of your Taiji Pole. Connecting with the "Taiji Pole of Man," also immediately connects your mind and intention to the Celestial "Taiji Pole of Heaven" (the Pole Star). This energetic fusion causes the seven stars of the Big Dipper to descend the Celestial Pole and energetically cover your physical, energetic, and spirit body (Figure 1.93).
15. Enveloped in the power of the Seven Stars of the Big Dipper, you can now begin to energetically create, imprint, feel and activate the magical stone.
16. After completing the imprinting, the priest will energetically write his personal Daoist magical seal with his right Sword Fingers onto the energetic matrix of the magical stone. This magical seal (Jing and Qi) is needed in order to prevent anyone else other than the priest from using the magical tool.

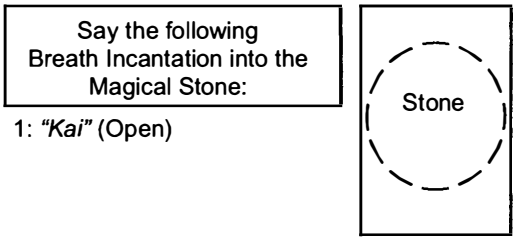


Figure 1.90. "Opening" the Stone #3

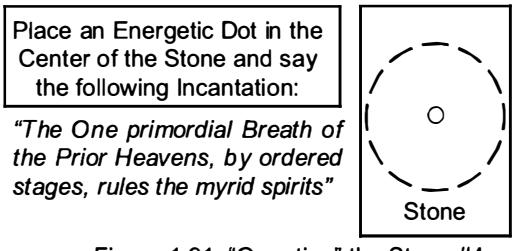


Figure 1.91. "Opening" the Stone #4

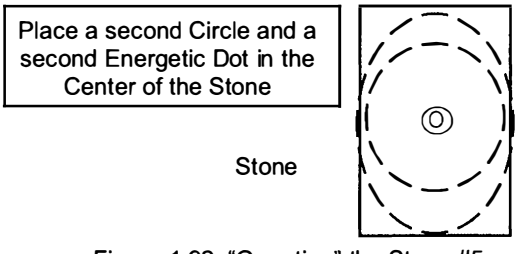


Figure 1.92. "Opening" the Stone #5

17. Then look into the Heavens and face the direction of the Big Dipper tail (the tail points to the opening of the Celestial "Gate of Life"). Imagine the Celestial "Gate of Life" opening and releasing its "Golden Vapor of Life." While inhaling this "Golden Vapor of Life" into the Yellow Court, draw your personal Daoist magical seal with your tongue on the upper palate of your mouth.
18. With the exhale, release the final breath to energetically seal (Qi and Shen) the magical stone by allowing both energetic seals to fuse and solidify your magical power within the stone. The stone has now received the finishing seal used to contain and activate its magical power.

Depending on the specific design and purpose of the magical stone, there can be several

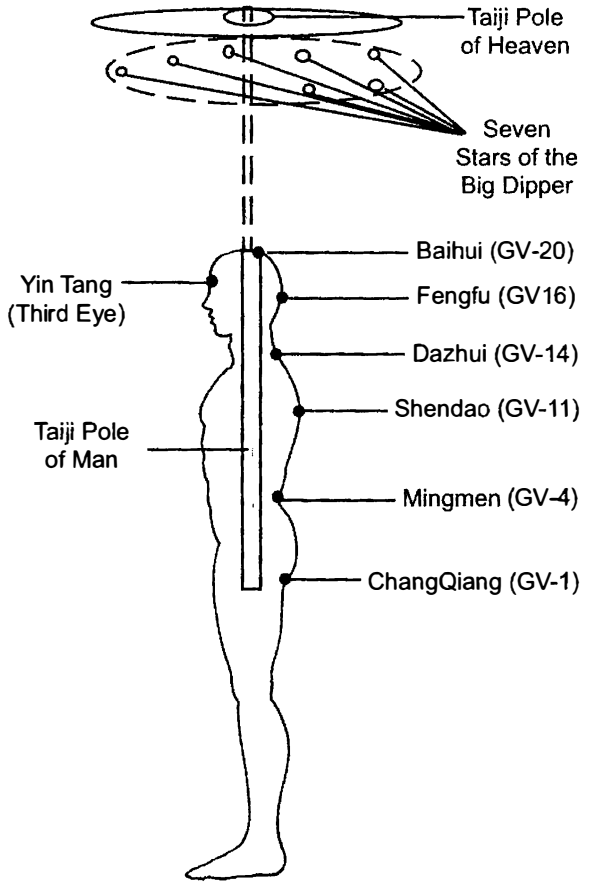


Figure 1.93. The Seven Stars of the Big Dipper Envelop the Daoist Master's Body

additional steps that must be performed. The empowering and energetic loading (imprinting, charging, and activating) of a magical stone is carried out either by the priest or by a spirit entity that the master has summoned for this specific purpose. When a spirit entity carries out the imprinting, charging, and activation of a talisman or magical stone, the energy that is used is at the expense of the spirit entity's own personal reservoir of energy (the Qi and Shen of that particular spirit entity). When a spirit entity is used for this purpose, the traditional signs or symbols used to carry out this process are generally engraved and passed on from one master to another throughout history.

(5) Imprinting, Charging, and Activating the Magic Stone

After completing the basic protocol needed to energetically "Open" the stone, the priest next begins to synchronize the focused intention of his or her personal energetic field with the stone's energetic field. All stones possess natural energies, each having its own unique powers and energetic potentials. When performing the imprinting, charging, and activation, the stone's inherent energies merge and fuse with the personal powers of the priest. All of the priest's intentions can now be imprinted and made manifest through the energetic structure of the stone.

For a Daoist priest, one of the first steps in programming a magic stone is the dedication of the stone and its specific purpose and function for divine service. If the stone's power is not as effective as anticipated, it is usually due to a lack of will, clarity, or intention of the priest in the initial dedication ritual.

In the beginning ritual used for the energetic "Opening" of the stone, the priest has already stated through magical Breath Incantation the seed words "Xu" (allow or permit), *"Bi"* (is necessary), *and "Kai"* (Open).

The priest also connected with the Divine and proclaimed his or her authority to magically imprint the stone by saying,

"The One Primordial Breath
of the Prior Heavens,
by ordered stages,
rules the myriad spirits"

Now, in order to dedicate the stone, the priest proceeds as follows:

1. After Opening the magical Stone, place it in your right hand, enveloped by your left hand (the left hand should be positioned on the outside of the right hand).
2. Imagine, feel, and experience a divine light descending from the heavens and surrounding the external and internal energetic structures of the stone.
3. After the stone has been completely enveloped and saturated in divine light, say the following incantation:

"The power of this stone is only for exacting good of the highest order. In this stone of the Earth, there is only the power of love and divine light."

4. Now begin to energetically Imprint the type of energy (i.e., healing, defensive, or spiritual purpose) that you want to activate within this stone of power. This is accomplished through the use of thought projection, intention, and repeated Mantras (sounded Breath Incantations that are repeated in order to increase the power of the stones function). It is important to speak the incantation in a low vibrating tone until you feel its energy resonate through every particle of the stone.
5. After energetically Imprinting the stone, Charge and fortify it by adding divine Qi. It is important that the Divine Qi, your Qi, and the Qi of the stone fuse to become a three cord link of power. Each strand represents one of the Three Treasures.
6. Next, to energetically Activate the magical stone, a secret Hand Seal and Words of Power (Breath Incantations) are imprinted into the energetic matrix of the stone. This allows only the priest to access the stone's full power, and simultaneously prevents any other individual from carelessly utilizing this magical tool. Throughout history, certain priests have neglected to complete this process, thereby allowing other individuals the opportunity to misuse the original priest's initial intention and creative powers, resulting in adverse Karmic.
7. After Imprinting, Charging, and Activating the Magic Stone, if you always remain mindful of the great power that the stone has been imprinted with, you will be in good position to hold and utilize its divine power.

(6) ENDING THE RITUAL AND CLOSING THE MAGICAL CEREMONY

After completing the imprinting, charging, and activation of a Magical Stone, it is important to complete the ritual with a proper ending. The ending is just as important as the opening and should be performed with reverence and respect.

1. After activating the magical stone, place it on the Earth Altar and light three incense.
2. After lighting three incenses, bow 3 times in front of the Earth Altar, giving respect to the "Three Pure Ones" and the "Jade Emperor," represented in the Heavenly Altar.
3. Next, it is important to acknowledge and thank the four powers for their assistance and help in the construction and imprinting of the energetic matrix of the magical stone.

- Begin by facing the Earth Altar, and bow 3 times to pay respect to the energy of the Qian (Heaven) Trigram and its power of Air / Wind. The Wood / Air Element is seen as an Element of all-pervading motion and is also associated with the gaseous state of matter, creating movement and keeping everything alive. Acknowledge this Element's power, and thank it for its assistance in the construction of the magical stone. Then bid it part in peace.
- Then turning counterclockwise with your right side facing the Earth Altar (East), bow 3 times to pay respect to the energy of the Li (Fire) Trigram and its power of heat and light. The Fire Element is associated with the heat, light and vibrational essence of all energetic substances. Acknowledge this Element's power, and thank it for its assistance in the construction of the magical stone. Then bid it part in peace.
- Then turn clockwise and face the Kan (Water) Trigram. With your left side positioned to the Earth Altar, bow 3 times to pay respect to the

energy of the Water Element and its power of unity and fuse all other Elements. The Water Element provides the cohesive medium for the other elements to fuse. Acknowledge this Element's power, and thank it for its assistance in the construction of the magical stone. Then bid it part in peace.

- Next, continue to turn clockwise to face the Kun (Earth) Trigram, with your back positioned to the Earth Altar, bow 3 times to pay respect to the energy of the Earth Element. The Earth Element is associated with the solid state of matter, and is the basis from which all physical things are built. The Earth Element provides stability, form and structure; it allows for the growth of energy. Acknowledge this Element's power, and thank it for its assistance in the construction of the magical stone. Then bid it part in peace.
- Finally, continue to turn clockwise to face the Qian (Heaven) Trigram and the Earth Altar.

4. Then, placing the three incense into the incense burner on the altar table, approach the two red candles. This next part of the ritual is known as "Closing the Eyes of the Altar," and is used to dispatch the Celestial Immortals from the physical realm.
   - Begin by showing your respect and thanking the Three Pure Ones and the Jade Emperor for their assistance, and then bid they depart in peace.
   - Next, extinguish the right (Celestial Yin-Moon) candle first, followed by the left (Celestial Yang-Sun) candle. It is important to not blow the candle flames out; use a candle snuff to extinguish the flames instead.
5. Finally, place your mind on understanding that the various powers of all four Elements evolve from the Divine, and are associated with the infinite space (Wuji) of the Dao, existing within all matter. Since the power of the Dao is still active within the magic circle in which you stand, close your eyes and bring both hands together forming a "Buddhist Greeting Posture" Hand Seal at your Middle Dantian (Figure 1.94).

Figure 1.94. The "Buddhist Greeting Posture"

   - Next, separate your hands by moving your left (Yang) palm upwards (fingers pointing to the Heavens) while simultaneously moving your right (Yin) palm downwards (fingers pointing towards the Earth). As you separate the celestial powers of Yang and Yin, repeat the following incantation:

"I now release the combined powers of Heaven and Earth, and return this spirit back into this vessel for divine purpose."

6. Then perform one "Pulling Down the Heavens," and return to a quiescent Standing Wuji posture. Now that the rituals are completed, you can begin use the magical stone whenever appropriate.

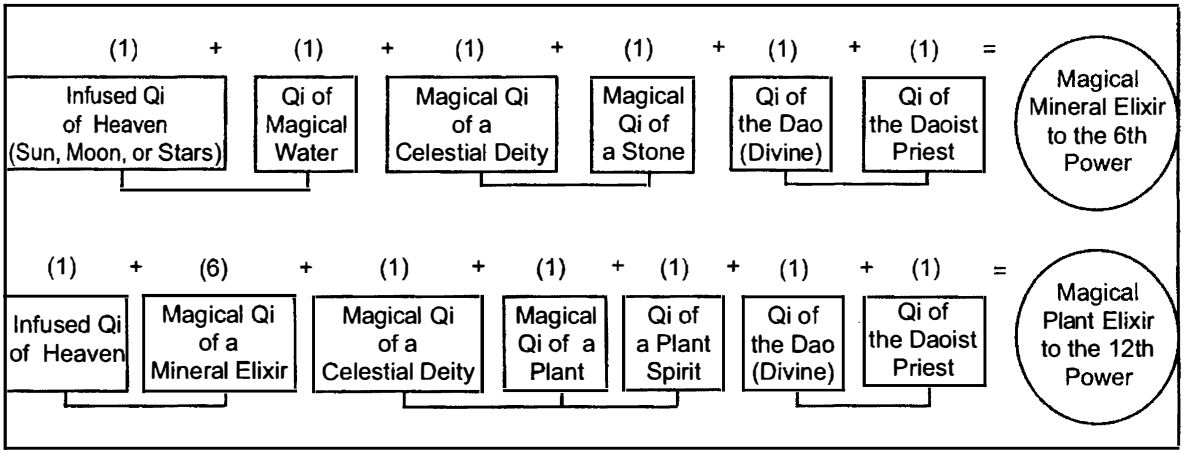


Figure 1.95. A magical herbal elixir properly constructed by a Daoist Priest has 12 times the power of any normal elixir formula created by an herbalist.

CREATING GEM ELIXIRS

When absorbing the healing properties of the magical stones, gems and metals, the ancient Daoists noted the magical properties of these minerals could be internally ingested through two main methods, described as follows:

- **Ingesting the Magical Powers of Gem Stones:** The first method used for absorbing a magical stone's energetic qualities was through a visual interactive process. This process involves the absorption of the gem's celestial light through the physical eyes, sometimes known as "visual sipping."

  Sacred symbols (such as Yantras) are sometimes used to reflect a stone's planetary energies, and can also be used to activate and increase the intuitive powers of a priest's subconscious awareness. In ancient times, articles of clothing, armor, jewelry or other accoutrements were encrusted with gems as a means of receiving their magical powers and celestial influence.
- **Gem Elixirs:** The second method used for absorbing a magical stone's energetic qualities involves the ingestion of the gem as living liquid light. The value of the Planetary Gem Elixir lies in its ability to be taken at frequent intervals, infusing the body's Jing, Qi, and Shen with its subtle transformative properties over time.

A Gem Elixir is the name given to a fluid that has been infused with the energies of a particular crystal, either through the power of infused sunlight or moonlight. An "Ens" is the "First Extract" of a mineral's energetic nature. It is defined as an extract of the latent and previously untapped energetic potential of a rock or mineral. Hence the Ens is also termed "First Matter," and is believed to be the potency and magical substance of an items first natural life-impulse. The Gem Ens is to the Mineral Kingdom what an Essential Oil is to the Plant Kingdom. Therefore, the Ens is to be sought after above all things in the Mineral World.

Mineral or Gem Ens Elixirs are traditionally known as the "Greater Circulation" in External Alchemic traditions. They are formed by cultivating and extracting the Jing, Qi, and Shen of specific metals and minerals. This alchemical process follows the same principles as those used in plant work, which is known as the "Lesser Circulation." In certain magical traditions however, the "Greater Circulation" is traditionally undertaken only by a priest after a certain degree of plant mastery has been attained. However, in ancient Daoism, a disciple was taught the secret skill of Plant Magic only after mastering the art of Mineral Magic. The mastery of the energetic and spiritual powers of the various minerals provided an important alchemical foundation, and empowered the priest

with the essential understanding from which to study the esoteric energetic and spiritual powers of the plant realm. This essential knowledge also empowered the Daoist priest with the ability to properly construct powerful magical elixirs and Immortal Pills.

One little known fact, is that a magical Mineral Elixir properly constructed by a Daoist priest has six times the power of any prescription formula created by an herbalist. Additionally, when properly constructed, a magical Herbal Elixir created by a Daoist priest has 12 times the power of any normally constructed herbal formula created by an herbalist (Figure 1.95).

Crystals have the ability to absorb negative electromagnetic pathogens, as well as emit pure clean energy. Because crystals have powerful vibrations it is easy to transfer these energetic vibrations into water which act as a condenser. In ancient China, gem remedies (also known as elixirs or essences) were either taken internally as tonics (unless the stone was toxic), or applied externally and used as energetic and spiritual "enhancers" (sometimes the stones were applied directly onto the skin, or placed in bath water).

Before going on an expedition, the famous Mongolian ruler Genghis Khan, would give his soldiers a handful of pulverized rock as a drug for the treatment of arrow and sword wounds, and a handful of ground up rock as a remedy for fatigue and food poisoning. It is also believed that these rock powers were boiled in water, drunk, and used in cooking (known as rock soup, or "mineral soup"). Also, for hundreds of years up till the present time, many of the main components of drugs in Tibetan medicine have been pulverized minerals.

Gem elixirs are liquid preparations that contain the condensed healing vibrations of a particular gem or mineral. Much of the information that exists on the energetic healing qualities of gem stones has been derived from their physical signatures. These include the crystal system or family that a particular stone belongs to, its color, hardness, composition, and the geologic process by which it was formed. With that information in mind, the primary focus for creating ancient

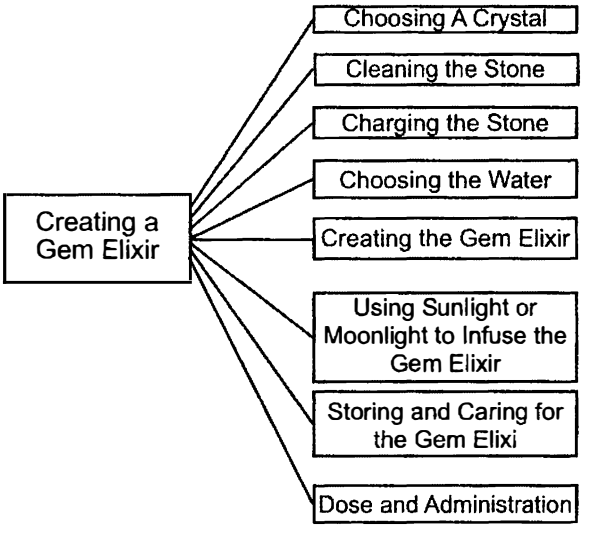


Figure 1.96. A magical Gem Elixir is generally divided into eight simple steps.

magical Gem Elixirs has been on summonsing, condensing, and ingesting the most subtle invisible energetic and spiritual powers of a particular stone, as well as the specific Elemental powers that were called into service during the time of its preparation.

Gem elixirs can be used in order to access the healing support of the mineral realm in a very efficient way through their ease and flexibility of application. For example, they can be applied internally or externally, by themselves, or in combination with other vibrational remedies. They are particularly effective when used in conjunction with Plant Elixirs (e.g., Flower Essences), as they help to physically stabilize and root the spiritual shifts in consciousness that are catalyzed by the transformational energies of the plants.

Generally, the process of creating a Gem Elixir is divided into eight simple steps: Choosing A Crystal, Cleansing the Stone, Charging the Stone, Choosing the Type of Elixir Water, Creating the Gem Elixir, Using Sunlight or Moonlight to Infuse the Gem Elixir, Storing and Caring for the Gem Elixir, and Dose and Administration, described as follows (Figure 96):

(1) CHOOSING A CRYSTAL

In order to make an elixir, the Daoist priest must first choose a crystal that matches his or her specific needs. Although the size of the crystal does not matter, it is extremely important to begin by thoroughly cleansing the crystal. After obtaining a crystal, there are a few things that must be done in order to ensure that it used without incurring harm.

Stones are subject to a wide range of energetic imprinting before they arrive into your possession. Prior to using them in magic, or charging them with your own personal energies, it is strongly suggested that you perform a cleansing ritual on the stone. This will neutralize any unwanted energies that have been imprinted into and are currently residing within the stone. It is important to note, however, that certain masters believe that if you have collected this stone yourself from nature, there is no need to worry about purification.

If after the cleansing process, you still feel some negative energy imbedded within the stone when you hold it, you will need to repeat the cleansing process. After you feel that the stone has been cleared and cleansed, then you are ready to use it for whatever purpose you desire.

(2) CLEANING THE STONE

The priest will then begin purging and cleaning the stone of any and all negative influences. Next, the stone is dedicated to an appropriate deity or celestial power, with a statement of intention, such as the hidden magic and power of the stone will be used for self-defense, healing, intuitions, etc.

The following is a very basic ritual used for cleansing and purifying magical tools used by Daoist mystics. There are many variations and modifications that can be add to this ritual, depending on the priest's intended goal. After becoming more familiar with the Daoist magic techniques, the rituals can be modified to become as simple or complicated as the priest desires.

In order to perform the following Cleansing Ritual, you will need sea-salt, a small amount of purified water, a red candle, and three sticks of incense (preferably myrrh, frankincense, or white sage). Although you do not need to use an altar to perform this ritual, if you have already established one, you are encouraged to use it.

- Firstly, sit comfortably in a quiet location.
- Have your crystals and the other items that you need for the purification ritual laid out in front of you. The salt represents the Element of Earth. The Water is the Element of Water. The candle represents the Element of Fire (its red color is symbolic of purification), and the three sticks of incense represents the Element of Air (and the fervent prayers to the Three Pure Ones).
- Add a pinch of salt to your small bowl/container of water, and say the following incantation:

"I Now Combine the Tian Ling Shen (Celestial Magical Powers) of Shui (Water) and Di (Earth)."

- Next, take your crystal, and dip it into the solution of salt water, and say the following incantation:

"By the Magical Powers of Shui and Di I Now Cleanse and Purify You."

- Now, quickly pass the crystal through the candle flame three times, and say the following incantation:

"By the Tian Ling Shen (Celestial Magical Powers) of Huo (Fire) I Now Cleanse and Purify You."

- Now, quickly pass the crystal through the incense smoke three times, and say the following incantation:

"By the Tian Ling Shen (Celestial Magical Powers) of Feng (Wood/Air) I Now Cleanse and Purify You."

With any Daoist ritual or esoteric magical working, visualization is a vital part of the ceremony. You have to concentrate extremely hard, and actually see in your mind's eye the candle flame, incense smoke, and salt solution draining

away all of the stone's toxic energies. Feel them flowing out of the stone as you perform your work. Allow the powers of nature work through you. Feel, experience, and know that the magical words of the various incantations accomplish your will and heart's desire. Know that what you feel and see in your mind's eye gives any magical work its power.

(3) Charging the Stone

Before you use any stone for magic or as a talisman, it should be charged or programmed with the desired energies. All stones possess a natural energy of their own. Many ancient civilizations held great respect for the power that stones held, and various stones were often used as a central part of their religious life. The process used for charging the stone personalizes this energy, and lets you focus your needs and intentions into the stone.

Using The Energetic Power of The Sun

Some simple methods of energizing a crystal (i.e., quartz) include leaving it in bright sunlight for a day, with the Sun's warm rays shining full on it. This is also a method used in cleansing a stone.

Using The Energetic Power of Other Crystals

You can also use other crystals to assist in the cleansing and energizing process. A cluster of clear quartz is excellent for this. Simply sit the stone on the cluster for a couple of days. It is suggested that any stone you are using to purify and energize others be cleansed on a regular basis, to rid it of any negative energy it may have absorbed from the other stones.

Reprogramming and Imprinting

You can reprogram and imprint the specific personal energies into a stone. This imprinting process is described as follows:

- First, choose a stone whose properties specifically fit your required needs. This makes the imprinting easier, especially when you can fuse your own energies together with the energetic powers of the stone.
- After the stone has been fully cleansed, sit comfortably and hold it in your right (Yin) hand and seal it with your left (Yang) hand.
- Imagine and feel the specific type of energy and power that you want the stone to hold (e.g., love, protection, clairvoyance, or wealth), and experience this energy with your whole being.
- Visualize, feel, and experience this energy flowing through your core self and into the crystal. The more you can concentrate, and really see, feel, hear, smell, and taste the energy flowing into the stone, the more effective the programming will be. Experience this cultivated energy residing within you and acting as your personal power. You can now move this energy from your body, out into stones, talismans, charms, candles, weapons, and other magical objects to help you achieve your magical goals. The movement of this or other forms of natural energy is at the heart of Daoist magic.

(4) Choosing the Type of Elixir Water

Different kinds of water have different magical powers. The effect of water depends substantially on the water's source, temperature, and level of purity. Water constantly changes its energetic properties according to the subtle life-energy it absorbs from the environment (e.g., water from a spring, well, rain, or morning dew). It is for this reason that water from various sources is specially collected during certain seasons of the year. Additionally, the ocean and all water courses connected to it are said to be linked to the Underworld, the Moon, and Nature Spirits.

Gem Elixirs are generally "born" in water (e.g., rain water, well water, spring water, mineral water, talismanic water, Holy Water, or morning dew). Water has the ability to hold energy patterns intact for long periods of time, therefore making this an ideal medium for capturing the powers of a stone. The elixir can then be used for healing or empowering the physical, energetic, or spiritual body, depending on the disciple's specific needs and the specific energies of the particular crystal or gem.

Gathering Rain

The ancient Daoists noted that all forms of water fall from the Heavens, including rain, snow, hail, and sleet. Each of these share a connection with the subtle Yin and Yang forces of life. According to ancient alchemy, the energies of Yin and Yang gather in the clouds as part of the subtle

cycle of energies linked to the seasons. During the second, third, and fourth lunar months (March, April, and May) these forces descend in the form of rain to bring new life to the soil. Rain water caught in clean containers during this special time period will have special magical properties, and can be harvested to give additional strength to a Gem Elixir. It is important to note, however, that the gathered rain water cannot be kept for more than a few days before the celestial energies begin to depart. Additionally, the rain water should only be collected in places where the air is pure.

Another important type of water used by the ancient Daoists was rain water gathered from a thunder storm. During a thunder storm, containers were set out to catch the rain that fell during severe thunder and lightning showers. This special water was traditionally used for making powerful magic tools, especially those used in exorcisms.

Gathering Morning Dew

Dew is water that condenses out of the air and morning mist onto leaves, grass, and other surfaces (i.e., Magic Mirrors). In ancient Daoist alchemy, dew was believed to carry the subtle energies of life, forming one of the main pathways through which the energies of Heaven and Earth unite. Therefore, during the Spring and Autumn times, the Daoist mystic would gather dew at dawn from the leaves of specific herbs, Magic Mirrors, and crystal formations left out overnight. Another method was to simply drag a thin, clean, cotton towel over the grass until the sheet was dripping with moisture.

The dew should only be collected in places where the air is pure and the soil has not been contaminated with chemicals. It is also important to note that dew should always be gathered before the direct rays of the Sun touches it. Additionally, the gathered dew cannot be kept for more than a few days before the celestial energies begin to depart.

(5) CREATING THE GEM ELIXIR

Make sure that you have gathered together all of the items and specific ingredients that you will need to create the Gem Elixir. This should include the following list (Figure 1.97):

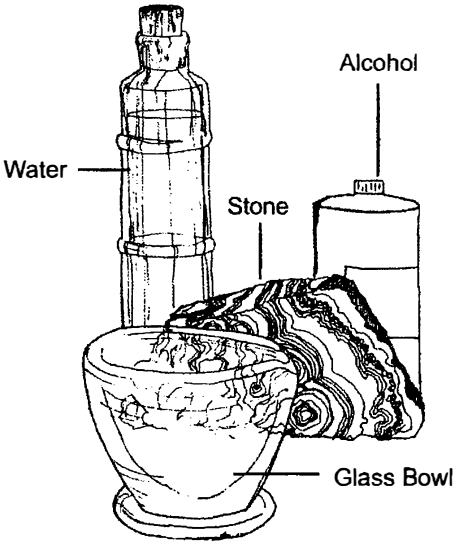


Figure 1.97. Creating a Stone Elixir

- **A Stone:** Any particular crystal, mineral, rock, and gemstone that contains the specific energetic and spiritual qualities and powers necessary to achieve your magical goal.
- **Glass Bowl:** A clear glass bowl is needed as a "birthing" chamber through which to combine and infuse the Gem Elixir.
- **Water:** The particular type of Water (rain water, well water, spring water, mineral water, Holy Water, or Talismanic Water) containing the specific energetic and spiritual qualities and powers needed to hold the Gem Elixir's energetic patterns intact for long periods of time.
- **Alcohol:** After the crystal has been placed in the water during the infusion process, its extracted essence can then be preserved by blending it with rice wine, brandy, or other form of spirit alcohol.
- **Mother Container:** A dark colored glass bottle is needed for storing the "mother" elixir.
- **Child Container:** A dark colored glass eyedropper bottle is needed for storing the "child" elixir, and is to be completely used up before refilling from the "mother" container.

In order to make a Gem Elixir, begin by placing a cleansed non-water soluble crystal in a glass bowl and cover it with the pure water. Then place the bowl in an area that will be exposed to the direct sunlight (or moonlight) for the selected period of time. If possible, place the glass bowl on the roof of your house, so that it catches the rays from all angles, and is less likely to have any shadows pass over it during the infusion process.

(6) Using Sunlight or Moonlight to Infuse the Gem Elixir

When making your elixir, you will need to decide whether you are going to use sunlight or moonlight for infusing your Gem Elixir. Sunlight (the gathering of Yang) is traditionally used for elixirs that are designed for aiding the physical body. Moonlight (the gathering of Yin) is used for those elixirs that are directed towards spiritual and magical needs. As a general rule any elixir that will be used for physical purposes or bodily healing should be created with sunlight, and any elixir that will be used for magical, psychic, or mental purposes should be created with moonlight.

You will also need to choose a day or night when the sky is cloud-free, as the infusion process requires direct Sun or Moon light for at least three hours. If there is some cloud covering, you will not be able to create a strong enough infusion in only 3 hours, and will need to leave it out all day or night for the complete 12 hour process. Keep the gemstones in the water solution for a minimum of 24 hours. Some priests take from seven to 14 days to make an elixir, spending some time each day to mentally reinforce and infuse the elixir with Breath Incantations (Mantras).

After the crystal has been placed in the water during the infusion process, its extracted essence can then be preserved by blending it with rice wine, brandy, or other form of spirit alcohol. The resulting liquid is taken orally, usually a few drops in a glass of water. Sometimes a piece of the crystal or gem is left in the bottle after the infusion process to further enhance the potion. In order to further reinforce your intentions, specific visualizations, affirmations, and incantations can also be incorporated while consuming the Gem Elixir.

(7) Storing and Caring for Gem Elixir

Leave the infusion elixir untouched for at least 3 hours (7 hours for maximum results), then pour the liquid into the clean dark glass bottle. Fill half of the bottle with your infusion, and then fill the rest of the bottle with rice wine, brandy, or another form of spirit alcoholic. Seal the bottle, and then shake vigorously for 30 seconds. This completes the construction of the mother elixir. Next pour some of the Gem Elixir in a child container. This container is to be used every day.

After you have labeled the bottle, store its contents in a cool dark spot for later use. In some Daoist schools, the priest will leave the crystal or gem in the bottom of the mother elixir in order to further infuse its properties.

After you remove the crystal from the mother container, make sure that you have bottled the original tincture in a dark glass bottle with an airtight stopper. This original tincture will keep for more than a week if you added 50% Brandy or Vodka as its preservative. Store the mother elixir in a cool dark place.

(8) Dose and Administration

The prescribed dosage of the Gem Elixir will vary according to the strength of the elixir and the specific gems used. Some practitioners recommend only 3 to 5 drops of elixir in a glass of water twice a day, while others may suggest 12-18 drops twice a day, or even drinking a small tea cup three times a day. Because each individual has his or her own unique constitutional reactions to a specific Gem Elixir, it is best to use your own energetic sensitivity and intuition to decide on the dosage and frequency of administration. This can be done through quiescent meditation, by sitting quietly with the bottle of elixir in your hands, and attuning yourself to its energetic resonations. Each stone has a guardian spirit or spirit entity responsible for its magical power. Ask the spirit of the stone for guidance, and see if you can intuit the information.

Elixirs can be also be administered directly under the tongue, undiluted, as with flower essences. The rich blood supply to the mouth area, and the thin skin under the tongue allows for rapid

absorption of the elixir. You can also apply some to an afflicted area of the body that you are wishing to treat, or use a Gem Elixir in a bath.

Some masters recommend that the disciple start with the undiluted, sublingual (under the tongue) administration for the first few weeks, then move on to the dilution method (i.e. in a glass of water) for a few weeks to a month.

The important thing to remember is that when you choose a specific dosage, stick with it. Also, only use one Gem Elixir at a time and completely finish a bottle before you refill it. Once you finish a bottle the desired shift is usually complete. Elixirs, like Essences, work best when used in increments of three or seven. Each bottle will last approximately one week when kept in a dark glass bottle with an airtight stopper, away from sunlight.

Gem elixirs are designed to gently affect the body, mind, and spirit over a period of time, not instantaneously. Therefore, you will need to continue to use the specific dosage for at least a month in order to achieve the best results. Afterwards, you may then feel the need to decrease the dosage, and then eventually stop. The treatment can be repeated, as you feel the need arise.

TOXIC STONES

There are quite a few gems and crystals that should never be used to make elixirs in the above mentioned manner. The basic rule of thumb is that any stone containing metals should not be used. This includes most brightly colored blue and green stones, as these often take their coloring from metals, and metals can be toxic in humans. Water leaches the toxins from the stone, which would then be ingested.

If you are using toxic stones, It is important that you use the indirect method, by placing the stone in a small glass jar and then placing the glass jar into the bowl of water. Alternatively, you can use the below mentioned stones in a safe manner, by taking a glass of water, holding the stone to the side of the glass, and visualizing the energies infusing the water. Drink the glass of water immediately, and repeat two to four times daily, for two months. This will not, however, be as effective as the traditional Gem Elixir recipe.

Before constructing a Gem Elixir, to make sure that you have not selected a stone that can cause you harm. The following is the list of stones, and their potentially toxic ingredients:

Amazonite - Copper
Atacamite - Copper
Auricalcite - Zinc and Copper
Azurite - Copper
Boji-stones - Sulfur
Bronchantite - Copper
Chalcantite - Copper
Chalcopyrite - Copper & Sulphur
Cinnabar - Mercury
Conicalcite - Copper
Crysocolla - Copper
Cuprite - Copper
Dioptase - Copper
Gem Silica - Copper
Galena / Galenite - Lead (almost 90%)
Garnierite / Genthite / Falcondoite - Nickel
Halite - will dissolve in water
Hematite - will rust in water
Lapis Lazuli -Pyrite inclusions contain Sulfur
Magnetite - will rust in water
Malachite - toxic, only used in polished form.
Markasite - Sulfur
Mohawkite - Copper & Arsenic
Psiomelan - Barium
Pyrite - Sulfur
Realgar - Sulfur & Arsenic
Stibnite - Lead
Smithsonite - Zinc & Copper
Ulexite - stone will lose its luster in water
Vanadanite - Lead
Wulfenite - Lead & molybdenum

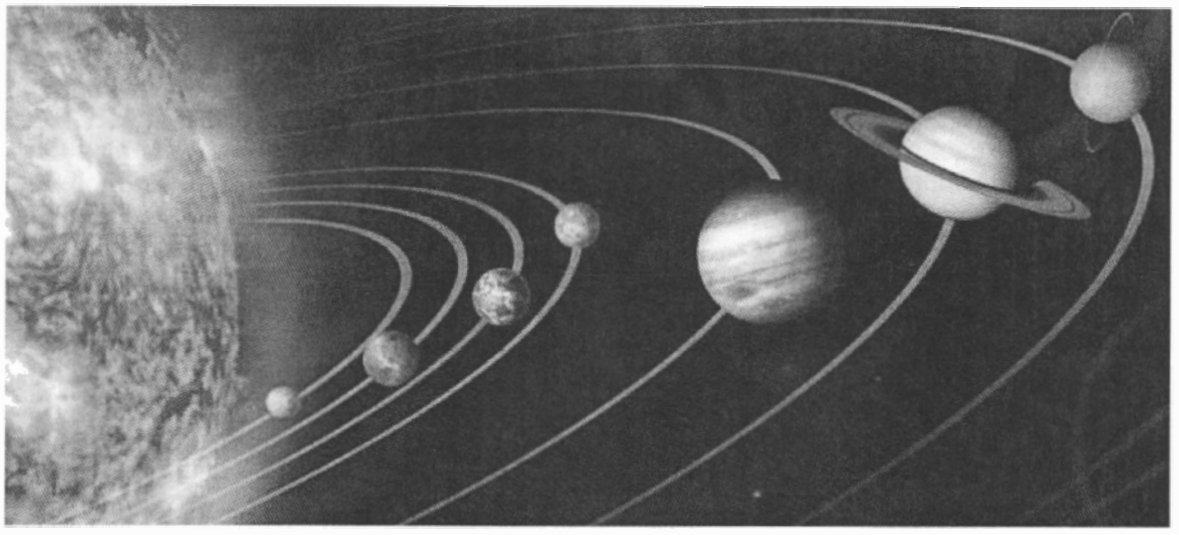


Figure 1.98. Creating Planetary Gem Elixirs

PLANETARY GEM ELIXIRS

The qualities and uses of gemstones are best understood through the study of their colors, growth patterns, and mineral components. However, they can also be energetically classified according to planetary affiliations and chakra affiliations.

The ancient Daoists considered gemstones to be celestial gifts from the Heavens, and understood that they were responsible for activating and awakening the inner dimensional awareness of the psyche. Gems, like people, were believed to receive their unique powers from the cosmic energies of the planets. The ancient priests believed that the color-coded energy emitted from each of the planets in our solar system was filled with an interstellar intelligence that infused itself into the natural landscape of Earth (Figure 1.98). The stars of the galaxy and the cosmic rays that permeate their celestial territory were seen as evidence that revealed the Daoist priest's true spiritual identity as ambassadors of divine awareness. Gems were believed to possess a unique capacity to reflect this chromatically coded light in physical form. Thus, they secretly served as precise vehicles of expression for the mechanics of manifest and unmanifest creation.

One closely guarded secret in ancient China was the utilization of precious gems as transmitters of light and specific frequencies of consciousness. Throughout the centuries, the use of Planetary Gem Elixirs was often limited to members of the imperial royal court, the elite strata of Chinese society, or certain secret Daoist and Buddhist sects with political influence. Planetary Gem Elixirs embody the sacred art and science of imprinting a fluid medium with the subtle energetic field and spiritual power of a specific planet along with the intrinsic energetic pattern of its representative gem.

In ancient times, the elixirs were prepared from rare and superior stones (i.e., those that were natural, flawless, and untreated) in a geometrically refined state. The alchemical principles involved in the creation of Planetary Gem Elixirs reflect a high degree of discipline, prayerful intent, and in-depth knowledge of 60 year astrological cycles, including patterns of the Sun, Moon, Five Planets, 28 Star Constellations, 10 Heavenly Stems, and 12 Earthly Branches. Amplified by the carefully guided ritual practice with which they were prepared, the elixirs were considered to be powerful catalysts for personal evolution and transformation.

Through their elegant but powerful interplay with human consciousness, the Planetary Gem Elixirs work with the highest levels of the human emotional and mental processes. Their celestial influences transmute the limited thought structures of the conscious self, creating an energetic bridge to the spiritual realm of the Divine Self. The ancient Daoist priests therefore sought after the celestial infusion and empowerment of planetary realms in order to assist them in their goal of constructing the "Immortal Fetus."

The Planetary Gem Elixirs were also believed to be capable of opening the inter-dimensional portals that align the mystic with advanced interstellar intelligence, and they were therefore used while performing certain Daoist Star Stepping patterns and Hand Seals.

THE SEVEN CELESTIAL PLANETS

In order to understand the significance of Planetary Gem Elixirs and the type and extent of their influence, it is important to first understand the specific celestial planets from which they receive their stellar powers.

There is an intimate connection between Astrology, Astronomy, Feng Shui, and Ming Shu (Fate Calculation Divination). According to ancient Daoist teachings, all climatic changes are believed to be produced by the moral conduct of the people, through the agency of the Sun, Moon, and Stars. Additionally, Yin and Yang, Five Element, and Eight Trigram calculations are used to determine the various astrological calculations.

In ancient China, the Sun, Moon, Planets, and Star Constellations were divided into four divisions of Yang and Yin classifications, described as follows:

- **Sun (Tai Yang):** Major Yang Influence
- **Moon (Tai Yin):** Major Yin Influence
- **Five Planets (Shao Yin):** Lessor Yin Influence
- **28 Stars Constellations (Shao Yang):** Lessor Yang Influence

The positive and negative magical influences of these important celestial bodies constantly vary, according to their celestial positions. For example, the appearance of comets and eclipses of the Sun and Moon were believed to have a malign energetic influence over the affairs of men.

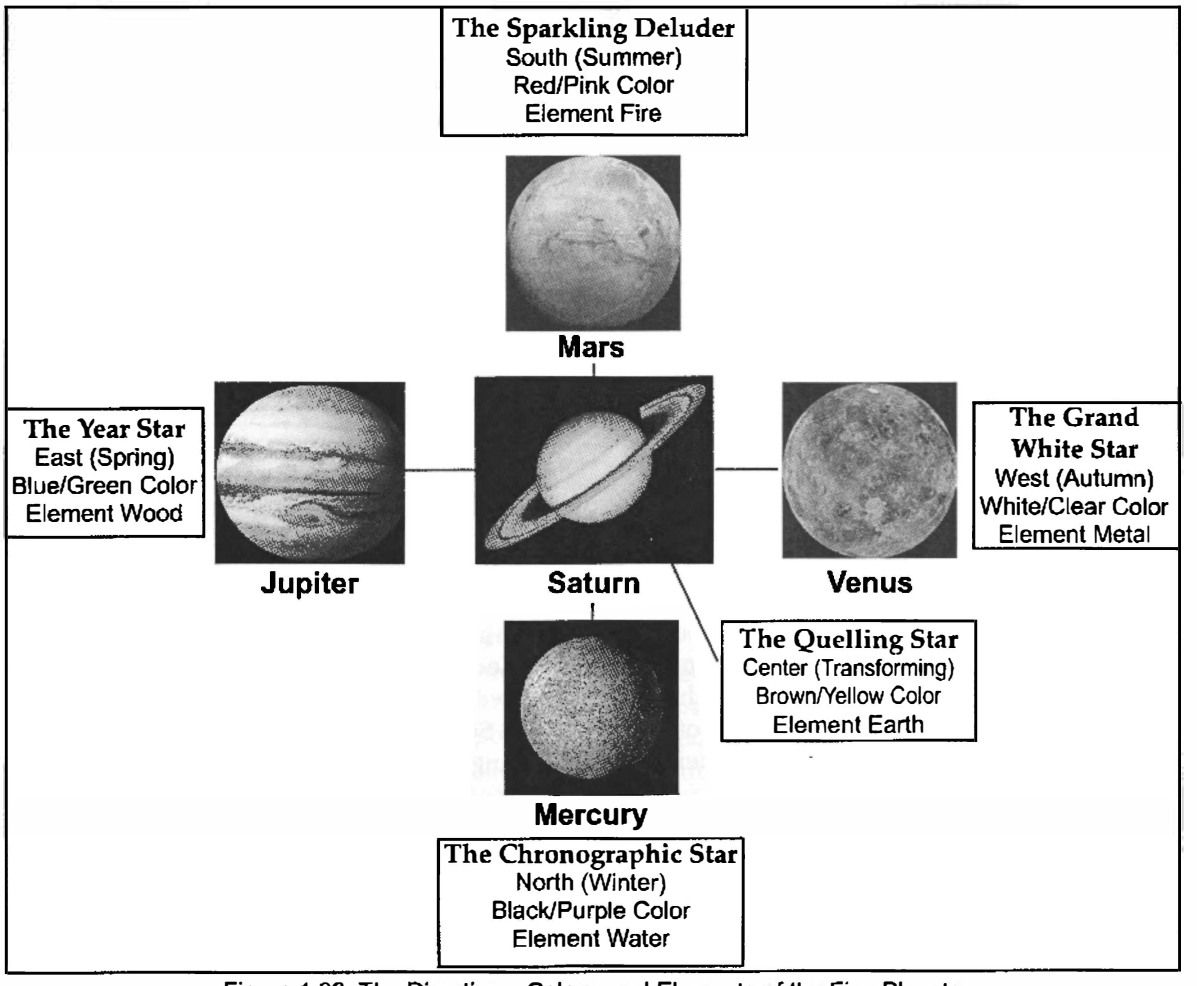


Figure 1.99. The Directions, Colors, and Elements of the Five Planets

According to ancient Daoist teachings, the Seven Stars (i.e., the Sun, Moon, and Five Planets) are the embodiment of Dao. Heaven and Earth depend on the Perfect Vital Breath of the Sun, Moon, and Stars to nourish all things. According to the *Book of the Mysterious Gate and Precious Sea*, "the essence of Yang is the Sun, and the essence of Yin is the Moon. Sharing the essence of the Sun and Moon are the Stars. Together, they nourish the twelve thousand things by the perfect Dao. Even the beasts and grass are nourished by Secret Dao and Essential Virtue of the Sun, Moon, and Stars."

In ancient China, it was common practice for people to worship Stellar Sovereigns or Star Gods. The original Star Gods consisted of the Celestial Immortals that lived and ruled over the powers of the Sun, Moon and Five Planets. In ancient Daoist mysticism, these seven celestial energies were sometimes collectively known as the "Seven Celestial Stars" or "Higher Phase Stars" (Shangxingxing). In this celestial model, the Sun and Moon represent the Yang and Yin energies of Heaven, while the Five Planets symbolize the Five Element energies of Heaven.

Since the Five Planets do not radiate light like the Sun does, they were therefore considered to have a Yin quality like the Moon and Earth. The ancient Chinese believed that the Five Planets

were responsible for the internal Yin organ energy formation within the body during fetal development, and that they sustained these vital pools of energy throughout the individual's life on Earth. Because they were connected to the specific color resonances vibrating within each of the body's five internal Yin organs (Figure 1.99), these seven celestial planets became the focus of several Qigong meditations and elixir prescriptions developed in ancient China. According to the section written on stars in the ancient Daoist text *Seven Slips of a Cloudy Satchel*, each of the Five Planets has its own name, energetic power, and spiritual influence. For example:

- **The Year Star is Jupiter:** Its Direction is East, Color is Blue/Green, and its Element is Wood.

  According to Daoist magical teachings, Jupiter symbolizes Wood, and rules the Spring season.

  When Jupiter and Saturn meet in the same "house," it indicates good fortune to the empire.

- **The Sparkling Deluder is Mars:** Its Direction is South, Color is Red, and its Element is Fire.

  According to Daoist magical teachings, Mars symbolizes Fire, and rules the Summer season. It is the author of punishments, and is the producer of sudden confusion.

- **The Quelling Star is Saturn:** Its Direction is Center, Color is Brown/Yellow, and its Element is Earth.

  According to Daoist magical teachings, Saturn symbolizes Earth, and rules the transition of energy occurring between the four seasons.

  If Saturn with the other four planets should appear white and round, mourning and drought are in store for the country.

  If Saturn should appear red, disturbances are to be expected, and troops will take the field.

  If Saturn should appear green, floods are to be looked for.

  If Saturn should appear black, sickness and death will spread over the land.

  If Saturn should appear yellow, a time of prosperity is at hand.

- **The Grand White Star is Venus:** Its Direction is West, Color is White, and its Element is Metal.

  According to Daoist magical teachings, Venus symbolizes Metal (Gold), and rules the Autumn season. It is considered to be a complacent planet. However, while in many of its phases it foretells peace and prosperity, it also foreshadows the disruption of the empire and the movement of troops. For example:

  If Venus at first looms large and afterwards small, the national forces will be weak.

  If Venus at first looms small and afterwards large, the national forces will be strong.

  If Venus appears large and extended, trouble will fall upon princes and nobles, and military expeditions , then undertaken, will begin fortunately and end with disaster.

  If Venus appears compact and small, campaigns which begin in misfortune will end successfully.

- **The Chronographic Star is Mercury:** Its Direction is North, Color is Black/Purple, and its Element is Water.

  According to Daoist magical teachings, Mercury symbolizes Water, and rules the Winter season.

  If Mercury appears white in color, it forecasts drought.

  If Mercury appears yellow in color, crops will be scorched.

  If Mercury appears red in color, soldiers will arise.

  If Mercury appears black in color, floods are at hand.

  If Mercury appears large and white in the East, troops beyond the frontier will disperse.

  If Mercury appears large and red, the Middle Kingdom will be victorious.

  If Mercury appears in certain conjunctions with Venus, it foreshadows great battles in which strangers will be victorious.

  If Mercury approaches Venus, several tens of thousands on men will meet in strife, and the men and ministers of the ruler will die.

PLANET MEDITATIONS

According to ancient Daoist teaching, before a priest began to meditate on a specific celestial planet or star constellation, it was important that he first energetically feel the planets subtle movements, within both the Heavens and the Earth. According to ancient Daoist belief, as each planet moved through the Heavens, it had a subtle energetic affect on the various energetic fields of everything living within the Earth.

When meditating on a specific planet, the ancient Daoists would close their physical eyes and begin to imagine and feel that they were opening the celestial portal of their Third Eye. This image allowed the various energetic fields of each of the five main planets to be independently experienced (Figure 1.100).

The unique image and different energy of each planet eventually merged and formed within the priest's Three Bodies (physical, energetic and spirit body). Then, while pulsing within the priest's Third Eye area, his body would experience a mild tremor as it energetically connected with the planet's resonating energies. Through this unique experience, the ancient Daoists learned how to examine and feel the most subtle changes each planet brought to the Earthly realm.

Traditionally, each planet was used for its energetic influence on the human tissues according to the following Magical Correspondences:

- **Jupiter:** Influences the Qi of the body's liver and Hun (Ethereal Soul). Green/Blue Light and vapor.
- **Mars:** Influences the Qi of the body's heart, vitality, and the body's physical strength. Red Light and vapor.
- **Saturn:** Influences the Qi of the body's stomach, spleen, and digestive system. Yellow Light and vapor.
- **Venus:** Influences the Qi of the body's lungs, and glands. White Light and vapor.
- **Mercury:** Influences the Qi of the body's kidneys and nervous system. Black/Dark Blue Light and vapor.

PLANET INCENSE OFFERINGS

After the priest had chosen a particular celestial planet or star constellation through which to focus and direct his meditation, it was essential that he present the guardian of that planet's magical powers with the appropriate offerings. Each of the seven celestial deities governing the seven main planets required different offerings and sacrifices. This was needed to appease the guardians of that celestial portal. Without this appeasement, the true understanding of the planet deities secret magical powers and the deeper subtleties of the planets spiritual influence could not be accessed or ascertained. The seven planets and their specific offerings are described as follows:

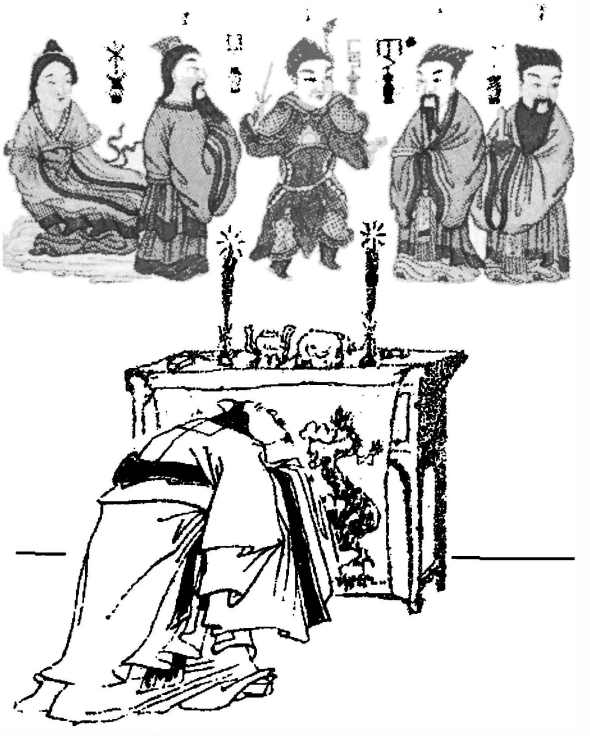


Figure 1.100. "Daoist priest, worshipping the spirits of the Fives Planets: Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter and Saturn

- **Sun:** In the hour or day (Sunday) of the Sun, incense offerings should include deer musk amber, frankincense, myrrh, saffron, cloves, laurel and cinnamon, mixed together with the brain of an eagle and the blood of a white cock. All of the ingredients should be combined and rolled into small balls and placed on the flames of the altar fire.

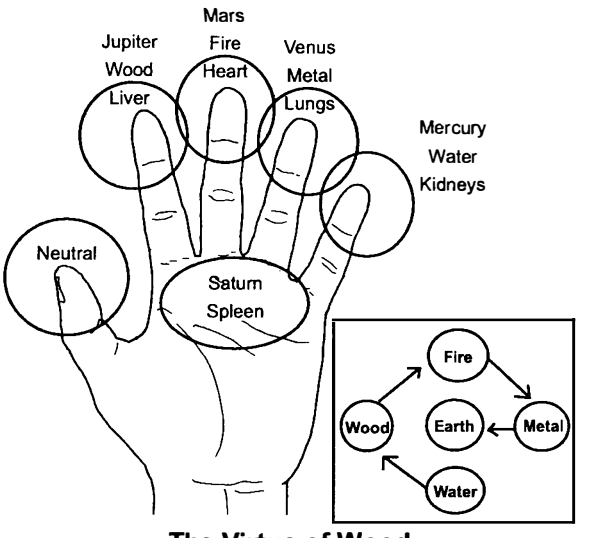
- **Moon:** In the hour or day (Monday) of the Moon, incense offerings should include poppy seed, dried frogs, camphor, frankincense and the eyes of an ox mixed with blood. When the Moon incense is burning, spirits in the form of ghosts in filmy transparent draperies, with pale and luminous faces should be seen.
- **Mars:** In the hour or day (Tuesday) of Mars, the incense offerings should include aromatic gum, sandalwood, frankincense, myrrh, and the blood of a black cat.
- **Mercury:** In the hour or day (Wednesday) of Mercury, incense offerings should include frankincense mixed with the brain of a fox.
- **Jupiter:** In the hour or day (Thursday) of Jupiter, offerings should include peacock feathers, a swallow, and a piece of Lapis-Lazuli. The ashes should be gathered and added to the blood of a stork, and presented at the altar. When the Jupiter offering is burned, spirits in the form of kings accompanied by their criers should be seen.
- **Venus:** In the hour or day (Friday) of Venus, incense offerings should include spermaceti, roses, coral, aloes, mixed with the brains and blood of a white pigeon.
- **Saturn:** In the hour or day (Saturday) of Saturn, incense offerings should include pepper, with deer musk and frankincense. When the Saturn incense is burning, spirits in the form of cats and wolves should be seen.

THE "FIVE PLANET INCANTATION"

The following secret incantation was used in ancient China by Daoist priests in order to invoke the magical protection of the Five Planets. In this special incantation, the priest evokes the celestial energy of the Five Element Creative Cycle, by using his left thumb to press specific points on his left hand, while speaking the incantation.

"The Five Planets Shine!
Their light illuminates the Five Directions!

The Watery Planet
Averts all catastrophes!



The Virtue of Wood
Brings Prosperity!

The Flaming Planet
Extinguishes Fires!

The Great White Planet
Repels Metal Weapons!

The Stabilizing Planet
Holds the others in place!

Family and State are benefited!

My name in carved
On the Tablet of Jade!
I am Registered
In the Chamber of the Emperor!

I ride the radiating rays!
I soar upward
into the Great Emptiness!

I enter and exit the Great Void!
I wander
Feasting throughout the Universe!

The Five Clouds lift the Covers
I summon the Gods
and tame the Winds!

The countless rulers do my bidding,
and protect the Immortal One!"

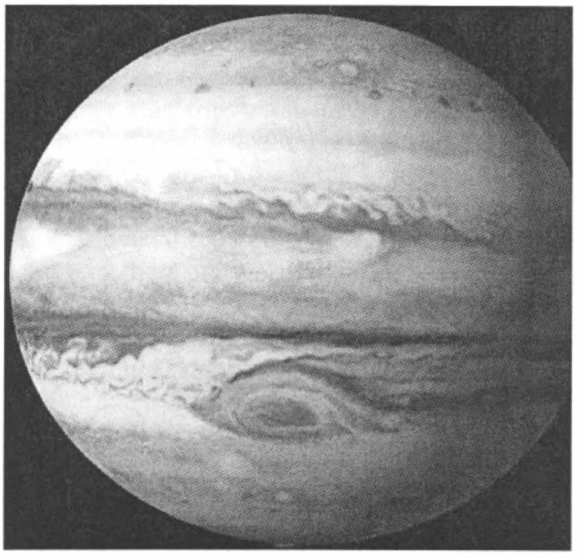


Figure 1.101. The Planet Jupiter

The Categorization of Planetary Gem Elixirs and Specific Powers

In order to effectively construct "Planetary Gem Elixirs," it is necessary to have a thorough comprehension of the nature of each of the Seven Celestial Planets. This includes the colors, directional influences, Elements, ruling deities, associated gems, and Hand Seals needed in order to obtain a specific astrological connection to the desired planets.

The Planet Jupiter

The planet Jupiter (Figure 1.101) represents the celestial energy flowing from the easterly direction of the Heavens and emits a blue/green light energy. This celestial energy influences the energetic function of the body's Liver and Gall Bladder organs. The planet Jupiter is called "Muxing," the Wood Element Star. Its position in the heavens relates to the left side of the body's center Taiji Pole, and the blue/green celestial dragon "Mengzhang." It is associated with Spring, growth, and birth.

The ancient Daoist text known as the *Secretly Transmitted Supreme Pervasive Perfect Book of the Five Planets* states "In the East is the Perfect Imperial Sovereign of the Year Star (also known as the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Wood)."

The name of the ruling Celestial Immortal of Jupiter is Chenglan, though this deity is also known as Qingning (Figure 1.102). The Perfect

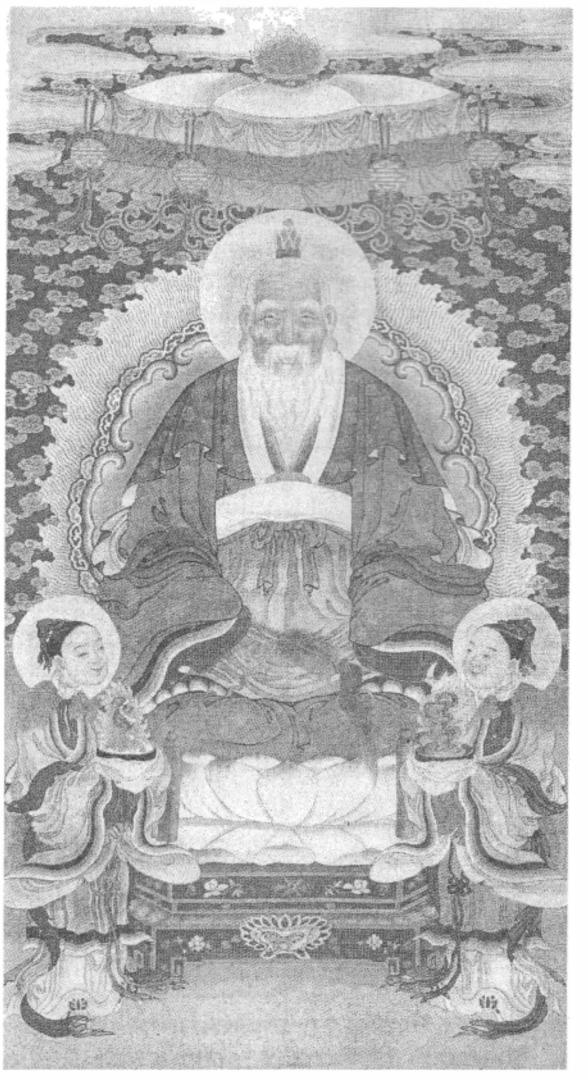


Figure 1.102. The Green Emperor of the Eastern Direction. His name is Chenglan, also known as Qingning. He is the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Wood.

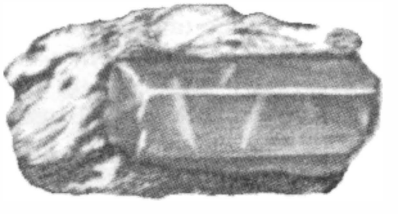


Figure 1.103. The Jupiter Planetary Elixir is generally constructed using Green Emerald

Sovereign of the Virtue of Wood is in charge of the birth of all things. It changes depression into stimulation. People who are fortunate and lucky should encourage its kindness, entice it, and seek after its influence and power.

THE JUPITER PLANETARY ELIXIR (USING GREEN EMERALD)

In Chinese alchemy, the color used to gather the planetary essence of Jupiter and the Wood Element is blue/green. Gemstones governed by Jupiter include emerald, peridot, tsavorite, chrome tourmaline, chrome diopside, green Jade, and other natural green (or blue gems) of flawless (eye-clean) quality. When making a Jupiter Planetary Elixir, a green emerald can be chosen because of its beautiful color (Figure 1.103). An emerald can be found in colors ranging from deep velvet green to light grass green. The best and most auspicious gem should be radiant in color, smooth and transparent, with bright refracting rays.

Metaphysical Properties

When placed beneath the tongue, a Jupiter Planetary Elixir constructed from a vibrant green emerald enables the priest to conjure evil spirits. The ancient mystics believed that this elixir could be used in order to reveal hidden secrets by heightening the priest's sensory perceptions and activating the his or her psychic abilities. A Jupiter Planetary Elixir also enhances receptivity to celestial and terrestrial energies and inspires communion with nature.

Preparation and Imprinting

When creating a Jupiter Planetary Elixir, it is important for the priest to form an energetic bridge that connects together the specific planet (Jupiter), the celestial Immortal responsible for bringing the planetary power down to the Earth (Celestial Immortal Chenglan), the specific direction the energy is being transferred from (East), and the specific gem stone being used (green emerald). These components form the "Four Pillars" of the Planetary Elixir, and they must all be utilized when energizing and imprinting the elixir.

Each planet has a ruling day of the week, as well as a ruling time period. The time period changes from season to season depending on the position of the Sun. When a planet is at its "High Tide" (the season of the specific planet) it manifests its strongest influence of celestial power. Therefore, Jupiter Planetary Elixirs are generally constructed in the Springtime, on Thursdays, and between the hours of 11 P.M.-3 A.M. Certain Daoist traditions may utilize different days or prefer to construct Jupiter Planetary Elixirs at dawn (5-7 A.M.), when the energy of the Eastern Palace is at its peak.

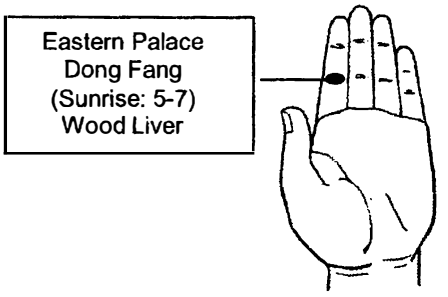


Figure 1.104. Hand Seal pattern used for bringing Wood Element Qi from the planet Jupiter (via the Eastern Direction) into a glass of water for energetic imprinting.

Incantation and Hand Seal

The magical act of speaking the proper incantation and using the proper Hand Seal (Figure 1.104) is needed for gathering and condensing the planetary energy into the Qi of the elixir. Each Hand Seal technique is combined with a specific Breath Incantation.

The following Breath Incantation is from the Mao Shan Daoist tradition and is used for bringing Qi from a specific celestial direction into a vessel of water for making a Planetary Elixir. If a Daoist priest wishes to gather Heavenly Qi from the planet Jupiter to imprint into the water, he or she can repeat the following Breath Incantation:

"Dong Fang Wu Ji Fei Tian Shen Wang
Su Jiang Gan Qi Yu Wu Shui Zhong!
JiJi Ru lu ling!"

This translates as: "Eastern Palace of the infinite flying heavenly god, bring down the Liver Qi into my water, quickly do this as it is law."

Each Breath Incantation and Hand Seal is changed according to the priest's needs by substituting the specific Palace and the specific internal organ Qi. Each of the palaces also has corresponding times, Elements of control, organ energies, altar gifts, and governing immortals.

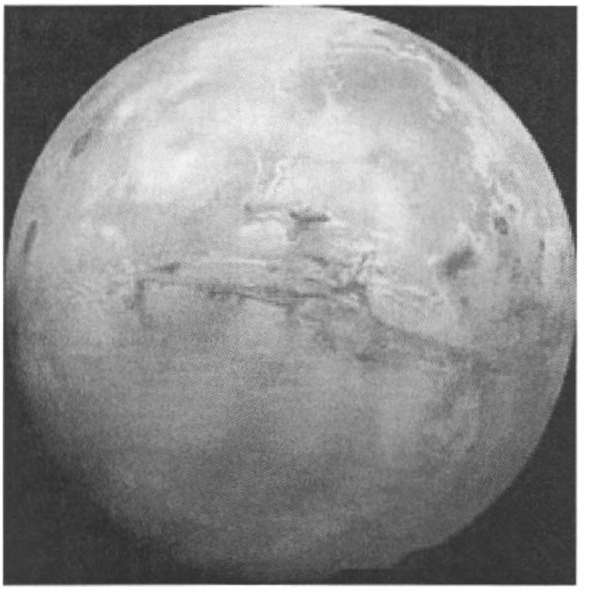


Figure 1.105. The Planet Mars

THE PLANET MARS

The planet Mars (Figure 1.105) represents the celestial energy flowing from the southerly direction of the Heavens and emits a red light energy. This celestial energy influences the energetic function of the body's Heart and Small Intestine organs. The planet Mars is called "Huoxing," the Fire Element Star. Its position in the heavens relates to the front side of the body's center Taiji Pole, and the red celestial phoenix "Lingguang." It is associated with influencing energetic vitality and physical strength.

The ancient Daoist text known as the *Secretly Transmitted Supreme Pervasive Perfect Book of the Five Planets* states "In the South is the Perfect Imperial Sovereign of the Sparkling Deluder (also known as the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Fire). The name of the ruling Celestial Immortal of Mars is Haokong Weichun, though this deity is also known as Sanrong (Figure 1.106). The Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Fire is in charge of the growth of all things. It lightens the dark and obscure. People who are unfortunate, unlucky, or suffering from illness and troubles should encourage its kindness, entice it, and seek after its influence and power."

Figure 1 .106. The Red Emperor of the Southern Direction. His name is Haokong Weichun, also known as Sanrong. He is the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Fire.

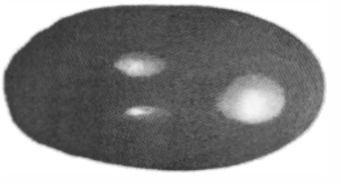


Figure 1.107. The Mars Planetary Elixir is generally constructed using Red Coral

THE MARS PLANETARY ELIXIR (USING RED CORAL)

In Chinese alchemy, the color used to gather the planetary essence of Mars and the Fire Element is red. Mars is a masculine planet that radiates an intense and fiery energy. Gemstones governed by Mars include natural coral, carnelian, ruby, garnet, and other red colored gems. When making a Mars Planetary Elixir, red coral can be chosen because of its dark cinnabar red color (Figure 1.107).

Coral can be found in colors ranging from deep cinnabar red to light orange-red. The best and most auspicious coral should be radiant in color, smooth, and free of defects (this is imperative for proper transmission of auspicious celestial energy).

Metaphysical Properties

When swallowed, a Mars Planetary Elixir constructed from a red coral enables the priest to ward off evil. It also imbues the priest with sudden insight and wisdom and protects him or her against madness.

The ancient mystics believed that drinking red coral Elixirs could protect an individual from encountering natural calamities (i.e. being struck by thunder and lightning, overtaken by floods, avoiding fires, etc.).

Preparation and Imprinting

When creating a Mars Planetary Elixir, it is important for the priest to form an energetic bridge that connects together the specific planet (Mars), the celestial Immortal responsible for bringing the planetary power down to the Earth (Celestial Immortal Haokong Weichun), the specific direction the energy is being transferred from (South), and the specific gem stone being used (red coral). These components form the "Four Pillars" of the Planetary Elixir, and they must all be utilized when energizing and imprinting the elixir.

Each planet has a ruling day of the week, as well as a ruling time period. The time period changes from season to season depending on the position of the Sun. When a planet is at its "High Tide" (the season of the specific planet) it manifests its strongest influence of celestial power. Therefore, Mars Planetary Elixirs are generally constructed in the Summertime, on Tuesdays, and between the hours of 11 A.M.-3 P.M. Certain Daoist traditions may utilize different days or prefer to construct Mars Planetary Elixirs at noon, when the energy of the Southern Palace is at its peak.

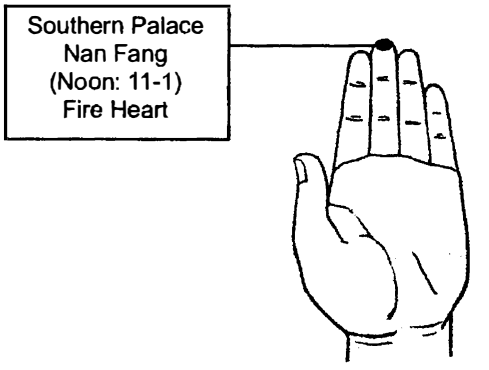


Figure 1.108. Hand Seal pattern used for bringing Fire Element Qi from the planet Mars (via the Southern Direction) into a glass of water for energetic imprinting.

Incantation and Hand Seal

The magical act of speaking the proper incantation and using the proper Hand Seal (Figure 1.108) is needed for gathering and condensing the planetary energy into the Qi of the elixir. Each Hand Seal technique is combined with a specific Breath Incantation.

The following Breath Incantation is from the Mao Shan Daoist tradition and is used for bringing Qi from a specific celestial direction into a vessel of water for making a Planetary Elixir. If a Daoist priest wishes to gather Heavenly Qi from the planet Mars to imprint into the water , he or she can repeat the following Breath Incantation:

"Nan Fang Wu Ji Fei Tian Shen Wang
Su Jiang Xin Qi Yu Wu Shui Zhong!
JiJi Ru lu ling!"

This translates as: "Southern Palace of the infinite flying heavenly god, bring down the Heart Qi into my water, quickly do this as it is law."

Each Breath Incantation and Hand Seal is changed according to the priest's needs by substituting the specific Palace and the specific internal organ Qi. Each of the palaces also has corresponding times, Elements of control, organ energies, altar gifts, and governing immortals.

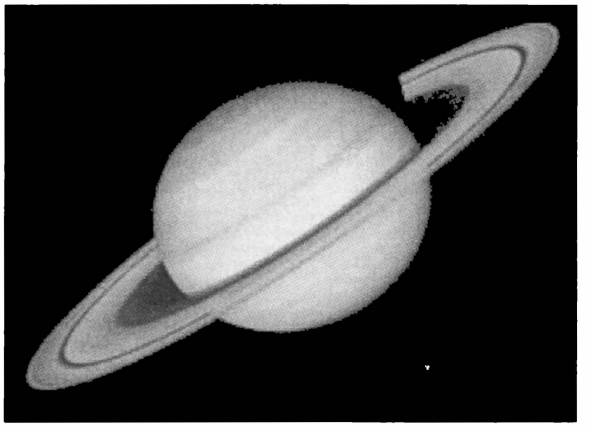


Figure 1.109. The Planet Saturn

THE PLANET SATURN

The planet Saturn (Figure 1.109) represents the celestial energy flowing from the central direction of the Heavens and emits a golden-yellow or light brown light energy. This celestial energy influences the energetic function of the body's Spleen and Stomach organs. The planet Saturn is called "Tuxing," the Earth Element Star. Its position in the heavens relates to the center core of the body's Taiji Pole.

The ancient Chinese believed that it took approximately twenty-eight years for Saturn to make a complete revolution around the Sun. Each year, when Saturn entered into another constellation, it was said that "Saturn held authority over that constellation for one year."

The ancient Daoist text known as the *Secretly Transmitted Supreme Pervasive Perfect Book of the Five Planets* states "In the Center is the Perfect Imperial Sovereign of the Quelling Star (also known as the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Earth). The name of the ruling Celestial Immortal of Saturn is Cangmu, though this deity is also known as Danyan (Figure 1.110). The Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Earth is in charge of the breeding of all things in the four seasons. It reaps the fruits. People who are suffering from legal cases and worries due to bad luck should encourage its kindness, entice it, and seek after its influence and power."

Figure 1.110. The Yellow Emperor of the Central Direction. His name is Cangmu, also known as Danyan. He is the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Earth.

Figure 1.111. The Saturn Planetary Elixir is generally constructed using Yellow Sapphire

THE SATURN PLANETARY ELIXIR (USING YELLOW SAPPHIRE)

In Chinese alchemy, the color used to gather the planetary essence of Saturn and the Earth Element is golden-yellow or light brown. Gemstones governed by Saturn include yellow sapphires, topaz, citrine, heliodor, and other flawless (eye-clean) yellow gems. When making a Saturn Planetary Elixir, yellow sapphire can be chosen because of its beautiful color (Figure 1.111). A yellow sapphire can be found in colors ranging from deep golden yellow to light yellow. The best and most auspicious gem should be radiant in color and transparent, with bright refracting rays.

Metaphysical Properties

When swallowed, a Saturn Planetary Elixir constructed from a yellow sapphire strengthens the priest's inner light and increases his or her ability to assimilate celestial light. It clears vision, expands awareness into the higher mind, opens spiritual insight, sharpens clarity and continuity of thought, deepens soul alignment to divine guidance and supreme source, and strengthens the core self.

Preparation and Imprinting

When creating a Saturn Planetary Elixir, it is important for the priest to form an energetic bridge that connects together the specific planet (Saturn), the celestial Immortal responsible for bringing the planetary power down to the Earth (Celestial Immortal Cangmu), the specific direction the energy is being transferred from (Center), and the specific gem stone being used (yellow sapphire). These components form the "Four Pillars" of the Planetary Elixir, and they must all be utilized when energizing and imprinting the elixir.

Each planet has a ruling day of the week, as well as a ruling time period. The time period changes from season to season depending on the position of the Sun. When a planet is at its "High Tide" (the season of the specific planet) it manifests its strongest influence of celestial power. Therefore, Saturn Planetary Elixirs are generally constructed during the 18 days of energetic transformation that occur at the end of each of the four seasons. Some Daoist traditions construct Saturn Planetary Elixirs on Saturdays, though the specific time of day will vary according to the season.

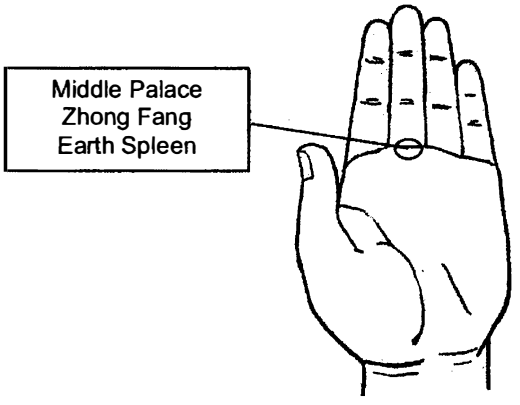


Figure 1.112. Hand Seal pattern used for bringing Earth Element Qi from the planet Saturn (via the Middle Direction) into a glass of water for energetic imprinting.

Incantation and Hand Seal

The magical act of speaking the proper incantation and using the proper Hand Seal (Figure 1.112) is needed for gathering and condensing the planetary energy into the Qi of the elixir. Each Hand Seal technique is combined with a specific Breath Incantation.

The following Breath Incantation is from the Mao Shan Daoist tradition and is used for bringing Qi from a specific celestial direction into a vessel of water for making a Planetary Elixir. If a Daoist priest wishes to gather Heavenly Qi from the planet Saturn to imprint into the water, he or she can repeat the following Breath Incantation:

"Zhong Fang Wu Ji Fei Tian Shen Wang
Su Jiang Pi Qi Yu Wu Shui Zhong!
JiJi Ru lu ling!"

This translates as: "Middle Palace of the infinite flying heavenly god, bring down the Spleen Qi into my water, quickly do this as it is law."

Each Breath Incantation and Hand Seal is changed according to the priest's needs by substituting the specific Palace and the specific internal organ Qi. Each of the palaces also has corresponding times, Elements of control, organ energies, altar gifts, and governing immortals.

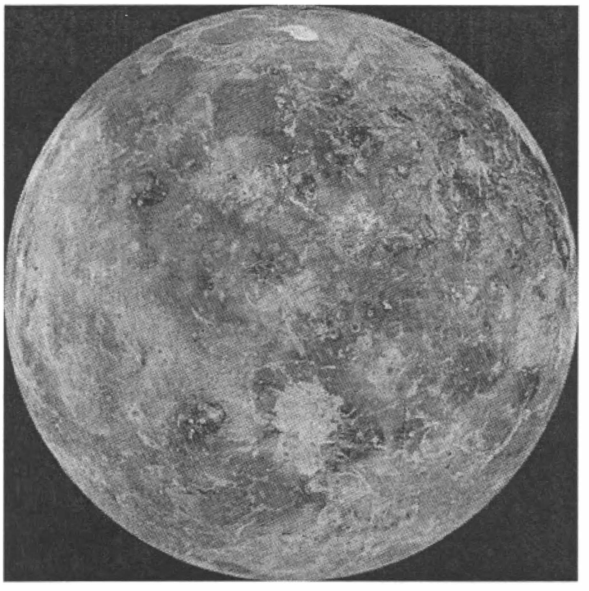


Figure 1.113. The Planet Venus

The Planet Venus

The planet Venus (Figure 1.113) represents the celestial energy flowing from the Westerly direction of the Heavens and emits a clear/white light energy. This celestial energy influences the energetic function of the body's Lungs and Large Intestine organs. The planet Venus is called "Jinxing," the Metal Element Star. Its position in the heavens relates to the right side of the body's Taiji Pole, and the white celestial tiger "Jianbing."

The ancient Daoist text known as the *Secretly Transmitted Supreme Pervasive Perfect Book of the Five Planets* states "In the West is the Perfect Imperial Sovereign of the Grand White Star (also known as the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Metal). The name of the ruling Celestial Immortal of Venus is Haokong Debiao (Figure 1.114). The Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Metal is in charge of the ending of all things. It reaps the fruits. People who are involved in many legal cases should encourage its kindness, entice it, and seek after its influence and power."

The Venus Planetary Elixir (Using Clear Diamond)

In Chinese alchemy, the color used to gather the planetary essence of Venus and the Metal Ele-

Figure 1.114. The White Emperor of the Western Direction. His name is Haokong Debiao. He is the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Metal.

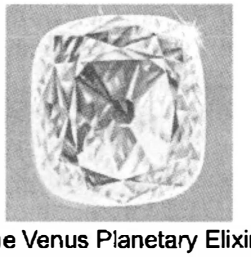


Figure 1.115. The Venus Planetary Elixir is generally constructed using Clear Diamond

ment is clear or white. Diamond is ruled by the planet Venus. Although a diamond can be white, blue, red, and black in color, the planet Venus only transmits its cosmic energy through clear diamonds, quartz crystals, zircons, goshenites, white topaz, white sapphires, and other colorless gemstones with clear transparency. When making a Venus Planetary Elixir, a diamond can be chosen because of its clear transparency (Figure 1.115). The best and most auspicious gem should be radiant and transparent, with bright refracting rays.

Metaphysical Properties

When swallowed, a Venus Planetary Elixir constructed from a clear diamond has a unifying effect with the body's Yang (positive) and Yin (negative) energetic fields. It opens and cleanses the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), enhances clear vision and insight, strengthens the energetic matrix of body's Ling Shen, and is used in order to amplify the projection of Qi (energy) and Shen (spirit). It creates a charismatic energy field, increases artistic abilities, and deepens the feelings of appreciation and beauty. A Venus Planetary Elixir constructed from a clear diamond can be used in order to help fuse Shen (spirit) into Jing (matter). It can also be used in order to ward off evil, drive away evil spirits, and remove the bad effects of "Evil Eyes." In ancient times, this elixir was used to protect against the plague.

Preparation and Imprinting

When creating a Venus Planetary Elixir, it is important for the priest to form an energetic bridge that connects together the specific planet (Venus), the celestial Immortal responsible for bringing the planetary power down to the Earth (Celestial Immortal Haokong), the specific direction the energy is being transferred from (West), and the specific gem stone being used (clear diamond). These components form the "Four Pillars" of the Planetary Elixir, and they must all be utilized when energizing and imprinting the elixir.

Each planet has a ruling day of the week, as well as a ruling time period. The time period changes from season to season depending on the position of the Sun. When a planet is at its "High Tide" (the season of the specific planet) it manifests its strongest influence of celestial power. Therefore,

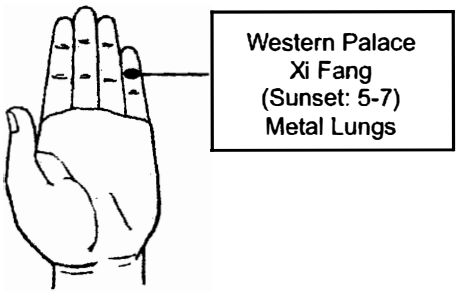


Figure 1.116. Hand Seal pattern used for bringing Metal Element Qi from the planet Venus (via the Western Direction) into a glass of water for energetic imprinting.

Venus Planetary Elixirs are generally constructed in the Autumn, on Fridays, and between the hours of 3 A.M.-7 A.M. Certain Daoist traditions may utilize different days or prefer to construct Venus Planetary Elixirs at sunset (5-7 P.M.), when the energy of the Western Palace is at its peak.

Incantation and Hand Seal

The magical act of speaking the proper incantation and using the proper Hand Seal (Figure 1.116) is needed for gathering and condensing the planetary energy into the Qi of the elixir. Each Hand Seal technique is combined with a specific Breath Incantation.

The following Breath Incantation is from the Mao Shan Daoist tradition and is used for bringing Qi from a specific celestial direction into a vessel of water for making a Planetary Elixir. If a Daoist priest wishes to gather Heavenly Qi from the planet Venus to imprint into the water , he or she can repeat the following Breath Incantation:

"Xi Fang Wu Ji Fei Tian Shen Wang
Su Jiang Fei Qi Yu Wu Shui Zhong!
JiJi Ru lu ling!"

This translates as: "Western Palace of the infinite flying heavenly god, bring down the Lung Qi into my water, quickly do this as it is law."

Each Breath Incantation and Hand Seal is changed according to the priest's needs by substituting the specific Palace and the specific internal organ Qi. Each of the palaces also has corresponding times, Elements of control, organ energies, altar gifts, and governing immortals.

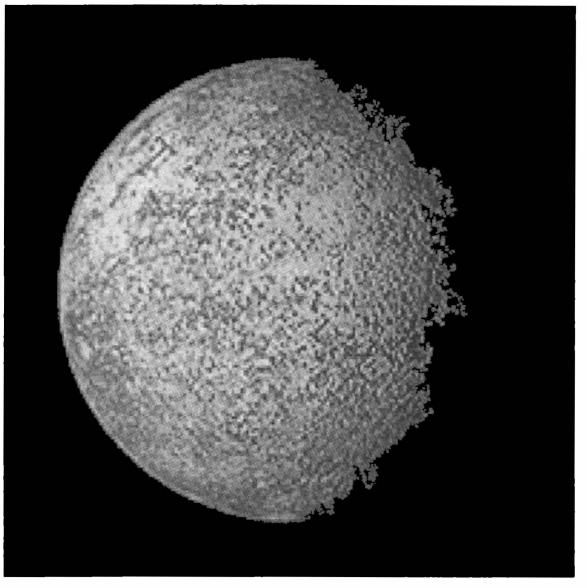


Figure 1.117. The Planet Mercury

THE PLANET MERCURY

The planet Mercury (Figure 1.117) represents the celestial energy flowing from the Northern direction of the Heavens and emits a black or dark "midnight" blue light energy. This celestial energy influences the energetic function of the body's Kidneys and Urinary Bladder organs. The planet Mercury is called "Shuixing," the Water Element Star. Its position in the heavens relates to the back side of the body's Taiji Pole, and the dark celestial warrior "Zhiming" (or black turtle/snake). It influences communication and the energetic function of the nervous system.

The ancient Daoist text known as the *Secretly Transmitted Supreme Pervasive Perfect Book of the Five Planets* states "In the North is the Perfect Imperial Sovereign of the Chronographic Star (also known as the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Water). The name of the ruling Celestial Immortal of Mercury is Qiyuan, though this deity is also known as Jiyuan (Figure 1.118). The Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Water is in charge of the moistening and dredging of all things. People who are suffering from many robberies due to bad luck should encourage its kindness, entice it, and seek after its influence and power."

Figure 1.118. The Black Emperor of the Northern Direction. His name is Qiyuan, also known as Jiyuan. He is the Perfect Sovereign of the Virtue of Water.

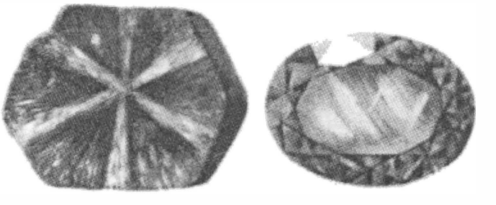


Figure 1.119. The Mercury Planetary Elixir is generally constructed using Blue Sapphire

THE MERCURY PLANETARY ELIXIR (USING BLUE SAPPHIRE)

In Chinese alchemy, the color used to gather the planetary essence of Mercury and the Water Element is black or dark midnight blue. Gemstones governed by Mercury include blue sapphires, blue spinels, tanzanite, indicolite, iolite, amethyst, and other natural blue to violet gems with transparent clarity. When making a Mercury Planetary Elixir, blue sapphire can be chosen because of its beautiful color (Figure 1.119). A blue sapphire can be found in colors ranging from dark blue to deep blue. The best and most auspicious gem should be radiant in color and transparent, with bright refracting rays.

Metaphysical Properties

When swallowed, a Mercury Planetary Elixir constructed from a blue sapphire can be used for inducing trances and gathering wisdom. It fosters a contemplative nature, enhances intuitive psychic perception, induces meditative states, and cultivates a state of calmness, tranquility, and peace of mind. It expands and slows down the experience of time, giving rise to a transcendent view of reality, tolerance, and non-attachment. A Mercury Planetary Elixir constructed from a blue sapphire also creates a protective influence in the three Wei Qi fields, it strengthens faith and commitment to spiritual dimensions of life, and enhances self-love and acceptance.

Preparation and Imprinting

When creating a Mercury Planetary Elixir, it is important for the priest to form an energetic bridge that connects together the specific planet (Mercury), the celestial Immortal responsible for bringing the planetary power down to the Earth (Celestial Immortal Qiyuan), the specific direction the energy is being transferred from (North), and the specific gem stone being used (blue sapphire). These components form the "Four Pillars" of the Planetary Elixir, and they must all be utilized when energizing and imprinting the elixir.

Each planet has a ruling day of the week, as well as a ruling time period. The time period changes from season to season depending on the position of the Sun. When a planet is at its "High Tide" (the season of the specific planet) it manifests its strongest influence of celestial power. Therefore, Mercury Planetary Elixirs are generally constructed in the Winter, on Wednesdays, and between the hours of 3 P.M.-7 P.M. Certain Daoist traditions may utilize different days or prefer to construct Mercury Planetary Elixirs at midnight, when the energy of the Northern Palace is at its peak.

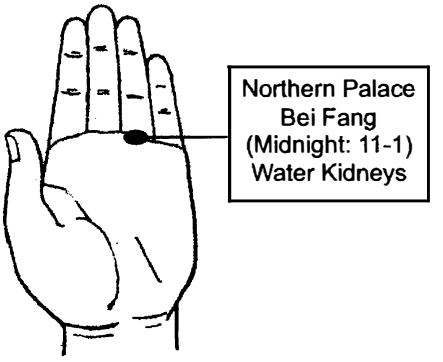


Figure 1.120. Hand Seal pattern used for bringing Water Element Qi from the planet Mercury (via the Northern Direction) into a glass of water for energetic imprinting.

Incantation and Hand Seal

The magical act of speaking the proper incantation and using the proper Hand Seal (Figure 1.120) is needed for gathering and condensing the planetary energy into the Qi of the elixir. Each Hand Seal technique is combined with a specific Breath Incantation.

The following Breath Incantation is from the Mao Shan Daoist tradition and is used for bringing Qi from a specific celestial direction into a vessel of water for making a Planetary Elixir. If a Daoist priest wishes to gather Heavenly Qi from the planet Mercury to imprint into the water , he or she can repeat the following Breath Incantation:

"Bei Fang Wu Ji Fei Tian Shen Wang
Su Jiang Shen Qi Yu Wu Shui Zhong!
JiJi Ru lu ling!"

This translates as: "Northern Palace of the infinite flying heavenly god, bring down the Kidney Qi into my water, quickly do this as it is law."

Each Breath Incantation and Hand Seal is changed according to the priest's needs by substituting the specific Palace and the specific internal organ Qi. Each of the palaces also has corresponding times, Elements of control, organ energies, altar gifts, and governing immortals.

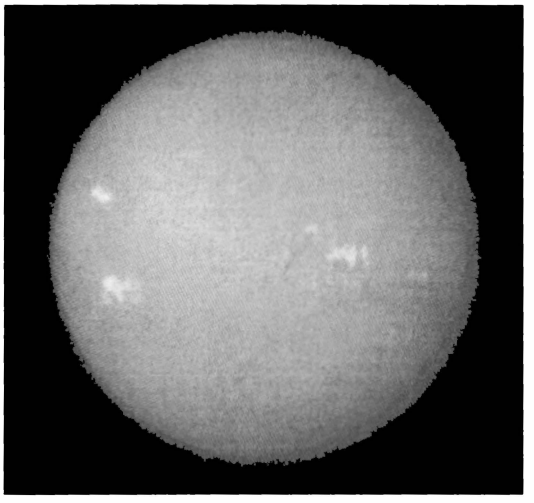


Figure 1.121. The Sun

"The Sun Radiates Nine Yang, The Law of God is Magical!" May the God of the Sun - Quickly bring his Magical Light into my water! Ji Ji Ru Lu Ling!

Figure 1.122. The Sun God Shen Yi

THE SUN

The Sun (Figure 1.121) represents the celestial Yang energy flowing from the Heavens. During the Han Dynasties, the ancient Daoists regarded the Sun as a male deity, the immortal Shen Yi (Figure 1.122), and referred to him as the "Essence of Yang." The ancient Daoists also called the energetic and spiritual manifestation of the Sun the "Supreme Yang Sovereign of the Sun Palace."

The ancient Daoists believed that absorbing light-energy from the Sun could be used to replenish an individual's spiritual energy. This belief originated from the conviction that when Heaven and Earth separated during creation, spiritual energy (being light), ascended into the Heavens and collected into the celestial bodies of the Sun, Moon and Stars. Thus conscious exposure to the energy of these celestial bodies could be used to increase and fortify one's spiritual energy.

THE SUN PLANETARY ELIXIR (USING CITRINE)

In Chinese alchemy, the color used to gather the planetary essence of the Sun and the Celestial Fire Element is golden yellow. Gemstones that are specifically ruled by the Sun are natural citrine, Golden Amber, and Golden Yellow Topaz. When making a Sun Planetary Elixir, citrine can be chosen because of its beautiful yellow color (Figure 1.123). Citrine can be found in colors ranging from

Figure 1.123. The Sun Planetary Elixir is generally constructed using Golden Yellow Citrine

dark yellow to yellowish brown. The best and most auspicious gem should be radiant in color and transparent, with bright refracting rays. In order to properly transmit solar energy, Sun stones must be flawless (visually clear).

Metaphysical Properties

When swallowed, a Sun Planetary Elixir constructed from citrine can be used to cleanse the chakras (especially those located in the Lower Dantian and the Middle Dantian areas), activate the Upper Dantian, increase intuition, and cleanse and balance the spiritual body by aligning it with the physical body. It also increases the powers of concentration, awakens and revitalizes the mind, and promotes inner peace so that true wisdom can emerge.

Preparation and Imprinting

When creating a Sun Planetary Elixir, it is important for the priest to form an energetic bridge that connects together the specific planet (Sun), the celestial Immortal responsible for bringing the

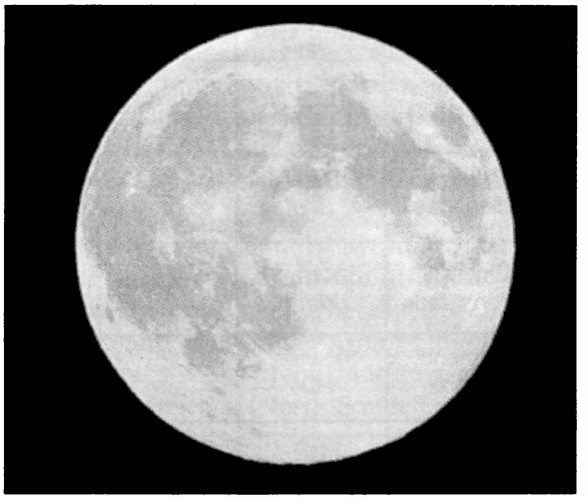


Figure 1.124. The Moon

"Precise Moon - White and Silver, The Law of God is True!" May the Goddess of the Moon - Quickly bring her Magical Light into my water! Ji Ji Ru Lu Ling!

Figure 1.125. The Moon Goddess Heng O

planetary power down to the Earth (Celestial Immortal Shen Yi), the specific direction the energy is being transferred from (the position of the Sun in the sky), and the specific gem stone being used (citrine). These components form the "Four Pillars" of the Planetary Elixir, and they must all be utilized when energizing and imprinting the elixir.

THE MOON

The Moon (Figure 1.124) represents the celestial Yin energy flowing from the Heavens. The ancient Daoists regarded the Moon as a female deity, the immortal Heng O (Figure 1.125), and referring to her as the "Essence of Yin." The ancient Daoists also called the energetic and spiritual manifestation of the Moon the "Supreme Yin Sovereign of the Moon Palace." The Moon governs the mind, and it's position in the horoscope can determine a person's habitual patterns of thought, feeling, and decisions.

THE MOON PLANETARY ELIXIR (USING SILVER/WHITE PEARL)

In Chinese alchemy, the color used to gather the planetary essence of the Moon and the Water Element is silvery white. The gemstones ruled by the Moon are natural pearl, white coral, and moonstone. Flawless (eye-clean) round pearls of superior quality are required in order to properly transmit the beneficial powers of Lunar energy (Figure 1.126).

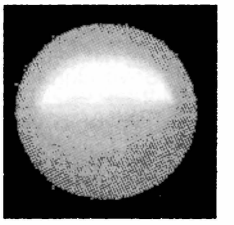


Figure 1.126. The Moon Planetary Elixir is generally constructed using Silver/White Pearl

Metaphysical Properties

When swallowed, a Moon Planetary Elixir constructed from a silver / white pearl can be used to stimulate the inner constructs of the psyche. It can also be used in order to enhance lucid dreaming and dream recall.

Preparation and Imprinting

When creating a Moon Planetary Elixir, it is important for the priest to form an energetic bridge that connects together the specific planet (the Full Moon), the celestial Immortal responsible for bringing the planetary power down to the Earth (Celestial Immortal Heng O), the specific direction the energy is being transferred from (the position of the Full Moon in the sky), and the specific gem stone being used (silver / white pearl). These components form the "Four Pillars" of the Planetary Elixir, and they must all be utilized when energizing and imprinting the elixir.

Planet/Palace	Immortal	Association	Gem	Alter Gift	Spell	Metal
Mars (Tues) Southern Palace: Fire Element	Red Immortal Haokong Weichun	Aggression, Conflict, Violence	Red Coral, Ruby, Garnet	Light: *Deng* (Candles)	Power	Iron
Mercury (Wed) Northern Palace: Water Element	Black Immortal Qiyuan	Communication, Information, Logic	Blue Sapphire	Water: *Shui*	Divination	Quick Silver
Jupiter (Thur) Eastern Palace: Wood Element	Green/Blue Immortal Chenglan	Generosity, Growth, Expansion	Emerald, Green Jade	Incense: *Xiang*	Prosperity	Tin
Venus (Fri) Western Palace: Metal Element	White Immortal Haokong Debiao	Harmony, Romance, Sensuality	Diamond, Quartz	Flowers: *Hua*	Love	Copper
Saturn (Sat) Middle Palace: Earth Element	Yellow Immortal Cangmu	Discipline, Constraint, Restriction	Yellow Sapphire	Fruit: *Gua*	Binding	Lead
Sun Palace (Sun) Fire Element	Supreme Yang Sovereign Shen Yi	Life Force, Vitality, Power	Golden Amber, Citrine, Topaz	Fire: *Huo* (Candles)	Health	Gold
Moon Palace (Mon) Water Element	Supreme Yin Sovereign Heng O	Intuition, Emotion, Subconscious	White Pearl, Moonstone	Water: *Shui*	Fertility	Silver

Figure 1.127. The Daoist Chart of Seven Celestial Planets and their Correspondences

Creating a Planetary Gem Elixir

A Planetary Gem Elixir is constructed using the same equipment that is required for the construction of a normal Gem Ens Elixir. This includes the following materials:

- **A Stone:** Any particular crystal, mineral, rock, and gemstone that contains the specific energetic and spiritual qualities and powers necessary to achieve a magical connection with the desired Heavenly body.
- **Glass Bowl:** A clear glass bowl is needed as a "birthing" chamber in which to combine and infuse the Planetary Gem Elixir.
- **Water:** The type of water (rain water, well water, spring water, mineral water, Holy Water, or Talismanic Water) used for creating the Planetary Gem Elixir is chosen so that its specific energetic and spiritual qualities enhance the magical powers of the stone and planet.
- **Alcohol:** After the crystal has been placed in the water during the infusion process, its extracted essence can then be preserved by blending the water with rice wine, brandy, or other form of spirit alcohol.
- **Mother Container:** A dark colored glass bottle is needed for storing the "mother" elixir.
- **Child Container:** A dark colored glass eyedropper bottle is needed for storing the "child" elixir, and is to be completely used up before refilling from the "mother" container.

In ancient Daoism, the Seven Celestial Planets were considered to be the Heavenly Palaces of certain Celestial Immortals, each possessing different attributes, aspects, temperaments, and magical powers (Figure 1.127). Therefore, in order to construct a Planetary Gem Elixir, the priest will also need to know the following information before starting the ritual:

- **The Planet:** It is important to understand the specific planet's energetic powers, physical traits (distinctive physical characteristics), location (direction of influence), color, sound, season (orbital period), time (day and hour), and key words (incantations) in order to evoke the planet's energetic properties.

- **The Deity:** You should have a intimate understanding of the Planetary Deity that you will be summoning (i.e., name, appearance, color, palace, weapons, sacrifices or offerings required, specific requirements for summoning and then releasing the Planetary Deity's power).
- **The Altar:** You should determine if the ritual will be performed outside or inside, in the morning (to utilize the heating power of the Sun) or in the evening (to utilize the condensing power of the Moon), and towards which specific direction (North, South, East, or West).
- **The Purpose:** Before beginning, it is extremely important to know what you are doing and why (i.e., what the magical effects of that specific Planetary Gem Elixir will be). You also need to know what specifically to do if things "go wrong," and you inadvertently incur the wrath of an agitated celestial deity.

Performing the Planetary Gem Elixir Ritual

The key aspect in using the celestial power of a planet in conjunction with a gem is timing. The planetary correspondences work most effectively in a spell when it is cast at an astrologically appropriate time. In timing a ritual, the goal is to catch and use the pivotal movement wherein all of the forces of the cosmos are aligned in just the right way so as to initiate a powerful magical influence onto the forming elixir.

In order to create the Planetary Gem Elixir, proceed as follows:

- First, gather all of the ingredients together and place the Gem within the water inside glass bowel.
- Next, place the Gem and glass bowel onto the Earth Altar and perform a purification ritual.
- After summoning the powers of the Four Directions (Elemental powers), begin to focus your attention onto the stone.
- Focus your mind on the specific planet and deity that you have chosen to assist you in empowering the elixir.
- State the purpose and function of the Planetary Gem Elixir and perform the required Hand Seals while speaking the invocations needed to bring the Planetary Deity into the altar room and infuse it into the elixir water.
- After completing the ritual, present offerings to the Planetary Deity and then dispatch the powers of the Four Directions.

Dose and Administration

Elixirs can be also be administered directly under the tongue, undiluted, as with flower essences. The rich blood supply to the mouth area, and the thin skin under the tongue allows for rapid absorption of the elixir. You can also apply some to an afflicted area of the body that you are wishing to treat, or use a Gem Elixir in a bath.

Some masters recommend that the disciple start with the undiluted, sublingual (under the tongue) administration for the first few weeks, then move on to the dilution method (i.e. in a glass of water) for a few weeks to a month.

The important thing to remember is that when you choose a specific dosage, stick with it. Also, only use one Gem Elixir at a time and completely finish a bottle before you refill it. Once you finish a bottle the desired shift is usually complete. Elixirs, like Essences, work best when used in increments of three or seven. Each bottle will last approximately one week when kept in a dark glass bottle with an airtight stopper, away from sunlight.

Gem elixirs are designed to gently affect the body, mind, and spirit over a period of time, not instantaneously. Therefore, you will need to continue to use the specific dosage for at least a month in order to achieve the best results. Afterwards, you may then feel the need to decrease the dosage, and then eventually stop. The treatment can be repeated, as you feel the need arise.

Storage

It is extremely important to have an altar, shrine, or power center in your home where you can keep your stones and perform rituals without being disturbed. This magical area is considered to be your energy source, the sanctuary where you renew yourself and activate your spirit. The more you use these magical stones placed on your altar, the more Qi and Shen they will develop, and the more effective your incantations and spells will become.

Additional Gemstone Formulas

In ancient Daoism, there is a long history of using minerals, stones, crystals, and gems for magical amulets, rings, and talismans. Each stone's specific colors and powers gave way to creating powerful tools used in ancient rituals for conjuring and spell casting.

The following are a few examples of the many energetic mineral formulas used by priests throughout the world. These magical practices vary according to cultural influence and spiritual tradition.

- **Combining Different Minerals for Protection:** Sometimes, various magical stones were combined in order to enhance and increase their energetic properties. For example, the combination of Chlorite, with Carnelian and Ruby Crystals are sometimes used to eliminate psychic attack, and were also in exorcism rituals to cause any "Earthbound spirit" to leave a possessed or oppressed person, place, or thing. By grinding these three magical minerals, a priest could energetically protect him or herself (as well as the environment) from the return of unwanted spirit entities and negative energies.
- **Combining Quartz and Colored Silk:** In ancient China, clear quartz crystal were placed onto various colored silk cloths (and were also sometimes placed into various colored lamps) in order to energize a room. The clear quartz was used to absorb, reflect, and radiate the energy of the vibrant silk color into the environment (Figure 1.128). This specific mineral and colored silk combination was often used for creating a healing or meditative environment.

  It is important when using clear quartz crystal to use a silk cloth as its base instead of cotton. Silk is considered to be more insulating and protective. It will hold in the crystal's energies, while simultaneously shielding it from any toxic outside influences.

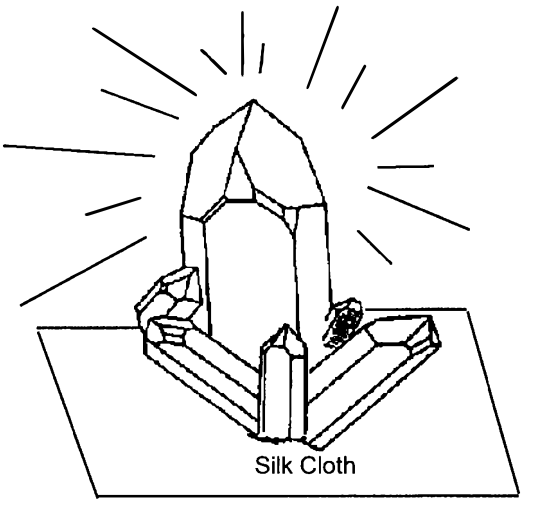


Figure 1.128. The Clear Quartz Crystal was used to absorb and radiates the color of the silk cloth into the environment

Secret Powers of Metals

Alchemy in China, has been associated mainly with the development of magic and medicinal potions. To the ancient Daoist alchemists, the secret powers of metals were traditionally kept away from the public, hidden within the confines of the specific school's secret training. The magical components of each metal contained both energetic and spiritual properties that had tremendous influence and power over the priest's energetic fields.

Traditionally, the use of metals were commonplace in ancient Daoist alchemy. So much so, that secret code words were used in order to describe the transformative powers of Jing and Qi using lead and gold.

According to the *Dian Chen Yin Que*, the purest essence of the Water and Fire energy contained within magical Mountains and Lakes, creates the abundant breath of Metal and Stones.

Gold

To the ancient Chinese, gold was an important metal in alchemy. It is considered to be associated with the Yang energetic properties of the Sun. Gold is heavy, soft and yellow or red in color, and is considered to be a powerful energetic conductor. It not only revitalizes one's physical energies, but also

enhances any stone or mineral that is encircled within its metal, promoting the energetic power of the stone with a dose of quickening energy.

Because gold is a powerful energetic conductor, it was commonly used for its healing properties. To the ancient Chinese, gold was considered to be impermeable to weather and the effects of aging, therefore, it was used as a healing agent of renewal and regeneration.

Gold can be used to help with arthritis, blood and circulation problems, chemical and hormone imbalances, stress-related illnesses, pulmonary problems ,and mild Shen Disturbances (mental and emotional confusion and emotional imbalances).

MERCURY

To the ancient Chinese, mercury was an important metal in alchemy. The ancient Chinese alchemists used formulations of mercury as elixirs and attempted to transmute other substances into gold to use the gold as an elixir to prolong life. Gold colored powders and liquids were a mainstay of the Chinese alchemist's practice.

Intriguing because of its silver hue and liquid state at room temperature, elemental mercury was known to the ancient Chinese as a form of liquid power. Although mercury's mystique held the promise of power, many of the ancient alchemists also knew it to be toxic. It was in the mining of the element where mercury first became associated with human illness beginning as tremors and progressing to severe mental derangement.

The largest natural source of mercury is cinnabar. This reddish mineral containing mercury and sulfur has been used as a pigment since ancient times. Mercury is primarily a neurological poison, causing tremors, extreme mood changes, and eventually loss of hearing and restricted vision. Certain forms of mercury poisoning also cause damage to the liver and kidneys.

In the ancient art of alchemy, mercury, sulfur, and salt were the Earth's three principle substances. The Hindu word for alchemy is "Rasasiddhi," meaning "knowledge of mercury." Believing that mercury was at the core of all metals, alchemists supposed that gold, silver, copper, tin, lead and iron were all mixtures of mercury and other substances.

In 2nd century China, the study of mercury centered on a search for an elixir of life to confer longevity or immortality. The prominent Chinese alchemist Ge Hong, who lived in the 4th century, believed that man is what he eats, and so by eating gold he could attain perfection. Yet, he reasoned, a true believer was likely to be poor, and so it was necessary to find a substitute for the precious metal. This, in his estimation, could be accomplished by making gold from cinnabar. Ge Hong's other uses for cinnabar included smearing it on the feet to enable a person to walk on water, placing it over a doorway to ward off thieves, and combining it with raspberry juice to enable elderly men to beget children.

SILVER

This metal is considered to be associated with the Yin energetic properties of the Moon. It is a soft, relative heavy white metal known for its watery, cold and moist properties.

Formed as part of an amulet, silver can be used to invoke lunar forces, and to communicate with nature spirits. In certain magical traditions, it is used in order to disrupt a priest from shape-shifting and transformation into an energetic animal form.

Silver is thought to intensify and purify when used as a setting for gems. It is thought to be feminine and protective. In Tibet, silver bells are rung during ceremonies to invoke the celestial Yin powers, and to repel evil spirits.

Traditionally, silver is considered to be a healing metal that acts as a mirror to your inner spirit and should therefore not be worn all of the time. Stones that should not be set in silver include amber, tourmaline and zircon.

Silver is also a detoxifying agent, that is beneficial to the throat and lungs. Your synapses fire more efficiently when wearing silver because it acts as an energy conductor. Silver is also believed to purge the body of infection, improve eyesight, and is mentioned with regards to treating epilepsy, oozing, and festering wounds.

According to ancient Daoist teachings, the Milky Way is poetically known as the "Silver River, the Moon is known as the "Silver Sickle" or "Silver Candle," and the human eye is known as the "Silver Sea."

Copper

To the ancient Chinese, copper was an important metal in alchemy. It was considered to be a powerful conduit, used for channeling the energies that flowed between Heaven and Earth. It is naturally red in color (turning greenish in color during corrosion), easily shaped, and excellent for conducting energy.

The ancient Daoist priests believed that copper could easily carry the Qi and Shen (thoughts and feelings) of the priest into the spirit realm. Copper was also believed to be able to guard and protect the priest against evil, therefore most Daoist magical tools placed on the altar (i.e., knives, purification vessels, incense trays, incense holders, candle stick holders, Bagua talisman diagrams, etc.) were constructed out of copper.

Copper is known for its healing effects and its power as an energetic conductor. In fact, many of healing stones have copper as a trace element (i.e., Azurite, Chrysocolla, Malachite and Turquoise).

Copper supports and reinforces the mineral content of gems and crystals so that they interact better with the physical body. Copper reacts best with stones that contain a high metal content, such as Aventurine, Rhodonite, Tiger's-eye, and Mica. It is important to note that Copper has little reaction to stones that lack metal ore in their makeup. Also, do not place coral, pearls, and most crystalline stones in copper (amethyst is one of the few exceptions).

Because it energizes and stimulates the flow of Qi throughout the body and mind, copper is most consciously worn as a healing agent to release energy blocks. The healing benefits of copper also include relieving arthritic pain, menstrual cramps, tension headaches, repeated stress injuries, sports-related soreness, as well as tonifying and purifying the blood, treating the immune system, metabolism and mucous membranes.

Brass

Although brass is the result of combining copper and zinc, it is the iron content in the brass that makes it an energetic stabilizer. Traditionally, most healers favor brass as a detoxifier and cleanser for patients who have too much metal in their bloodstream

Bronze

Bronze is also the result of combining copper and zinc, and it has the same healing power as brass. Bronze is believed to give strength of character to its owner.

Planetary Metals

Each planet is associated with certain metals, stones, colors, animals, and incenses. Traditionally, if a magical stone was to be imprinted and set into an amulet, its corresponding planetary metal was used to increase its energetic power. The ancient Daoists believed that the energetic virtues of these specific metals would help increase the celestial properties of the planets.

One way in ancient China used to categorize the Five Metals, was designed according to their corresponding Five Element colors, described as follows:

- Gold - Yellow
- Silver - White
- Copper - Red
- Lead - Blue
- Iron - Black

As the ancient skill of working metal advanced, the priests began to expand their understanding and magical interactions with metal alchemy. The following is a more advanced list of planetary metals, described as follows:

- **Moon (Silver):** The metal silver naturally shines bright like the Moon. Therefore, the luminous quality of silver was believed to be associated with the Moon.
- **Mercury (Quicksilver or Pewter):** The metal used to represent the planet Mercury was traditionally a white alloy such as quicksilver (not silver or tin). Because this liquid metal could not be used to construct talismans, in ancient China an alloy constructed of silver and gold was traditionally used to make a Mercury. In modern times, a mixed metal such as pewter is commonly used to represent the planet Mercury. The direction associated with Mercury is North.
- **Venus (Copper):** The metal copper was traditionally associated with the planet Venus. The direction associated with Venus is West.
- **Sun (Gold or Brass):** The metal gold naturally shines bright like the Sun. Therefore, the lu-

minous quality of gold and brass were both believed to be associated with the Sun.

- **Mars (Iron or Steel):** The metal iron is red in its natural oxidized state (which gives blood its crimson color), and was used to make weapons and tools. Therefore, the planet Mars was believed to be associated with the metal iron. Because steel is a metal based on iron, it is also believed to be ruled by the planet Mars. The direction associated with Mars is South.
- **Jupiter (Tin):** The metal tin was formerly used to construct religious metals because it was plentiful and cheap. Jupiter was therefore considered to be the ruler over the various types of religions because of its abundance. The direction associated with Jupiter is East.
- **Saturn (Lead):** The metal lead was considered to be the densest and heaviest metal, and was therefore associated with the slowest, outermost planet Saturn. Because it is poisonous, the planet Saturn is also considered to be the ruler of death. The direction associated with Saturn is Center.

It is important to note that for various reasons, some of these metals are considered to be toxic and should not be habitually kept in contact with the skin.

MAGICAL PLANETARY METAL PATTERNS

In ancient China, various metals were alchemically combined in order to create special magical charms, magical rings, and other magical tools. Depending on the specific Daoist sect, the various magical metal combinations were traditionally divided into a fusion of three, five, or seven metals (Figure 1.129 and Figure 1.130).

The types of metals and the reason for their various combinations depended on the specific design and energetic function of the magical tool.

Certain metals were combined and magically used for purification and consecration purposes (i.e., the creation of certain types of altar cups, altar trays, candle holders, incense burners, etc.).

Other metals were combined and used for magical protection and banishment purposes (i.e., magical swords, protection charms, demon screamers, etc.).

When combining the specific metals, special offerings were presented to certain deities and their magical powers were "borrowed" in order to magically activate the metal.

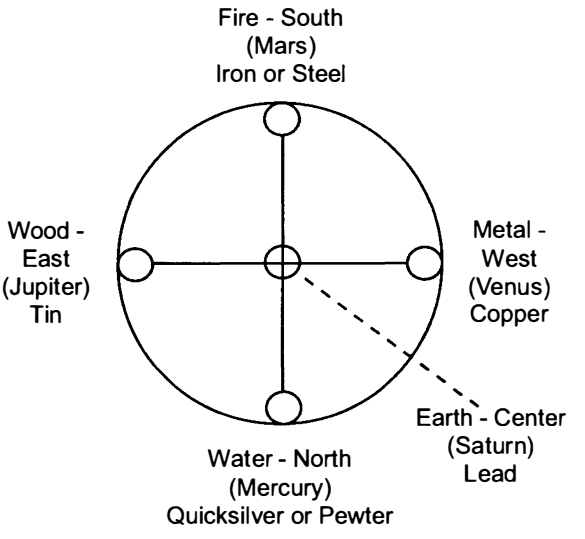


Figure 1.129. "The Five Elements" Planetary Metal Combination

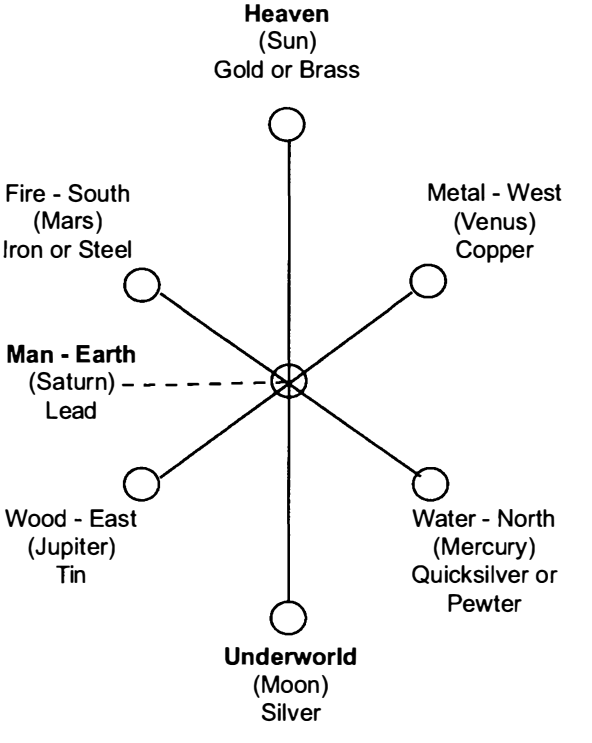


Figure 1.130. "The Seven Planets" Planetary Metal Combination

Magical Stone Tools

The following are several magical tools constructed out of magical stones, gems and minerals. These magical tools were used in ancient Chinese sorcery.

Divination Using A White Jade Ball

Over the centuries, Chinese mystics have developed countless devices to foresee the future, such as tea leaves, Yarrow Sticks, Magic Mirrors, the Yi-Jing, and the White Jade Ball. The Jade Ball is one of the most intriguing magical tools used by the ancient Daoist mystics for scrying. Scrying is defined as the magical art of gazing onto the surface of something and receiving information in the form of visions.

The Jade Ball is made of fine White Jade that had undergone a special magnetizing process. By observing the reflections on the ball's surface, the Daoist mystic can see events that will take place in a person's or country's future. Although very few mystics know how to use this ball to foresee the future, it can be very effective in the hands of a skilled seer (Figure 1.131).

When gazing into the White Jade Ball, your Yintang (Third Eye) will begin to open, and subconscious visions and intuitions coming from the inner recesses of the mind will be projected into the White Jade Ball, which acts as a medium to catch these images. The more you train your mind, the clearer the patterns will become, and the energetic impressions will slowly begin to stabilize. The ancient Daoist technique used for scrying with a White Jade Ball is described as follows:

- In order to practice scrying with a white Jade or crystal ball, it is important to first sit in a dark room with the ball placed between your palms and two red candle placed beside the White Jade Ball.
- Next, perform the One Through Ten meditation and the Three Invocations (see *Chinese Medical Qigong Therapy #3*, Chapter 26).
- After the last invocation, bring the divine light up from the Lower Dantian along the Taiji Pole and energize the heart and Middle Dantian area. Connect this energetic center to the center core of the White Jade Ball.

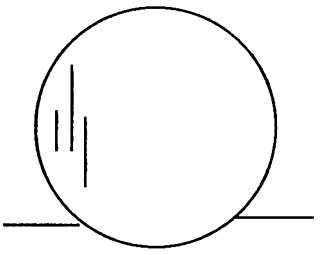


Figure 1.131. The White Jade Ball

- Next, bring the divine light up from the Middle Dantian along the Taiji Pole and energize the Third Eye and Upper Dantian area. Connect this energetic center to the center core of the White Jade Ball.
- Slowly begin to focus your attention onto the surface of the White Jade Ball. Envision pure white light inside of the ball and maintain that image for half an hour. Do not stare, but allow you vision to softly observe the surface image of the ball.
- After training for half an hour, end the meditation and place the ball into a black silk protective bag. Keep this bag safe, away from people and curious individuals. After one month of consistent practicing for about half an hour each day, visions will begin to appear on the surface of the ball.

It is important to note that choosing a stone ball for scrying should not be undertaken lightly. This is a powerful and deeply personal tool that has its own energy and will become intimately imbued with your own projected Qi and Shen. It is a powerful energetic container that should never be touched or handled by others. If this happens, it should be again cleansed before using.

Healing With Crystals

The energy in the human body produces a polarity similar to that of crystals. A crystal is a natural silicon formation extracted from the Earth, it collects Yin and radiates Yang. The ancient Chinese believed that crystals gathered up ancient messages from deep within the Earth, and that crystals allowed the mind to focus in such a way as to unite an intuitive individual with these ancient messages.

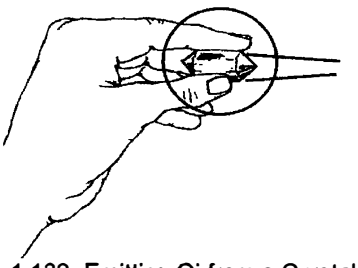


Figure 1.132. Emitting Qi from a Crystal

The ancient Chinese believed that quartz crystal was water that had been transformed into solid matter during the course of a thousand years. It was also believed that quartz crystal could be used to enhance and increase the priest's power of Qi and Shen emission (Figure 1.132).

There were three types of crystals commonly used in ancient Daoist healing: the Round Crystal, the Diamond-Shaped Crystal (Quartz), and the Purple Mountain (Amethyst) Crystal. When using these minerals for healing, each crystal must be alive (vibrant), brilliant in color, and shine from within.

Because crystals emit a very strong white light energy, they can be used to enhance energetic treatments, allowing the Daoist priest the ability to energetically cut deep into an individual's tissues like a laser beam. Crystals can be used for scooping energetic toxins, cleansing and purging an individual's body, and for cutting loose pathogenic Qi within the individual's tissues and external fields of Qi. Crystals can also be used for tonification.

COMBINING MEDICAL QIGONG THERAPY AND MINERAL MAGIC

In modern times, the use of Medical Qigong Qi Emission Therapy in combination with Mineral Magic is slowly becoming a popular form of clinical application. The combined energetic therapies are used in order to relax the patient's body, promote the flow of Qi, Blood, oxygen, and nutrients to all of his or her cells, as well as

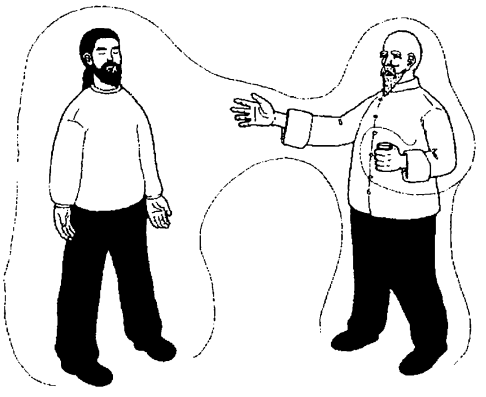


Figure 1.133. A priest emits the energy of specific patent herbal medicine into his patient.

to promote the removal of waste products from the cells and tissues. This increased energy flow through the body's microcirculation is used in the clinic in order to nourish the patient's diseased or stressed tissues.

One example of a treatment technique used in ancient China by Daoist priests to treat patients using mineral magic is described as follows:

- **Absorption:** To begin with, the priest will hold the mineral in his or her left hand and begin to energetically feel, ingest, and absorb the medicinal and energetic properties of the mineral into his or her Lower Dantian.
- **Projection:** After the priest had embodied the specific energetic nature of the gem or mineral, he or she will start to project the crystal's specific healing qualities into the patient's body for treatment. In this type of application, the energetic properties of a quartz crystal was sometimes combined with a specific imagined color in order to enhance the mineral's tonification effect. The priest would then project the combined energy of the mineral and its enhanced imagined color into the patient's body, targeting a specific internal organ (Figure 1.133).

Magic Stone Talismans

Magical stone talismans have always been used by Daoist priests. In ancient China, stone talismans were be constructed of specific materials and infused with special magical properties. For stone talismans, the special powers of the crystalline mineral were chosen to naturally support the magical inscriptions etched into the rock by the priest. Depending on its specific design, a stone talisman could provide healing power, protection, wealth, or love. Certain talismans could even act as keys that opened magical gateways into other dimensions. Additionally, the ancient Chinese Grimoires (Daoist books of seals and incantations) offer instruction on making specific talismans and detail the magical powers that they invoke.

People often confuse the magical properties of amulets with those of talismans. Amulets are responsible for passively protecting an individual from harm, evil, and negativity. Talismans, however, actively transform the individual's energetic field, enabling him or her to have certain magical powers.

Magic Stone Rings

Magical rings have been one of a priest's tools of power for centuries. In ancient China, Daoist mystics would construct their rings of power out of Jade, special metals, esoteric minerals, or special woods. The Daoist mystic's magic ring had many functions, and depending on how it was magically charged and imprinted, it offered the priest the utmost protection (Figure 1.134).

The priest's magic ring is considered to be one of the most powerful tools that he or she will possess. The wearing of a magic ring was believed to help ward off many types of malevolent spirits. When the ring was used with a guardian stone, and it contained such gems as Amber, Garnet, Hematite, Jet, Labradorite, Lapis Lazuli, Malachite, Obsidian, Opals, Peridot, Prehnite, or Sugilite, the magical power of the priest was said to double. In order to magnify the magic ring's power, the guardian stone was traditionally worn next to the priest's skin.

Symbolically, the magic ring represents the infinite space of the Wuji and the magical circle

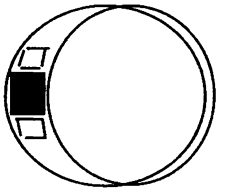


Figure 1.134. The Magical Stone Ring

through which the priest invokes and controls all forms of magic. It is a sacred space: the space in which the union of Yin and Yang takes place and in which all Elements are gathered, created, activated, destroyed, and dispersed.

The Daoist priest's magic ring is traditionally either completely constructed out of stone (e.g., Jade, Quartz Crystal, Lapis Lazuli, or other powerful stones) or was constructed out of specific metals that were magically combined in order to form a powerful circular talisman. The power of the ring's magical circle energetically binds the priest to the esoteric power of the material with which the ring is constructed (e.g., Jade, gold, sliver, etc.).

Over the years the ring will begin to develop a kind of magical personality and become synchronized with the priest's life force energy. Therefore, the magic ring symbolizes the priest's entire magical personality, and the ring can bring this power forth merely by being placed on the priest's finger.

A magic ring can either be a ring that has been previously constructed, or it can be purposefully constructed by the priest, according to his or her level of understanding. The secrets behind the actual construction of magic rings are well guarded and known only to a few, so magic rings can rarely be bought and are very treasured gifts. Sometimes special gems are added to the ring, denoting or enhancing specific powers. Other times the rings will contain magical symbols that gather and generate subtle energetic power.

Certain schools will only wear their rings of power when performing magical rituals. In these schools the priests accustom themselves to only wearing the magical rings whenever they meditate or perform any type of magical work. In all

schools of sorcery, when a magician places the ring of power on his or her finger, he or she become a person of power, attuned to the life force and divine light contained within all things. The priest is now capable of realizing and utilizing every faculty and power of the universe and is able to claim his or her spiritual birthright.

IMPRISONING A SPIRIT IN THE MAGIC RING

In ancient China, there were numerous ways to acquire a spirit servant, although in order to keep it, the spirit servant (also called a fetch) had to be imprisoned in a magical object such the priest's magic ring. For example, if an evil priest wished to acquire a human soul for a spirit servant, the priest would first decide on a way to put the intended victim in a coma (e.g., usually poison). Once the victim fell into a coma, the priest would remove the soul from the victim's body, after which he or she could choose to imprison the victim's soul within the metal alloy of a magic ring. If the priest did not wish to acquire a human soul as a spirit servant, then he or she could choose to become partners with an evil entity and ask it for a "servant" to imprison in his or her magic ring. Once imprisoned in the ring, the spirit servant at the service of the priest until the ring was destroyed. Such magic rings are often passed down for generations.

One traditional function of the magic ring was as a ring of protection, which warned the priest of any impending ill will bent towards him or her. For example, whenever the magic ring was near any individual who harbored ill intention towards the priest, it would begin to turn from a silvery white color to an inky-black color. The more evil the intention sensed by the ring, the darker the magic ring would become. If the priest was not paying attention to the message emitted from the magic ring, it would begin to heat up and vibrate in order to warn the priest of the individual's intentions.

EXAMPLES OF IMPRISONING A SPIRIT IN A MAGIC RING

A few years ago one of my students contacted a priest and commissioned him to make a magical ring. Magical properties were imprinted into this metal ring and were designed for my student's protection. This metal ring was empowered in such a manner that if any individual approached my student and harbored ill intention, the silver colored ring would react to that energy by turning black. If, for some reason, the student was not aware of the color transformation, the ring would immediately become hot and vibrate. The stronger the individuals ill intent -the more powerful the ring's reaction. A few years later, the priest who made the magical ring became a "born-again" Christian. This change of heart caused him to recant all of his previous magical acts of sorcery. At that point, my student's magical ring (being a thin ban) broke, which caused the ring to lose its magical properties. I explained to my student that the reason the ring responded the way it had is because the priest had imprisoned a spirit entity into the metal through a magical incantation when he formed the ring. In order to free the spirit entity it was important that the ring be destroyed. Consequently, when the priest became a "born-again" Christian and renounced his previous practice, he set the spiritual law of cause and effect into action. The result of his spiritual transformation caused the removal of much of the karma that he had incurred, along with the destruction of many of his previous unethical actions, including summoning and imprisoning spirit entities to do one's personal biding.

OTHER TECHNIQUES USING MAGICAL RINGS

One ancient technique used by Daoist priests was to use the Magic Ring to become invisible. This was accomplished by turning the Magic Ring three to nine times in a clockwise direction while still being worn on the priest's finger. This allowed the priest to remove him or herself from the surrounding environment, and to also avoid being energetically and spiritually detected.

Another technique was to use the Magic Ring in order to increase his or her personal energetic field, transforming a normal Wei Qi field into a powerful and blinding radiant light. In this technique, the priest would turn the Magic Ring three to nine times in a counterclockwise direction while still being worn on the priest's finger. This allowed the priest the upper hand when fighting a hostile spirit entity or evil priest.

Stone Tongue Ring Techniques

The ancient Daoists believed that by rooting the tongue on the upper palate they could more easily disconnect the mind from all internal and external chatter. This connection also allowed the Qi of the internal organs and external environmental to naturally be absorbed into the priest's body, and it prevented the internal Wind (stirred by the mind) from becoming stuck inside the mystic's head, resulting in headaches and Shen Disturbances.

When a Daoist priest began to practice incantations, he or she would first be taught how to keep the tongue still and energetically connected before speaking. This allowed the priest's Shen to build and also facilitated a powerful release of Qi when the incantation was spoken. One technique used to help the priest train the tongue was to place a stone or metal ring (depending on the specific Element and type of power being trained) inside his or her mouth. The priest would then insert his or her tongue through the ring and keep it placed on the upper palate. This secret tongue training also facilitated a disciplined state of quiescent contemplation.

Stone Prayer Beads (Mala)

The term Mala refers to a garland or necklace of beads that is used as a tool for mystical training (Figure 1.135). Although not purely Daoist in origin, Malas have been extensively used by both Daoist and Buddhist disciples throughout the various dynasties in ancient China.

Malas, or prayer beads, are traditionally used for prayer, chanting, affirmation, mantras, and incantations and they are an essential component of many Daoist and Buddhist rituals. Today malas are used all over the world and in many different traditions; they are known variously as rosaries, worry beads, japa malas, or prayer beads. In ancient China, malas were variously known as Shu Zhu (Counting Beads), Fo Zhu (Buddha Beads), Nian Zhu (Prayer Beads), or Cháo Zhu (Court Beads).

Malas are filled with practical and symbolic meaning according to the number of beads they contain, the materials used to construct them, and the intention with which they are made and used. In ancient China, these sacred necklaces were believed to connect the mystic with the positive (Yang) energies of the universe. In the imperial palace, malas were named "court chains" and eventually became more of a status symbol than a prayer counter.

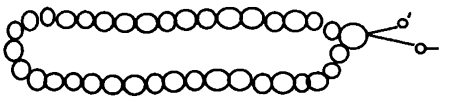


Figure 1.135. Prayer Stone Beads

Power beads that are strung in a magic circle have been used by priests since the dawning of time. The energy of the prayer beads comes from the use of the "imprinted power within physical form," and is developed through centuries of human mental imprinting. Ancient Daoist mystics used a string of beads to help them concentrate as they prayed and meditated, reciting a prayer for each bead that they passed through their fingers.

Materials Used as Prayer Beads

There are many types of prayer beads, some being used for general chanting purposes, and others being used exclusively for the energetic cultivation and projection of different powers. Since different types of matter resonate at different frequencies, the type of incantation or ritual that the mystic is going to perform determines the type of material that the mystic will use for his or her prayer beads. Malas can be made from a variety of materials including seeds (i.e. lotus), wood (i.e. sandalwood), bone (i.e. yak), glass (i.e. cat's eye), stones (i.e. Jade), and precious metals (i.e. gold). Tibetan prayer beads, for example, often contain beads of coral, shell, ivory, amber, turquoise, and other stones. Most mala beads are from 5mm to 8mm in diameter, though some types such as certain bodhi seed and lotus seed malas used in the Buddhist tradition can be as large as 25mm.

Each material, and thus each mala, has its own unique energetic vibration. Familiarity with the different qualities of each type of mala allows the mystic to enhance, attract, subdue, or balance, nearly any aspect reality provided the mystic knows the proper ritual and incantation.

WOODEN BEADS

Wooden Mala beads confer upon the mystic energetic balance and harmony. The energetic nature of a wooden Mala depends specifically upon the type of wood used in its construction. The following is a list of the woods and seeds that are those most commonly used in malas:

- **Aloe Mala:** These beads (constructed of aloeswood) are considered auspicious and bring good luck to its owner. Aloeswood is a rare ingredient used in creating special magical incense in Asian. The highest grades are worth more than gold by weight.
- **Birch Mala:** These beads are believed to have medicinal properties, and the birch is often referred to as "the spirit tree."
- **Bodhi Seed Mala:** These beads are sacred to Buddhists, as they are taken from the variety of tree under which the Buddha attained enlightenment. Sometimes the term "bodhi seed" is used to refer to the wood of the tulsi plant; both materials make good all around malas for spiritual practice.
- **Boxwood Mala:** These beads are said to insure longevity, as the boxwood tree has powerful medicinal properties.
- **Camphor Mala:** These beads are considered to be auspicious and are said to bring good luck to their owner.
- **Cedar Mala:** These fragrant beads are considered to have a purifying nature. They are used primarily in the Buddhist tradition, and the individual beads in a cedar mala often have mantras inscribed into their soft wood.
- **Ebony Mala:** These dark blue-black beads are symbolic of the deepest and most subtle aspects of matter. They are very Yin in nature and are highly durable.
- **Lotus Seed Mala:** These beads are commonly used in the Buddhist tradition and are said to promote compassion and enlightened thought. The beads make an excellent mala for peaceful practices and are often used in rituals associated with Guan Yin. The seeds of the lotus flower are large, oval shaped, shiny back, and very smooth to the touch. The lotus flower is symbolic of the flowering of the mystic's consciousness as it rises from the mud of the physical world through the water of the unconscious and into the freedom of full enlightenment.
- **Prunus Mala:** These beads are constructed from the peach wood. The peach is an important tree in Daoism, as its fruit is symbolic of the fruit of immortality that can be gained through a life of following the Dao, and its wood is believed to be able to ward off evil spirits. Many important Daoist tools are constructed of peach wood.
- **Rosewood Mala:** These beads are considered auspicious and bring good luck to their owner. They are usually deep red in color and can be used for most purposes, though they are especially known for contributing to states of compassion and love.
- **Rudraksha Mala:** These beads are made by drilling the brown, knobby seeds of the elaeocarpus ganitrus roxburgii tree.

  "Rudra" is a name for the ancient Vedic form of the god Shiva in his capacity as the ruthless forces of nature; "aksha" means tears, so the name means "Shiva's tears". A rudraksha mala is most often associated with Hindu austerities, penances, and Shiva-ritual worship. They are also used by some Buddhists for wrathful deity practices, partly because of the Tibetan Buddhist use of the term "rudra" for that which is to be transformed through ferocity. Rudraksha beads are very rough to the touch, and they come in varying sizes. A rudraksha is believed to confer benefits according to the number of segments in the seed: the fewer the segments, the more valuable the rudraksha bead. An ordinary seed has 4-6 faces; however some rudraksha beads may have only a single face (no segments - the rarest and most valuable), while others have as many as 14 segments.
- **Sandalwood (Red) Mala:** These beads are used for gathering spiritual power, and are associated with rituals for female deities.
- **Sandalwood (White) Mala:** These beads are used for spiritual devotion. They give off a wonderful fragrance, are said to enhance spiritual awareness, and are associated with the opening of the Upper Dantian. As they are

an endangered species, sandalwood trees are now protected by the Indian government, and sandalwood malas are growing increasingly more expensive and difficult to find.

Stone Beads

The first criterion in choosing stone beads is their substance and color. It should correspond with the color of the deity or energy of the specific practice that it will be used for. For example, turquoise is often used for Green Tara practice because it is considered to be a green stone in Tibetan culture. Malachite is also suitable, as well as emerald and Jade. In eastern Asia, Jade is associated with longevity and prosperity, so it is used for many deities associated with these concepts. In other words, there is an archetypal significance to these substances that goes beyond mere color associations. Additionally, each stone has its own unique energetic potential that can serve to further focus and enhance the mystic's intention. The following is a brief description of different stone beads used for malas, and the energetic potential of each:

- **Amber Mala:** These beads are difficult to find and are considered to have both healing and protective qualities because they link the conscious-self to the higher spiritual-self. Amber has been held in high regard as a powerful protective talisman for thousands of years. It absorbs negative energies and transmutes them into positive forces that stimulate the body to heal itself. The healing energy of amber is especially attuned to the heart, throat, and endocrine system.
- **Amethyst Mala:** These beads are used to enhance spiritual awareness and healing. Amethyst opens intuition, enhances psychic gifts, promotes divine love, and gives insight into the true nature of the core self. Amethyst beads also aid in cultivating peace, repelling harmful influences, and energizing the immune system.
- **Aventurine Mala:** These beads are said to aid in concentration and mental development. Aventurine also promotes wealth and fertility.
- **Carnelian Mala:** These beads are very healing and are good for purifying the blood. Carnelian malas have protective qualities, and they are said to bring prosperity and good luck. It ensures friendship, banishes fear, and gives self-confidence. Carnelian is a stabilizing stone with high energy, and it is excellent for restoring vitality and motivation.
- **Coral (Red) Mala:** These beads are highly prized in Tibet where they are used for Tantric practices. The red color of the coral is especially associated with life and fertility. Red Coral was used in ancient times to bring balance the physical and spirit realms, further aligning the priest with the divine source of all wisdom. It both opens and activates the Lower Chakra and is believed to protect the individual from depression and despair.
- **Dzi Mala:** These beads are also known as "Buddha-eye" beads. They are black and white in color, and are characterized by a "strong eye" pattern with a circle and square or a double wave. The meaning of the word Dzi is "shine, brightness, cleanness, or splendor." These beads have a long shape and tend to be used alone as amulets. The most valuable Dzi are those with three-eyes or nine-eyes, the best being those that have sharply contrasting patterns and are shiny with a faintly oily surface.

  The three-eyes of the three-eye Dzi are representative of prosperity, happiness, and longevity. The three-eye Dzi is said to enhance the ability to see a good opportunity and obtain it. The nine eyes of the nine-eye Dzi are associated with nine merits: compassion, glory, everlasting brightness, fame, dignity, power and authority, control, reputation, and the removal of obstacles.

  A Dzi stone can be worn as a single bead about the neck as an auspicious or medicinal amulet. Dzi stones are also placed within traditional Tibetan necklaces, interspersed with coral, pearls, amber or turquoise. Occasionally Dzi stones are used alone, and a whole necklace or mala is made exclusively from Dzi beads.

  It is said that Dzi are magical, and will protect the wearer from sickness (e.g., strokes, epilepsy, and other illnesses) and from harm (e.g., evil spirits and evil influences). The Dzi bead is one of the most mysterious of all the beads known to us today. Not much is known about these stones, or even how long

they have been an important part of Tibetan culture. However, it is believed that once a Dzi is broken, its power has been used up.

- **Garnet Mala:** These beads bring prosperity and are therefore often used to promote success in business ventures. Red Garnet also repels negative influences, promotes physical healing, strengthens the heart, and purifies the blood. It is also said to aid those interested in astral projection. Because Red Garnet helps to align the emotional body to the spirit body, sleeping with it will help you remember your dreams.

  According to ancient tradition, Garnet Malas (that are deep wine colored) are to be magically energized in a Fire Ritual, that required the priest to invoke the celestial powers of the planet Saturn.
- **Hematite Mala:** These beads are very powerful stones, used throughout the ages to make all manner of magical objects. Hematite has long been associated with psychic awareness, and some people believe that it assists in spirit travel, soul travel, and scrying. It acts as a magnet that transforms spiritual power into determined action. In the West, hematite has long been used to shorten recovery time in those healing from wounds and gashes. When used as a talisman, Hematite ensures (for the wearer) a favorable hearing of petitions addressed to the celestial kings and good fortune in the area of lawsuits and other judgements.

  According to ancient tradition, Hematite malas are to be magically energized in a Fire Ritual, that required the priest to invoke the celestial powers of the planet Saturn. Hematite malas were commonly used in order to enhance mental activity, as well as dissolve negativity and balance the body's Yin (female) and Yang (male) energies and emotions.
- **Jade Mala:** These beads have been used for thousands of years. Both Jade Malas and Jade necklaces have been found that date as far back as 3500 B.C. In ancient China, Jade was referred to as "the stone of heaven," and the ancient Daoists believed that the sacredness of Jade was such that it conferred upon its owner sovereignty, as well as magical and healing powers; Jade was also said to nourish the spirit, balance the body's Yin and Yang energies, and have the capacity of assuring immortality.

  According to ancient tradition, Jade malas are energized in a magical ritual carried out on the 11th Moon. Jade is known as a "Stone of Protection." Therefore, it was believed that malas constructed of Jade provided an energetic barrier against all forms of physical attack and illness. It was also said to encourage meditative spirit travel, and to help in making the dream process productive and healing.
- **Lapis Lazuli Mala:** These beads are very healing and are said to improve the well-being of the wearer by integrating mental, spiritual, and emotional states. Lapis Lazuli is a beautiful deep blue color, and it is recommended for use in prayer, meditation, and the cultivation of intuitive powers. It stimulates the Upper Dantian, opens up the Third Eye, enhances dream work and Spirit Travel, increases psychic abilities, and facilitates enlightenment. In ancient times Lapis Lazuli was believed to poses enormous serenity, and it was used as a key to spiritual attainment. As a psychic stone, Lapis Lazuli is believed to harmonize the body on each physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual level.
- **Malachite Mala:** These beads have a powerful healing effect on the physical body. Malachite is also known as the "stone of saints." It is considered to be a stone of transformation. When placed on the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye), Malachite will activate inner-vision and psychic vision. It can be used for scrying or to access the internal or external dimensions of other worlds (journeying through its convoluted patterns releases the mind and stimulates pictures released from the subconscious mind). Malachite amplifies the body's Yin and Yang Qi and it grounds the spiritual energy by rooting the Shen. When placed on the Yellow Court it facilitates a deeper emotional healing by releasing the negative experiences of old traumas and bringing suppressed feelings to the surface.
- **Mother-of-Pearl Mala:** These beads are believed to multiply the energetic and spiritual effects of prayers and incantations by

1,000,000. Mother-of-pearl is used for purification, long life, and warding off disease and misery. It also helps balance the emotions and is used to neutralize excesses of sun energy.

- **Quartz (Rock) Crystal Mala:** These beads bring strength. In the West and in China quartz symbolizes purity and is considered to be a strong healer and a powerful amulet. Quartz Crystal connects the mystic to his or her spirit guides and enhances deeper meditational states. It also facilitates accessing the energetic fields of the infinite space of the Wuji.

  Clear Quartz Crystal Malas are considered to be auspicious for praying to the Goddess. These Clear Crystals amplify a priest's mantras, give them higher energy, and increase their power. According to ancient tradition, Clear Quartz Malas are to be magically energized during the Full Moon in order to invoke the celestial powers of the Goddess.
- **Quartz (Rose) Crystal Mala:** These beads are primarily associated with bringing love. They are believed to be very beneficial for artists, as they promote creativity by opening emotional pathways. Rose quartz engenders kindness, compassion, and tenderness. It is used to strengthen empathy and sensitivity, and it enhances positive affirmations. It is calming, reassuring, and excellent for recovering from emotional trauma or crisis. Used in emotional healing, Rose Quartz releases unexpressed emotions, alleviates heartache, and soothes internalized pain.

  According to ancient tradition, Rose Quartz Malas are to be magically energized during the Full Moon in order to invoke the celestial powers of the Goddess. Rose Quartz Malas have a calming influence and help to clear emotional negative.
- **Tiger Eye Mala:** These beads can be used in order to bring protection against psychic attacks and curses. Tiger eye beads promote the vibrant circulation of energy, increase courage, and are associated with creativity. Tiger's Eye combines the energy of the Earth with the energy of the Sun in order to create a high vibrational state. It can be used to enhance psychic abilities and balance the Lower Dantian Qi.

  Tiger Eye Malas are energized in a magical ritual carried out on the 4th Moon. The Tiger Eye stone is sometimes used to attract and maintain wealth. It also stimulates awareness and understanding and promotes optimism, psychic ability, and intuition.
- **Turquoise Mala:** These beads are powerful healing stones. Turquoise is considered to be an antidote to both physical and spiritual poisons, and are used to ward off the Evil Eye. In Tibet, turquoise was considered to bring wealth and affection and was used as a powerful medicinal talisman.

Bone Beads

Animal substances like tiger bone, antique ivory, or mammoth ivory make powerful malas that are good for all-purpose use. Beads made from human bone, however, are used for entering into the lower spirit realms or the Underworld, and for controlling fearsome spirit entities. Chinese bone beads are a fine example of the unique skill and craftsmanship practiced by ancient artisans, and such beads often had complex designs etched into them. For example, extremely complex hollow Chinese knots, flowers, and images of butterflies are but some of the many designs carved into the bone in order to express its spiritual significance.

The most treasured type of bone beads are those made from the skull bones of dead holy men or lamas.

Precious Metal Beads

Metals such as gold and silver may also be used to construct malas. In practice, however, precious metals are rarely used as the primary bead on a mala but are rather used to decorate the mala or to connect the individual beads together. Since such metals are good conductors of electric energy, their inclusion on a mala can greatly increase its energetic potential. Malas made from or decorated with precious metals are generally used to wealth, knowledge, ability, or power. Sliver is the most commonly utilized metal for malas, though malas with brass, copper, or gold are also found.

CONSTRUCTING MALAS

Although it is fairly easy to find pre-made malas, often in the desired material, it is always best if the mystic uses either a mala that he or she has personally made or one that was made by his or her teacher. The number of prayer beads on a mala can be 36, 48, 50, 99, 108, or any spiritual number that is significant to the tradition of the mystic utilizing it as spiritual tool. The number 108 is used most often, and it represents the union of the Dao (the number 1) and its infinite manifestations (the number 8, symbolizing the interaction of Yin and Yang) taking place within the circle of the Wuji (the number zero). However, some Daoist mystics maintain that, since it is difficult to concentrate the mind for long periods, the extra 8 beads are to make up for any mistakes and ensure the mystic gets at least 100 clear repetitions for each mala cycle.

Some mystics will add counter beads (a different type, shape, or arrangement of beads that hangs off the mala) at certain intervals (usually 10 or 20 beads apart) along the mala in order to keep track of the number of mala cycles chanted. Alternately, a loose bead or grain of rice may be moved from one bowl to another upon the completion of a mala cycle. This helps the practitioner keep track of very large numbers of mantra repetitions, such as 10,000, 100,000 or even 1,000,000.

The beads on a mala meet at a leader bead (also called the meru, stupa, guru, or guide bead) that is not used as a chanting bead. This bead represents one's guide, patriarch, primary spiritual icon, a deity, immortal, or guardian spirit. It protects the intent of the mystic by simultaneously acting as a energetic keystone that completes the circle of beads while also releasing any unwanted energy via the tassel. Therefore, the leader bead represents both the beginning and the ending of the incantation or mantra practice. Cords come out of the leader bead and are commonly attached to two beads and a tassel. The ancient Daoists believed that evil spirits did not like dangling objects, making the tassel effective in warding off the Evil Eye. In Tibetan malas, the end pieces include the Dorje (thunderbolt) and the Drilbu (bell). These end beads represent the two energies of form and formlessness - Yin and Yang. The prayer beads are usually strung on three cords of strong linen or silk. Silk is considered to be the most energetically rich material available.

Before constructing a mala, the priest first considers the nature of the ritual or incantation he or she is about to undertake (i.e., whether it is a ritual for purification, increasing spiritual perception, enhancing physical prowess, or acquiring wealth). The priest then chooses from among the several types of possible mala beads that suit that particular purpose, picking the variety that he or she most strongly resonates with or that most dramatically enhances the ritual. Once the beads have been chosen, an appropriate cord on which to string the beads is acquired. The prayer beads are usually strung on three intertwined cords of strong linen or silk (silk is considered to be the most energetically rich material available). The cord is generally white but is sometimes black or red.

After purifying the cords, beads, and any other materials that will be used in the making of the mala, the priest is ready to begin. As each bead is slipped into place, the mystic infuses it with a mantra or breath incantation, usually accompanied by a visualization. In the *Palace of Vast Jewels*, it says that, when constructing a Mala, it is important to recite an incantation seven times and then blow on the beads (Breath Incantation) in order to increase the spiritual power of one's subsequent recitations. Upon finishing the last bead and tying the sacred knot, the mystic then seals the mala with his or her personal magic symbol. Once a mala has been thus energetically constructed, it becomes a reservoir of the mystic's spiritual energy and should not be allowed to touch the ground.

The prayer beads can be either unknotted (for those who like to flow with their prayer) or constructed with a knot between each bead (for those who like to pause and consider). Traditionally, when the mystic wanted to wear the prayer beads in order to bring increased energetic flow into his or her life, he or she selected the unknotted version. When the mystic wanted to bring more conscious control into their life, the knotted ver-

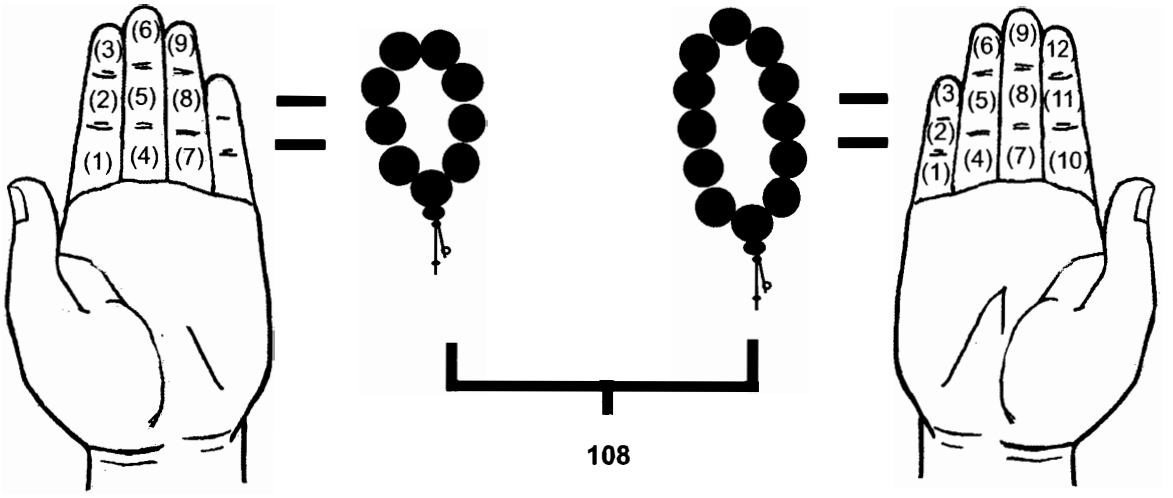


Figure 1.136. An example of using the finger digits of each hand as living malas

sion was selected. When doing intense chanting, the knotted version is considered to be the best. Occasionally a mala is constructed only of knotted rope (often called a prayer rope), in which case the specially constructed knots are used for counting, taking the place of the beads.

Counting On Malas

Mantras (repeated incantations) are sometimes spoken and repeated when any priest uses a mala as a magical tool for gathering spiritual power. In certain magical traditions, the priest is taught to use the finger digits of each hand as living beads when training mantras.

In this type of training, the priest will use the first nine digits on the first three fingers of his or her left hand as a marker. This is equivalent to a nine bead mala. When counting, the priest will place his or her left thumb onto the next digit only after a series of 12 counts has been completed (Figure 1.136).

On the right hand, the priest will use all 12 digits of his or her four fingers. This is equivalent to a twelve bead mala. When counting, the priest will place his or her left thumb onto the next digit after each mantras has been spoken (this practice is sometimes also used for counting breaths).

After reciting and counting twelve mantras with the right hand, the priest will move to the next digit on his or her left hand. In this manner, the priest will progress through 108 mantra repetitions (9X12).

The Function of Using Malas

Using mala beads allows the Daoist mystic to relax, focus, and immerse his or her mind completely into the particular incantation or prayer while not having to keep track of the number of repetitions. When working with advanced rituals and incantations, the energy can become so powerful that it is essential for the mystic to be assured of the proper number of recitations. This is especially true for rituals in which certain energies are awakened by secret incantations that are specifically designed to create a balanced opposition of intensities that propels the mystic into ever deeper states of awareness and power.

The practice of chanting with a mala is initiated by starting at the leader bead and rotating each bead between the thumb and the second or ring finger, depending on the mystic's particular sect and tradition. One mantra or incantation is recited for each bead that passes through the fingers. When one cycle is completed and the leader bead is reached, it is traditional to reverse direction instead of passing over the leader bead. Reaching this leader bead signifies the completion of one cycle of chanting. Often the disciple is required

to repeat 10 or more such cycles in a single sitting, depending on the length of the incantation and the specific nature of the training. In certain Daoist schools a cycle is not considered complete until the mystic has gone over each bead twice, once in each direction.

The mantra or breath incantation can be repeated in many ways. The mystic may repeat an incantation out loud and fast to ground the incantation in the physical body and send it into the physical world. He or she may repeat the incantation in a whisper to influence the energetic world, or the mystic may repeat the incantation only internally in order to influence the spirit world.

A simple but effective way to work with prayer beads is to focus intention on a specific aspect of your life and what you want to achieve. Chant a word or phrase representing that quality while holding each bead. This places that intent inside the circle of beads, which you can then wear to keep that energy around you throughout the day. When you wear the prayer beads inside or outside your clothes (e.g., around the neck or coiled above the elbow), the prayer beads resonate your intention inside their circle of power. This circle creates an energetic field that positively influences the flow of energy and consciousness in and around your body. When not being worn, you may keep your prayer beads in a small bag or on the Altar.

It is common to reserve a mala exclusively for the recitation of a particular mantra or breath incantation in order to build up a stronger energetic charge. Some mystics will therefore keep numerous malas, each for the recitation of a different chant.

When you wish to change your intent, it is important to ritually clear your beads by passing them through the smoke from the incense on your sacred altar. Do not wash or soak the beads. If they are strung on silk, the best conductor of energy, the cord that keeps the beads together can disintegrate in water. You may wish to polish them with a soft cloth.

USING THE MALA AS AN ORACLE

In ancient Tibet, the priest's mala was also used as an oracular tool. One specific divination method utilizing a mala is described as follows:

- The priest performing the divination first prays to the deity he is invoking for the correct answer and recites that deity's mantras.
- He then holds up the Mala horizontally in front of him, with the fingers of each hand grasping a randomly chosen bead, leaving half the beads or fewer between them.
- Then the fingers of each hand move towards each other counting three beads at a time. The outcome of the divination depends on the number of beads left.
- When only one bead remains, the result is called a Falcon. When two beads remain, it is called Raven. When three beads remain the result is called a Snow Lion.

The procedure is repeated three times:

- **The First Pass:** The outcome of the first pass indicates the extent of the deities' support and the quality of the divination in general. A Falcon at the first attempt would indicate support from protectors, luck in a new enterprise, or success in a lawsuit. A Raven on the first pass means the protectors are not on your side: there will be no accomplishment, lawsuit will be unsuccessful, and there are enemies present. Such a divination would caution against starting on any new enterprise. A Snow Lion on the first round would indicate support from the deities, slow but stable accomplishments, and weakness on the part of enemies. If the question concerned successful business, a Snow Lion would be regarded as a neutral result.
- **The Second Pass:** During the second pass, the outcome indicates conditions to take place in one's immediate environment. A Falcon at the second pass indicates good luck in general, but not much success for those wishing to have children; the overall risk of thefts and illnesses will remain small. A Raven indicates serious illness, obstacles to health, and a decline in the life force; there will be a tendency for things to get lost or stolen (however, in

the case of an ordained person, these negative aspects would be reduced).

- **The Third Pass:** On the third pass, the number of remaining beads gives clues about an expected person arriving from elsewhere. This was a very important aspect of life in Tibet, for people traveled constantly and there was no communication system. With regard to an expected visitor, a Falcon on the third pass indicates imminent news or arrival; with regard to illness, it would indicate finding the best way to cure it. A Raven on the third pass is a bad indication concerning expected travelers: they are likely to encounter obstacles on the way, they will not arrive at all, or they will be robbed. The sick will not be cured, and possessions will be lost or stolen. A Snow Lion on the third round indicates that travelers will arrive late but will come to no harm; problems with health will be few, although there will be difficulties in finding the right treatment.

  The most positive results of such a divination would be three consecutive Falcons. This would indicate that accomplishments will be swift, patients will recover, and travelers will arrive quickly.

Warding Off Ghosts Using Malas

Because prayer beads are a tool used for divine purposes, one of their virtues is the ability to fend off hostile ghosts. For example, when prayer beads that have been effectively charged with divine white light are hung at the entrance of a house, they will keep all evil spirits away. Even if they have a strong desire to harm the people inside the building, the spirit entities will not be able to cross the spiritual barrier created by the prayer beads. If an individual is disturbed by ghosts during the night, he or she can also keep the prayer beads in the bedroom to frighten the spirit entities away.

In short, the prayer beads act as a charm that can effectively dispel demons and all other types of evil spirits. It should be noted, however, that certain Daoists traditions believe that the power of these sacred objects can be neutralized if a woman's undergarment or blood is rubbed on the mala or on the individual wearing it.

Increasing Psychic Skills Using Crystals

To the ancient Daoist teachings, certain magical crystals could be used as energetic portals into the natural realm of the Mineral Kingdom.

The following are some exercises and meditations used by ancient Daoists in order to increase their magical clairvoyant powers.

The Qilin Meditation

One ancient exercise practiced in order to develope the Daoist priest's perceptional matrix using Crystal Magic was known as "The Qi Lin (Unicorn) Meditation." This particular meditation is described as follows:

- After performing the required purification ritual, the priest will choose a specific crystal and hold it in his or her hands (left hand on the outside, right hand on the inside, thumbs touching). The crystal should be placed in the center of the right palm.
- Observe and energetically feel the crystal from the top of its structure to its base. There should be an energetic connection that extends from your three Dantians into the energetic matrix of the crystal.
- Next, open your Yin Tang (Third Eye) and extend your Shen into the crystal (certain Daoist and Buddhist priests will exhale their breath into the crystal while simultaneously sounding the sacred tone Ohm).
- While observing the crystal from your Third Eye, feel the specific colored vibrational essence of the crystal's reflected light. Then envelop, fuse, and energetically fall into the center core of the crystal's energetic matrix.
- As you feel the energetic connection existing between you and the crystal, begin to spiral a clear wave of white light energy back and forth between the crystal and your Third Eye.
- As your intention penetrates the crystal's three bodies (physical, energetic, and spiritual matrix), close your eyes and allow the energy fields to dissolve into space.
- Experience the crystals Element, its power, its vibrant color, and all of its magical natures. Feel the Divine Mind that created the crystal, and comprehend the crystal's magical func-

tion. If a spirit guardian comes up, offer it a gift exchange as you continue to attune and align yourself with the crystal's magical nature.

OPENING THE THIRD EYE EXERCISE

The following exercise was used in ancient China by Daoist priests in order to enhance their clairvoyant perceptions by Opening their "Heavenly Eye" (Third Eye). After practicing this magical technique correctly, the disciple will be able to Open his Heavenly Eye.

- After waking up, choose a stone or Gem that has been specifically energized, dedicated, and magically activated for the specific purpose of opening the Heavenly Eye. The morning time (5-7 a.m.) is considered to be one of the best times to Open the Third Eye Point, allowing it to receive the positive Yang energies emitted from the Morning Sun.
- Place the stone on your Third Eye and begin to rub the area for about 1-3 minutes.

  Rubbing towards the left is used for enhancing and increasing clairvoyant powers.

  Rubbing towards the right is used for cleansing.
- For Increasing Psychic Vision, choose from one of the following stones: Clear Apophyllite, Diamond, Violet and Purple Fluorite, Herderite, Iolite, Labradorite, Lapis Lazuli, Lazulite, Moldavite, Phenacite, Pietersite, Rutilated Quartz, Selenite, Sodalite, Sugilite, and Blue Tourmaline.
- For Developing the ability to Scry, choose from one of the following stones: Golden Beryl, Iolite, Black Jasper, Lazulite, Malachite, Black Obsidian, Golden-Sheen Obsidian, Rainbow Obsidian, Silver-Sheen Obsidian, Phantom Quartz, Rutilated Quartz, Star Sapphite
- For Developing the ability to Soul Travel, choose from one of the following stones: Angelite, Deep Blue Apatite, Golden Yellow Calcite, Cavansite, Celestite, Garnet, Herderite, Blue Jasper, Green Kyanite, Labradorite, Lapis Lazuli, Lazulite, Moldavite, Blue Obsidian, Silver-Sheen Obsidian, White Opal, Pietersite, Prehnite, Rutilated Quartz, Selenite, Seraphinite, Stibnite, and Sugilite.

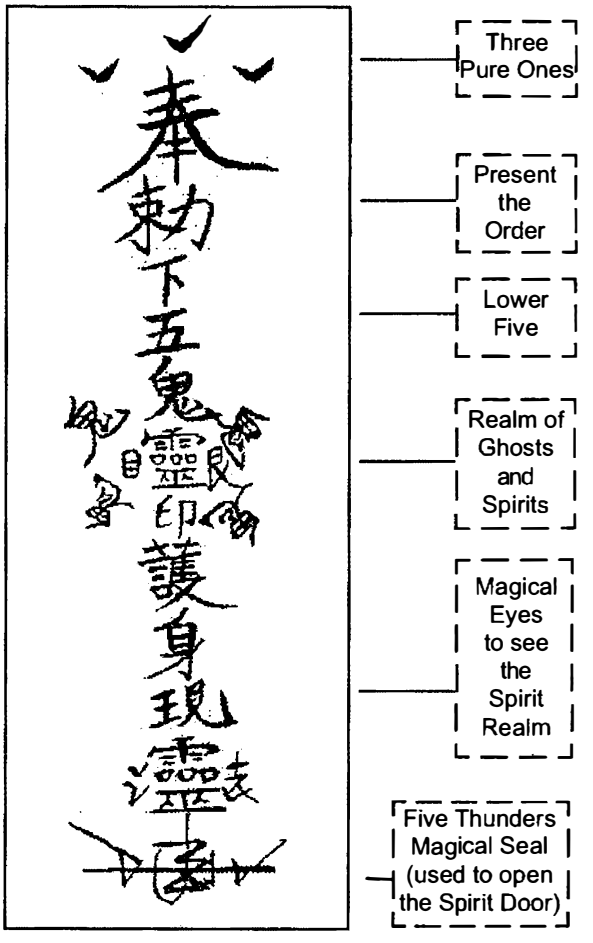


Figure 1.137. The "Open The Third Eye "Talisman

- Next, the burn the following talisman (Figure 1.137) over the Earth Altar and then place the ashes into a bowl of water.
- Use the spirit water to wash your eyes.
- While washing the eyes, speak the following secret incantation:

"To the Left and Right
all Heaven and Earth Rejoices!
Turning to the Right
the Sun and Moon shine brightly!

Great changes move across the Earth,
Revealing the appearance of
ghosts and spirits!
When the auspicious clouds appear
the Evil Star shall retreat!"

Energized Soil, The Secret Qi of The Earth

The ancient Chinese Feng Shui masters considered the Treasure of Earth to include the minerals and soil of all land formations.

Understanding the flow of energy across and within the landscape is one of the most essential skills in energy cultivation. The ancient Daoists believed that the Yang Celestial Breath of the Dao impregnates and distributes its Shen Ling (Magical Spirit) within the soil and land, settling within the mountains, hills valleys and other structures. This Celestial Breath can either be accumulated or expanded, active or latent, floating on the surface or hidden underneath, or combined with other structures of Nature.

In ancient China, it was believed that high-quality land contained soil that had a powerful energetic resonance. This type of soil had a solid but moist texture and consistency, being neither too wet nor too dry. The soil's dominant color (green/blue, red, yellow/light brown, white, or black) was believed to be determined by the particular Element governing that land area. For example, reddish soil was considered to be full of Celestial Breath and to contain powerful Shen Ling, while rocky soil was considered to be breathless and therefore weak. Additionally, certain types of rocks and soil were said to have higher concentrations of energy, while other types of rocks and soil had less.

The ancient Daoists believed that when Heaven (sky) and Earth were separated during creation, the generative energy (being heavy) descended and sank into the ground. It was therefore believed that absorbing the "Essence of the Earth" could replenish the individual's generative energy. The ancient Daoists also believed that the Earth energy expresses its power in Man's life through the basic instincts for survival and the primal drives for sex and reproduction.

The soil of the land is an important aspect to consider when gathering Qi. In ancient Daoist Folk Magic, the soil of the Earth was considered to be one of the most powerful ingredients that could be added to a priest's spell.

Harvesting the Magical Power of Earth Qi Through the Soil

There are several types of soil that can be gathered for magical purposes. To the ancient Daoists, the type of dirt that was gathered and the specific areas from which it was harvested determined the soils energetic quality and function.

Because the soil has absorbed and energetically fused with the collective consciousness of the environment (past and present), it contains much energetic knowledge and power. It is magically imbued with the energies and special qualities of the people, plants, animals, and minerals contained within the surrounding area.

Whether the soil is added to magical spells, curses, hexes, or magical tools (sachets, oils, herbal formulas, herbal powders, herbal washes, etc.), it is still seen as an energetic "mixing pot" containing ancient history and energetic charges.

The following are some examples of the specific energetic qualities that can be obtained through harvesting different types of soil (dirt).

Harvesting Temple Dirt

This type of soil is excellent when a priest wishes to invite the help of positive spiritual forces. It can be used in magical formulae involving protection against the intrusion of evil spirits.

Harvesting Courthouse Dirt

This type of soil is excellent when a priest is involved in legal matters and invokes the discerning eye of the law. It can be used for obtaining justice, debt collection, and for lawful protection.

Harvesting University Dirt

This type of soil is excellent when a priest is seeking to gain access to certain knowledge and wisdom, and can be used to assist the priest in retaining esoteric information.

Harvesting Hospital Dirt

This type of soil can be gathered from either a doctor's office, clinic, or hospital. It is excellent when a priest wishes to invoke any type of healing, but can also be used to cause illness.

Harvesting Market Dirt

This type of soil can be gathered from either a bank, market, or financial Institution. It is excellent

when a priest wishes to bring large amounts of cash or certain types of wealth into his or her life.

HARVESTING FARM DIRT

This type of soil can be gathered from either a farm, garden, or flower shop. This type of soil is excellent when a priest wishes to invoke Sex Magic or Love Spells, as it has a tendency to make love grow roots and blossom.

HARVESTING PRISON DIRT

This type of soil can be gathered from either a jail or prison. It is excellent when a priest wishes to make him or herself invisible to the police and legal authorities. It can also be used to bring jail or prison time.

HARVESTING MENTAL INSTITUTION DIRT

This type of soil can be gathered in order to cause insanity. Be warned, that the energy attached to this type of soil is generally wild, chaotic and unstable.

HARVESTING CEMETERY DIRT

When gathering soil from a graveyard, the priest must be aware that the dirt can either be imbued with the energies and magical qualities of certain heros and mystics who were once held in mystery and awe; or the dirt can be imbued with the energies and magical qualities of evil individuals and malevolent spirits.

In ancient China, evil sorcerers who could be payed to hex individuals, would sometimes summon demons or evil ghosts via the help of carefully selected graveyard items. According to Daoist Master Chen Chang Qi, in ancient China, items obtained from a graveyard such as the dirt, a brick or stone, old coffin wood, coffin nails, the corpse pillow, corpse jewelry, the clothing found on the corpse, or the soil, water, or plants found on top of a grave site, were all commonly used by both Daoists priests and evil sorcerers for summoning the corpse-spirits of various Gui.

Special decoctions were sometimes constructed from these graveyard items and utilized as powerful medicine to either bind and remove evil spirits (i.e., used to ease a victim's mental and physical torment), or to attach evil spirits onto an individual's energetic fields for malevolent purposes.

According to Master Chen Chang Qi, the exorcising or destructive powers of each grave site differs in energetic degree, according to the amount of Ling Shen (Magical Powers) contained within the individual buried at the grave site. Traditionally, items gathered from a grave site were commonly harvested during the first (New Moon) or fifteenth (Full Moon) of the lunar month.

One lethal technique used to magically destroy a victim, was to place a container filled with graveyard dirt on the altar, so that it can be energized by the power of the magical ritual. The priest then uses this dirt to cover a hexing doll (which represents the victim). In order to reinforce the hex's power, the priest would try to get close to the victim and sprinkle some of the energized graveyard dirt onto his or her shadow. Additionally, if the priest also stepped onto or spit on the victim's shadow, the curse could be further charged, and become extremely lethal.

Each cemetery is considered to be an energetic portal into the spiritual realm of the Underworld. Therefore before entering into this powerful magical realm, the priest must first bring incense (four pieces) to offer to Yan Luo Wang (the God of Death and King of Hell) in order to receive permission to enter.

When harvesting soil from the cemetery, be respectful and courteous. Always ask permission from the "donor" before gathering the soil from just below the headstone. Traditionally, any graveyard dirt that is taken during the hour just before midnight is normally used for "good" purposes, while any type of dirt that is taken after midnight is generally used for "vengeful" purposes.

After harvesting the dirt, it is important to label the soil according to the name of the donor, along with his or her birth and death dates. The soil is then added to magical formulae according to its specific purpose and function.

Before leaving the grave, bury a piece of black onyx as a parting gift. This magical stone is used to peacefully separate the priest from the spirit who's energy occupies the soil.

The type of dirt that you gather and from which grave, depends on your specific need.

When combined with various esoteric herbs and minerals, the cemetery dirt can suddenly become a powerful energetic portal, capable of numerous supernatural abilities. For example, the dirt gathered from outside a cemetery can be used to call the spirits of the dead.

The following are some examples of various grave dirt and their specific magical manifestations.

- **An Ancestor:** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used for spiritual guidance, assistance, and protection.
- **A Priest or Nun:** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used for spiritual guidance, assistance, and protection. However, it can also be used to create guilt over something and induce an emotional state of great anxiety, fear, and worry over being caught.
- **A Surgeon or Doctor:** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used for healing. However, this dirt can also be used in magical formula that can cause sickness.
- **A Judge or Lawyer:** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used for legal guidance, assistance, and protection. However, it can also be used in magical formula that can bring about a change in legal decision. The energy attached to this type of soil is generally aggressive and strong.
- **A General or Soldier:** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used for aggressive assistance, and protection. The energy attached to this type of soil is generally powerful and strong. Because these individuals are trained to follow orders, the soil can be used for almost anything.
- **A Serial Killer or Executed Murderer:** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used in powerful revenge hexes, designed to induce serious harm to a specific individual who has caused serious harm and injustice to many. The energy attached to this type of soil is extremely aggressive. Be warned, when magically incorporated with certain herbs and minerals, this type of soil has been known to cause death.
- **A Insane Individual:** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used to cause insanity in another. Be warned, that the energy attached to this type of soil is generally wild, chaotic and unstable.
- **A Hooker or Gigolo:** The energy gathered from the graves of extremely promiscuous individuals is often used to induce a love triangle or bring about the sexual urges used to cause a victim to cheat on his or her spouse. It is traditionally used in Love Magic for breaking up a romantic involvement.
- **A Gambler:** If the gambler was extremely successful, then the energy gathered from this type of grave can be used to bring about or increase good luck.
- **An Adolescent (Ages 11-19):** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used to cause inattentiveness and irresponsible behavior. It can also be used in Sex Magic in order to cause romantic involvement, kindle sexual attraction, and increase sexual prowess.
- **A Child (Ages 2-10):** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used to create the appearance of innocence or can also be used in order to develop new friendships.
- **An Infant (Ages 0-2):** The energy gathered from these types of graves is often used to create neediness. This is used in Love Magic in order to ensure that the victim becomes totally dependent on an individual.

SPIRIT ROCK FORMATIONS

To the ancient Daoist mystics, "Spirit rocks" were considered to be a special class of rock formation that carries a higher and more powerful quality of Earth Qi than ordinary rocks (Figure 1.138). These magical stone formations can be either beneficial, neutral, or destructive, depending on their shape, size, and location.

"GOOD" ENERGETIC ROCKS

Spirit rocks that resemble auspicious objects are considered to be extremely beneficial. For example, mountainous rock formations that resemble deities or "magical" animals (such as a dragon, tiger, phoenix, snake, pig, elephant, etc.), or Daoist or Buddhist symbols (such as a command block, candle, incense burner, altar pen, banner, etc.) are believed to carry powerful auspicious energy. Smooth rock formations are also known to carry benevolent energy.

If a huge rock is positioned in the middle of a stream, it was known in ancient China as a "Northern Star," and was believed to create extremely auspicious energy for those individuals living upstream.

Additionally, when training in mountains, it is important to practice in places where the rocks are "alive" and not "dead." A living rock will have a certain brightness radiating from its external structure. Therefore, it is important that the Daoist mystic observe the energetic movement and force radiating from within the surrounding rock formations when training in a natural outdoor environment.

"EVIL" ENERGETIC ROCKS

Certain Spirit Rocks are considered to be evil or to carry an evil presence. Stone formations that resemble grotesque-looking objects are considered to be extremely malevolent. Rock formations that resemble ghostly faces, for example, are believed to carry extremely powerful malevolent energy.

ELEMENT ROCKS

"Element Rocks" are believed to contain the various powers and influences of the Earth's Five Elements. The following are examples of the energetic influences that the Elements have on stones:

- **Fire Element:** Stones that contain more of the Fire Element release fire (sparks) and flash in red color.
- **Earth Element:** Stones that contain more of the Earth Element are dark and heavy.
- **Water Element:** Stones that contain more of the Water Element are transparent like quartz crystals.

Figure 1.138. An example of a Spirit Rock Immortal

ENERGY REGULATORS

Energy Regulators are a specific class of mountain formations resembling tall pillars, or valves. The location of an Energy Regulator will have a profound effect on the surrounding environment. For example:

- When an Energy Regulator is located near a Dragon's Vein (the energy moving along the Dragon's Spine), it routes the energy into a valley or plain.
- When an Energy Regulator is located in the middle of a valley, it amplifies the energy and channels it through the valley (Figure 1.139).
- When an Energy Regulator is located along the spine of a mountainous range, it acts as a valve, controlling the amount of Earth Qi that passes through the Dragon Vein.

Research from Europe has confirmed that the standing stone formations of Energy Regulators can be polarized or energetically charged in relationship to the ground around them. The strength of this energetic field rises and falls in a regular cycle, changing from hour to hour.

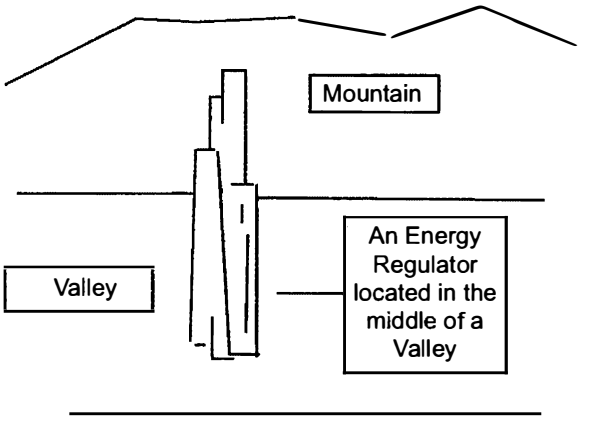


Figure 1.139. Energy Regulators are a specific class of rock formations resembling tall pillars.

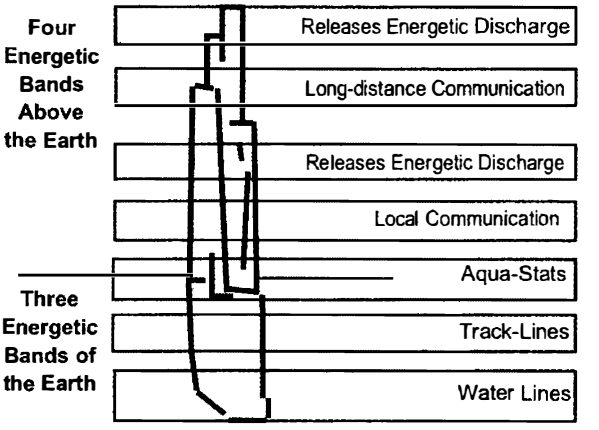


Figure 1.140. There are seven energetic bands on most large stone Energy Regulators.

According to researchers, the energetic field moves up and down the large stones following a lunar cycle. This lunar cycle appears to control the release of the stone's energy in a sine-wave form; the maximum power of the cycle occurs on the days before the new moon and full moon. The spiralling movement of the cycle feeds energy from the Earth towards the Heavens during the first half of the cycle (new moon to full moon), and then feeds energy from the Heavens towards the Earth during the second half of the cycle (full moon to new moon). The flow of the Earth's energy moves through the standing stone formations of Energy Regulators like a living, breathing pulse.

Additionally, there are seven energetic bands existing on most large stone Energy Regulators (Figure 1.140). The energetic bands that exist along the stone formation seem to control the spiralling movement of the stone's energetic cycle. The bottom three energetic bands connect the Qi of the stone to the electromagnetic fields of the Earth and relate to the underground energetic flows of Water-lines, Track-lines, and Aqua-stats. The remaining four bands connect with specific energies existing above the ground; each of these various energetic bands has different functions, all dealing with over-ground communications.

The tip of the stone Energy Regulators has been known to discharge a mild electrical shock onto the hand of any individual sensitive to the Earth's energetic flows. This electromagnetic shock is commonly due to the amount of quartz crystal contained within the stone's physical structure. Silica, the basic compound from which all quartz is derived, is the most abundant mineral contained within the Earth's crust. Sandstone and conglomerate are chiefly composed of small quartz crystals. The frequency of the stone's resonance depends on its quartz content, size, shape, and cut.

The Seven Energetic Bands and the Seven Chakras

The seven energetic bands existing on each Energy Regulator and each large mountain formation also correspond to the seven Chakra areas of the human body. Each of these seven areas can be utilized for gathering Earth Qi. One meditation used in ancient Daoist alchemy for gathering Earth Qi through the seven energetic portals is described as follows:

- After dividing the sacred rock into seven areas, the priest envelopes and fuses his or her Qi and Shen with the magical energetic field of the Energy Regulator or large mountain. It is important that the priest imagine, feel, and experience these seven sacred areas as energetic colors and magical vapors (Figure 1.141):

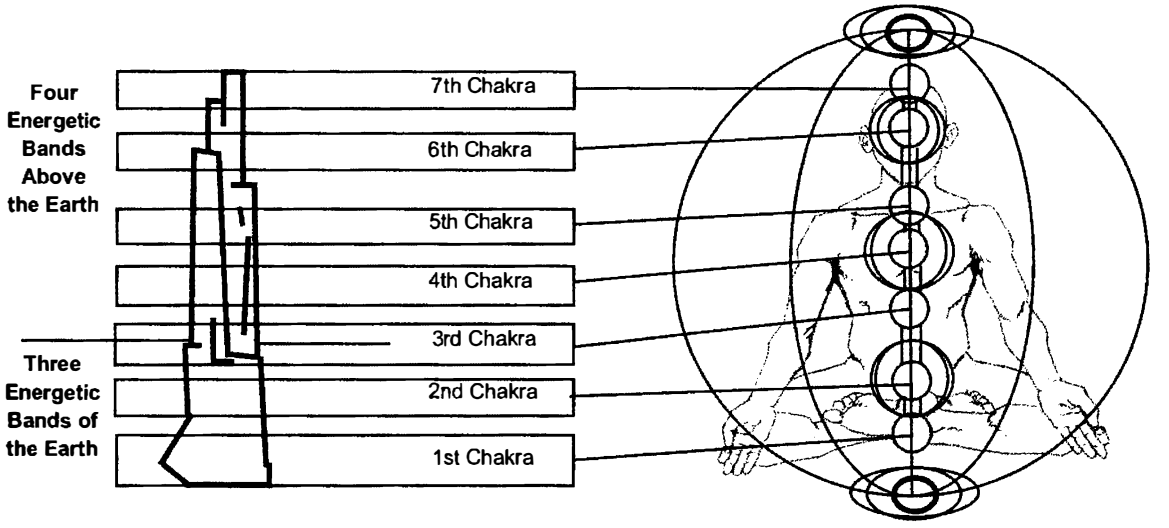


Figure 1.141. The seven energetic bands of Energy Regulators correspond to the Seven Chakras.

The Seventh Chakra and Violet Vapor: The peak of the Energy Regulator or mountain corresponds to the energy of the Baihui (One Hundred Meetings) and the Transpersonal Point (located one fist above the head) of the human body.

The Sixth Chakra and Indigo Vapor: The next section down from the top of the Energy Regulator or mountain corresponds to the energy of the Yintang (Third Eye), Fengfu (Wind Palace) and Upper Dantian areas of the human body.

The Fifth Chakra and Blue Vapor: The next section of the Energy Regulator or mountain corresponds to the energy of the throat (Heaven's Chimney).

The Fourth Chakra and Green Vapor: The next section of the Energy Regulator or mountain corresponds to the energy of the Shanzhong (Center Altar), heart, Shendao (Spirit's Path) and Middle Dantian areas of the human body.

The Third Chakra and Yellow Vapor: The next section of the Energy Regulator or mountain corresponds to the energy of the Shenfu (Spirit Storehouse), Yellow Court, and solar plexus areas of the human body.

The Second Chakra and Orange Vapor: The next section of the Energy Regulator or mountain corresponds to the energy of the Shenque (Spirit Palace Gate), Mingmen (Gate of Destiny) and Lower Dantian areas of the human body.

The First Chakra and Red Vapor: The root or bottom section of the Energy Regulator or mountain corresponds to the energy of the Hui Yin (Meeting of Yin), and the base of the perineum.

- After energetically connecting with the seven sacred areas, the priest then inhales and absorbs these external energies into his or her body. It is important that the priest imagines, feels, and energetically experiences each of the different magical powers of each of these various colored lights and vapors as they enter into his or her tissues.

SACRED STONE FORMATIONS

It has been discovered that energetic waterlines (the flow of underground water courses, springs, or fissures) are commonly located intersecting beneath many of the various types of Energy Regulators and sacred stone formations, especially standing stone formations, stone circle formations, and barrows. In 1939, French and English archaeologists concurred that there was a definite connection between prehistoric sacred stone sites and the energetic flow of underground water currents. Much of this information comes from extensive research conducted by noted

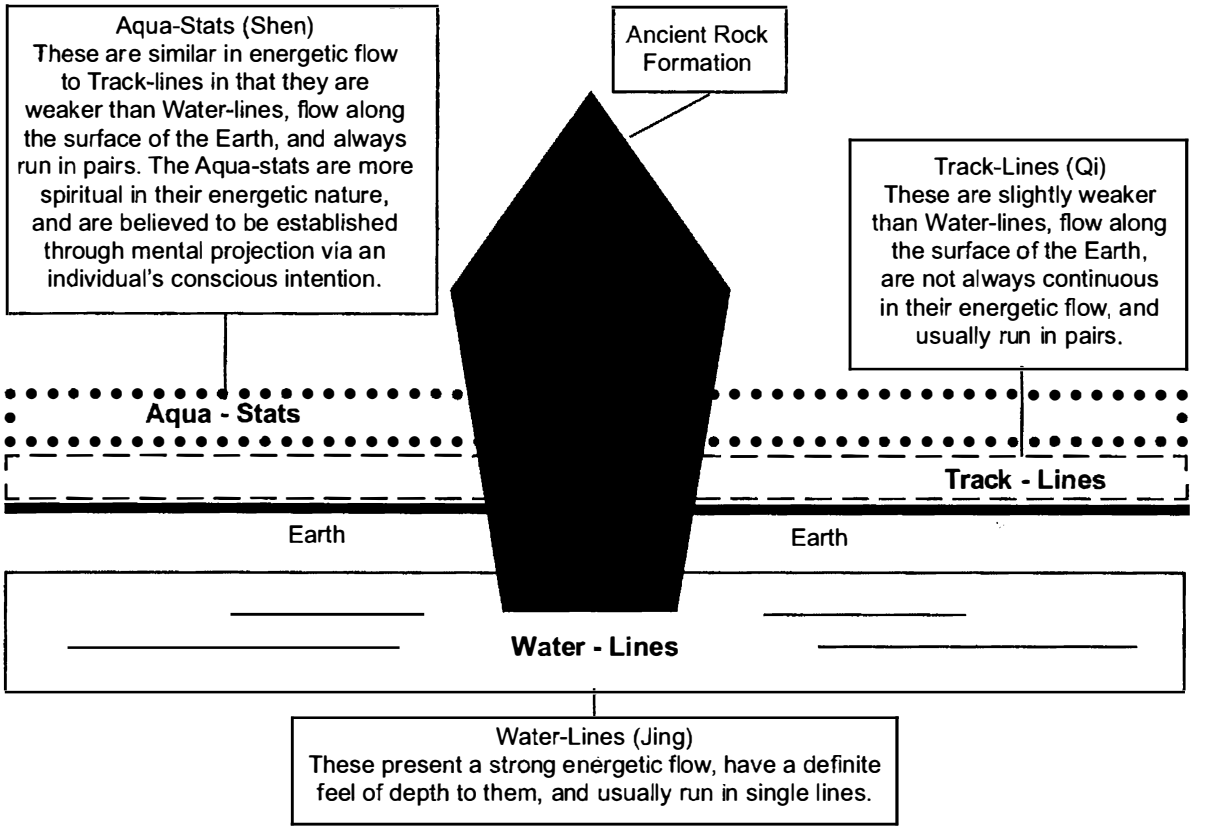


Figure 1.142. Three Types of Energetic Fields

dowser Tom Graves, as well as additional field-work conducted by archaeologists throughout France and England.

The various types of energies created by these Energy Regulators and sacred stone formations appear to have created spirals of energy which are geophysical anomalies. The energetic pattern formed by the subterranean web of water lines existing below the surface of the Earth determined the power, shape, and size of the sacred stone's energetic field above the ground. Some of these water-lines form large spirals around certain sacred stone formations; other stones demonstrate the existence of several spirals converging onto the same stone.

Three Types of Energetic Fields

It was also discovered that each sacred stone contained three different types of electromagnetic energetic fields. These electromagnetic fields are created from the underground energetic flows of Water-lines, Track-lines, and Aqua-stats, explained as follows (Figure 1.142):

- **Water-lines (Jing):** Water-lines present a strong energetic flow, have a definite feel of depth to them, and usually run in single lines.
- **Track-lines (Qi):** Track-lines are slightly weaker than Water-lines, flow along the surface of the Earth, are not always continuous in their energetic flow, and usually run in pairs.
- **Aqua-stats (Shen):** Aqua-stats are similar in energetic flow to Track-lines in that they are weaker then Water-lines, flow along the surface of the Earth, and always run in pairs. The Aqua-stats are more spiritual in their energetic nature, then are Water-lines and Track-lines. They are believed to be established through mental projection via an individual's conscious intention.

STALACTITES AND STALAGMITES

In ancient China, stones of unusual shapes and colors were believed to confer immortality if powdered and swallowed. Of these special immortal stones, both stalactites and stalagmites held a special interest with the ancient Daoist priests.

Stalactites and stalagmites are known as "speleothems," deposits of minerals that form into cave structures and line the insides of a cave (Figure 1.143). Stalactites are the formations that hang from the ceilings of caves like icicles, while stalagmites look like they're emerging from the ground and stand up like a traffic cone. Some may take thousands of years to form, while others can grow quite rapidly. The two formations are also sometimes referred to collectively as "dripstone."

In the *Cloud Forest Lapidary*, written during the Song Dynasty (960-1279 A.D.), the energetic and healing properties of both stalactites and stalagmites were discussed in great detail. Such names as ginger-stone, stone-spleen, and stomach-stone were used in order to describe their pharmaceutical uses.

STALACTITES

Stalactites hanging from the roof or sides of a cave were studied and included in the ancient Daoist pharmacopeia along with numerous other inorganic compounds and materials. Such names as "Stone Bell Milk" were used, for example, to describe the chemical deposits flowing down from certain stalactites.

STALAGMITES

Stalagmites, rising from the cave floor, were sometimes considered to be one of the varieties of magical mushrooms and were described by ancient Daoist Ge Hong as follows:

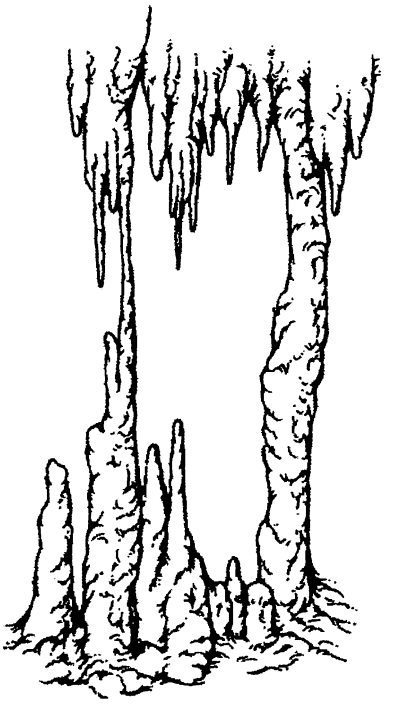


Figure 1.143. Stalactites (hang fron the cave ceiling) and Stalagmites (grow from the cave floor)

The stone-honey mushroom grows in the stone caves of the Shaoshi mountain. There is a stone pillar standing more than one hundred feet from the entrance to the cave. On top of this pillar is stone cover that looks like an upturned lid, standing ten feet high. You can observe the stone-honey's Qi fall from the roof of the cave and slide into this cover. At definite intervals, single drops invariably appear and continually fall like rainwater. Though the stone-honey Qi never ceases to fall, the lid never overflows. Above the cave there are characters inscribed in "tadpole" script, saying "those who succeed in eating one tou of stone-honey Qi will enjoy life for a thousand years."

GATHERING QI FROM CAVES

Shandong (Mountain caves) with their natural energetic formations, and their potential for collecting and pooling the Earth's Yin energies, were of particular interest to the ancient Daoists. Any type of cave, pit, or sunken enclosed area that desended deep into the underground was considered to be a condencer of powerful Yin energy. Because both "dark" and "wet" correspond to Yin, the ancient Daoists believed that when meditating deep inside a cave, the Yin energy reaches its extreme, and Yang energy arises.

Metaphysically, caves can symbolize a place where sacred information has been stored, or hidden, to be found when the time was right. Caves also represent a place or sanctuary in the unconscious mind that can be accessed only when a person's soul is ready. Caves are places of myth and magic that challenge you to decipher the metaphors within. In certain Chinese traditions, the openings to caves were believed to be portals leading into other dimensions. In fact in ancient China, the room in which a bridegroom first meets his betrothed was called the cave-room.

The sanctuary of a cave's opening symbolized the womb of the Earth. The presence of freshwater in or nearby the cave's entrance was said to render it fertile (Figure 1.144). The location and specific names given to a cave reflected their natural energetic history and affiliation with local animals or spirit-entities.

In ancient China, a cave whose opening resembled the mouth of a conch shell or contained some other auspicious sign was regarded as sacred. A conch shell was considered an emblem of power, authority and sovereignty to the ancient Chinese and Tibetan shamans. A blast from a conch shell was believed to banish evil spirits, scare away poisonous creatures and even avert natural disasters.

Many of these sacred sites are energetic power places and are endowed with strange cave formations, rocks, and landscapes. In ancient China, it was believed that the Earth Spirits (Nature Spirits) fed on the energetic nature of the Earth's Yin Elements. This is why, in the ancient Daoist traditions,

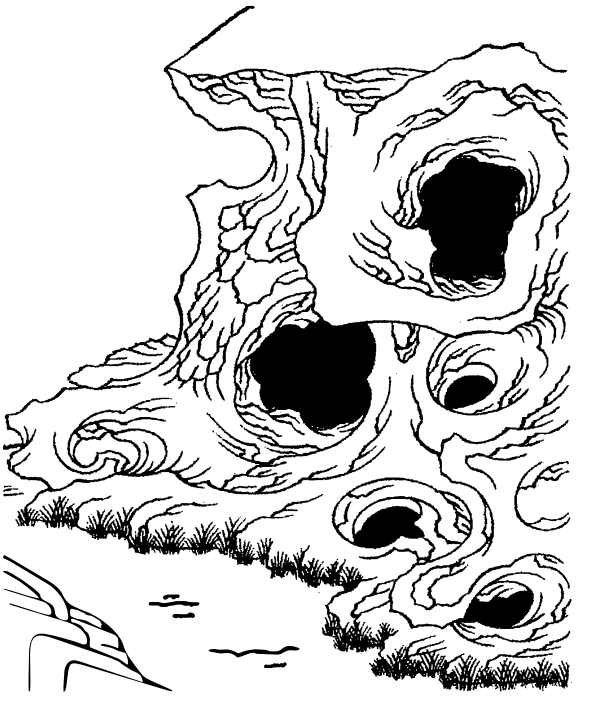


Figure 1.144. The sanctuary of a cave's opening symbolized the womb of the Earth, and the presence of freshwater in or nearby rendered it fertile. (Inspired from the original artwork of Robert Beer)

deep caves (which pooled the Earth's Yin energy) were sought after as places for transformational meditation. Throughout Tibet and the Himalayan mountains it is common to find imprints of hands, feet, or ritual objects impressed into cave walls or natural rock formations, displaying the miraculous energetic and spiritual accomplishments of various enlightened masters who frequented these places for deep meditation.

Caves and grottos that contained hot springs or "oracle" lakes were considered natural "self-generating" geological anomalies, and such places are often associated with miraculous activity.

The importance of meditation and training in a dark cavern within the Earth is that it allows the mystic to overcome the habitual need for external stimulation, allowing the mind to become still. The *Daodejing* states, "From the darkness comes the light," and "when stillness reaches its climax, it produces motion." These ancient proverbs

describe the quiescent training that can be experienced and perfected in cave meditation. As the physical tissues adjust to the quiescent darkness, the whole body slowly becomes filled with great light and vibration.

Modern research has shown that the humidity and lack of oxygen circulation in caves allows carbon dioxide to build up disproportionately within the geological cavern. The increased level of carbon dioxide contained within the cave helps enable the Daoist mystic to eject his or her spirit body from the shell of physical tissues (the physical body). Thus cave training increases the mystic's ability to Soul Travel and allows him or her to easily enter into deeper states of meditation.

The ancient Chinese observed that within the Earth are numerous caverns shaped like deep pools, shallow ponds, halls, and cavities. When the Wind blows into these caverns, the various openings can begin to vibrate, and their resonance can produce sounds ranging from low moans to loud thunderous roars. When meditating in a cave, these powerful vibrations often cause the Daoist mystic to feel his or her physical tissues vibrate like a reed. This is why the tone produced by the Wind was also known in ancient times as the "Voice of Heaven."

From a modern Feng Shui perspective, the "cave" is viewed as one's home or dwelling space. Whether a its a high rise apartment complex, condominium, or house, the important energetic factor is the type of Five Element shape surrounding one's living space (Figure 1.145).

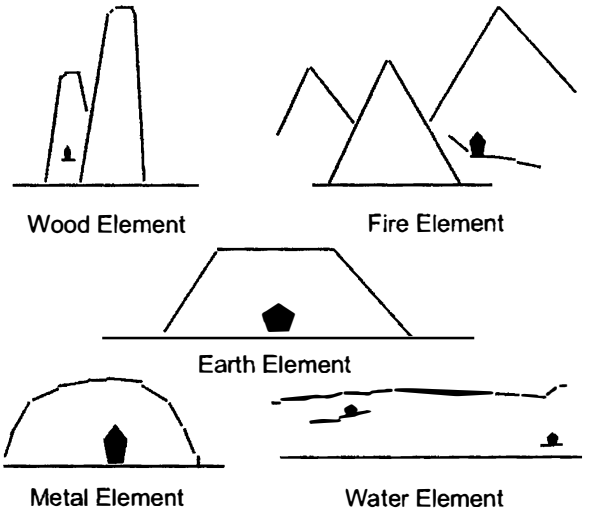


Figure 1.145. The Five Element Forms of Mountains and Hills

HISTORY OF CAVE MEDITATION

The ancient Daoists believed that mountain caves provided a means for practicing and cultivating inward stillness, away from towns and villages. Caves were sometimes known as "Di Fei" (Earth Lungs), and were believed to be filled with the concentrated Yin energy (cave) contained within a Yang (mountain) form.

In ancient China, caves were used to reconnect the hunter with the realm of nature spirits. Here the hunters came to invoke the spirit of the "master of animals," who controlled the fertility of the herds. They came to honor the spirits of the animals that would be taken for the tribe, and to call for the return of the dead beasts to renewed life. Therefore, when entering into a cave, the ancient Daoist mystics understood that they were coming into a place set apart, a place "between the worlds," where life and death met.

In Chinese culture, cave meditation is recognized as the most powerful way to develop intuition, perseverance, patience, and tranquility. Since ancient times, the deep cavern of a Daoist mystic's cave has been considered a place of spiritual power and transformation. Existing in utter darkness, far away from the light of the Sun, Moon, and Stars, a meditation cave is used as a vessel through which one's deepest journeys and most profound transformations can occur.

Because caves are places of mystery and are sometimes governed by the powers of the night, they were also used for secret initiations and mysterious ceremonies.

Entering into the cave is symbolic of entering into a cauldron of transformation. This dangerous passage begins with a journey into a cold earthen tomb to emotionally and spiritually die. At the same time, this spiritual passage also represents entering into the fertile womb of the Earth to again be reborn. In Daoist Cave Magic, this focus on

death and rebirth allows the mystic to fundamentally address what frightens him or her the most about the darkness and death. The purification act of descending into a dark pit is used as a process of personal dissolution and loss in which the mystic faces the worst that he or she can imagine.

Surrounded by the secluding solidity of Earth, the priest can shed the holdings and defenses that lock him or her into particular patterns and gain the freedom to "reform."

To "enter" the cave is to move "in." As such, it involves a direct movement towards the core self and away from peripheral self. By moving towards a deeper connection with one's self and away from the superficial. Like water, the mystic is gravitationally drawn towards the center. Therefore the cave acts like a kind of energetic magnet; its Yin drawing the mystic towards his or her core Yang self. Unlike spirit travel, which allows the priest to ascend into the Heavenly world (with its images of lightness, flight, travel, farseeing, swelling energy, and power), the cave journey involves an inward and downward spiral.

The cave is always an interiority. Its direction is inward, but it is also down. As an interior hollow, the heart is hidden; it is a intimate personal place of darkness and isolation.

When entering the cave, the mystic symbolically travels far away from normal life activities, and enters into unchanging darkness, allowing him or her the ability to return to the source of all things, and reconnect with the true place of power. The mystic enters willingly into the cave. In the cave, the mystic finds danger, fear, rebellion, disillusion, and finally death, then transformation.

Five Element and Eight Trigram Correspondences

According to ancient tradition, before choosing a cave to practice meditation (sometimes refered to as "Dark Room" training), the Daoist priest would first determine the mountain's Five Element Correspondence and then ascertain the cave's Eight Trigram Correspondence. With this information, the priest knew what to expect from the energetic environment and could determine the best times to train. For example, if the priest determined that the dark chamber was a Wind (Trigram) Cave, existing within a Fire (Element) Mountain, it meant that during the summer time, the energy within the Fire Mountain would be at its peak. Since the cave also corresponds to the Wind Trigram and the Wood Element season, during the Spring time the Qi within the cave would be perfect for training Dream Magic and Spirit Travel. The Five Element Mountain Correspondence and the Eight Trigram Cave Correspondence are described as follows:

Five Element Mountain Correspondence

The ancient Daoists believed that the shape of every mountain or hill, and the direction of its watercourse, was related to one of the Five Element energetic patterns. The Five Element Mountain formations are geological patterns that symbolize the material expression of the Five Element energetic patterns. The Earth Qi in the various Five Element Mountain formations waxes and wanes in correspondence with the seasons and the positions of the planets, described as follows:

- **Wood Element:** A Wood Element Mountain Formation rises straight upward, and it is tall, slender, and steep, with a rounded or flat top. Because it looks straight, high, and slim, it was sometimes known in ancient China as a "Pen Mountain." Its season of power is spring, and its ruling planet is Jupiter.

  The Qi of nature is most powerful in Wood Element Mountain Formations during the spring time. Magical minerals and plants related to the Wood Element and the planet Jupiter were therefore harvested on Wood Element Mountain Formations during that time of the year, particularly during the spring equinox. The spring time is also considered to be the most auspicious time to energetically train the Hun (Ethereal Soul) on Wood Element Mountain Formations, and to practice Thunder Magic (especially during the first thunder storms of spring), Dream Magic, and Sex Magic.
- **Fire Element:** A Fire Element Mountain Formation rises upwards, coming to a sharp point like a peak. Because it has a broad base and

pointed peak, it was sometimes known in ancient China as a "Seal Mountain." Its season of power is summer, and its ruling planet is Mars.

The Qi of nature is most powerful in Fire Element Mountain Formations during the summer time. Magical minerals and plants related to the Fire Element and the planet Mars were therefore harvested on Fire Element Mountain Formations during that time of the year, especially during the summer solstice. The summer time is also considered to be the most auspicious time to energetically train the Yuan Shen (Eternal Soul or Original Spirit) on Fire Element Mountain Formations and to practice the cultivation of the Immortal Fetus or Golden Child (i.e., Soul Travelling).

- **Earth Element:** An Earth Element Mountain Formation is squared and boxed, with the top forming a plateau. Because it has a round body and a flat peak, it was sometimes known in ancient China as a "Drum Mountain." Its season of power is late summer, and its ruling planet is Saturn.

  The Qi of nature is most powerful in Earth Element Mountain Formations during the late summer. Magical minerals and plants that related to the Earth Element and the planet Saturn were therefore harvested on Earth Element Mountain Formations during that time of the year. The late summer is also considered to be the most auspicious time to energetically train the Yi (Intention and proposed goal of fulfilling Heaven's Mandate) on Earth Element Mountain Formations and to practice spiritual cultivation of the esoteric powers of the Yellow Court (used in all magical incantations and invocations).
- **Metal Element:** A Metal Element Mountain Formation is curved with the top being gently rounded. Because it is round on the top and broad at the base, it was sometimes known in ancient China as a "Bell Mountain." Its season of power is autumn, and its ruling planet is Venus.

  The Qi of nature is most powerful in Metal Element Mountain Formations during the autumn time. Magical minerals and plants related to the Metal Element and the planet Venus were therefore harvested on Metal Element Mountain Formations during that time of the year, especially during the autumn equinox. The autumn time is also considered to be the most auspicious time to energetically train the Po (Corporeal Soul) on Metal Element Mountain Formations and to practice Nei Gong (Internal Skill) cultivation techniques.
- **Water Element:** A Water Element Mountain Formation is wavy, with an irregular surface, and contours that resemble the wavelike patterns of a lake or river. It has a flat top and was sometimes known in ancient China as a "Jade Belt Mountain." Its season of power is winter, and its ruling planet is Mercury.

  The Qi of nature is most powerful in Water Element Mountain Formations during the winter time. Magical minerals and plants related to the Water Element and the planet Mercury were therefore harvested on Water Element Mountain Formations during that time of the year, especially during the winter solstice. The winter time is also considered to be the most auspicious time to energetically train the Zhi (Will Power) on Water Element Mountain Formations, and to practice the cultivation and refinement of Jing Qi.

THE EIGHT TRIGRAM CAVE CORRESPONDENCE

When walking into a cave for magical cultivation practice, each of the various turns in the cave can be associated with a specific Yin or Yang energetic pattern. Turning to the left is considered to be Yang, while turning to the right is considered to be Yin.

When a priest enters into a cave, three turns are required in order to achieve adequate darkness (a prerequisite for Dark Room retreat practice). Each turn is attributed to either a Yin (- -) or Yang (---) Yao. When combined together, the three Yaos complete a magical trigram that enables the priest to cultivate the subtle Earth energies using the esoteric understanding of the Bagua.

The entrance of a cave represents an energetic portal into the infinite space of the Wuji. The ancient Daoists imagined this entrance to be a sacred pathway leading to the subtle energies of the first

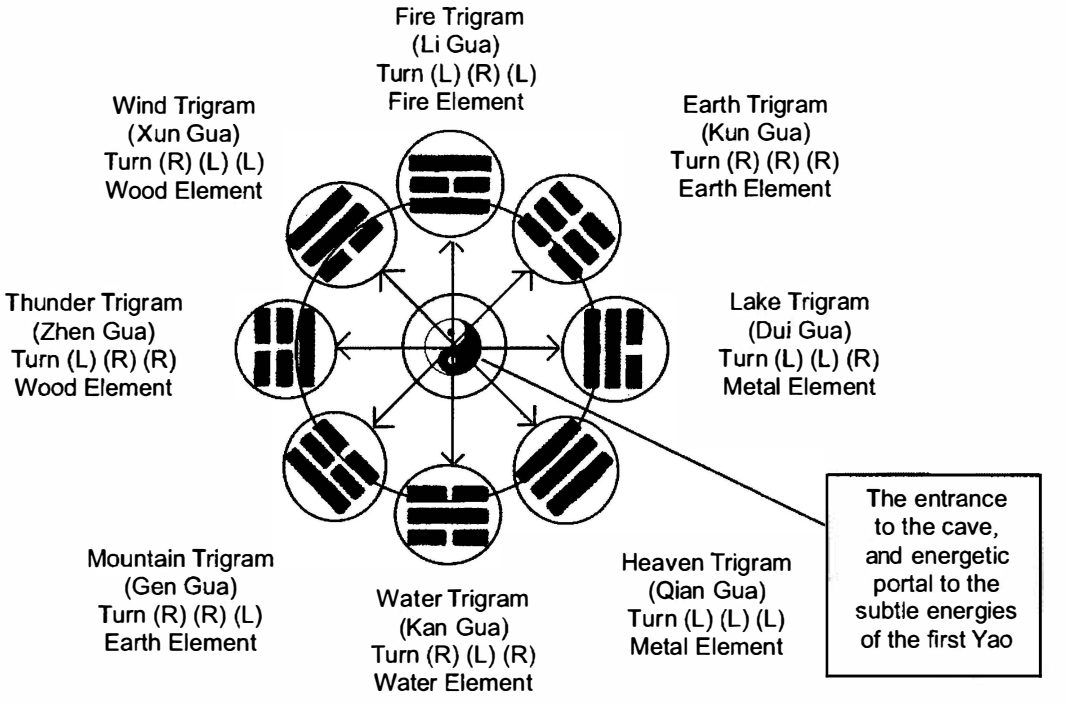


Figure 1.146. Bagua Cave Formations

Yao (Figure 1.146). The Eight Trigram Cave Correspondences are described as follows:

- **The Zhen Gua (Thunder Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the left, then to the right, followed by another right, the cave can be considered a Zhen Gua Cave. The Zhen Gua Cave corresponds to the Wood Element and represents the "first impulse" or creative stimulation of Qi. It is an excellent cave in which to begin the process of awakening consciousness.
- **The Xun Gua (Wind Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the right, then to the left, followed by another left, the cave can be considered a Xun Gua Cave. The Xun Gua Cave corresponds to the Wood Element and the energy of emotions and feeling sensations. It is an excellent cave in which to begin the process of training inner development of pure transformation.
- **The Li Gua (Fire Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the left, then to the right, followed by a turn towards the left, the cave can be considered a Li Gua Cave. The Li Gua Cave corresponds to the Fire Element and the energy of maturity and vitality. It is an excellent cave in which to begin the process of training the full development of consciousness.
- **The Kun Gua (Earth Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the right, then to the right, followed by another right, the cave can be considered a Kun Gua Cave. The Kun Gua Cave corresponds to the Earth Element and the state of openness, receptivity, and fertility. These spiritual virtues will occur after the priest has attained a high level of spiritual maturity.
- **The Dui Gua (Lake Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the left, then to the left, followed by a turn towards the right, the cave can be considered a Dui Gua Cave. The Dui Gua Cave corresponds to the Metal Element and is an excellent cave in which to train perceptive contemplation and internal reflection.

- **The Qian Gua (Heaven Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the left, then to the left, followed by another left, the cave can be considered a Qian Gua Cave. The Qian Gua Cave corresponds to the Metal Element and the creative forces. It is an excellent cave in which to awaken, stimulate, and activate an internal connection to the divine mind.
- **The Kan Gua (Water Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the right, then to the left, followed by a turn towards the right, the cave can be considered a Kan Gua Cave. The Kan Gua Cave corresponds to the Water Element and is an excellent cave in which to access spiritual depth and maturity.
- **The Gen Gua (Mountain Trigram) Cave:** When entering a cave, if the priest first turns towards the right, then to the right, followed by a turn towards the left, the cave can be considered a Gen Gua Cave. The Gen Gua Cave corresponds to the Earth Element and is an excellent cave in which to train quiescence, inwardness, and completion.

PREPARATION FOR CAVE MEDITATION

Cave Meditation is a prominent practice in Daoist priesty. As a magical tool, the meditation cave is used as an alchemical chamber in which the Daoist priest is able to accelerate the transformation of his or her physical, energetic, and spiritual bodies. There are many references to this type of training described throughout China's ancient history.

One of the primary functions of Daoist Cave Meditation is the isolation of the priest from external sound and light. While enveloped within the terrestrial Yin and meditating within the submerged darkness of the cave, the intensification of energy in the Daoist priest's Yintang (Third Eye) stimulates his or her pineal gland. As the pineal gland becomes stimulated, it overflows with neurotransmitters that awaken the higher brain, enabling the priest to more easily manipulate and imprint patterns in his or her brain. At this stage, the brain becomes aware of the functions of its own nervous system, and the priest's imagination begins to externalize, projecting outwards. The priest then activates his or her clairvoyant, clairsentient, and clairaudient powers.

This type of training is equivalent to a spiritual death and rebirth. Therefore as a solo retreat, the individual begins by committing to a time period of anywhere from three to five days to start. Later, a two to three week time period can be undertaken.

This training is not meant to be a one-hour morning or evening sitting. It is important to continue training in the cave for the entire predetermined time. This enables the priest to repeatedly create and dwell in a natural state of emptiness as often and as long as possible. Cave meditation training is not meant to cause a fleeting experience, but rather a profound spiritual state that is absorbed deep into the priest's entire being, all the way down to the cellular level.

GUIDELINES FOR CAVE TRAINING

When practicing Cave Meditation, it is important to understand that this training also entails a personal vow of silence (i.e., except for necessary contact with your support person). While living in this type of solitude situation, all food and other necessities should be attended to before starting. It is also important that minimal or no disturbance occurs, and that the mystic not leave the premises.

Before entering the cave it is helpful to develop and follow a check list, some helpful things to add to this list should include the following:

- Pay all necessary bills in advance,
- Stock up on food, water, toiletries, etc.,
- Place a message on your answering machine and auto-responder for email that you are in retreat for the ensuing period of time.
- Make sure the proper sitting meditation and sleeping areas are taken care of.

One must be totally committed to this transformational process in order to get more than just superficial results. The rules for cave meditation are as follows:

- No books
- No tapes
- Keep note-taking as minimal as possible

- Cancel out all thoughts as soon as noticed
- Stay put as much as you can
- Spend maximum time (at least 10 hours per day) sitting in meditation.

To help moderate comfort, several times a day stretch and if need be lay down. However, still maintain the state of mind of releasing and letting go. Determinedly, refuse thoughts and any other input. It is important to eliminate, not create, movement and thought.

DIET

The participant is encouraged to engage in a healthy preparatory diet and bowel cleansing process, commencing 4 weeks before entering the cave. Diet should be rich in Vitamin D, beta-carotene and colon cleansing, calcium/magnesium and zinc.

Additional supplements of vitamin D, calcium (2,000 gms.), magnesium (500 mg.), zinc, will prepare and enhance the body's capacity for this training.

In addition, it is suggested that participants also increase their daily intake of seaweed and blue green algae approximately four weeks before the retreat. Bring along a good supply of both as wells vitamin C, D, magnesium and zinc into the cave. This will enable essential amino acids and enzymes required by the body and third eye, to produce the neurotransmitters needed to experience the heightened states of enlightenment.

When talking about the practical procedure, my teacher emphatically drew our attention to the need to abstain from food that is fatty, stinking, spicy, or scented in nature. He insisted that the fatty or stinking flavored food is capable of sinking and contaminating the body's Qi; while the spicy or scented food is capable of raising and dispersing the body's Qi. When induced to sink or become contaminated, the gathered and concentrated life-force energy will become rebellious and difficult to compress; when raised and dispersed, the gathered and concentrated energies will drift away and become difficult to gather.

He reminded us that the ideal diet is to be mostly composed of vegetables. However, it is important to not to gorge yourself when hungry, because it could stir the internal energy and lead to the disturbance of mind-will (Shen Zhi). Therefore, for best results, we were told to always eat food in a moderate way.

It was also recommended that we adhere to a diet of fruit (or dried fruit) and other lightweight foods, with tea and lots of water to avoid dehydration. The focus is not to stress your body through starvation, but to consume a diet containing high, clean, direct energy, which is the nature of a fruit.

Food necessities can be delivered to someplace distant from you (i.e., near the entry-way of the cave) by your support person once a week, if necessary.

In preparation, fresh juices and soups should be consumed for breakfast and a light organic meal for lunch. The preparation diet should consists of a simple, often liquid type of food. Seaweed and blue green algae meet many of the general dietary requirements, supplying high concentrations of the eight essential amino acids required by the body. Fresh juices, especially from the noni (Morinda) fruit, supply the metabolic enzymes necessary for developing the neuro-endocrine system to its highest potential.

Sufficient levels of tryptophan are especially important for an optimal cave meditation experience. Tryptophan is one of 20 amino acids that are the basic building blocks of proteins. It is one of the eight essential amino acids, meaning it cannot be synthesized by the body from other amino acids, and must therefore be ingested in foods. Adults need from 3.5 mg/kg/day to 350-500 mg of tryptophan per day. As tryptophan crosses the blood-brain barrier, it is converted to serotonin with the assistance of vitamins B6, B12, and folate.

Tryptophan is also converted in the body to niacin (vitamin B-3) and picolinic acid. Giving high doses of vitamin B-6 along with tryptophan increases its conversion to niacin and decreases its uptake into the nervous system. Low blood tryptophan levels have been reported in depressed patients and are corrected with tryptophan supplementation. Tryptophan is better absorbed in the brain when consumed as part of a high carbohydrate meal.

Some of the tryptophan-rich foods recommended for cave meditation training, are listed as follows:

Almonds,
Animal protein: beef, chicken, turkey
Bananas
Brewer's yeast
Brown rice
Cottage cheese
Dates
Figs
Fish and other forms of seafood
Legumes
Malt
Milk and milk products
Peanuts
Seaweed (blue-green algae or Spirulina)
Soy nuts
Tofu, soy milk, soy yogurt, soy beans
Watermelon seeds

THE 9 DIETS OF DAOIST MAGIC CAVE TRAINING

In ancient China, there were 9 special diets that a Daoist priest was conditioned to adhere to when cave training to cultivate the Golden Fetus. Each of these unique diets required special type of preparation in additional to the cave meditation training. According to Master Red Pine, in the *High-Pure Lord's 9-Forms Scripture*, the 9 diets assigned to a Daoist priest when performing cave meditation are described as follows:

- **The 1st Diet (Eating Grain):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a diet composed of mostly millet and wheat.
- **The 2nd Diet (Eating Vegetables):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a diet composed of mostly vegetables and fungus.
- **The 3rd Diet (Fasting):** This eating pattern consisted of not eating food, but existing on a diet composed of drinking specialized magical elixirs.
- **The 4th Diet (Eating Qi):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a secret diet of only magical Talisman Water.
- **The 5th Diet (Eating Yellow Sprouts):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a secret magical diet composed of a special alchemical transformed Lead (Kidney Water) and Mercury (Heart Fire). The ancient Daoists texts state: "When the Dragon and Tiger copulate; the yellow sprouts are born."

According to the *Daojiao Dan ("Discussion on the Cavity of the Dao")*, the alchemical difference between Lead and Mercury is as follows: "The spirit within the mind is called the "original nature of mercury." The original nature of mercury, is accumulated in the Yellow Pavilion. The vapor of the body is the essence of lead."

"The generative essence within the mind is called the "fluid of mercury." The fluid of mercury, is accumulated in the Purple Pavilion. The generative essence of the body is the splendor of lead."

- **The 6th Diet (Swallowing Light):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a magical diet of celestial light from the Northern Dipper Stars.
- **The 7th Diet (Ingesting Vapor and Mist):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a magical diet composed of ingesting vapors and mists from the Qi of the Four Directions.
- **The 8th Diet (Absorbing Primordial Vapor):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a magical diet of absorbing the primordial vapors that exist within the infinite space of the Wuji.
- **The 9th Diet (Feeding Like the Fetus in a Womb):** This eating pattern consisted of existing on a magical diet composed of the only Divine Qi.

ADDITIONAL ADVICE

It is imperative to leave any light-emitting device outside of the cave. The eyes and our perception will become extremely sensitive to the least bit of illumination; even the faintest leakages of light, such as a watch dial or LED, will disturb the environment. Therefore, do not bring illuminated clocks and watches, flashlights, flash cameras, palm pilots, cell phones, etc.

Make sure that all clothing and personal items that you will need for the period of training are in order. Create a way of laying out the different items so that you can easily determine what you

are selecting. Organization and order can make everyday functioning much easier.

It is important to take care of all personal business before entering the cave, such as letters, phone calls, etc., and to plan on total isolation from the outside world for the duration of the retreat.

Bring sunglasses and eye-shades to readjust to the light when you leave the cave.

Best Time for Cave Meditation

The Winter Solstice is the perfect time for a dark retreat. This "shortest day of the year" is synonymous for the "maximum of Yin energy," since is it the day when our hemisphere spends the longest time in the dark. Because Yin energy is related to and is often defined as darkness, quiet, receiving, calming, yielding, and feminine energies, it is more introspective and internal when compared to her counterpart, Yang energy. In Daoist alchemical texts, she is called "The Dark Feminine."

Freeing The Mind

The core of this spiritual liberation technique is to completely empty and free the mind. This means reducing all mental and physical activities as close to zero as possible. It is within this absolutely quiet and empty space that we have an extremely powerful impactive experience of our true core self. As the Shen Zhi (Acquired Mind) is stripped down and allowed to empty out, the Yuan Shen (Congenital Mind) reunites with the Shen Xian (Eternal Soul) and the unforgettable experience of true liberation is achieved.

Cave training is not meant for simply touching this experience. Most individuals who enter the cave have already experienced such an awakening at least once in their lives or they would not even be on the spiritual path. Such spiritual encounters are an essential part of the inspirations that motivate us. In order to be effective, cave training usually involves a minimum of two to three weeks dwelling in that space, supported by just a few, albeit extremely powerful, insights. The sole purpose is to become, rather than to just touch.

Beginners will generally encounter both physical and mental resistance, however, with time, patience, and an attitude of "this too shall pass," the mystic will become accustomed to the new environment. Breath awareness is perhaps the simplest and most direct meditation technique to accomplish the task of becoming accustomed to the new environment. Every time a thought is recognized, be determined to cancel that thought immediately, and return to breath awareness and body awareness. On the outgoing breath, let-go of mind, emotions, body tensions, and so on.

The Breakthrough

Once the mystic has completely emptied the mind of all of its acquired emotions and experiences, he or she experiences a quiescent state of emptiness, freedom and light. The mystic now realizes that all of the internal beliefs he or she has been clinging to has only existed within his or her mind and emotions. Therefore, in reality, none of it ever existed as truth, only as the perceived and accepted internal and cultural programming.

When we actually dwell deeply, repeatedly, and continuously in the experience of emptiness and nothingness, we gradually realize that all our internal despair is gone, and it never actually was what we perceived it to be. It then becomes obvious that there is no need or wish to re-internalize and allow any of those beliefs to resurface. This is one reason why mystics in all religions and traditions eventually seek solitude in places such as caves, forests, deserts, or mountains.

Stages of Experience

Within the first 3 days, an individual will generally experience waves of overpowering sleep (making up for any sleep deficiency and overtaxation of the body) and slowly learns to relax their body and mind. At first, due to the complete isolation from external light, the pineal gland floods the brain with the neurotransmitter melatonin. This causes the initial sleeping pattern to normally regulate itself between 12-14 hours a day.

Once the pineal gland overflows the somatic neurotransmitters, the individual's brain awakens and begins to experience an electrical shift in the core brain. This transformation allows the individual to perceive life anew, from the Earth's energetic womb.

During days 3-5, the pineal gland begins to increase the production of "Pinoline," inducing a greater fluidity of thought and healing energy within the body's tissues. This transitional period allows for the projection of the spirit body. When the pinoline is triggered, the individual also activates his or her clairvoyant, clairsentient and clairaudient powers. They may now see lights and visions, hear music, and gain phenomenal insights.

Between days 6-8, the pineal gland starts to produce the neurohormone 5-MeO-DMT. This psychoactive tryptamine is considered to be highly luminescent; it is also extremely phosphorescent due to the amount of phosphene that it transmits onto the visual cortex. The neurotransmitter 5-MeO-DMT is normally only active when we are in the womb and within the first months of our lives. While in the darkness of the cave, it switches on 40% more of the cerebral cortex and suddenly awakens the nervous system to become self-aware. It is this empathogenic neurotransmitter that expands the spirit body and gives rise to the awakening of the individual's telepathic skills. The flood of the neurotransmitter 5-Meo-DMT also discharges the darkness from the dark room of the cave, causing a bright light to become suddenly activated. This vibrant white light is the manifestation of the individual's spirit body, which enables his or her to externally project.

During days 9-12, there is now enough "Mono Amine Oxidase Inhibition" triggered by the Pinoline, to allow the pineal gland's "serotonin to melatonin cycle" to become intercepted by adrenaline and ephedrine activity and converted into a "serotonin-DMT pathway." When the body's DMT (DiMethylTryptamine) levels reach more than 25mg, the individual's meditative experience can become extremely visual (the DMT is considered to be the visual third eye neurotransmitter). The DMT enables the spirit body to journey into the various interdimensional realms of time and space.

While in this altered state, the individual can now observe how he or she filters reality and sees the inter-activity by which the world of matter is perceived as a hologram of projected images. When the individual comes out of the cave and observes the light particles coming in through his or her eyes, there is a suddenly awareness of how everything that he or she sees is actually created within the mind. Even colors become an experience of the individual's mind, created by the brain according to ones own experience. As the individual begins to understand that they create visual holograms of the outside world, they are freed to change, adjust and reprogram this mental filter in order to see a wider band of waves (generally, we see less than 0.5% of 100% actual waves emanations in the objective universe), and easily experience the vision of higher dimensions.

At this state, the individual experiences this universal hologram not as an illusion, but realize that everything is connected and all are a part of the Dao. All of the experiences within the cave begins to show the individual the different versions by which he or she can construct reality from the consciousness. That is one of the most valuable tools in Daoist sorcery, as it can exposes the master to the various energetic and spirit realms in which he or she exists.

While meditating within the cave, the individual senses and intuitions becomes super-alert. One can go into a much higher activated brain state and start to interact consciously with the Yuan Shen. This actually only happens in lucid dream training, Spirit Travel, and Soul Travel. In the darkness of the cave, the mystic can dream while being awake. Sound transforms into vision, the body's nervous system becomes aware of itself, and the sense of one's being increases. The intention is to root ones Shen Zhi (Acquired Mind) so deeply that the spiritual realm of the dream world synthesizes with the individual's Yuan Shen (Original Spirit).

In the Cave the Daoist will utilize several techniques that enable him or her the ability to projection into the infinite space of the Wuji and experience Spirit Travel (Traveling Clairvoyance or Remote Viewing) and Soul Travel (Astral Projection).

ENDING THE TRAINING

The end of the training is really just the beginning. Similar in training to that of ending several weeks of a food fast, the mystic will now face the problem of information overload and sensory over-stimulation when trying to reenter society. It is therefore encouraged to begin by first sitting in a secluded garden for a bit after coming out of the sacred space of the cave.

After leaving the cave and reentering the material world, several Daoist mystics suggest that the individual practice two to three hours of meditation in the morning for the first week, focusing on the Lower Dantian (or on the Middle Dantian for women who are menstruating). This allows the mystic to "root" his or her mind. In the evening before sleep, the mystic is to focus on the Upper Dantian area (in third eye and crown). This helps solidify the mystic's new state of awakened mind, as he or she reintegrates with the physical world.

SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH

Dr. Callaway of the University of Kuopio, Finland, has conclusive evidence that the Near Death Experience, Out Of Body Experience, and death itself, are based on Pinoline, DMT (DiMethyl-Tryptamine), and 5meoDMT release. Every night we produce Pinoline (6meoTHBC), 5meoDMT, and DMT. Lucid dreams are induced by DMT.

The DMT and 5meoDMT act on the T-RNA messengers which carry out the protein synthesis for the body's DNA. This reaction allows for the rebuilding of the body's cells, tissues, and organs. The DMT and 5meoDMT are harmonics of Pinoline, and therefore can transduce the superconducting perfect information and energy into practical genetic regulation (Figure 1.147).

At birth, our brains are flooded with 5meoDMT, becoming 40% more active and open. When we are in puberty, the Pineal gland begins to calcify, and we start to loose contact with clairvoyant intuitions.

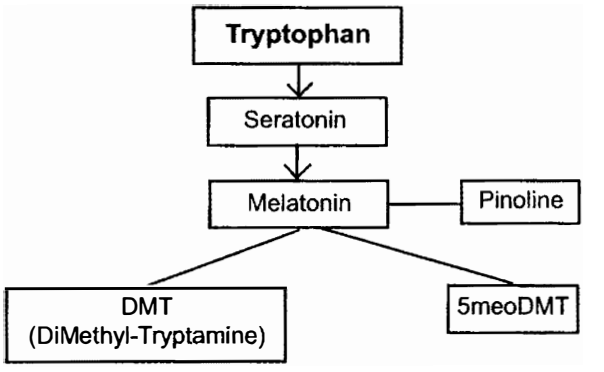


Figure 1.147. The amino acid Trypophan is the precursor for Seratonin, Melatonen, Pinoline, 5meoDMT, and DMT molecules.

Living in absolute darkness during cave meditation floods the brain with Melatonin, and forces the pineal gland to produce hormones and become active. Once there is a threshold of Melatonin, then Pinoline results. Normally, after 20 minutes of sleep we produce Pinoline, which the Pineal gland produces from Melatonin. After several hours, the brain cells are saturated, and the Serotonin brain cells become filled.

After some 4-7 days the 5meoDMT begins to awaken. At this stage, the individual can see images in 3-dimensional Holograms, and the thoughts behind the language.

After 10-12 days the individual begins to see in infra red, and ultra violet patterns. At this stage, the mystic can actually walk across the cave room and touch a person, by seeing the resonations of their heat patterns. The 3-dimensional Hologram Images exteriorize and one is suddenly consciously walking within the spiritual realm of the dream world.

Remember that, while practicing Cave Meditation, a diet consisting of algaes and other high protein, enzyme rich and amino acid tryptophan rich foods can aid in the acceleration of the brain's production of Pinoline, DMT, 5meoDMT.

"THE IMAGINED CAVE" MEDITATION

The following meditation is designed to help the mystic experience the inner spiritual process of transformation. The initial goal is to bring the mystic face to face with the illusions and distractions that inhibit his or her spiritual growth. It also allows for the integration of the conscious self (the mystic's personality) with the Divine Self.

In the following practice, the mystic will need to create a sacred spiritual place of sanctuary by him or herself through the projection of their thoughts and emotions. By doing this kind of inner work, the mystic is assisting his or her soul in pouring into their psyche the special qualities and powers needed to unfold higher levels of consciousness. The mystic is also helping to better understand the mystery of who he or she really is.

Each of the phases of this work will unfold the mystic's internal process of transformation and energize seed ideas for his or her awakening and enlightenment. When performed in the right frame of mind, the mystic will develop stable patterns within his or her psyche in a natural way. The symbols the mystic will be working with were considered by the ancient Daoist priests to be the universal keys needed in order to open one's inner-self to the powerful subtle energies within one's being. Therefore, the mystic should only begin the cave meditations after he or she sure that they understand all the various steps.

- Begin by performing the "One Through Ten" and the "Three Invocations." These meditations are designed to purify you of any toxic Qi and help you enter a higher spiritual state of mind.
- When you are ready, invite your intuitive subconscious mind to accompany you on this inner journey. If you wish, you can ask your intuitive subconscious mind to take the image of a special symbolic form (i.e., an angel or other spiritual guide). This energetic form allows your intuitive subconscious mind to choose how it wants to appear and interact with you. Always accept the first impression that comes.
- Imagine, see, and feel yourself as a hermit entering into a dark cave. Experience this feeling as real. In this dark and humid place, begin to reflect on your life, focusing on who you think you are, and what you have done.
- Look at all of the events in your life and relive the most important experiences.
- As you watch the various images unfold, and observe the ego patterns that you have created, imagine that you were viewing yourself in a movie, watching these experiences from your impersonal observer.
- At all times during your introspection, remember to remain in touch with the center of pure consciousness and from a neutral point of view.
- Reflect on all of the qualities that you have developed and come to know well.
- Rekindle your goals and aspirations.
- Let your spirit guide be the witness of all of your secret and personal reflections, and if you feel that you need its assistance, ask for it. You will find this period of self-discovery rewarding because it will bring up forgotten memories that need to be consciously discarded.

Try to spend time in your imaginary cave everyday, especially in the morning and at night before going to sleep. Do not attempt to fantasize or imagine things happening around you. Try only to remain calm and meditative even in your visualization.

It is important to create a healing space and sanctuary within yourself in order to invite the subtle subconscious impulses coming from your Eternal Soul to assist you in this inner process. This inner space allows you to let go of everything that you no longer need.

You are learning to let go of all the illusions of the world and enter into a place within yourself where your inner desire for purification will unfold. Therefore your intent when practicing this meditation has to be real and powerful.

THE STUDY OF THE REALM OF PLANTS

INTRODUCTION TO THE ALCHEMICAL TRANSFORMATIONS OF PLANTS

Traditionally, Daoist priests have always lived on mountains or within forests where hundreds of medicinal plants grew. According to the *Classics of Mountains and Rivers,* ancient Daoist priests were known for creating the Elixir of Immortality and for the skillful use of a wide variety of medicinal substances. It was also said that these Daoist priests carried "death-banishing" medicinal herbs that they used to drive away sickness and evil spirits (Figure 1.148).

Since plants, like humans, are living things, it is easier to establish an energetic and spiritual relationship with the plant realm than it is to establish such a relationship with the metallic or mineral realm. In Daoist magic, the energetic and spiritual relationship with a plant substance (i.e., root, branch, leaves, fruit, seeds, etc.) is dependent on the level of a priest's psychic development. The effects the plant substance has on the priest's energy and consciousness are in direct proportion to the strength of the relationship the mystic has with the plant realm. This energetic transformation does not generally incur risk to the individual's consciousness and may also be purposefully initiated in order to bring about spiritual growth. The most powerful energetic and spiritual principles are found in the forces of fecundation (impregnation using essence, energy, and spirit) and reproduction (duplicating the essence, energy, and spiritual nature of a specific item). Focusing on these two primary principles, the ancient Chinese alchemists sought to master the energetic and spiritual extraction and utilization of the plant realm.

Each species of tree, shrub, plant, and herb has its own energetic quality and spiritual aspect. Plant Alchemy is neither chemistry nor hyperchemistry, but a biodynamic process more closely related to fermentation (or putrefaction) than to classical chemical reactions. Plant Alchemy leads to a profound knowledge of the fundamental mechanisms of nature, yet it is contrary to "normal" science which only considers the material aspect of these mechanisms. Unlike traditional herbology or biochemistry, Plant Alchemy also considers the spiritual aspect of the plant substance, which is generally invisible at first to the sensory perceptions of the disciple. The energetic and spiritual aspects of Daoist alchemical study bring the disciple to a higher level of spiritual consciousness. The study and understanding of all the qualities of the plant realm gives the Daoist disciple a great advantage in comprehending its true function and purpose (as opposed to simply studying its chemical nature in plant biology).

Figure 1.148. Herbology is both a science and an art

There is a difference between chemistry and alchemy. In chemistry, if you have the right ingredients, and if operations are correctly performed, success will be achieved -- irrespective of the operator. However, in Alchemy, even if you have the right ingredients and if operations are properly conducted, success is not necessarily achieved because it depends upon the personal state of the operator. In a very restrictive sense, Alchemy could be viewed as the parapsychology of chemistry, for the success of the operation depends upon the inner spiritual state of the operator. To succeed, the chemist must obey the laws of Nature, but the Alchemist must also, in his or her work, align him or her with the designs of Nature.

Chemistry does not view the body it works with as alive. The processes are such that chemistry only deals with dead bodies (which cannot evolve). Conversely, Alchemy is a biodynamic system which utilizes and manipulates the forces of life in its operations. It is a threefold magical system (i.e., purification, regeneration, and evolution) that focuses on the specific energetic effects of Qi transformations that occur within the human body.

HERBOLOGY

Herbal formulas have been used successfully to treat a variety of illnesses for well over 5000 years. Much of the Chinese medical research on pharmacology organized during the Qin (221-206 B.C.) and Han (206 B.C.-220 A.D.) Dynasties was recorded in the *Canon of Materia Medica of Shen Nong* (also known as the Canon of Herbal Medicine). This text contains 252 plants, 67 animals, and 46 minerals, and includes a brief description of the places of each herb's origin, secondary names, the specific forms and properties of each herb, and the curative powers of each part of the plant, animal, or mineral.

Herbal medicine was the historical precursor to pharmaceutical medicines. Today, herbs still provide the source and inspiration for the majority of the pharmaceuticals used in modern Western medicine, including those utilized for the treatment of viral and bacterial diseases, pain, tumors, chronic diseases, internal and external tissue regeneration, and many other infirmities.

Herbology is both a science and an art. An herbalist spends many years studying the herbs used to create herbal formulas. The herbalist must also understand the energetic effects of each individual herb, and the synergistic effects of herbal combinations and formulas.

Herbs can be used for tonifying, purging, dispersing, warming, cooling, nourishing the Yin, nourishing the Yang, and clearing heat, as well as for moving Qi, Blood, Phlegm, and Fluids within the body. They cause the Qi in the body to either ascend or descend, and primarily affect either the upper or the lower portions of the body. Thus, Chinese herbs are categorized according to the nature and effect that they produce on the Qi of the body.

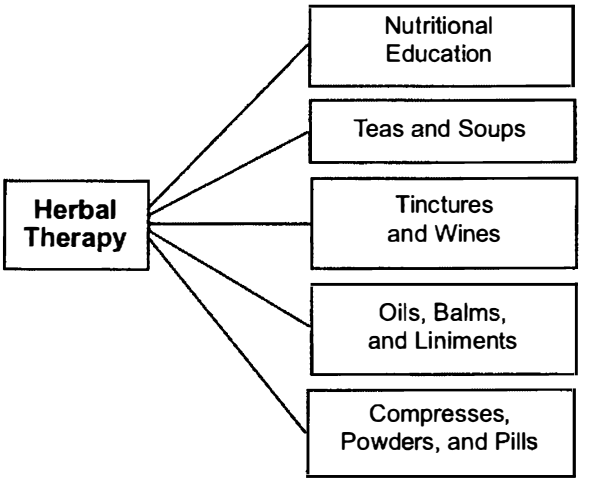


Figure 1.149. The Five Main Branches of Chinese Herbal Therapy

Chinese medicine prescribes specific parts of plants (flowers, leaves, stems, seeds, roots, bark, etc.) for particular medicinal purposes. Parts of trees, shrubs, herbs, vines, and flowers are selected for their specific properties (hot, warm, neutral, cool, and cold) and taste (sour, bitter, sweet, pungent, and salty). These properties either tonify or disperse Qi and Blood.

Chinese medicinal herbology includes the cultivation and gathering of seeds, grains, fruits, flowers, leaves, barks, stems, and roots. Non-herbal components such as minerals, fish, animals, or insect parts are sometimes added to enhance the herbs' healing effect.

Chinese herbs cure energetically by moving Qi in the channels. Each herb enters specific channels and affects different internal organs. Herbs are therefore an extremely powerful healing modality. The herbalist uses herbs to tonify (strengthen) and move Qi and Blood as well as to eliminate heat from the patient's Blood. When tailored to an individual's constitution or combined into a formula for specific symptoms, herbs can be an invaluable aid in restoring and maintaining the health of the body. Taking an improper herb or herbal formula can have potentially deleterious effects.

Chinese herbal therapy includes five major clinical applications: nutritional education (food and diet); teas and soups (tang); tinctures and

wines (jin); oils, balms, and liniments (you and gao); and compresses, powders (san), and pills (wan). These five primary branches are described as follows (Figure 1.149):

1. **Nutritional Education:** This clinical application is used in order to assist patients in choosing the correct foods for their body's nourishment and optimum health, as well as for the treatments of disease. Similar to herbs, foods have many healing properties and can be used as seasonal prescriptions. An old Chinese saying stresses the importance of diet by asking the question, "Are herbs food or food herbs?"

   During China's Six Dynasties period (420-581 A.D.), the main concern of a doctor was maintaining a patient's health by means of diet, herbal prescriptions and physical exercise. As a result, two types of medical literature developed in China: books that focused on nourishing life and the classics of diet.
2. **Teas and Soups:** This clinical application consists of water-based herbal formulas traditionally prepared from raw or processed herbal ingredients. These are ingested for the treatment of internal and external disorders whether acute or chronic in nature.
3. **Tinctures and Wines:** This clinical application consists of alcohol-based herbal formulas. Tinctures are concentrated alcohol-based formulas prepared from raw herbs that are used in small doses for treatment (similar to teas and soups). Wines are traditionally applied externally to alleviate pain or ingested as a tonic, depending on the specific formula and the disease being treated.
4. **Oils, Balms, and Liniments:** This clinical application consists of oil-based herbal formulas, usually applied externally for the treatment of muscle, tendon, and ligament trauma, to alleviate pain, disperse Excess Qi, or to draw Qi into specific areas for tonification.
5. **Compresses, Powders, and Pills:** This clinical application consists of herbs that have been pulverized into a powder. Compresses are made into a paste or poultice and are then applied externally for the treatment of acute or chronic injuries. Powdered herbs can also be formed into teas, crackers, cakes, pastries and honey-based candies. They are ingested for internal organ tonification and rebalancing of the body's energy systems. Pills are herbs specifically prepared from traditional formulas, rolled into little balls, and orally ingested for the treatment of internal disorders.

Superior, Medium, and Inferior Herbs

According to ancient Daoist text *Redoubled Yang's Fifteen Discourses*, "all medicinal herbs are the flourishing emanations of mountains and waterways, the essential florescence of plants and trees. If one is willing to study them as essences, one can enliven the innate nature and destiny of others."

Virtually all plants and herbs have significant medicinal potential. Additionally, the ancient Chinese shaman healers explored and documented the specific medicinal potentials of various animal and mineral substances. Over a period of 5,000 years, the Chinese materia medica has accumulated information on the medicinal uses of over 30,000 plant, animal, and mineral substances; of these about 3,000 are of primary clinical importance, while 300 remain in common everyday use.

The ancient Chinese shaman healers divided the Plant Kingdom into several different categories, based on the plant's essential qualities and the level at which these qualities influenced the body's Jing, Qi, and Shen. This method of categorization existed until the Song Dynasty (960-1279 A.D.). After observing the ability of plants to infuse new life into the sick, the Plant Kingdom was divided into three separate divisions: Superior Herbs (tonics), Common Herbs (slightly toxic), and Inferior Herbs (toxic). The three methods of categorization are described as follows (Figure 1.150):

- **Superior Herbs:** These special magical plants and substances appeared, either by their shape or color, to contain the most concentrated form of "soul substance," and could therefore be used to obtain immortality. Rather than simply restore health and promote longevity, the soul substance of these various magical plants immediately enveloped, penetrated, and permeated the body-moistures (i.e., blood, sweat, saliva, tears, etc.), and body-vapors,

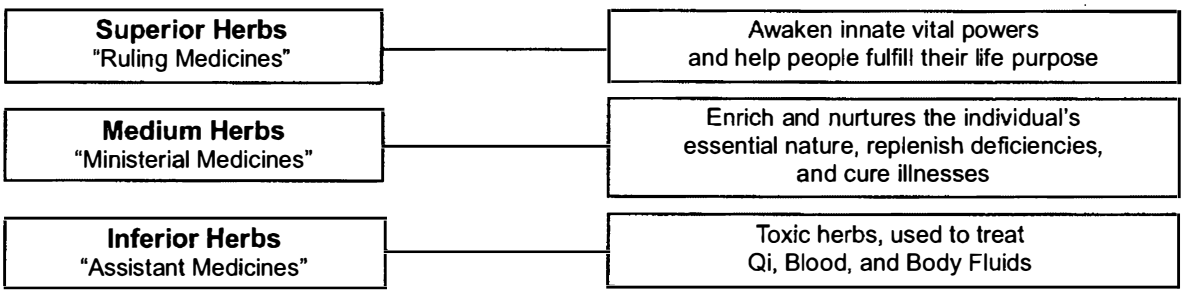


Figure 1.150. The Three Traditional Classes of Chinese Herbs (Materia Medica)

producing and enhancing the vital energy, vital odors, and vital colors of the tissues. Because they were specifically endowed with powerful Ling Shen ("Magical Spirit"), these special herbs were considered by the ancient Daoists to be the drugs of immortality.

According to ancient Daoist teaching, the plants that were believed to contain the greatest amount of soul-substance were those that grew in water and constantly absorbed moisture (like the "Fungus of Immortality"), or those that sprang up suddenly during a thunderstorm (like the "Red Cloud Herb").

Superior Herbs were believed to "feed" and restore the individual's Jing, Qi, Shen, and especially the Prenatal Wu Jing Shen (original spirit energies of the five Yin viscera). Specific herbal formulas (i.e., powders, pills, tinctures, elixirs, talismans, etc.) that contained the same qualities as Superior Herbs were commonly known as "Ling Yao" (drugs possessing Ling), Shen Yao (drugs containing spirit substance), or Xian Yao (drugs used by immortals).

This category of herbs included 120 varieties of superior medicinal substances. They affect the circulation and collection of internal Qi and Shen, and they are usually taken in conjunction with specific exercises and meditations. Certain herbs are only suitable for the body when the individual has attained a high level of both internal and external development; in addition, other herbs are only effective if the common blockages in certain energetic pathways have already been opened.

Considered in ancient times as the "ruling" medicines, these herbs are said to awaken our innate vital powers and help to fulfill our life purpose. Superior herbs (i.e., mushrooms; knotted fungus; the leaves, resin, or roots of a thousand year old pine, fir, or cypress tree; the ancient large fruits or kernels of certain plum, pear, jujube, or Nai trees; the ancient seeds of cassia, sesame, and Chinese Cinnamon trees, etc.) were also said to have an effect on the body's Jing, Qi, and Shen by making the body light, preventing old age, prolonging life, forestalling hunger, and creating advanced spirit travel abilities.

- **Medium Herbs:** Considered in ancient times as "ministerial" medicines, these herbs are said to enrich and nurture the individual's character and essential nature, replenish deficiencies, and cure illnesses. These herbs, however, should not be taken over a long period of time.

  This category of herbs included 120 varieties of moderate types of medicinal substances. Their curative properties are ideal for countering illness, strengthening the patient's constitution, helping to maintain general health, and strengthening the patient's immune system. Examples of Medium Herbs are bitter ginseng, Angelica, scallions, etc. The Ming Dynasty physician Liao Zhong-Chun wrote in his classic herbal pharmacopeia: *Annotated Divine Husbandman's Classic of the Materia Medica (Shen-Nong Ben-Cao Jing Shu)*, "the ministerial plant *Paedaria foetida* controls extremely poisonous magical infections; expels malignancies and evil influences; dispels killer-demons, plague, and pestilence; and eliminates spirit possession."
- **Inferior Herbs:** Considered in ancient times as "assistant" medicines, Inferior Herbs were used to remove disease, ward-off venomous

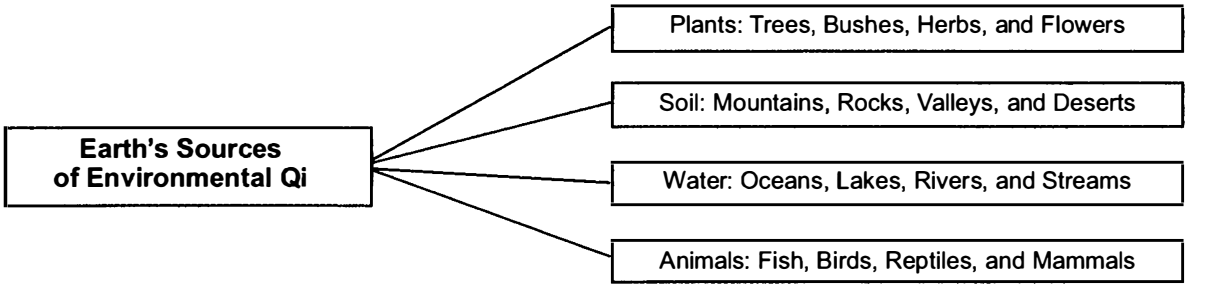


Figure 1.151. Earth's Sources of Environmental Qi

insects, and drive away demonic influences. They are mostly toxic and must be taken with caution when used to treat an individual's disease. Inferior herbs (e.g., aconite, peaches, plums, etc.) were said to have a curative effect on the body's Qi, Blood, and Body Fluids. This category of herbs included 120 varieties of inferior types of medicinal substances.

The Earth's Energetic Fields

The Earth's geomagnetic field exists as a supportive energetic cocoon. However, it is not uniform in strength and quality. For example, modern research has shown that this energetic field is twice as strong over North America and Russia then it is over Brazil (known as the Brazilian Low).

It is also interesting to note that the Earth's energetic field is always slightly stronger on the side of the planet facing away from the Sun's energetic influence. This difference in energetic field strength is due to the fact that without the Sun's energetic influence, the Earth's energetic field naturally extends outward into space. However, as one side of the Earth encounters the intense heat, light, and electromagnetic energy radiating outward from the Sun, the exposed half of the Earth's own energetic field immediately becomes compressed.

Additionally, modern research has concluded that because the Earth's longer energetic lines reach outward into space in the evening time, a stronger Earthly magnetic field passes through the body's tissues at night. At night, when the environment is not subject to the influence of intense solar radiation, the energetic lines in the ground extend far out into the atmosphere; it is therefore more beneficial to an individual's health to sleep at night, rather than to sleep in the daytime when the Earth's energetic field is subject to the pressures of daylight radiation.

Gathering Energy from Nature

The ability to gather energy from nature and the environment is extremely important to the Daoist priest. The energy of the Earth gathers and moves within the structural components of the planet, flowing like mighty rivers of Qi. It is infused into the terrain and vegetation, as well as into the water that we drink.

The ancient Daoists believed that the mineral realm manifests within the bones of the human body, and to a lesser extent, within the mineral substances contained in the blood. Additionally, it was also believed that the physical and energetic life of the human tissue resembled the life of the plant world, containing and manifesting energetic roots, branches, stems, and fruit. Therefore, specific attention was placed on understanding the interactions between the energy and patterns of living tissues (plants, animals, and humans) and the energy and patterns of the Earth.

The quality and quantity of environmental Qi is different in each geographic area (Figure 1.151) as it is the energy that has been collected from the structural components of the Earth itself (i.e., soil, fields, deserts, plants, trees, forests, mountains, streams, rivers, lakes, and oceans, etc.). The energetic potential of the Earth's Qi changes from Yang to Yin energy with the rising and setting of the Sun, which therefore directly affects the environmental energy.

Although food and water are excellent sources for gathering energy, the Daoist priest relies heavily on the rarefied energetic and spiritual qualities of minerals and herbs to compliment and enliven

his or her personal process of alchemy. It is therefore important for the doctor to find alternative sources of energy in order to replenish his or her system when it becomes depleted. By studying the waxing and waning of the Earth's Yin and Yang energies, the priest can optimize the absorption of environmental energy.

According to ancient Daoist teachings, every individual must ingest and transform the energy assimilated from the Earth in the form of Postnatal Qi (energy from the Soil, Water, and Wind) in order for the body's tissues to survive and maintain proper function. Accordingly, without the constant replenishment of these substances gathered from the Earth's energetic fields, all forms of healing would be greatly compromised and the patient could easily relapse into his or her prior condition. The healing energy from the Earth's energetic fields is assimilated into the body through Nutrition, Rehydration, and Respiration, described as follows:

- **Nutrition (Energy from the Soil):** Plants (herbs and vegetables) and animal products are ingested as food, allowing the refined energy of the soil to be absorbed and retained by the body in order to reenergize the tissues. Without proper nutrition, gathered from the energy of Earth's soil, the Blood can become Deficient and weak. Energetically Deficient Blood can then result in diminished distribution of nutrients at the cellular level, weakening internal organ function and creating a deficiency in the individual's life-force energy. There is an ancient Chinese saying that goes, "There can be no health without proper nutrition and no proper nutrition without proper assimilation."
- **Rehydration (Energy from Water):** Water absorbs and retains the energetic imprinting of the soil and is used by the body in order to reenergize the tissues. Proper hydration is necessary for the body's fluids (i.e., Jing, Xue, Jin, and Ye) to provide the Yin basis that enables the absorption and utilization of Yang energy. Without adequate rehydration from energy- enriched water, the body is unable to function properly and the ability of the internal systems to secrete and excrete is impaired. When there is chronic dehydration, body's secretion glands are unable to manufacture the juices and fluids needed for digestion, absorption, and assimilation; and the excreting glands are unable to provide for the excretion of waste products. Additionally, the individual's internal organs can begin to overheat, further drying up the body's internal fluids.
- **Respiration (Energy from Air):** Similar to plants and water, the air of any environment absorbs and retains the energetic imprinting of the local soil, foliage, terrain, and buildings, and is used by the body to reenergize the tissues. Without adequate respiration, an individual's Blood acidifies due to carbon dioxide build up, resulting in diminished cellular distribution of nutrients, weakened internal organ function, and a deficiency in life-force energy.

Therefore, the ability to absorb energy from nature in the form of proper food, drink, and breathing is necessary for acquiring health and internal strength and is an essential aspect of Daoist alchemy. However, the ancient Daoists went a step further, and sought to develop and refine techniques of absorbing Qi directly from the natural environment without relying on the availability of food and drink.

THE ENERGETIC NATURE OF PLANTS

The ancient Daoist believed that the Earth is a living organism, and that plants (like minerals) are energetic portals into the powerful forces of nature. If the Daoist priest learned how to live in harmony with these natural energies, he or she would not only be able to cultivate these energies, but would also understand how to direct these powerful forces.

One ancient Daoist teaching states that "dreams and visions are mans (human) doorways into the Plant Realm." The magical world of plants and plant spirits was therefore believed to be accessed through "dream language" or an energetic expansion of the priest's psychic senses.

The ancient Daoist also believed that plants could "speak," not only among themselves, but also with animals and humans as well. Plant "speech" sounds like the energetic hum of a high-voltage wire (with a rhythmic, songlike quality to it). During magical ceremonies with visionary plants, this energetic hum (or song) is sometimes audible to shamans and clairvoyant priests.

The ancient Daoists believed that the inner nature of a plant could be discovered by its outer form or "energetic signature." The appearance of a plant was therefore believed to be the gateway into its spirit or consciousness. Any priest who made an ally of a plant through its "guardian spirit" was believed to be in contact with not just that specific plant and its energetic realm, but also with the "soul of nature" itself (as well as with every plant there is or has ever been). Each plant is not just a representative of itself and its own spiritual qualities, but of its entire species as well.

Two laws of Sympathetic Magic state that, "like produces like;" and that "once there has been an energetic contact and interaction with a person, place or thing, that energetic action can continue to act on-each-other even at a distance, after physical contact has been severed."

Plants establish a form of psychic connection between people and animals. Extensive research conducted by Clever Backster has concluded that not only are plants as sensitive as human beings, but they are able to read emotions and intentions, have memory, emotions, psychic abilities, and very humanlike reactions. Backster also discovered that plants retain their energy and intelligence, even when dried and shredded, as long as the connection to a human being had been established.

In ancient times, a Daoist priest would distinguish the spiritual powers (Ling Shen) and energetic qualities of a plant by observing several physical and energetic characteristics:

- **Color:** The colors of the flowers and fruit were divided into Five Elements, and were also categorized according to Yang (Bright) or Yin (Faded) energetic colors.
- **Smell:** The scents and perfumes of the flowers, leaves, branches, and roots were divided into sweet, pungent, etc., and were attributed to Five Element energetic qualities.
- **Shape:** The shapes and forms of the leaves, flowers, and fruits (e.g., round and long, round and short, smooth or serrated edges, etc.) were divided into Five Elements, and were also categorized according to Yang or Yin energetic qualities. The shape of the plant also informed the priest what approach was needed in the form of energetic communication. For example, plants with large leaves and high water content tend to be more responsive to the mental powers of a priest's intention then those with smaller leaves and lower water content.
- **Habitat:** The locations of where the plants grow (e.g., marsh, mountain, forest, desert, etc.), and the mythological landscapes that they occupied also determined the herbs magical energetic properties.
- **Emotion:** The moods that each plant evoked (i.e., quiet, happy, depressed, angry, etc.) were also used to determined each herbs magical energetic properties.

The ancient Daoists believed that a plant's energetic potency would lie dormant until the specific magical incantation was spoken, which defined its purpose and directed its energetic action. It was important that the ancestral spirits first be petitioned in order to initiate this energetic activation. Without this petition or statement of intent, the magic contained within the herbs would not work to its full potential (and would sometimes not work at all).

Additionally, it was also taught that each type of plant had a secret name and a secret password that was used to energetically open the plant's magical power. The priest must first know the type of plant he or she is harvesting, call it by its secret name, and then present the magical password or talisman needed in order to remove it from its energetic connection to the Earth. This is why, in Daoist sorcery, magical chants and incantations are used to make contact with the plant spirits and to invoke the power of the plants.

THE MAGICAL PROPERTIES OF PLANTS

In ancient Daoism, a disciple was taught the secret skill of Plant Magic only after mastering the art of Mineral Magic. The mastery of the energetic and spiritual powers of the various minerals provided an important alchemical foundation, and empowered the priest with the essential understanding from which to study the esoteric energetic and spiritual powers of the plant realm. This essential knowledge also empowered the Daoist priest with the ability to properly construct powerful magical elixirs and Immortal Pills.

One little known fact, is that when properly constructed, a magical Herbal Elixir created by a Daoist priest has 12 times the power of any normally constructed herbal formula created by an herbalist (Figure 1.152).

In Daoist magic, herbs are used for their vibrational essence and magical correspondences. Similar to humans, each herb has either a male (Yang) or female (Yin) gender, is ruled by a planet, dominated by an Element, and is often considered to be sacred to a certain spirit entity or deity.

The specific energetic properties and actions of a magical herb will change according to the portion of the plant (i.e., root, stem, branch, leaves, flowers, and fruit) being used. For example, the leaf and flower parts of a plant are generally more detoxifying and dispersing, while the heavier roots tend to be more tonifying.

Before ingesting or utilizing the energetic properties of any magical herb, it is important that the priest fully understand the herb's magical and medical properties, as well as its counter-indications. Additionally, it is also important to understand how these herbs are prepared before using them (e.g., some herbs are to be pounded, rolled, and ingested as pills; other herbs are steeped in hot water and drank as teas, certain herbs are to be smoked, while other herbs must be boiled or fried in order to neutralize their inherent toxicities, etc.). Some herbs can be addictive, and others are considered to be poisonous if ingested in too large a dose.

Certain herbs (or oils) act as a catalyst for other herbs. They provide the magical "spark" that empowers the herbal formula. Herbs can also act as "focusing" agents, and in such cases they are combined with various ingredients in a magical formula in order to bring the other herbs together and "focus" the priest's intent. Other herbs are used for "refocusing," and they help change the energetic vibration in a given situation, causing it to shift or transform.

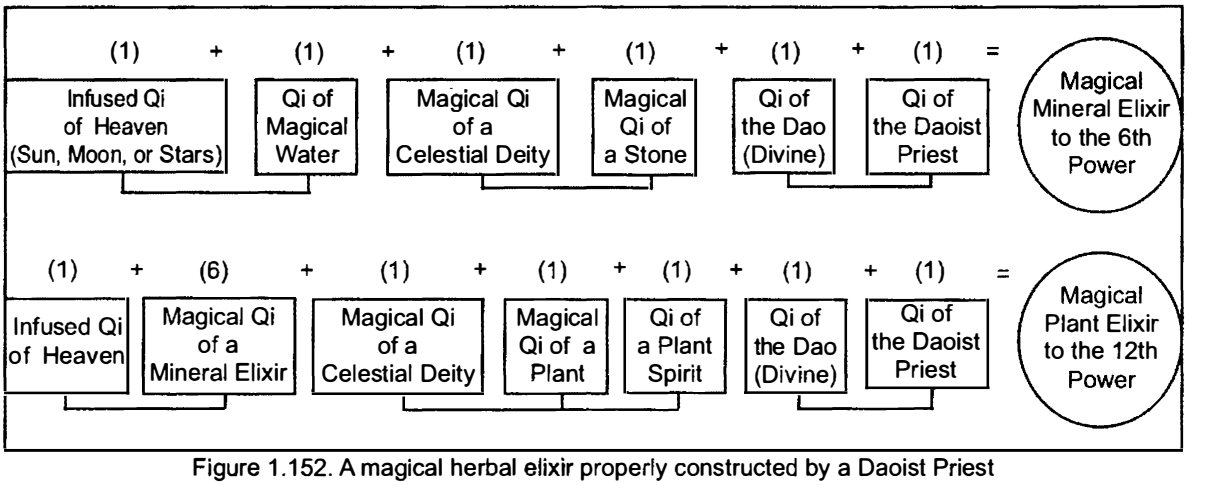


Figure 1.152. A magical herbal elixir properly constructed by a Daoist Priest has 12 times the power of any normal elixir formula created by an herbalist.

There are also certain herbs that are specifically used for "Neutralizing, Controlling, Compelling, Commanding, or Destroying." These specific herbs are used when the priest really needs to assert his or her will over a situation. For example, certain herbs are used primarily for "Hexing."

In ancient Daoist magic, the construction of an effective and powerful herbal tool involves a complex process on magical strategy (Figure 1.153). The priest first determines his or her magical goal (i.e., Healing, Protection, Banishing, etc.). Then the specific Form that will carry the herbs (i.e., incense, sachet, tea, oil, doll, etc.). He or she then chooses the appropriate available herbs from which to construct the herbal formula. The priest then processes any herbs that require special treatment before constructing the magical formula. He or she then makes the herbal formula, and in some cases incorporates it into a magical herbal tool.

The priest then energizes and imprints the magical tool or formula with his or her desired intention; alternately, the priest can connect with a specific deity and request it to magically imprint and empower the magical tool or formula. Empowered with this esoteric wisdom, the priest could additionally use the energetic powers of a mineral tool to imprison spirit entities inside a plant or elixir orb. Once imprisoned, the spirit entity could later be used and dispatched as a "spirit servant."

Next, the priest energetically Activates the magical tool or herbal formula. After activating the magical tool or herbal formula, the priest then energetically wraps and magically seals the item. The magical tool or herbal formula is now ready for use. Once constructed, some esoteric tools or elixirs retain their magical power indefinitely (others must be used within a few days or weeks).

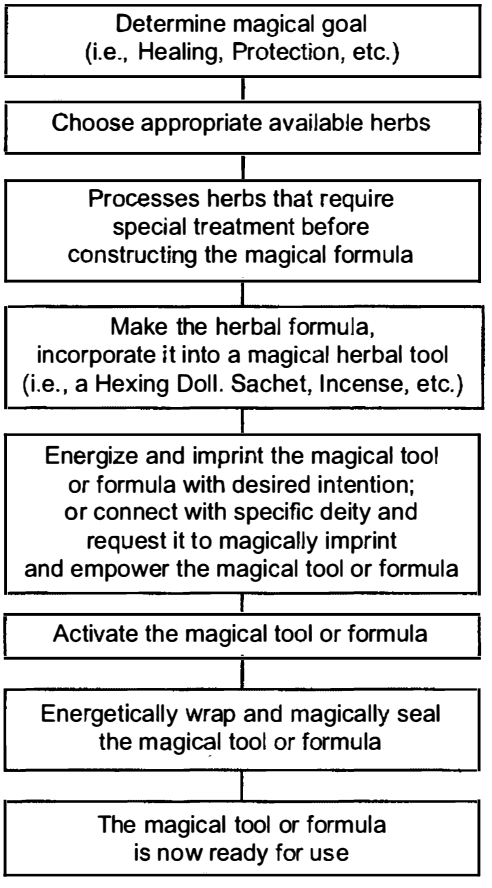


Figure 1.153. The Process of Constructing A Magical Tool or Herbal Formula

PROCESSING MAGICAL HERBS

Processing herbs to alter their energetic properties is an ancient method used in Daoist magic. Correctly processing a Daoist magical herb can cause an essential transformation of the herb's energetic qualities or specific biochemical constituents. For example, if left in their natural state, certain herbs are considered to be toxic to humans and must be properly processed before being used in magic or as a medicine. The qualities of other herbs can be enhanced, diminished, or redirected depending on how the herb is processed.

There are a few general considerations that must be taken into mind when processing individual herbs. For example, heating any ingredient makes it warmer, adding honey makes it more energetically tonifying and phlegm relieving, adding vinegar brings it to the liver, carbonizing helps it to inhibit bleeding, soaking or adding alcohol makes it warmer and more dispersing, and adding salt to an herbal formula helps direct it to the kidneys.

There are seven main considerations that the priest must understand before preparing certain magical herbs. These seven considerations are described follows:

1. **Cleansing:** Washing the herb in order to eliminate foreign or non-medicinal substances
2. **Dissipating:** Removing disagreeable odors and flavors emanating from the herb
3. **Directing:** Changing which organ systems the herb affects
4. **Modifying Qi:** Changing the energetic properties (flavor, nature, and action) of the herb
5. **Diminishing:** Reducing toxicity, moderating drastic actions caused from the herbs, as well as diminishing side effects
6. **Reinforcing:** Enhancing the desired therapeutic effects of the herb
7. **Storing:** The type of storage necessary to maintain the vitality of the herb

METHODS OF PROCESSING

Methods used for processing and purifying Chinese magical herbs include Processing Herbs Through Fire, Processing Herbs Through Water, and Processing Herbs Through Both Fire and Water. These are commonly known as the Pao Zhi ("Frying and Cooking") methods of processing herbs. These ancient methods are described as follows:

Processing Herbs Through Fire

- **Calcination:** In this type of preparation, the herbs are directly or indirectly calcined over a fierce fire in order to make them crispy for crushing or carbonization. Most of the solid and hard mineral herbs or shells are directly calcined.
- **Roasting:** In this type of preparation, the herbs are wrapped in moistened paper or flour paste. The herbs are then heated in smoldering cinder or roasted in an oven until their coating becomes charred. This process is used in order to remove oil from herbs or to moderate their energetic properties.
- **Stir-Baking:** In this type of preparation, the herbs are placed into a pot over a fire and continually stir-baked for an extended period of time, then taken out. According to the extent of the heating performed, the herbs can either be stir-baked until yellow in color, stir-baked until charred, or stir-baked until carbonized. Stir-baking an herb until it is yellow or charred can moderate the herb's energetic properties or strengthen the effect of invigorating the spleen. When an herb is stir-baked carbonized, it can strengthen the effects of stopping bleeding and arresting diarrhea.
- **Stir-Baking With an Auxiliary Fluid:** In this type of preparation, the herb is stir-baked along with an auxiliary fluid such as wine, vinegar, salt water, ginger juice, and honey. Stir-baking herbs with an auxiliary fluid can strengthen the herb's magical effects, reduce toxicity, and remove abnormal flavor. In addition, herbs stir-baked with other auxiliary materials including sand and talc powder can make them crispy and enable their active ingredients to be easily decocted out.

Processing Herbs Through Water

- **Water-Refining:** In this type of preparation, mineral herbs insoluble in water are crushed, put in a mortar, ground with water into fine powder in suspension; then they are poured into a vessel for precipitation and dried.

Processing Herbs Through Both Fire and Water

- **Boiling:** In this type of preparation, the herbs are boiled in water with auxiliary materials in order to reduce their toxicity.
- **Steaming:** In this type of preparation, the herbs are steamed solely or with auxiliary materials in order to change their properties, strengthen their potency, or reduce their toxic effects.

ESOTERIC METHODS OF PREPARATION

A Daoist priest is familiar with many different methods of extracting, harnessing, and directing an herb's magical properties. Since the physical, energetic, and spiritual qualities of each herb differ. According to ancient Daoist teachings, there are four primary methods of absorbing Plant Qi. These four methods are divided into Yin and Yang, as well as Heaven and Earth categorized, described as follows:

- **Orally Ingested (through teas, soups, pills, etc.):** This procedure is considered to be an Internal, Yin, Earth method.
- **Topically Applied (through oils, balms, liniments, compresses, etc.):** This procedure is considered to be an External, Yang, Earth method.
- **Infused (through steaming):** This procedure is considered to be a Yin, Water, Heaven method.

- **Inhaled (through smoking and incense):** This procedure is considered to be a Yang, Fire, Heaven method.

The type of preparation that the priest uses depends upon the desired outcome. Certain magical practices require the ceremonial burning of particular combinations of herbal powders, while other practices may involve months of elaborate rituals.

It is important to note that there are several other lesser known esoteric methods of extracting, harnessing, and directing an herb's magical properties. Traditionally, it was taught that the magical properties of a plant could be gathered and harvested via five different energetic applications. These five methods are described as follows:

- **Vampiring Plant Qi (via an Energy Bubble):** Many priests choose to harness the energetic and spiritual qualities of an herb by withdrawing the desired magical qualities directly out from the living plant itself. This Ling Qi is then energetically added directly into a magical formula or specific spell. In this method, the priest extends his or her Qi and Shen and creates an energy bubble, enveloping the energetic field of a particular forest, tree, field, bush, or plant. Next, the priest would use his or her left hand to maintain the energy bubbly, and with the right hand, begins unwinding the plant's energetic field (using small counter-clockwise circular rotations to release the plant's stored energy). Once the Qi within the energy bubble becomes active, alive, and full of vibrant plant Qi, the priest immediately inhales and absorbs the plant's energetic powers.
- **Swiping Plant Qi (via Dew Harvesting):** A plant's energetic essence may be harvested by gathering the dew that has collected on the plant during the night. To obtain the energetic essence of a plant through its dew the Daoist priest must harvest the dew during dawn, "the gateway between the worlds." The priest goes to the plant in the early morning and energetically envelops it. He or she then drops into the center core of the plant to connect with the energetic and spiritual essence of the plant. He or she then pushes this essence out to the most exterior portion of the plant (i.e., the plant's leaves). The priest then carefully wipes off this magical dew with a purified cheesecloth. Once a sufficient quantity has been obtained, the dew is then squeezed out of the cheesecloth and stored in a sealed jar. In order to maintain the energetic and spiritual qualities of this magical dew, the entire process must be completed during the dawn hours, and the dew must not ever be exposed to direct sunlight.
- **Cutting Plant Parts (via Removing it from its Soil/Earth Connection):** In this common method, the priest extends his or her Qi and Shen and creates an energy bubble, enveloping the energetic field of a particular plant. Next, the priest speaks a specific incantation in order to freeze the plant's specific energetic and spiritual essence within its tuberous cells. Then, the priest removes a magical knife (previously energized for this particular ritual) and begins to surgically remove the plant or plant part.
- **Extracting Plant Qi Through Urine (via Harvesting Mid-stream):** Another secret way of preparing an herb is that of extracting its qualities through urine. While urine itself is occasionally a secret ingredient that is added directly into a magical formula (generally the urine of a young virgin male taken mid-stream), an herb or herbal formula may be ingested by the priest and then excreted out through his or her own urine. This urine may then either be used as a magical medicine or as part of a more elaborate magical formula. Additionally, certain animals (such as cows or reindeer) are sometimes fed a specific plants or plant formula, the essence of which is later harvested through the animal's urine.
- **Asking Permission from the Plant's Spirit:** With a vase of water in hand, the priest extends his or her Qi and Shen and creates an energy bubble, enveloping the energetic field of a particular forest, tree, field, bush, or plant. Next, the priest contacts the area's Guardian Plant Spirit, expressing his or her specific needs and concerns, asking for assistance in impregnating the vase of water

with the plant's magical essence. This spirit-to-spirit interaction and exchange of Ling Qi is considered to be a necessary protocol in this type of energetic exchange, and it is always used before the priest is granted permission to receive a plant's stored energetic powers.

A similar result can be obtained by requesting a Plant Spirit infuse its magical properties into the desired object, person, or spell. Neither of these methods requires the consumption or use of the physical structure of the plant. However, if a dried herb is used, its energetic and spiritual properties may become exhausted after one or more uses.

COMMON METHODS OF PREPARATION

Common methods of preparation include the construction of Tinctures, Wines, Liniments, Infusions, Decoctions, Soups, Syrups, Oils, Balms and Salves, Ointments, Suppositories, Pills, Powders, Poultices and Compresses, Incense and Smoking Mixtures. These ancient methods are described as follows:

- **Tinctures:** To make an herbal tincture, mix six and a half ounces of powdered or macerated dried herb with one quart of 90 to 160 proof alcohol. Shake the mixture twice daily for two weeks and keep it away from direct sunlight. Then press out as much liquid as possible and store it in a dark glass container. To make a tincture using a fresh herb, mix 16 ounces of macerated fresh herb with 32 ounces of 200 proof alcohol, and follow the same steps outlined above.
- **Wines:** Herbal wines are essentially the same as herbal tinctures, though wines use a higher herb to alcohol ratio and a lower proof alcohol. To make an herbal wine, mix 16 ounces of powdered or macerated herb and 32 ounces of 40 to 90 proof alcohol. Shake the mixture twice daily for two weeks and keep it away from direct sunlight. Then press out as much liquid as possible and store it in dark glass container.
- **Liniments:** An herbal liniment is made in essentially the same way as an herbal wine, but a liniment uses herbs that treat external conditions (bruising, eczema, boils, etc.). To make an herbal liniment, mix 16 ounces of powdered or macerated herb and 32 ounces of 40 to 90 proof alcohol (e.g. rice wine). Shake the mixture twice daily for two weeks and keep it away from direct sunlight. Then press out as much liquid as possible and store it in dark glass container.
- **Infusions:** To make an infusion, pour hot or boiling water over the herb and cover the water-herb mixture. Most infusions are prepared using boiling hot water, but there are a few herbs that require slightly lower temperatures. Let the mixture steep for anywhere from 4 to 20 minutes (depending on the herb or herbs used), and then strain out the herb. The resulting tea is best used immediately, but it will keep for one or two days at room temperature. This method works best for flowers or when the volatile qualities of an herb (e.g. menthol from Bo He/Mint) are desired. Methods using the inhalation of vapors from a steaming herbal tea most often involve infusions. In this technique, the steam vapors are slowly inhaled (with the head close to the tea and covered in a cloth so little or no steam can escape) after letting the infusion steep for only one to three minutes and without straining the herbs.
- **Decoctions:** To make a decoction, place the herbs in a pot of cold water and bring the mixture to a boil. Simmer the mixture for 20-30 minutes (certain roots need to be boiled longer), let it cool, and then strain out the herbs. In certain formulas the mixture is boiled until only half the volume of water remains. In both infusions and decoctions the ratio of herb to water is not as important as the total amount of herbs used, since the quantity of water remaining at the end of the preparation will vary. The resulting tea is best used immediately, but it will keep for one or two days at room temperature. Alternately, it can be preserved for several months by adding 20% alcohol. The decoction method works best for twig, barks, roots, and certain dried fruits.
- **Soups:** In herbal soups, herbs are combined with specific foods and cooked over a low heat for several hours. To make an herbal soup, combine the herbs with the desired food (e.g. rice) and five to six cups of water. Bring the mixture to a boil and then let it cook over a low heat until the mixture is reduced to two cups.

- **Syrups:** To make an herbal syrup, boil two ounces of herbs in one quart of water until the mixture is reduced to two cups. Then strain it and add two to three ounces of honey and a gelling component such as Irish Moss. To make a thicker syrup using sugar, boil one pound of sugar cane extract with one pint of water until sticky. Soak the herbs (either loose or tied in a cloth) in this solution for 20 minutes, stirring occasionally. Remove the herbs and let the solution cool, then store it and refrigerate in air tight bottles.
- **Oils:** To make an herbal oil, warm one pint of the desired oil (Olive Oil, Grape Seed Oil or Jojoba Oil) in a pan until hot. Then add two ounces of the desired herbs into the oil. Leave the mixture covered on low heat for anywhere from 20 minutes to two hours or until the herb has lost its color. Let the oil cool sufficiently before straining out the herb. A more difficult method of making an herbal oil is to keep the oil and herb mixture at a lower heat (around 130-140 degrees Fahrenheit) for two weeks. Alternately, some herbal oils are made by using the warmth of the sun.
- **Balms and Salves:** Balms and Salves essentially refer to the same thing. To make a balm or salve, thoroughly mix an ounce of beeswax into a pint of hot herbal oil. Once the mixture cools it should remain slightly hard at room temperature.
- **Ointments:** To make an herbal ointment, simply add an appropriate amount of finely powdered herbs to a cream or lotion and mix thoroughly.
- **Suppositories:** To make an herbal suppository, mix an appropriate amount of powdered herbs with lard, ghee, or cocoa butter. Roll this mixture into strips (roughly the diameter of your thumb) and allow it to harden. A one inch piece is then placed into the rectum or vagina.
- **Pills:** There are several methods used to make herbal pills. The first method uses a strong decoction, while the second uses only powdered herbs. To make an herbal pill from a decoction, follow the directions for making an herbal decoction, but continue to boil the herbs until nearly all the water evaporates and only a thick syrup remains. It is important to watch the mixture carefully for the last few minutes to prevent it from burning. Then strain out the liquid and mix it with a small amount of a finely powdered neutral carrier herb such as slippery elm powder. Spread the mixture out in thin sheets on a non-stick surface (these days wax paper is used for this purpose). Before is dries completely, take a small amount of the mixture and roll it into balls of the desired size. This method is generally deemed to be stronger and more effective than that of using powdered herbs alone.

  To make pills from powdered herbs alone, first powder the herbs finely with a mortar and pestle. Then mix the resulting powder with a liquid such as molasses, ghee, or honey. Roll small amounts of the resulting mixture into pills of the desired size.
- **Powders:** To make an herbal powder, simply powder the herb with a mortar and pestle. The resulting herbal powder is then either applied directly or rolled in honey (or molasses) in order to create magical pills, crackers, cakes, or pastries. Powdered herbs may also be burned as herbal incense, sprinkled on the body of a victim, or sprinkled around the floors of a home.
- **Poultices and Compresses:** To make a poultice or compress using dried herbs, wrap and tie one cup of the herb in a cloth and then soak it in about two cups of boiling water for one to two minutes. Remove the herbs and let them cool to a temperature that is as hot as you can stand. Place the herbs (still wrapped in the cloth) directly on to the skin. Cover the poultice with a cloth or airtight wrapping, and let it remain for 10 to 20 minutes. Remove the poultice before it cools down completely. The poultice or compress can be held on the skin longer if it is kept warm by a hot water bottle.
- **Incense:** To make an herbal incense, mix together one part powdered herbs with anywhere from one-tenth to one part resin (the Makko resin of the evergreen tree Machilus thunbergii works great). The amount of resin used depends upon the combustibility of the other ingredients. Mix all the ingredients together thoroughly, then roll the mixture into small cones and let dry. Generally, sweet odors

are usually used for summoning, meditation and other positive magical goals, while foul odors are used for banishing rituals.

Another common method of using incense is simply sprinkling an appropriate amount of a mixture of powdered herbs onto a lit material such as charcoal.

- **Smoking Mixtures:** To make a smoking mixture, combine appropriate amounts of the desired herbs in a pipe, light it, and inhale the smoke into the lungs.
- **Bathing Mixtures:** To make a bathing mixture, combine appropriate amounts of the desired herbs in warm tub water and soak.

THE ENERGETIC ACTIVATION OF MAGICAL HERBS

Simply preparing an herbal formula by no means ensures that the priest has access to the full potential of an herb's energetic and spiritual qualities. In fact, if an incorrect method of preparation is used, the herb's physical qualities may not even be made available. A competent priest knows not only the proper method of using each herb, but also the proper ritual by which its energetic and spiritual aspects may be harnessed. In Daoist magic, no observers are allowed to witness the process, so as to keep the priest's focused attention completely directed into the herbs. Herbal magic is considered to be a personal art, one in which the priest actively participates and pours his or her life-force energy into the outcome.

In order to increase the spectrum and effectiveness of the herb's influence, its magical powers must be energetically accessed, programmed, and activated prior to their use. This energetic activation is sometimes called an "enchantment" in magic. This magical process is used in order to ensure that the resonant vibrations of the herb are attuned to the priest's specific needs. Enchanting an herb or formula aligns the priest's intention with the specific plants involved in the magical application. In certain magical traditions, the herbs begin their enchantment process while they are being harvested, or even when they are being planted.

The priest's true power comes from the ability to access and utilize the energy of his or her Ling Shen (Magical Spirit). The priest's Ling Shen is energetically directed by the four powers of his or her Imagination (Green Dragon), Sensation (White Tiger), Intention (Red Phoenix), and Attention (Black Turtle/Snake). All of these four powers must be present in order for any magical ritual or enchantment to be successful.

To properly prepare a magical herbal formula, it is important that all the herbs to be used have been properly harvested, stored, and (when necessary) processed. The priest then cleanses him or herself, the area in which the formula will be constructed, and all the herbs and tools that he or she will use. The herbs are then brought to the Earth Altar, and a consecration ritual is performed in secret.

In the Daoist tradition, it is taught that each herb is connected to a specific "spirit guardian" that is responsible for overseeing that herb's magical powers. In the beginning of the activation ritual, the Daoist priest will summon that herb's "guardian," present offerings (usually incense), and then define the purpose and specific function of the herb or herbal formula being constructed. This allows the priest to receive the spirit's "celestial blessing" and work within "Heaven's Mandate." This is also one reason why certain priests who perform Black Magic will summon demonic entities and offer blood sacrifices in order to construct poisons and paralyzing formulas.

Depending on the ingredients being used and the goal of the formula, the priest proceeds to construct the formula while using one or more of the following techniques:

- Drawing in energy from the Divine
- Drawing in energy from one or more Deities, Nature Spirits, or Familiars
- Drawing in energy from one or more of the Four Quadrants of Heaven
- Drawing in energy from one or more of the Star Constellations
- Drawing in energy from one or more of the Five Planets
- Drawing in energy from one or more of the Eight Powers of the Bagua
- Drawing in energy from one or more of the Four Quadrants (Directions) of Earth
- Drawing in energy from one or more of the Five Elements

- Energizing the herbs with specific Mantras or Incantations

While focusing on the herbs and sensing the vibrational resonance, the priest will emit Qi into the herbs while performing Breath Incantations and speaking magical Words of Power. The Words of Power are designed to imprint into the herbs the power of the priest's desire and intention. This directed intention should flow into the very core of the herb's energetic matrix and imprint it with the priest's projected will. When the herb begins "tingling with power," the priest knows that it has been activated, and the plant is now enchanted.

As part of the magical preparation process, certain formulas require the priest to expose the formula for a prescribed number of days to Moonlight (the formula is carefully covered and stored when the moon is not present in the night sky), Sunlight (the formula is carefully covered and stored during night hours), or the Yin energy of the Earth (the formula is buried in a sealed container for anywhere from one month to several years). After the formula has been prepared, it is energetically sealed and either used immediately or stored in an airtight container away from direct sunlight.

Function and Use of Magical Herbs

In order to harness the full energetic potential of a magical herb, the imprinting of the herb or herbal formula must be aligned with its intended magical application. Once the priest chooses the specific magical application (i.e., Protection, Purification, Exorcism, Healing, etc.) that best matches his or her intended goal, then herbs are selected and imprinted accordingly.

Purification and Consecration

When imprinting herbs for Purification and Consecration, the primary goal is to have the formula be powerful enough to drive away any negative energy. This allows the priest to create a divine healing space or sanctuary needed to perform magical rituals.

- **Herbs that aid in Purification and Consecration include:** Alkanet, Anise, Asafoetida, Avens, Bay Leaf, Benzoinum, Betony, Bloodroot, Broom, Cedar, Chamomile, Copal Resin, Euphorbia, Fennel Seed, Gum Arabic, Holy Thistle, Hyssop, Iris, Lavender, Lemon Verbena, Mimosa, Parsley, Rosemary, Sage, Shallot, Thyme, Turmeric, Valerian, Vervain, and Yucca.

Protection

When imprinting herbs for Protection, the primary goal is to guard a person, place, or thing from physical, emotional, mental, and spiritual attacks (e.g., injury, accidents, poisoning, disease, etc.). Protective herbs can be used to create a defensive energetic field surrounding the priest's body, room, house, land, possessions, mate, family, pets, etc. When carried as a Protective Amulet or Sachet, the magical herbs increase the effectiveness of the priest's natural defences.

- **Herbs that aid in Protection include:** Acacia, African Violet, Agrimony, Ague Root, Aloe, Althea Root, Alyssum, Amaranth, Anemone, Angelica, Anise, Arbutus, Asafoetida, Ash, Balm of Gilead, Bamboo, Barley, Bay Leaf, Betony, Birch, Bittersweet, Blackberry, Sheng Ma, Bladderwrack, Bloodroot, Blueberry, Bodhi, Boneset, Briony, Bromeliad, Broom, Buckthorn, Calamus Root, Caraway, Carnation, Cascara Sagrada, Castor, Cedar, Celandine, Chrysanthemum, Cinchona, Cinnamon, Cinquefoil, Clove, Cumin, Qiu Chong, Cyclamen, Cypress, Datura, Devil's Bit, Devil's Shoestring, Dill, Dogwood, Ebony, Elder, Eucalyptus, Fennel Seed, Fern, Feverwort, Flax, Fleabane, Foxglove, Frankincense Resin, Galangal, Garlic, Geranium, Hazel, Heather, Holly, Honeysuckle Flower, Horehound, Hyssop, Irish Moss, Ivy, Juniper, Larkspur, Lilac Flower, Lily, Linden, Lotus, Mallow, Mandrake, Marigold Flower, Masterwort, Mimosa, Peppermint, Mistletoe, Molluka, Mugwort, Mulberry, Mullein, Myrrh, Nettle, Pine, Oak, Orris, Parsley, Pennyroyal, Peony, Periwinkle, Pine, Plantain, Primrose, Purslane, Ragwort, Rattlesnake Root, Rose Petals, Rosemary, Rowan, St. John's Wort, Sandalwood (White), Snapdragon, Squill, Tamarisk, Thistle, Tormentil, Valerian, Violet, Willow, Wintergreen, Witch Hazel, Wolf's Bane, Woodruff, Wormwood, Yerba Santa, and Yucca.
- **Herbs that aid in Legal Matters include:** Buckthorn, Cascara Sagrada, Celandine, Hickory, and Marigold Flower.

VISIONS

When imprinting herbs for Visions, the primary goal is to increase the priest's psychic skills and induce magical abilities such as soul travel (astral projection), spirit travel (traveling clairvoyance), lucid dreaming, prophetic dreams, visions, scrying, divination, invisibility, and entering states of elevated consciousness.

- **Herbs that aid in Strengthening Psychic Powers include:** Acacia, Bay Leaf, Bistort, Bladderwrack, Borage, Buchu, Celery, Cinnamon, Citron, Elecampane, Eyebright, Flax, Galangal, Honeysuckle Flower, Lemongrass, Mace, Marigold Flower, Mastic, Mugwort, Rose Petals, Rowan, Saffron, Star Anise, Stillengia, Sumbul, Thyme, Uva Ursa, Wormwood, Yarrow, and Yerba Santa.
- **Herbs that aid in Soul Projection include:** Anise Seed, Benzoinum, Dittany of Crete, Jasmine Flower, Marigold Flowers, Mugwort, Poplar, St. Johns Wort, and Valerian.
- **Herbs that aid in Prophetic Dreams include:** Bracken, Buchu, Cinquefoil, Heliotrope, Jasmine Flower, Marigold, Mimosa, Mugwort, and Rose Petals.
- **Herbs that aid in Inducing Visions include:** Angelica, Coltsfoot, Crocus, Damiana, and Kava-Kava.
- **Herbs that aid in Meditation include:** Bodhi, and Gotu Kola.

HEALING

When imprinting herbs for Healing, the primary goal is to bring health and healing energy into an individual's body, mind, and spirit. The type of herbs used in healing formulas are chosen according to the patient's constitution, condition, and specific needs.

Certain herbal formulas are designed in order to protect the priest by preventing disease from occurring. As a general rule, these magical herbal formula should be changed every three months. Nearly every herb in the priest's apothecary has a healing application.

LOVE

When imprinting herbs for Love, the primary goal is to find companionship, sexual intimacy, or emotional fulfillment. These herbs can be used to attract an unspecified individual into your life, or to bewitch an individual who is already known to you. They help place you in situations where you meet people, help you to overcome shyness, and allow you to communicate in a loving manner. Because like-attracts-like, these herbs will generally expand your energetic field, and on a subconscious level, draw to you individuals who are comparable to your own energetic and spiritual evolution.

Sometimes love spells are used to "capture" a person's affections. Be aware that when love spells are used to entrap an individual's affections, the confused victim's emotional state quickly disintegrates into emotional slavery. Magically forcing an individual to become either involved in an unwanted relationship or to remain faithful without choice creates powerful negative karma.

- **Herbs that aid in Attracting Love include:** Adam and Eve Root, Aloes Wood, Aster, Avens, Balm of Gilead, Barley, Basil, Betony, Black Cohosh, Bloodroot, Caper, Cardamom, Chamomile, Cinnamon, Clove, Coltsfoot, Columbine, Copal Resin, Coriander, Crocus, Daffodil, Damiana, Devil's Bit, Dill, Dogbane, Elm, Fig, Gardenia, Geranium, Hemp, Hibiscus Flower, Jasmine Flower, Juniper, Lavender, Licorice, Lobelia, Lotus, Maidenhair, Mallow, Mandrake, Maple, Marjoram, Mastic, Meadowsweet, Mistletoe, Oleander, Orchid, Peach, Peppermint, Periwinkle, Plum, Poppy, Prickly Ash, Primrose, Purslane, Rosemary, Rose Petals, Rue, Saffron, Skullcap, Spearmint, Strawberry, Sugar Cane, Tamarind, Thyme, Tormentil, Valerian, Vanilla, Vervain, Vetivert, Violet, Willow, Wormwood, and Yohimbe.

LUST

When imprinting herbs for Lust, the primary goal is to increase passion and sexual desire in a mate. These herbs are considered to be powerful forms of magic, and are commonly used in Sex Magic rituals.

Sometimes certain Lust formulas consumed in Sex Magic rituals are used to arouse another person's passions unknowingly. Be aware that when Lust herbs are maliciously used to excite an unsuspecting individual's passions, it creates powerful negative karma.

- **Herbs that aid in Creating or Increasing Lust include:** Black Cohosh, Caper, Caraway, Green Cardamon Pods, Cat Tail, Celery, Cinnamon, Cistanches, Cnidium Seeds, Daisy, Damiana, Deerstongue, Dill, Dodder Seeds (Chinese), Dulse, Endive, Eryngo, Galangal, Garlic, Ginger, Ginseng, Grains of Paradise, Hibiscus Flower, Lemongrass, Licorice, Maguey, Nettle, Parsley, Patchouli, Peppermint, Rosemary, Saffron, Schisandra Fruit, Senega Root (Chinese), Sesame, Southernwood, Vanilla, Violet, Yerba Mate, and Yohimbe.

Luck

When imprinting herbs for Luck, the primary goal is to change and transform the energetic condition of "bad luck" into "good luck." "Good luck" can be defined as being in the right place at the right time, meeting the right people at the perfect transition time in one's life, and saying the appropriate things at the right time, all of which can create positive energetic changes in one's life. If an individual is naturally "not lucky," this negative energetic pattern can be transformed, and positive changes can be acquired through the use of these herbs. How this "luck" will manifest is never understood, as it is a personal energetic interaction between the individual and the "powers that be."

- **Herbs that aid in Obtaining Luck include:** Allspice, Aloe, Bamboo, Banyan, Calamus Root, China Berry, Cinchona, Daffodil, Devil's Bit, Fern, Hazel, Heather, Holly, Huckleberry, Irish Moss, Linden, Oak, Poppy, Purslane, Rose Petals, Lu Fu Mu (Rauwolfia serpentina), Star Anise, Strawberry, Vetivert, and Violet.

Money

When imprinting herbs for Money, the primary goal is to increase an individual's financial wealth. Money is considered to be energetic in nature. When a priest uses magic to draw money, it is generally taken from some form of energetic connection attached to the priest and is discharged first energetically - then physically transferred. Money can come in the form of unexpected gifts, lucrative business opportunities, or even as an inheritance. Therefore, it is important to be specific when using these magical herbal formulas for financial gain (i.e., seeking a pay raise at work, receiving dividends on a lucrative investment, etc.) and not "assume" that what you are creating is "free."

- **Herbs that aid in Obtaining Money and Wealth include:** Allspice, Basil, Blackberry, Black Cohosh, Bladderwrack, Briony, Bromeliad, Buckwheat, Calamus Root, Camellia, Cascara Sagrada, Cedar, Chamomile, Cinnamon, Cinquefoil, Clove, Cowslip, Comfrey, Dill, Dock, Elder, Fern, Flax, Fumitory, Galangal, Ginger, Goldenrod, Golden Seal, Grains of Paradise, Heliotrope, Honeysuckle Flower, Irish Moss, Jasmine Flower, Majoram, Mandrake, Maple, Moonwort, Myrtle, Nutmeg, Oak, Patchouli, Peppermint, Periwinkle, Pine, Poplar, Poppy, Sesame, Squill, Trillium, Vervain, Vetivert, and Woodruff.

Divination

- **Herbs that aid in Divination include:** Broom, Camphor, Dandelion, Fig, Goldenrod, Ground Ivy, Hibiscus Flower, Meadowsweet, and Orris.
- **Herbs that aid in Love Divination include:** Dodder, Mullein, Pansy, Rose Petals, St. John's Wort, and Willow.

Spirit Manifestation

When imprinting herbs for Manifestation, the primary goal is to create herbal formulas that will assist the priest in summoning a spirit entity into the physical realm. The Spirit Manifestation herbs are general burned as incense so that the smoke can be used by the spirit entity as an energetic medium in which to materialize.

- **Herbs that aid in Spirit Manifestation include:** Balm of Gilead, Dittany of Crete, and Mastic.
- **Herbs that aid in Raising the Dead include:** Yew

Invisibility

- **Herbs that aid in Invisibility include:** Amaranth, Anise Seeds, Chicory, Edelweiss, Fern, Heliotrope, Mistletoe, Poppy, and Wolf's Bane.

Weather Magic

When imprinting herbs for Weather Magic, the primary goal is to change the weather conditions within a certain area or province. One of the main methods is to burn herbal incense (generally over hot coals) as an offering to the gods responsible for controlling Wind, Rain, and Thunder.

If the gods are pleased with the offerings (and sometimes sacrifices), the weather would change, clouds would gather, and rain would fall.

- **Herbs that aid in Rain Fall include:** Bracken, Cotton, Fern, Heather, Pansy, Rice, and Toadstool.
- **Herbs that aid in Raising the Wind include:** Bladderwrack, Broom, and Saffron.

EXORCISM

When imprinting herbs for Exorcism, the primary goal is to have the formulae be powerful enough to drive away the negative energy (i.e., caused from bewitchment, psychic attacks initiated from Black Magic, angry ghosts, malevolent spirit entities, demonic beings, etc.) that has been imprinted within a person, place, or thing. The herbs used for Exorcism are much more powerful than herbs used for Purification and Consecration, and they sometimes require several days of preparation rituals before imprinting and utilizing them.

Depending on the specific type and power of the spirit entity the Exorcism is directed towards, the priest will sometimes have to go into seclusion for several days of prayer and fasting. This purification is performed in order to spiritually prepare the priest for the encounter with the evil spirit prior to attempting to free the person, place, or thing.

- **Herbs that aid in Exorcism include:** Angelica, Arbutus, Asafoetida, Basil, Birch, Boneset, Buckthorn, Clove, Cumin, Devil's Bit, Elder, Fern, Frankincense Resin, Fumitory, Heliotrope, Horehound, Juniper, Lilac Flower, Mistletoe, Mullein, Myrrh, Nettle, Peppermint, Pine, Rosemary, Rue, Sagebrush, Sandalwood (White), Tamarisk, Thistle, and Yarrow.

HEXING

When imprinting herbs for Hexing, the primary goal is to effectively curse a person, place, or thing, causing it great harm or fear. A hex is sometimes known as an "evil spell" and is sometimes used to negatively influence an individual's life out of revenge, spite, or malicious jealousy. Additionally, Hexing can also be used in Binding Rituals, in order to stop an individual who is willfully harming others.

Sometimes in Daoist magic "Binding" is performed in order to keep a person (place or thing) tied to someone, held against their will, or unable to speak certain personal information (i.e., spreading gossip or revealing secret teachings). In this case, vines, cords of red rope, or hair are commonly used to wrap a symbolic representation of the person, place, or thing to an object such as a stone. Traditionally, vines are considered to be more powerful Binding agents than cords of rope, because a vine will naturally attach and wrap itself around something and begin to imprison it. Each year, as the strength of the vine increases, its magical binding ability increases in strength.

- **Herbs that aid in Stopping Gossip include:** Clove and Slippery Elm.
- **Herbs that aid in Hexing include:** Ashroot, Barbarry, Bayberry, Bittersweet, Briony Root, Cinquefoil, Datura, Hemlock, Henbane, Knotgrass, Lemongrass, Mandrake, Mullein, Patchouli, and Pepper.

HEX-BREAKING

When imprinting herbs for Hex-Breaking, the primary goal is to lift and remove the curse (sometimes known as "Uncrossing"), destroy the power of the spell, or return the curse back to its originator. Hexes and curses can manifest through consistent and otherwise unexplainable occurrences and chronic conditions (e.g., recurring accidents that damage the same areas of the body, unexplainable illnesses, financial losses, emotional losses, etc.). Hex-Breaking herbs are chosen for their traditional ability to change and transform the curse's original energetic pattern.

- **Herbs that aid in Hex-Breaking include:** Bamboo, Datura, Galangal, Huckleberry, Hydrangea, Poke, Squill, Thistle, Vetivert, and Wintergreen.
- **Herbs that aid in Breaking Love Spells include:** Lily, Lotus, and Pistachio.

POISONING

When imprinting herbs for Poisoning, the primary goal is to cause either a slow or rapid breakdown of an individual's physical body. This physical deterioration can result from a slow or rapid death caused from the destruction of the body's Central Nervous System, Cardiovascular System, Hepatic System, Renal System, and Hematologic System (depending on the type of poisons used).

There are also certain herbal poisons that directly attack the body's Endocrine System. The category of Poisoning Herbs also falls under the heading of Hexing, and is sometimes used to negatively transform the energetic matrix that supports an individual's body, mind, emotions, and spirit.

The most common types of poisons used in ancient times included the following:

- **Aconite (Plant):** Also known as "Fu Zi," "Wolf's Bane (used to poison wolves) and Monkshood. This deadly poison is known to induce such symptoms as tingling, numbness, cold and clammy skin, weak and irregular pulse, and difficulty in breathing. Death can occur with small amounts of the herb. Most of the poison is extrapolated from the root of the plant.

  Cooking the herb will convert the poison to a nontoxic substance. Medicinal usage has long preparation times (not the raw plant). In ancient China, Aconite was commonly used to poison arrows for hunting. When the arrow was saturated with the poison (wrapped in wet cotton), it could be used to kill a tiger immediately with a hit to its body. One ancient text states: "In making poison arrows for shooting wild beasts, the tubers of wild Aconitum are boiled in water. The resulting liquid, being highly viscous and poisonous, is smeared on the sharp edges of arrowheads. These treated arrowheads are effective in the quick killing of both human beings and animals, even though the victim may shed only a trace of blood."
- **Strychnine (Plant):** One of the popular poisons used in ancient times. This deadly poison is known to induce such symptoms as strong muscle spasms, seizures without loss of consciousness, and death within a few hours.
- **Cyanide (Fruit Pit):** This special type of poison is extracted from the pits of cherries and peaches. This deadly poison is known to prevent the cells from using oxygen (similar to suffocation), and can induce such symptoms as red skin, weakness, confusion, dizziness, sleepiness, coma, and death. A large dose can cause rapid death.
- **Amanita Exitialis (Fungus):** Also known as the "Guangzhou Destroying Angel," this species had the highest mortality rate of all toxic mushrooms in China. It has been estimated that about 50 grams (1.8 oz) of fresh mushrooms contains sufficient toxin to cause the death of a 110 pound adult. Once the poison enters the body, the toxins are taken up by the liver and then circulate within the enterohepatic circuit. Liver failure is the common cause of death.
- **Arsenic (Mineral):** Also known as Xionghuang ("Male Yellow"), Cihuang ("Female Yellow"), and Yushi ("Yu Stone"), this is also one of the most popular poisons used in ancient times. This deadly poison is known to induce such symptoms as stomach problems (mimicking food poisoning) so it was difficult to detect in ancient times. A single large dose can lead to violent vomiting, diarrhea and death. A series of smaller doses (chronic poisoning) can lead to weakness, paralysis, confusion, and eventually death. Other symptoms can include skin rash, hair loss, jaundice.
- **Bungarus Multicinctus (Many-Banded Krait):** The venom of the Many-banded Krait consists of both pre- and post-synaptic neurotoxins, and is believed to be the fourth most venomous land snake in the world. Symptoms may include discomfort in the chest, general ache, weak feeling in limbs, ataxia, glossolysis, loss of voice, swallowing paralysis, tunnel vision, and suppression of breathing that leads to death.
- **Latrodectus Elegans (Chinese Black Widow Spider):** This spider has a strong neurotoxic venom and can be dangerous, especially for young children. When mixed with other herbal ingredients, the applications of the poison can vary. For example, it can sometimes be used as a numbing agent; to cause severe pain that lasts from one to three days; or to place someone into a coma or deathlike state.
- **The "Wu Du" ("Five Poisons"):** In Southern China there was a famous black magic poison called the "Wu Du" (Five Poisons). This poisonous formula was prepared on the fifth

day of the fifth Moon, by placing a poisonous centipede, a viper, a poisonous scorpion, a poisonous frog, and a gecko in a clay pot (Figure 1.154). The pot (known as a Gu) was then placed in a dark storage area, and left there for a year. A priest who was proficient in this type of magic was known as a "Wu Gu."

The creatures gradually ate each other and the remains were taken from the pot and mixed with special herbs while speaking magical incantations in order to create a specific type of poison. If the viper remained (which was normally the case), the priest would speak magical incantations while creating Snake-Gu (mixing the Gu ingredients with snake-saliva). This poisonous powder was then used in various types of dark magical practices. For example, it could be placed into an individual's drink (wine) or food and used to bring about the death of a hated rival, or mixed with enough herbs to place the rival into a coma. The sorcerer would then steal the rival's spirit soul (Hun and Yuan Shen), imprison it in a gourd (along with a personal item belonging to the victim), and use it as a spirit slave.

According to ancient writings, "This type of disease (created from the Wu Du) cannot be cured. It is not caused from spirit entities nor by bad food, but from the patient's disordered mind, causing him to lose the firmness of his will. Such a soul roams restlessly about because its corpse is being mutilated (by the poison)."

Of the many Gu formulae mentioned in ancient Chinese texts, there are several symptoms associated with its devastating poison. According to these texts, "When one is affected by such poison, it manifests in ten thousand forms. There is a feeling that some beast is gnawing inside of his body, and it produces cramps located in his heart and abdominal areas. He both vomits and passes a bloody liquid resembling rotten meat. His strength wanes, bones become heavy, joints stiffen, and respiration stops. His five intestines eventually become devoured, and he will die."

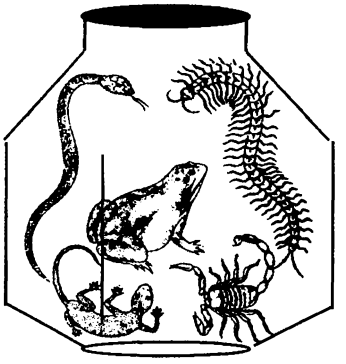


Figure 1.154. The Wu Du "Five Deadly Poisons" were placed inside a clay jar, and then stored in a dark place.

There are slow (death in a year) and quick (death in ten days) progressions to this type of poisoning. One way of diagnosing if the patient has ingested the Gu poison is to have him spit into a bowl of water. If the spittle sinks it is Gu; if it floats, it is not.

Another famous formula used in ancient China by priests of black magic was known as the "Flying Poison." This magical formula was used for "drawing out life." It required the mixture of several herbs along with the dreaded "golden caterpillar." It is said that, when these poisonous caterpillars are combined and cooked in order to create the Flying Poison formula, the insect's spirit enters into the herbal mixture and waits for its chance to avenge itself.

The poison is then placed into a victim's drink (wine) or food. Once the victim ingests the Flying Poison, the spirits of the golden caterpillars revive and begin inflecting pain. Eventually, the victim's belly inflates to such a degree that it finally bursts, causing his death.

PARALYZING

When imprinting herbs for paralyzing, the primary goal is to immobilize a victim and utilize his or her Shen as a "spirit servant." There are also certain herbal poisons that, when correctly formulated, will directly attack the victim's body, resulting in coma like symptoms. The category of Paralyzing Herbs also falls under the heading of Hexing.

MAGICAL HERBAL TOOLS

Once constructed and imprinted, a magical herbal formula can be used to create many different magical tools. These magical tools will vary according to their purpose and function. For example, a Magical Charm can be constructed to bring good luck; however, the same magical function (bringing good luck) can also be achieved by constructing a Magical Oil, Magical Potion, or Magical Incense. Each priest has his or her own specialities and preferences as to which tools through which to work his or her magic. Common magical tools include: Charms and Sachets, Dream Pillows, Herbal Dolls, Consecrating Powders, Incense, Purifying Baths, Anointing Oils, Potions, and Smoking Mixtures (Figure 1.155).

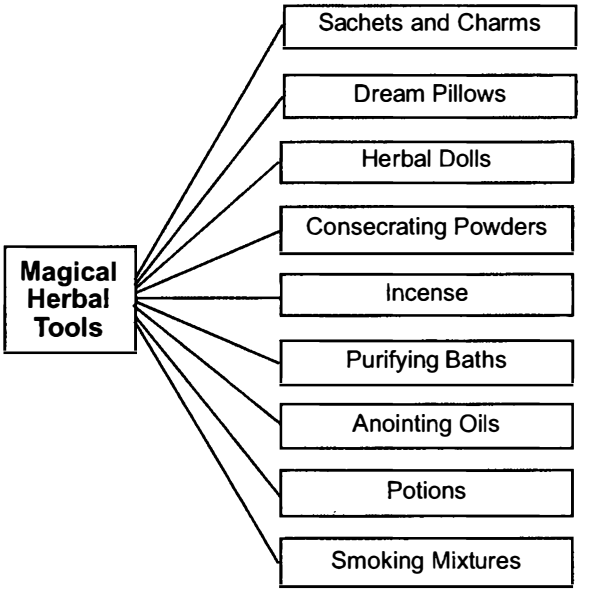


Figure 1.155. Examples of Herbal Magical Tools

MAGICAL SACHETS

Magical Sachets consist of special minerals, plants, drops of oil, and sometimes certain animal products that have been combined together inside a cloth container and used for a specific magical purpose (spirit travel, passion and romance, healing disease, etc.). In China, Magical Sachets have been carried or worn as talismans for centuries. Traditionally, a Sachet will contain at least three or more magical objects (roots, leaves, stones, talismanic paper, etc.). The combination must always add up to an odd (Yang) number, which is then used to energetically activate the magical contents of the Sachet.

Depending on the purpose and type of magical spell being performed, the priest will then carry the Sachet, wear it next to his or her skin, hang it in the house, bury it in a sacred area, add it to a special bath, burn it, or stuff it inside a special statue or magical icon.

- In creating a Magical Sachet, a small bag is constructed using a specific color and type of material.
- Next, a combination of magical plants and consecrated items made to bring protection (i.e., from harm, injury, evil eye, evil spirits, black magic, disease, and accidents), luck, love, etc. are encased within the material.
- In order to increase its magical effect, the Sachet is also fastened with a specific color, shape, and type of thread.
- The Sachet was then tied together with a certain number of magical knots used to enhance its magical power (usually a minimum of three knots is required).
- The Sachet was then energetically activated by and adding the magical power of the four elements as follows: Fire (via incense or candle flame), Air (via Breath Incantation), Water (via Holy Water or spit), and Earth (via crushing the contents of the bag).

MAGICAL CHARMS

In order to avert evil spirits, magical herbal elixir water can be used to create Charm Paper (i.e., creating Magical Talismans, Power Symbol Charms, Sacred Prayer Charms, etc.). The Charm Paper can then be rolled or folded into any shape and tied to a belt, placed in the pocket, purse, wallet, or any type of baggage. It can also be placed into a locket and worn around the neck, attached to the top of the main door, or placed onto the frame of a bed-post.

Healing Charm Paper comes in various colors. The specific color of the Charm Paper signifies the nature and character of the disease and type of cure required. For example:

- A yellow Charm Paper is used for general therapy, including averting misfortune and bringing in of good luck.
- A white Charm Paper is used for exorcising known evil spirits, and for invoking the power of the White Spirit of the West.
- A green Charm Paper is only used for serious types of exorcism, and involves invoking the power of the Green Spirit of the East.

Sometimes Charm Paper is designed in the image of a man or woman, are created to serve as substitutes for the energetic transference of an individual's disease, ailment, or misfortune. These special Charms are then destroyed, either by fire or with a magical weapon.

DREAM PILLOWS

Similar in design to a Sachet, Dream Pillows can consist of special minerals, plants, and sometimes certain animal products that have been combined together inside a cloth container and used for a specific magical purpose (spirit travel, passion and romance, healing disease, etc.). In China, Dream Pillows and aroma-therapy have been used for centuries.

- In making a Dream Pillow, herbs such as Bracken, Jasmine Flower, Marigold Flower, Rose Petals, Mugwort, and Poplar are blended together and sprinkled with Neroli (or Orange) oil and spring water, and sealed within specific colored fabric.
- This mixture is then imprinted with the priest's intention and spoken magical incantations.
- After a Dream Pillow has been stuffed with magical herbs it is then squeezed or beaten in order to activate it and release the aroma of the herbs. Releasing the magical power of the herbs' aroma enables the priest to enter into a trance and also allows his or her three bodies to energetically experience the magical effect of the special herbs (e.g., lucid dreaming or Soul (astral) Travel).

MAGICAL HERB DOLLS

In this type of herbal magic, dolls are made out of roots, bark, leaves, vines, clay, and other materials. The dolls are usually surrounded in cloth and stuffed with herbs. The type of herbs that are placed inside of the doll depends on the priest's intention, (i.e., Herbal Dolls can be used to speed up a healing, attract money, initiate love, or invoke a curse).

Each of the various types of herbal dolls require a different set and combination of magical herbal substances, incantations, and focused intentions placed inside the doll during construction. Once the Herbal Doll is filled and completed, the enchanted herbs within the doll will go to work manifesting the priest's specific needs and desires. The Herbal Doll is then placed on the altar surrounded by candles and a final magical sealing and activation ritual is performed. Next, the doll is placed in a safe place, hidden from the public.

MAGICAL POWDERS

In this type of herbal magic, the herbs can be pulverized into powder and then sprinkled or placed around (or within) the energetic boundaries of a home, altar, or magic circle. This magical practice is used to either define a priest's energetic "territory," or to purify, summon, or banish spirit entities. Magical powders provide the base for constructing many other magical tools (i.e., Incense, Baths, Oils, Potions, etc.). They are also commonly used in Love Magic and Sex Magic.

The following are some examples of magical powders:

<u>Commanding and Controlling Powder</u>
(Sprinkled for regain command and control)
1 part Allspice
1 part Cinnamon
1 part Clover
1 part Patchouli
1 part Sandalwood

<u>Hexing Powder</u>
(Sprinkled to activate curses and hexes)
1 part Graveyard Dirt
1 part Patchouli leaves or root

<u>Exorcism Powder</u>
(Sprinkled to remove curses and hexes)
1 part Asafortida
1 part Bay Leaf
1 part Hyssop
1 part Salt
1 part Vervain

INCENSES

In this type of herbal magic, herbs are blended together in formulas and burned to achieve specific magical purposes (i.e., to purify, summon, banish, etc.). The burning of scented herbs mixed with gums and resins to create a magical incense has been historically utilized in magical rituals for thousands of years. In China, the *Huangdi Neijing* (Yellow Emperor's Cannon of Internal Medicine) lists many uses for scented herbs, recorded in twelve ancient scrolls during the Warring States period (475-221 B.C.).

The aromatic resins used by the ancient Daoists in magical incenses were considered to be the coagulated blood of living plants (i.e., the plants combined energy and spirit). Therefore, the exorcising powers of resins were considered to be one of the best forms of herbs used in "dispersing" magic.

When burned as an incense, herbs and resins were used to create magical vapors (smoke). These vapors were used to clear negative energy from a sacred space, summon a certain deity, or remove a malevolent spirit entity.

The word "perfume" comes from the Latin *pre fumer*, meaning "through smoke," and refers to its ritual use in magical ceremonies to summon the gods. In ancient times, magical incense was traditionally burned or smouldered on glowing charcoal.

The ancient Daoists believed that a plant's fragrance was its soul, and could be used as an energetic gateway into the infinite space of the Wuji. This is why during ceremonies surrounding death, the corpse was sometimes washed in perfume and incense was burned around the body, so that the soul of the deceased could mingle with these fragrances and find its way into the celestial realm of the infinite Dao. The following are some examples of magical incense:

Activation Incense
(For Activating a hexing doll or sachet)
1 part Ginger
1 part Nutmeg
1 part Black Pepper

Hex-Breaking Incense
(Used for reversing curses and hexes)
1 part Bay Leaf
1 part Lavender
1 part Rose Petals
1 part Sandalwood
1 part Verbena

Exorcism Incense
(Used for removing curses and hexes)
1 part Dragon's Blood Resin
1 part Frankincense
1 part Myrrh
1 part Salt

PURIFYING BATHS

In this type of herbal magic, a sachet or infusion containing specific herbs (plants, roots, minerals, etc.) is placed inside of a bath tub, along with a magical talisman. These items are used for ritual cleansing or healing, usually on a new or full moon, to invoke the magical powers of nature (i.e., the Plant Realm and the Celestial Realm) in order to achieve a specific desired goal. Sometimes the talisman is burned and its ashes are mixed with the magical herbs and placed inside of the sachet. Other times, certain infusions or powders are added directly into the bath.

In Purifying Baths used for healing, the flowers most frequently used are chosen because of their ability to energetically envelop the body in a powerful healing sent. Additionally, the flower's vibrant colors are also chosen in order to lift the patient's spirit.

Purifying Baths also include "Hot Herbal Wraps," that made from a combination of clay, mud, and herbs, applied to the skin. Hot Wraps are traditionally used to heal the body and spirit, remove bad luck or evil magic, find a mate, experience good fortune, etc.

The body must be completely immersed in order to allow the herbal mixture to flow into all of orifices, and should be submerged several times. When soaking, the body should be allowed to absorb the contents of the herbal bath for a minimum of ten minutes. When using a Bathing Mixture to rid

the body of serious toxic energy, it is important to first shower and clean your body prior to soaking in the magical herbs. After soaking, allow the body to "air-dry," and do not rinse off for at least 24 hours.

Hex-Breaking Bath
(Used for reversing curses and hexes)
1 part Bay Leaf
1 part Lavender Flowers (dried)
1 part Rose Petals (dried)
1 part Salt
1 part Juice of 1 Lemon

ANOINTING OILS

In this type of herbal magic, special oils and fragrances are constructed and used for "spiritual anointing" (i.e., the body, candles, metals, and talismans), and for protection. Because smells are considered to be invisible forms of energy that invoke emotional responses, priests consider fragrances as the manifestations of spiritual powers (i.e., fragrances are able to create feelings, change moods, alter energetic states, initiate healing or sickness, etc.).

The body's olfactory senses are controlled by the limbic system, which also controls the emotions, therefore smells can be used in order to evoke feelings as well as memories (an individual will experience not just the odor, but a specific mood associated with the smell). Even if an individual does not recognize the smell, he or she will still respond emotionally to it.

When using a magical Anointing Oil, when a priest pours an herbal fragrance onto his or her skin, the energetic and spiritual power activated within the oil begins to penetrate the priest's spirit. This creates a symbiotic interaction (existing between the plant spirit and human spirit), which gives the priest's Anointing Oil its power to influence people.

There are magical Anointing Oils that can be used: for performing powerful magical rituals, for returning a lover, for increasing financial wealth by creating opportunities, for giving advantage in court cases, etc. Anointing Oils are also commonly used in Sex Magic, Spirit Travel, and Invisibility Training. The following are some examples of magical oils:

Anointing Oil
(Used for Purification and Cleansing)
1 part Cassia
1/2 part Cinnamon
1 part Galanga Root
1 part Myrrh
1 pint Olive Oil

Hexing Oil #1
(For dressing candles, hexing dolls and sachets)
1 part Cinnamon
1 part Myrrh
1 part Patchouli
1 part Sage
1 part Vetivert
1 pint Grape Seed Oil or Jojoba Oil

Hexing Oil #2
(For dressing candles, hexing dolls and sachets)
1 part Cinnamon
1 part Myrrh
1 part Bayberry
1 pint Grape Seed Oil or Jojoba Oil

POTIONS

In this type of herbal magic, specific herbs are combined together to create a Potion. A Potion can be constructed in the form of a tincture, infusion, decoction, syrup, soup, or liniment. Potions can be used for healing, protection, purification and consecration, increasing psychic powers, altering consciousness, inducing trance, initiating Soul (astral) Projection, attracting money, initiating love or passion and lust, or cursing. Since a Potion can be used to accomplish nearly any desired purpose, exactly which herbs are used in a Potion depends upon the priest's intended magical application.

Potions can be drunk as teas, added to baths, used to anoint the body, rubbed on walls, floors, and furniture.

SMOKING MIXTURES

In this type of herbal magic, specific herbal formulas are constructed and smoked in order to facilitate altered states of consciousness.

Herbs of Magic and Daoist Alchemy

When I first started studying the energetic properties of Chinese medical herbs, one of my teachers, Dr. Yao, explicitly detailed the various reasons why I should also be studying American herbal therapy and the specific herbs and minerals indigenous to the area where I was living. He explained,

"You don't live in China. If you want to be a powerful healer, you must first study the energetic and spiritual properties of the animals, plants, and minerals where you live. The sickness that exists in the mountains is different then the sickness that exists by the ocean; the energy within the animals, plants, and minerals that is in the mountains are different from the energy within the animals, plants, and minerals that is by the sea. As a healer, you must learn how to observe and utilize the natural energy of the animals, plants and minerals gathered from the environment."

In Daoist Magic, when a priest is constructing a particular herbal formula for blessing (gathering a mate, money, land, or position of power) or cursing (destroying a relationship, bringing bad-luck, sickness, or death) he or she will generally follow the magical rule of correspondence that states "like attracts like." Therefore, the priest will choose sweet herbs in order to bring sweetness into someone's life and bitter herbs in order to bring bitterness into someone's life.

The following is an alphabetical list of some of the most commonly used magical plants and herbs found in several ancient and modern Asian and Western magical traditions. This compilation is meant to educate the reader as to the many energetic potentials ascribed to magical plants.

Acacia (A La Bo Jiao Shu)

Acacia is traditionally used for meditation, protection, and love. According to ancient Chinese belief, the homes of the gods of the North were Acacia trees (Figure 1.156). In certain magical systems, it is also used as an herb for attracting money. Acacia is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

- **Purification:** Acacia Oil is considered to be holy, and is used for anointing the body, and for the purification of an altar or ritual space.

Figure 1.156. Acacia
A La Bo Jiao Shu (Acacia senegal)

- **Protection:** Acacia can be used for protection, warding off evil. Burning its dried flowers brings wisdom and insight.
- **Summoning:** When Acacia Gum is burned with White Sandalwood, it not only attracts spirits, but also stimulates and enhances the priest's psychic abilities. Rubbing Acacia Oil on a white candle can be used in order to contact spirits of the dead (during this ritual, avoid getting Acacia Oil on the body).
- **Healing:** Acacia can be used to increase blood circulation within the skin, and treat skin infections such as smallpox, chicken pox, and measles. It benefits the joints, and can be used to ease arthritis pain (using visualization to awaken the cells to this elixir).

Acacia benefits all twelve chakra gates, but the Qi is mainly focused on the Yellow Court, Third Chakra area, and the hands. After drinking a Acacia elixir, the body's energy becomes purified, then made clearer. Eventually, the light of the Yellow Court becomes more brilliant. Next, the Qi of the Yellow Court is dissipated throughout the body, which usually takes two to three hours after drinking the magical essence. This elixir cleanses and strengthens all of the body's acupuncture points, especially those affecting the upper portion of the body (from the waist upwards). It also enhances all the body's channels, particularly the heart channel. It activates the heart & pericardium channels and quickens their metabolic-related rate briefly, so that the pulsations within the pericardium channel will increase. This elixir also effects the spirit body, bringing new images, pictures, and ideas of ones relationships.

Figure 1.157. Agarwood
Chen Xiang (Aloe Wood)

AGARWOOD (CHEN XIANG)

This magical herb is also known as Aloes Wood, Eaglewood, Agalloch, and Aquilaria agallocha Roxb (Figure 1.157). Agarwood is traditionally combined with other herbs and made into a Protection, Consecration, or Purification Incense, and to bring sweetness into a ritual or meditation area.

- **Protection:** The sent of Black Agarwood drives away evil spirits.
- **Meditation:** Agarwood is used in making incense. It is specifically used for purification, grounding, bringing clarity, opening up the Third Eye, inducing visions, and creating deep meditative states.
- **Healing:** Inhaling Black Agarwood smoke can be effectively used in order to immediately calm patients, who are given over to unpredictable emotional fits and rage.

AGRIMONY (OU LONG YA CAO)

Agrimony is use in Defensive Magic spells and placed in nearly all protection sachets (Figure 1.158). It has the ability to banish negative energies and spirit entities, and for this reason, it is commonly used to break hexes. Agrimony is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter.

- **Protection:** Because it acts as a deflective shield, Agrimony has also long history of use in reversing dark spells that have been cast upon a priest or other unsuspecting victim. When used properly, it not only breaks the hex, but also sends the malignant energy back to the originator.

In one ancient magical tradition, it is said that Agrimony placed under the head "will make one sleep as if dead." According to ancient lore, the sleeper will not awaken until the herb has been removed.

Figure 1.158. Agrimony
Ou Long Ya Cao (Agrimonia eupatoria)

Figure 1.159. Allspice
(Pimenta officinalis or P. dioica)

ALLSPICE

Allspice acts as a catalyst, and works it on higher energetic planes for either good or evil (Figure 1.159). It is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Mind Magic:** Allspice tends to affect the mind and thoughts of the person on whom it is used. It is frequently employed in areas of money, success, luck, love, and psychic influence. The main channel affected by Allspice is the Governing Vessel, allowing more Qi to become available for greater energetic integration.

Allspice also enhances psychic channeling abilities, and better incorporates the information into the person's psyche. It is important to note that Allspice should be used in combinations with other magical herbs in order to enhance one's psychic channeling ability. These magical ingredients should include lotus, green rose, and potato.

Figure 1.160. Althea
Yao Shu Kui (Althaea officinalis)

Figure 1.161. Alum
Ming Fan (Aluminium potassium sulfate)

- **Healing:** Allspice primarily impacts the emotional body. It can be used to emotionally balance a patient with a split personality structure. Use this magical essence when there is a self-inflicted injury, that may have come as a result of multiple personality schizophrenia. There may also be an extenuating problem, in that various parts of the patient's body may be numb. This is not entirely due to the nervous system. In this situation, the priest should use a combination of Allspice and Comfrey.

  Use Allspice when there are psychological problems caused from the brain's function becoming drastically slowed down. This may be caused from an accident, resulting from certain neural difficulties or problems in the patient's neck. As the brain's function is slowed, so then are the capacities for it to integrate. Allspice assists all form of memory loss. This includes senility, and difficulties in short-term and long-term memory. Be aware that in memory loss there may also be other contributing factors, such as psychological problems and an unwillingness to remember.

Althea Root (Yao Shu Kui)

Also known as Marshmallow, Althea Root is a mild and gently commanding herb (Figure 1.160). It is used both for protection and for increasing psychic powers. Althea Root is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon.

- **Protection:** When placed upon the altar, Althea Root is known to attract benevolent spirits to the altar space during magical rituals. When burned as an incense, it is used for protection and/or to stimulate psychic powers.

  In certain magical traditions, Althea Root was sometimes made into an ointment and rubbed on the skin in order to "cast out devils," as well as to protect the bearer against the harmful effects of Black Magic.
- **Love:** Considered to be more of a "persuasion" herb, Althea Root can be burned in combination with other herbs (i.e., Rose Petals and apple blossoms) for a subtle yet forceful form of love incense. One magical tradition encourages the priest to gather a bouquet of Althea Root flowers and place them in a vase outside his or her door or on a windowsill if he or she is experiencing a failing love. This bouquet will "cause them to think lovingly of the relationship, and after that their heart may return to you."

Alum (Ming Fan)

As a mineral, Alum is used like sea salt for energetic protection, and for destroying all forms of negative energy (Figure 1.161). Because it absorbs the watery energy that spirit entities live in, Alum can be placed in a dish and pot inside a room that is infested with negative energies in order to purify the space. The mineral can be scattered beneath the bed for protection while sleeping. It can also be carried in red cloth, added to bath water, or made into an infusion and sprinkled about the home or ritual space. Certain magical traditions also used it in the construction of magical inks.

In Daoist sorcery, 30% Alum is combined along with 30% Huang Bai and 40% Borneol when making Talismanic Paper. These three combined herbs were traditionally mixed during the paper creating process in order to help activate the spells and contain the magical incantations that were projected

Figure 162. Amaranth
Qian Sui Gu (Amaranthus hypochondriacus)

through the priest's calligraphy pen and through the Daoist priest's Breath Incantations.

AMARANTH (QIAN SUI GU)

Amaranth is powerful, and it is sometimes used to lend power to other herbs (Figure 1.162). Amaranth is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

- **Protection:** One magical tradition uses dried Amaranth flowers to call forth the spirits of the dead.
- **Visions:** Amaranth is sometimes used to stimulates visions and assist the priest in receiving messages from his or her higher self.
- **Love:** Amaranth can be used to induce a strong sexual drive, and it is also carried in order to mend the pain of a broken heart.
- **Healing:** In ancient times, a crown of Amaranth was worn on the head to speed up healing. Red Amaranth can be used to increase vitality. Golden Amaranth can be used to stimulate the body's immune system and help it fight against viral and bacterial inflammations. Golden Amaranth can also be used to treat mental disorders caused by chemical imbalances (i.e. hallucinations, attention-span disorientation, excessive radical dreams, autism, and schizophrenia).

AMBER (HU PO)

This opaque or transparent substance is actually fossilized resin (considered to be the coagulated blood and Shen of living plants), and can be either golden brown or yellow in color (Figure 1.163). In ancient China, Amber was believed to contain the souls of many tigers and the power of many Suns.

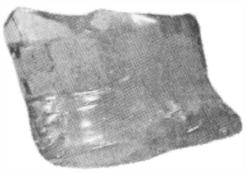


Figure 1.163. Amber
(Hu Po - Tiger Spirit)

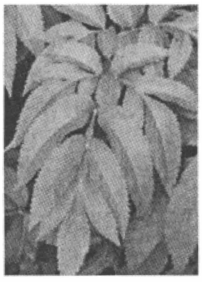


Figure 1.164. Angelica
Bai Zi (Angelica dahurica Bench. et Hook. f.)

- **Protection:** Amber is considered a powerful protector that links the conscious-self to the higher spiritual-self. Therefore it has been used for thousands of years as a powerful protective agent in creating incense and magical talismans. Amber purifies the body's physical, energetic, and emotional fields, absorbs negative energy and transmutes them into clear, positive forces that stimulate the body to heal itself.

  Amber also protects against psychic attacks released from sorcery or witchcraft, and it relieves nightmares. It can be used as a magical amplifier, and, because of its purification ability, Amber is sometimes used by priests when traveling into the lower spiritual realms of the Underworld.
- **Healing:** Amber is considered to be a form of solidified sunlight and is therefore sometimes used as a powerful Chakra cleanser.

ANGELICA (BAI ZI)

This magical herb is also known as Angelica dahurica Bench. et Hook. f. (Figure 1.164).

- **Meditation:** Bai Zi is used in making incense. It is specifically used for calming the spirit and for entering into deep states of meditation.

ANGELICA (YUAN DANG GUI)

Angelica has long been regarded as a spiritual plant with almost supernatural powers. There are several dozen varieties of Angelica; the most commonly used species are 3 to 4 feet tall with large roots (occurring either in clumps or as a single carrot-like tuber) and white flowers (Figure 1.165). It grows wild in damp places and is cultivated as both a medicinal and magical plant. Angelica is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

Angelica is one of the most powerful protective herbs known to natural magic. In certain magical traditions, it is known as "Masterwort," "Archangel" or "the Root of the Holy Ghost." The root is the most commonly used part of the plant; it can be used whole as an amulet, or pieces of the root can be eaten straight or powdered.

- **Protection:** Angelica enhances the effectiveness of the mind, and can be used by the priest to extend and actually control all portions of his or her physical body.

  Angelica also energetically protects by both creating a barrier against negative energy and by filling its user with positive energy. It was used in ancient times to purify the altar space and banish negativity.

  Angelica is also used to ward off psychic attacks from hostile priests or evil spirits and to break curses. Burning the powdered root removes hexes and invokes the presence of the celestial immortals.

  A priest can sprinkle the four corners of his or her house with Angelica powder or spread the powder around the perimeter of an area in order to ward off evil. The root can be carried in a pouch as a protective talisman. The root can also be worn about the neck as a protective amulet, or placed in strategic areas around the house to ward of evil spirits and dispel psychic attacks issued from hostile priests.
- **Exorcism:** Dried Angelica leaves are burned in exorcism and banishing rituals. Angelica is used in nearly all protection and exorcism incenses. Angelica is sometimes added to a bath in order to remove hexes, curses, and any spells that have been cast against the priest.
- **Visions:** Smoking Angelica leaves is said to cause visions. Angelica is also sometimes brewed as an eye lotion to strengthen vision. Portions of the root were also used as a ritual drink in order to induce a tranquilizing and hypnotic effect.
- **Healing:** Angelica is often used in healing incenses and herbal healing formulas. It serves to bring energies of healing and blessings to bear on a specific person, place, or thing. Portions of the root can be added to bath water to cleanse the body's energetic fields. In ancient Chinese medicine, the root of Angelica ("Self-Reliant Existence") was used to enter into the Kidney and Urinary Bladder channels in order to dispel Wind Cold and Dampness, as well as to alleviate painful obstructions in the lower back and legs. Angelica is a diuretic, relieves tension headaches, and is beneficial to the stomach and the digestion. It also relieves buildup of phlegm due to asthma and bronchitis.

  Because Angelica augments the nervous system (by energetically connecting the sympathetic and autonomic nervous systems), it is used to treat many neurological imbalances such as epilepsy. It energetically acts as a bonding agent, tying together the many diverse aspects of the personality. Therefore it is sometimes used to treat psychological imbalances such as disorientation, lack of confidence, sluggish response, and can be used in cases of obsession, and autism.

Figure 1.165. Angelica
Yuan Dang Gui (Angelica archangelica)

Figure 1.166. Asafoetida
E Wei (Ferula foetida)

Angelica also rejuvenates torn tissue in the body, and relieves diseases such as skin ulceration or eczema.

ASAFOETIDA (E WEI)

Asafoetida produces alternating leaves and can grow six to ten feet in height (Figure 1.166). It has a large fleshy root that is cultivated for its foul smelling but powerful juice. Asafoetida is sometimes known as "devil's dung," and its smell is quite vile. Asafoetida is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** Asafoetida is one of the strongest magical protection herbs and is said to destroy psychic attacks, curses, hexes, jinxes, and evil spirits. It can be eaten to ward off evil.

  When burned as an incense, Asafoetida can be used as a powerful tool for banishing (driving away evil) and for destroying energetic manifestations. It has a reputation for driving off evil spirits, no matter how powerful they are.

  It also clears objects in enclosed spaces (such as a room) of all magical energies. Priest's who practice the ritual of summoning entities often keep a bottle of powdered Asafoetida on the altar, just in case things go wrong.

  One disadvantage to this habit however, is that if the Asafoetida is ever used as an incense, every magical object present in the room where it is burned will be immediately stripped of its powers, and the magical energies of each object will have to be reconstructed and activated.

Figure 1.167. Bamboo
Zhu Zi (Bambusa vulgaris)

BAMBOO (ZHU ZI)

Bamboo is commonly used for Protection, Hex-Breaking, and Divination (Figure 1.167), and was used in ancient China as a charm against evil spirits. It was also used to construct a magical flute that, when played, had the power to summon a spirit entity. In such rituals, the name of the spirit was first carved onto the inside of a bamboo flute; the priest would then perform purification rites and play an improvised melody.

The bamboo tree was also the preferred material used by the ancient Daoists in the construction of Magical Staffs. Bamboo was chosen because of its unique energetic characteristics and powerful esoteric symbolism, described as follows:

- The bamboo's trailing branches bow to the ground because its heart is empty. An empty heart is humble. Therefore, the bamboo tree is a symbol of "virtue" (De). Also, because it has a "hollow center," bamboo also symbolizes "modesty."
- The bamboo tree is compared to a noble master, because it never changes. Convinced of its power, it stands upright and proud through every season, even through the worst storms. Therefore, the Bamboo tree is a symbol of "trust and permanence."
- The bamboo tree is forever green. The bamboo tree, pine tree, and plum tree are considered to be the "Three Friends of Winter" because they never change. Therefore, the bamboo tree is considered to be a symbol of "long life."
- The bamboo tree and its branches explode when set on fire. This loud "boom" is believed to drive away evil spirits and thunderstorms.

In ancient China, bamboo branches were originally used for fireworks in magical rituals and regular festivities (i.e., greeting the New Year). Therefore, the bamboo tree is a symbol of "initiating chaos" so that peace and tranquility can return.

- In Chinese, the word for "bamboo" and the word for "prayer" sound alike. Therefore, bamboo shoots are sometimes used during prayer ceremonies, and a vase containing bamboo branches can be used in order to increase the magical effectiveness of a prayer.

A magical elixir made from Bamboo is said to energetically open the body's central channel (Taiji Pole), through which the soul's eternal life-force flows.

The Bamboo is part of the "Four Gentlemen" (sijunzi), also known as the "Four Plants of Virtue." These include the plum, orchid, bamboo, and the chrysanthemum. Each of these plants represents one of the four seasons, and together, the four plants represent a year: the orchid represents Spring, the bamboo represents summer, the chrysanthemum represents autumn, and the plum represents winter. The plum and bamboo together signify friendship.

The *Zhupu (Bamboo Treatise)*, written during the Three Kingdoms Period (220-280 A.D.), gives a detailed account of the uses of Bamboo in ancient times. For example:

- The young shoots serve as food.
- The pulp serves in the manufacturing of paper.
- The stems serve for pipes, buckets, masts, furniture, cups, containers, etc.
- The leaves serve as rain-coats, thatch, packing, etc.
- The seeds, leaves, sap, and roots serve as medicine.
- The wood slabs serves as tablets for books, magical charms, and talismans.

Figure 1.168. Basil
Luo Le (Ocimum basilicum)

BASIL (LUO LE)

Basil is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.168).

- **Purification:** Basil can be used in consecrations and purification rituals. One ancient magical tradition states the Basil "discourages flies and encourages flavors," which is why the French put pots of Basil in their restaurants. It is a wonderful ingredient for a purification bath sachet.
- **Protection:** Basil is said to keep evil away, and can be mixed with other herbs for protection. In ancient times, it was believed that if Basil was strewn onto the floor, no evil would be able to inhabit the area. Therefore, in order to protect a home, small amounts of the herb were placed in each room.

  Priests are encouraged to rub it on the forehead for protection in a crowd of people whom they do not trust. Basil can also be burned as a form of exorcism incense.
- **Visions:** Basil is said to assist the priest in spirit travel.
- **Prosperity:** It is said that Basil attracts wealth to those who carry it in their pockets, purse, or wallet. Basil leaf was sometimes soaked in water for 3 days, then sprinkled about a place of business, placed with a merchant's changing money, or placed on the door sill in order to attract customers and dispel bad influences.

- **Resolving Conflict:** Basil has a penetrating quality. When ingested, its magical elixir is good for getting to the heart of the matter in emotional conditions. Two people attempting to negotiate will find that basil essence facilitates easier negotiation. It is an excellent essence for people who cannot resolve disputes.
- **Love:** Basil is add to love incense mixes and sachets, or its fresh leaves are rubbed against the skin as a natural "love" inducing perfume. It is an excellent incense to use when performing sex magic and love divinations.

  Basil is good for love spells and love potions, and it is also used for healing relationships. Basil is sometimes used to remove obstacles in love and create harmony (e.g., it was crushed and powdered while speaking a love and/or binding incantation, then it was sprinkled on food or sprinkled over a sleeping lover to assure fidelity). It was also used in a ritual bath to bring new love in, or to free oneself of an old love.

  Basil was said to clear the head when used as a snuff. It attracts friends and dispels melancholy, and it was even believed to make a barren woman fertile. In Eastern Europe it was once believed that a young man would love any woman from whose hand he had accepted a sprig of Basil.
- **Healing:** Basil can cause a slight draining of the nasal passages and the cleansing of the colon. It also helps remove toxemia from the body, and has a rejuvenating effect on the kidneys. Basil also enhances the sense of smell. Those with a keen sense of smell often have a fairly active endocrine system. Basil is a tonic for the endocrine system as a whole. Drinking the elixir can cause some beneficial effects for the spleen and some rejuvenation or increase in the capacity for producing white blood cells, especially in conjunction with the spleen.

Figure 1.169. Bay Leaf
Yue Gui Shu (Laurus nobilis)

BAY LEAF (YUE GUI SHU)

Bay Leaf is used for purification, to induce visions, for protection and for healing (Figure 1.169). In ancient times, Bay Leaf was believed that the priest's wishes could be written on a Bay Leaf leaf and then burned to make them come true. Bay Leaf is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

- **Purification:** Bay Leaf leaves are considered to be a psychic purifier. They can be add to cleansing teas and baths for purification and for healing the spiritual heart.
- **Protection:** Bay Leaf is considered to be a powerful commanding herb, and it can be used for banishing (in some magical traditions, Bay Leaf is also used for hexing). It was traditionally worn as an amulet to ward off evil and negativity, burned or scattered in Exorcism Rituals, or placed in the windows to guard against lightning. Because Bay Leaf was considered to be a "curse breaker," it was sometimes scattered around the altar area (scatter on the floor, and then sweep out for protection), burned (to remove curses and evil spells burn with White Sandalwood), or hung in the four corners in order to prevent any poltergeists or evil spirits from working mischief.

Figure 1.170. Feng Zi (Bee)

- **Visions:** Bay Leaf leaves were believed to induce prophetic dream-visions, clairvoyance, healing. They were one of the traditional herbal ingredients used in a "dream pillow." They could also be placed under a pillow in order to induce prophetic dreams, and their scent was sometimes inhaled to induce visions and clairvoyance, or to gain wisdom. The leaves were sometimes burnt or chewed in order to induce visions and prophesies.
- **Healing:** Bay Leaf leaves activate the Fifth (Throat) Chakra, open the bronchial passages, facilitate full breathing and the full expression of Qi. They are considered to be decongestive on all levels and are therefore good for treating colds, flu, rheumatism, and sprains.

Bee (Feng Zi)

From an ancient Chinese perspective, the Golden Yellow Bee (Figure 1.170), is the bringer of spiritual gifts (honey and wax), and is responsible for the natural energetic transformation of Earth-substance. When I was training at the Mao Shan Monastery in 2004, one of my teachers told me of the magical correspondences existing between the energy attracting the "Bees to a Hive," and the "Daoist Disciples to the teachings of Laozi." The sound of a Bee is not only the energetic manifestation of the Spirit Body entering into a higher resonance within the disciple's energy field, but it is also viewed as a symbolic representation of the Daoist priest's desire to achieve the pure sweetness of a spiritual walk, only acquired through persistent application.

When using a Bee as a magical ingredient for Loading the Altar Statue, it can either be inserted dead or alive. If the priest chooses to use dead bees, he should choose about 5- grams; If he chooses to use live bees, then he should only use 2 or 3 of the Golden Yellow insects.

Figure 1.171. Benzoinum
An Xi Xiang (Styrax benzoin)

Benzoinum (An Xi Xiang)

Benzoinum is a large tropical evergreen plant that is native to southeast Asia. It sometimes grows up to 60 feet tall, and its leaves resemble those of a lemon or orange tree (Figure 1.171). Benzoinum is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

- **Purification:** Benzoinum powder is used in the construction of herbal incense formulas, and it is used by itself as an incense (burned on charcoal) for purification. It can also be added to an incense formulas to heighten their effective-ness. Benzoinum can be burned to cleanse an altar space (or home before moving in).
- **Protection:** The resins of Benzoinum have been used for thousands of years for banishing evil spirits, purification, exorcism, and protection. Its oils and powdered incense are used for removing evil spirits and hexes. Therefore, Benzoinum is never added to hexing herbs.

  Benzoinum is sometimes added to other herbs in order to focus their energies and blend their powers. Its powder can be sprinkled onto any potion in order to make the formulas power last longer.

  It is used for communication and improving the thought processes, and is said to encourage confidence and empowerment while simultaneously calming and sedating the Shen.
- **Visions:** Benzoinum was believed to awaken the higher mind and was sometimes used in

order to assist the disciple in entering into the higher spiritual realms. In ancient times, the priests would burn Benzoinum incense in order to enter into Soul Projection (Astral Projection).

- **Prosperity:** Benzoinum is also said to attract prosperity, and it is mixed with Basil, Peony, or Cinnamon in order to make an incense that will attract customers.
- **Healing:** In ancient Chinese Medicine, Benzoinum ("Peaceful Rest Fragrance") was used to enter into the Heart, Liver, and Spleen Channels. It invigorates the blood, promotes the movement of Qi, and opens the upper orifices. It is also used to treat coma, delirium, and pain in the chest and abdominal area. Benzoinum is occasionally used to relieve dry skin, coughs, and arthritis.

BETONY (YAO YONG SHI CAN)

Most varieties of Betony (also known as Bishopswort) have a single trunk with alternating hairy leaves that extend out directly from the main stem; the color of the flower differs according to the exact variety (Figure 1.172). When mature, a Betony plant can grow in clusters up to three feet in height. Betony is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter.

- **Protection:** Betony is a powerful protective herb that has often been used to banish hostile magic, nightmares, and evil creatures that stalk in the night. It is sometimes planted in church yards to keep ghosts at rest, and it was worn as an amulet in ancient times for protection (especially by those individuals that habitually travelled after dark). Like many magical herbs however, it is believed to lose all its magical power if touched with iron. The entire plant can sometimes be molded into amulets, placed inside satchels, or used as an infusion to banish hostile magic and malevolent spirits. An herbal pillow can be filled with Betony to prevent nightmares. The dried bark can be placed under the pillow for protection from an incubus or succubus, or from any form of night spirit.

Figure 1.172. Betony
Yao Yong Shi Can (Stachys or Betonica officinalis)

The herb can also be grown outside in the yard to protect the house and all who live there from the psychic attack of destructive magical forces. In certain magical traditions, Betony is traditionally burned at the midsummer bonfire, and the adepts jump through the smoke in order to purify their bodies of all ills.

- **Love:** Betony is known as a good herb to carry when making love advances, and it is said to reunite quarrelling couples if the herb is added to their food. Works primarily in balancing attitudes in the conflict of sexual energy and the desire for higher principles.

Betony is sometimes used to enhance the higher spiritual philosophies and the necessary sacrifices that transpire with sexual abstinence (i.e., one gains insight into whether or not celibacy is the correct path). Because it also provides a state of inner peace without suppressing the sexual appetite, it can be used to help oversexed people exert more self-control. Betony energetically strengthens the energetic and spiritual bodies, as well as the Second and Seventh Chakras, and the pineal gland.

Figure 1.173. Bistort
Quan Can (Polygonum bistorta)

Figure 1.174. Black Cohosh
Zong Hua Sheng Ma (Cimicifuga racemosa)

Bistort (Quan Can)

Bistort root is also known as Dragonwort, and it is popularly used in several types of magical applications (Figure 1.173). Bistort is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

- **Purification:** It can be carried for purification and protection.
- **Protection:** Temples, altars, and dwellings can be cleared of ghosts and spirit entities by burning Bistort root as an incense. It can also be made into an infusion and sprinkled about the area.
- **Visions:** Bistort can be burned with Frankincense Resin or simply carried on its own in order to improve psychic powers. It is also good for divination.
- **Prosperity:** Bistort root can used in magical formulas for money drawing money, especially when combined with Juniper and Allspice. It is sometimes sprinkled in a purse or wallet in order to promote prosperity.
- **Love:** Bistort root can used for fertility, and it is often carried in order to help a woman conceive.
- **Healing:** Bistort is very grounding, it clears the mind, relieves mental disorientation, and brings one emotional resiliency and strength. It also helps realign the spinal column and activates the First Chakra (which strengthens the coccyx and sacrum).

Black Cohosh (Zong Hua Sheng Ma)

Black Cohosh, also kown as Blasck Snakeroot, is used for both love and protection (Figure 1.174). When carried, it is said to help strengthen courage, relieve depression, and calm the nerves. Black Cohosh is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** Black Cohosh is used for protection from all harm and evil. An infusion of Sheng Ma is commonly sprinkled in the ritual room in order to eliminate evil spirits and dispel negative energies.
- **Love:** Black Cohosh is said to increase the sexual potency of a priest's love life. It is sometimes sprinkled around the bed in order to get an arguing couple to stop fighting and make up. It is also added to love sachets or baths in order to attract love.

Black Cohosh is burned in many love spells, and is often used by male priests in order to induce seduction. The root can be combined and burned with "Adam and Eve" root in order to make a love spells more effective. It can also be used to destroy an unwanted love (burn Black Cohosh with specific artifacts of the person whom you want to leave you alone).

Figure 1.175. Blessed Thistle
(Cnicus benedictus)

Figure 1.176. Bloodroot
(Sanguinaria canadensis)

BLESSED THISTLE

Usually found in Europe and Western Asia, Blessed Thistle has the spiny leaves and flower heads that are common to all Thistles (Figure 1.175). Blessed Thistle is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** Blessed Thistle is generally used to battle hostile magic, and it was also useful against the lesser focused intentions of projected anger, hatred, envy, jealousy, blame, and ill-will. Blessed Thistle is used in hex-breaking spells. It can be worn to protect from evil, or added to baths for purification. It can also be strewn about to purify and cleanse buildings or rooms, increase protection from evil, and remove unwanted malevolent influences. Certain magical traditions believe that Blessed Thistle can be used to ward off thieves if it is grown in the garden.
- **Healing:** Blessed Thistle is used in healing spells to drive out melancholy. It strengthens the liver's function, combats hepatitis, aids memory, and purifies the blood stream. Blessed Thistle is good for treating migraines, nausea, and gallstones.

  Blessed Thistle also energetically affects the womb in females, and semen in males. It energetically works on all the levels of the sexual anatomy, doing whatever is necessary for restoring fertility (i.e., from removing blockages within the fallopian tubes to increasing low protein assimilation that resulted in low sperm count).

BLOODROOT

Bloodroot is used in order to protect the priest from harm. The darkest red roots are considered to be the best, and are commonly known as "king roots" (Figure 1.176). Bloodroot is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** It is said that no evil can cross where Bloodroot has been sprinkled. Therefore, it is commonly placed on each windowsill of a house. Bloodroot can be carried in black cloth for protection.

  Bloodroot is sometimes burned on charcoal or added to an herbal infusion of bath water in order to counter hexes and negative spells. Additionally, when thrown on the doorsteps of someone who is cursing you, Bloodroot will reverse the power of that priest's hex.
- **Mind Magic:** Bloodroot enhances mental concentration, and can be used to initiate deeper meditation and creative visualization practices. It also is helpful in bringing the energy body and spirit body into greater alignment, allowing them to function more as a single unit.
- **Love:** Bloodroot is sometimes used to maintain fidelity, especially when someone else is trying to take your lover. It can be carried in red cloth for love.
- **Healing:** Energetically, Bloodroot elixirs can be ingested in order to eases blood clots and can be used to treat certain types of cancer.

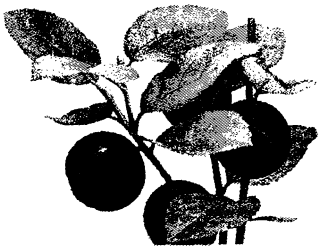


Figure 1.177. Blueberry
(Vaccinum frondosum)

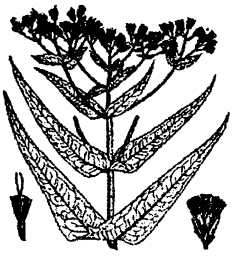


Figure 1.178. Boneset
(Eupatorium perfoliatum)

Figure 1.179. Borage
(Borago officinalis)

Blueberry

Blueberry leaves are used for protection against evil spirits, treachery, deception, and negativity. Although it does not return the treachery back to the individual who initiated the curse, it is said to keep the hex from reaching you (Figure 1.177).

In ancient times, Blueberry leaves were ground inside a mortar while speaking binding incantations. The powder was then sprinkled under the doormat in order to protect the inhabitants from harm. It was believed that anyone entering the house who wished you harm would either not stay long or would simply refuse to enter the house.

Certain magical traditions encourage their disciples to eat blueberry pies or tarts when under a psychic attack (especially during a full moon); this allows the energetic protection provided by the Blueberry to get inside of the disciple's body and additionally increases the herb's magical effectiveness.

Boneset

Boneset is used to ward off evil spirits, for protection, and to get rid of an enemy (Figure 1.178). Boneset is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

- **Protection:** Boneset is said to help the priest overcome fears. In order to drive away negative energy, disruptive animals, or evil spirits, the priest could sprinkle an infusion made from Boneset around the house, yard, or temple.
- **Exorcism:** In ancient times, Boneset was used to Exorcise a negative person by rubbing the leaves all over the individual and then taking the leaves outside and burning them.
- **Vision:** Boneset is sometimes used in magical formulas to induce visions and increase the priest's psychic abilities.

Borage

Borage is used to induce visions, for protection and for healing (Figure 1.179). Borage is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter.

- **Protection:** Its basic powers are said to give strength and provide courage (for this, it is carried in a yellow cloth whenever extra strength is needed).
- **Vision:** Borage tea is supposed to induce psychic and increase psychic powers.
- **Healing:** Traditionally, priests would used Borage in drinks to lift their spirits (especially during stressful times), and it is very good for treating fevers and infections.

Figure 1.180. Borneol
Bing Pian (Dryobalanops aromatica)

Figure 1.181. Bracken Fern
(Pteridium aquilinum)

BORNEOL (BING PIAN)

Borneol aromatically opens the orifices and revives the spirit (Figure 1.180). It is commonly used to effect the peripheral nervous system, and it has a stimulating effect on the higher centers of the brain.

In Daoist sorcery, 40% Borneol is combined along with 30% Huang Bai and 30% Alum when making Talismanic Paper. These three combined herbs were traditionally mixed during the paper creating process in order to help activate the spells and contain the magical incantations that were projected through the priest's calligraphy pen and through the Daoist priest's Breath Incantations.

BRACKEN FERN

Bracken Fern is used for invisibility training, protection and in Weather Magic (Figure 1.205). Bracken Fern is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury.

- **Protection:** The Fern is considered to be an extremely powerful protective plant. In ancient times, Fern were traditionally grow in and around the house for protection from evil and negativity. In certain magical traditions, dried Fern is sometimes thrown onto hot coals in order to exorcise evil spirits. The smoke from burning Fern is also said to drive away snakes. In one magical legend, it is said that Fern "sap" will confereternal youth onto those who drink it.
- **Invisibility:** Like all Ferns, Bracken is associated with the art of magic and invisibility. Priests who wish to walk unnoticed would commonly carry Fern "seeds" (powdered spores known as Hai Jin Sha) with them. In truth, Ferns have no seeds, but reproduce by means of spores, which grow on the bottom of the leaflets. The powdery spores have been gathered and pocketed by priests since ancient times. Traditionally this type of harvesting was done at midnight, and the spores were shaken out onto of sheet of virgin parchment or paper.

  Another "Invisibility" formula required Poppy Seed and dried Fern leaves to be ground together "beneath the dark light of a New Moon." Then, Myrrh, Marjoram, Slippery Elm and fresh Dill was added to the mixture along with fresh spring water and almond oil. The herbs were then dried and the mixture was sprinkled over objects to conceal them from others while speaking a magical incantation. If the invisible powder was added to a priest's magical sachet, it was first purified over the altar smoke.
- **Weather Magic:** The Fern is considered to be an excellent plant to use for Weather Magic (i.e., when burned outside, fern is used to bring rain).

Figure 1.182. Bramble
(Rubus fruticosus syn. R. ulmifolius)

BRAMBLE

Bramble leaf (also known as Blackberry) is a powerful herb of protection (Figure 1.182). Bramble is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Summoning:** Bramble is sometimes used for summoning and in invocations. It is believed that a Bramble patch is a favorite hiding place for Nature Spirits. Therefore Bramble is use to invoke and attract Nature Spirits. It is also used to attract wealth.
- **Protection:** Certain magical traditions teach that if it is twined into a wreath with Rowan and Ivy, it will keep away evil spirits.
- **Prosperity:** Bramble is sometimes used to attract wealth.

BROOM (JIN QUE ER)

Broom is used for purification and protection, to induce visions and in Weather Magic (Figure 1.183). Broom is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** Broom is traditionally used in purification and protection spells, and it is commonly scattered around an area to exorcise evil spirits. It can also be boiled in salt water and then sprinkled to keep poltergeists and evil spirits away.
- **Visions:** Broom is commonly used for divination, and for inducing prophetic dreams. A tea concocted of Broom can be used to increase psychic visions, and its smoke can be used as a sedative (use in moderation, as the smoke can be toxic).
- **Weather Magic:** Broom tops (or Scotch Broom) is used in Weather Magic in order to raise and calm winds (i.e., it is thrown into the air while speaking incantations in order to raise the wind; it is burned while speaking incantations in order to calm the wind).

Figure 1.183. Broom
Jin Que Er (Cytisus scoparius)

Figure 1.184. Bryony
Xie Gen Shu (Bryonia alba, B. dioica)

BRYONY (XIE GEN SHU)

Bryony is a climbing plant that has a prickly stem, grows up to about ten feet in length, and attaches itself via spiraling tendrils that grow opposite its leaves (Figure 1.184). Bryony is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Summoning:** The magical Bryony root was a common substitute for Mandrake because it possessed a similar humanlike appearance and many of the same traditional magical powers. Little humanlike figures were often carved in Bryony root and then buried in wet sand until the cut surfaces grew back again. The resulting action of this plant transplantation was then used to house a "Familiar" spirit, which was then fed with the daily offerings of wine.

- **Protection:** Like Mandrake, Bryony is a magical amplifier, and a small amount of the root placed in an amulet or talisman will increase the object's energetic power. By itself, the root has protective powers, but it can also be combined with solar herbs and magical stones to create a powerful energetic shield. Other traditions claimed that Bryony was excellent when used for protecting against lightning. Because the Bryony plants are poisonous, they should never be taken as internal elixirs or used in charms that come in close contact with the body.

Figure 1.185. Burdock
Niu Bang (Arctium lappa)

BURDOCK (NIU BANG)

The basic powers of Burdock are used for purification and for protection (Figure 1.185). Burdock is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Purification:** When taken in an elixir for 6 months or more (2x daily), it brings a powerful wave of clearing and cleansing energy to the spirit body.
- **Learning:** Burdock is also said to cleanse and clear various aspects of consciousness (i.e., shift old emotional habit patterns and increase one's ability to assimilate new information), bring a sense of calm and peace, and grant the priest a profound ability to energetically project thoughts. It can work deeply to assist the priest when he or she is attempting to learn new skills (i.e., new ways of working with their bodies or with their eyes). It can also be quite useful in Bate's therapy as new ways of integrating both what is learned through the operation of the eyes and what is being experienced.
- **Protection:** Burdock root can be powdered can cast around the home or ritual space in order to ward off negativity. Burdock root can also be added to protection sachets or combined with other herbs in order to create protection incenses (these incenses can then be later used in protection spells).

  One magical tradition claims it is best to gather Burdock roots during the waning Moon, dry them, then cut them into small pieces. These small pieces of Burdock root are then strung onto a red thread (like beads) and worn around the priest's neck for protection against evil spirits and negative thought forms.

  Burdock roots can also be carried inside a protection sachet or burned on coals in order to purify a room. The priest can rinse his or her body with a Burdock root decoction in order to rid negative feelings. It can also be added to a bucket of water and sprinkled around the home or used to wash the floor to cleanse a space of negativity.
- **Healing:** It is said that when laid at the soles of the feet, the leaves of Burdock help to cure gout. A magical elixir created from Burdock can be of great benefit in treating knee problems, helping to heal all of the cells relating to the knees (i.e., the cartilage, the back of the knee, and the patella). As the regeneration of tissue in the knees increases, the entire knee is aided.

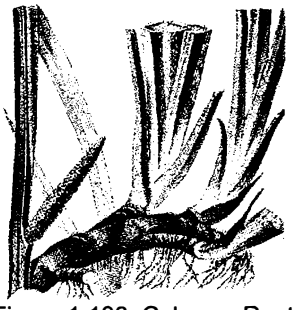


Figure 1.186. Calamus Root
Sheng Teng Shu (Acorus calamus)

Figure 1.187. Camphor
Zhang Nao (Cinnamomum camphora)

Calamus Root (Sheng Teng Shu)

Calamus Root is used to induce visions, for protection, and to attract love (Figure 186). Calamus Root is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon.

- **Protection:** This herb can be used to strengthen and bind spells. Also has a good reputation for overturning malicious spells or energies. It is considered to be a "controlling" herb (i.e. it is sometimes used in magical spells to control a person or situation) and is powerful enough to be used alone or in combination with other herbs.
- **Visions:** Calamus Root is considered to be a Hallucinogenic, however, this herb can be poisonous, and should be use with caution. It was sometimes chewed in order to bring about clear visions and to strengthen the psychic senses. In ancient times, Calamus Oil was rubbed into the feet to attract spirit or animal guides to accompany the priest on his or her vision quest.

  It is sometimes combined with Cannabis in order to neutralize the harmful side effects of the Cannabis plant.
- **Love:** Calamus Root is sometimes used in love spells and love potions in order to attract a lover.

Camphor (Zhang Nao)

Camphor is used for purification, protection, to induce visions, and for healing (Figure 1.187). Camphor is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon.

- **Purification:** Camphor is commonly used to cleanse and banish. It is traditionally offered to the Moon Goddess Heng O on a New Moon to thank her for answering prayers used in Love Magic.
- **Protection:** Camphor is sometimes placed in the corners of rooms in order to ward off evil. It is also used to ward off the unwanted advances from other individuals.
- **Visions:** This herb is used to stimulate psychic awareness, induce prophetic visions, and awaken past life memories. Camphor is also used in Divination Rituals.
- **Healing:** Camphor is sometimes used in healing for pain relief.

  Camphor temporarily aligns the subtle bodies, which activates the body's energy body, acupuncture points, channels, and nervous system.

Figure 1.188. Capsicum
Xiao Mi La (Capsicum frutescens)

CAPSICUM (XIAO MI LA)

The Capsicum family includes peppers of various sizes, shapes, and potencies (Figure 1.188). One of the most widely used forms of Capsicum is Cayenne. The addition of Cayenne increases the magical power of any spell, and its main focus of power is to control. Cayenne deactivates the liver's natural tendency to neutralize unknown or unusual substances; thus the addition of Cayenne to a formula vastly increases the power and effect of the formula. Capsicum is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** Capsicum is a catalyst of great strength and negativity, and is commonly used in hexes, or to break a hex. Because of its natural energetic fire (or spiritual spark), Capsicum is used by many priests in order to reverse evil and return it to the sender. Capsicum is sometimes used in love or separation spells.
- **Healing:** This herb contains capsaicin, which acts as a stimulating digestive aid. It aids in circulation and stimulates blood pressure. Capsicum strengthens the heart and is sometimes made into a poultice and applied externally to ease joint pain or treat certain types of cold diseases.

Figure 1.189. Caraway
Hao Zhong Zi (Carum carvi)

CARAWAY (HAO ZHONG ZI)

Caraway (also known as "rye seed"), is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.189).

- **Protection:** Caraway seeds are sometimes carried in a sachet for protection against all manner of evil spirits, entities, and negativity. It is often said that any object that holds Caraway seeds is theft proof.

  It is sometimes known as an herb of communication and information. Eating the seeds while conducting research will allow the priest to quickly discover the answers.
- **Visions:** Caraway is used in sleep pillows in order to help the priest remember his or her dreams.
- **Love:** It is said that when used in cooking, Caraway seeds will induce passion and lust. The seeds are also sometimes added to love sachets and love charms in order to attract a sexual partner. Chewing the seeds said to be helpful in gaining the love of the one you desire, and the seeds are also sometimes used in spells or added to sachets in order to ensure fidelity.
- **Healing:** Caraway seeds act as a mild stimulant for digestion. The seeds also strengthen the memory and are good to use when studying.

Figure 1.190. Cardamon
Bai Dou Kou (Elettaria cardamomum)

CARDAMON (BAI DOU KOU)

Cardamon (sometimes known as Xiao Dou Kou) is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.190).

- **Love:** The white Cardamon pods are primarily used as an aphrodisiac, especially in love rituals and to initiate romance. Cardamon is said to have some commanding and compelling magical properties, especially in the area of sex magic. It is used as a powerful catalyst for other herbs, and is commonly included in love or lust spells. It can also be added to love sachets, incense, or lust potions (e.g., add crushed seeds to warm wine and drink).
- **Prosperity:** The green Cardamon pods are primarily used to bring good luck and wealth.

CASCARA SAGRADA

Cascara Sagrada is used primarily for protection and in prosperity spells (Figure 1.191).

- **Protection:** Cascara bark was often carried to protect against curses or negative spirits. It was also sometimes worn as an amulet to protect against evil and hexes.
- **Prosperity:** Cascara Sagrada is used in money spells. For example, it is advised to sprinkle an infusion of Cascara Sagrada around the home before going to any court proceeding. This will help you to win your case.

CELANDINE, GREATER (DA BAI QU CAI)

Greater Celandine has a finger sized milky root and a hollow stem with alternating pinnate or pinnatifid leaves (Figure 1.192). It is commonly found in dark places and contains a bitter yellow juice

Figure 1.191. Cascara Sagrada
(Rhamnus purshiana)

Figure 1.192. Greater Celandine
Da Bai Qu Cai (Chelidonium majus)

that turns red when it comes in contact with the air.

Celandine is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; and it is associated with the Fire Element. There are two types of Celandine, "Greater Celandine" Da Bai Qu Cai and "Lesser Celandine" Xiao Bai Qu Cai." The Greater (Da Bai Qu Cai) is associated with the Sun, while the Lesser (Xiao Bai Qu Cai) is associated with Mars.

- **Protection:** Greater Celandine is a poisonous plant that is used in magic to break hexes. It is deadly and has a reaction time of approximately fourteen hours. Greater Celandine is also said to protect the priest in Legal Matters (i.e., helping the wearer escape unfair imprisonment and entrapment).
- **Visions:** Greater Celandine is a very important visionary herb. It is used to fill dream pillows or is taken as a tea just before bed in order to bring about prophetic dreams. It is used to increase the telepathic transference of information, activate lucid dreaming, and allow the priest the ability to receive additional

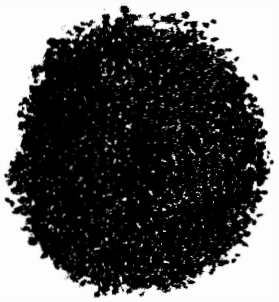


Figure 1.193. Celery Seed
Qin Cai Zi (Apium graveolens)

information from his or her spirit guides. It also helps to clarify the information received from the spirit guides.

- **Healing:** Greater Celandine affects the Fifth Chakra, and influences the acupuncture points located within the throat and thyroid areas. Therefore elixirs can be used to enhance the body's metabolism (which strengthens the channels), and treat diseases of the throat (particularly the vocal cords). This can be especially useful for singers and lectures for articulation and for receiving information. Greater Celandine is sometimes used to treat depression.

  It also benefits people unable to receive information clearly (i.e., autistic children, stubborn people, and people with short attention spans).

CELERY SEED (QIN CAI ZI)

In ancient times Celery Seed was chewed in order to aid focused concentration, and were also use in magical pillows to induce sleep (Figure 1.193). When burned with Orris Root (or with a drop of Basil oil), Celery Seed are said to increase psychic powers. The stalk as well as the seeds are believed to increase passion and lust when eaten. Celery Seed is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury.

CENTAURY (LONG DAN KE)

Centaury is a good plant for general magical purposes (Figure 1.194). It can be used to banish hostile magic as well as to open up magical states of consciousness. It is sometimes combined with other herbs or used as a base for other materials

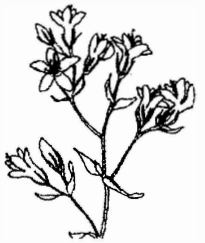


Figure 1.194. Centaury
Long Dan Ke (Erythraea centaurium)

Figure 1.195. Chamomile
Bai Hua Huang Chun Ju (Chameamelum nobile)

in order to give them additional force. Centaury is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

CHAMOMILE (BAI HUA HUANG CHUN JU)

Chamomile is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.195).

- **Purification:** Chamomile can be used for purifying and preparing the body and mind for magic. It can also be burnt as an incense in order to break bad habits and drive out negative thoughts.
- **Protection:** When sprinkled around the property, Chamomile is said to remove curses and spells cast against the inhabitants of the house or temple. In ancient times, children were bathed in Chamomile tea in order to protect them from the evil eye or break any curses that had been cast against them.
- **Prosperity:** It is said that Chamomile can be used to attract money, and a hand wash of Chamomile infusion is sometimes used by gamblers to ensure winnings. Chamomile is

Figure 1.196. Chicory
Ju Ju (Cichorium intybus)

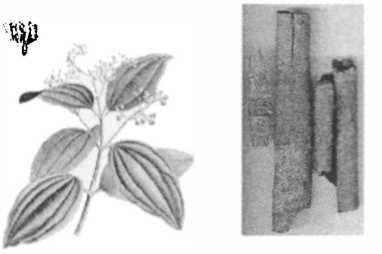


Figure 1.197. Cinnamon
Gui Pi (Cinnamomum zeylanicum)

used in Prosperity Rituals to attract money. It is also used as an amulet for prosperity.

- **Love:** The infusion of Chamomile is sometimes used as a wash for the face and hair (or added to a bath) in order to attract love.
- **Healing:** As an incense, Chamomile creates a peaceful atmosphere and helps the priest with centering. Chamomile tea helps digestion, relaxes and sedates the nerves, and helps to induce sleep. It is therefore often used in sleep and meditation incenses, and it can also be used in sleep pillows (especially good when combined with Hops and Lavender).

  Chamomile energetically augments the entire nervous system, especially the autonomic. It strengthens the kidneys and the entire ductless and respiratory systems. It relieves insomnia and kidney diseases, and is excellent for relieving stress in the nervous system. It stimulates the pineal gland, which creates a sense of harmony and organization through creative passive states applicable to meditation.

  It also regulates the flow of energy within the body's channels and awakens the Sixth Chakra (Third Eye).

Chicory (Ju Ju)

Chicory is generally carried and used to remove any obstacles that the priest might encounter (Figure 1.196). At one time, Chicory was thought to make its possessor invisible, and it was said to open locked boxes and doors if held against the locks (in order for the Chicory to have this type of magical power, it had to be gathered with a golden knife in perfect silence at noon or midnight in Midsummer). Certain magical traditions teach that if you anoint your body with Chicory juice, you will obtain favors from influential people and celebrities. Chicory is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

Cinnamon (Gui Pi)

Cinnamon is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.197). Cinnamon is gathered from the bark of the Cassia tree.

- **Purification:** Cinnamon is used in consecration rituals. In certain magical traditions, it is commonly burned as an incense in order to purify the altar space. Additionally, for any type of magical working, Cinnamon oil can be used for anointing purposes.
- **Protection:** Cinnamon is used in Protection rituals. It can be mixed with Frankincense Resin, Myrrh, and Bai Tan Xiang (White Sandalwood) and burned to keep away evil spirits.
- **Visions:** Cinnamon is used in making meditation incense, and is said to stimulate or strengthen the psychic powers, aid clairvoyance, and induce Soul Travel (astral projection). When burnt as an incense, Cinnamon raises the room's spiritual vibrations. It is therefore commonly used in spiritual quests.
- **Prosperity:** Cinnamon oil or powder is used in prosperity charms to attract money and establish financial "security."
- **Love:** Because Cinnamon is considered to be a male aphrodisiac, it is commonly used by female priests as part of a Love potion in

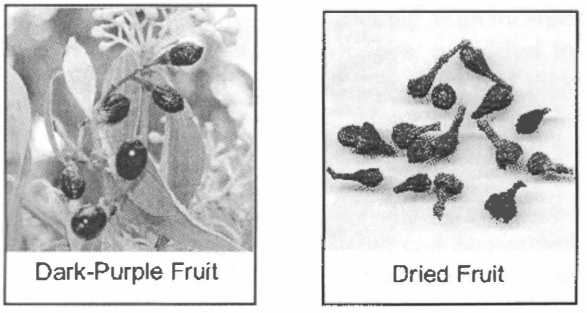


Figure 1.198. Gui Zi (Cinnamon Fruit)

order to induce lust and intensify passion in a relationship.

- **Healing:** Cinnamon is very healing on all levels. It can be used as a tincture for treating colds, flu, headache, toothache, and sore muscles. Its gentle warming energy also helps to heal the heart and kidneys.

Cinnamon is also used in making sachets and infusions. Filling a green or gold sachet with Cinnamon is used to draw money and success or as a healing charm. A purple sachet can be used to increase the wearer's magical and psychic powers. A red sachet placed under the pillow or bed will draw love, and a white sachet will increase your spirituality and give protection.

Additionally, during the Jin Dynasty (265-420 A.D.) there was a Daoist prescription that stated, "Thoroughly mix cassia (Cinnamon) bark with bamboo juice and the brains of a frog. This potion, if drunk, will cause you to walk upon the waters after seven years."

CINNAMON FRUIT (GUI ZI)

The Cinnamon Tree has Golden Red Bark, that is dried and is the cinnamon spice. Its new foliage is commonly deep red, with small white flowers that are followed by Dark-Purple fruit. The fruit is used dried and unripened, for cooking and they are similar to cloves (Figure 1.198).

This Cinnamon Tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun. The Cinnamon Tree is also closely associated with the myth of Heng'O ("Moon Goddess") and the "Moon Hare" ("Jade Rabbit").

Figure 1.199. Cinquefoil (Potentilla canadensis)

CINQUEFOIL

Cinquefoil is characterized by rosettes of basal pinnate leaves that spring from a rootstock of spreading runners. The European variety (also known as Five Finger Grass), is characterized by the presence of five-pointed (maple leaf shaped) leaves that spring directly from the stem (Figure 1.199). This important herb seems to strengthen nearly any form of magic, and for this reason it was added to a large array of magical workings. The root can be carried in a pocket or hung around the neck in order to improves one's powers of communication and persuasion or to protect against hostile magic. For magical purposes, Cinquefoil should always be gathered at midnight under a waxing moon. Cinquefoil is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter.

- **Purification:** Cinquefoil is commonly used in spells, charms, and bath sachets for purification.
- **Protection:** Cinquefoil can be used in herbal spells and magical charms for protection, though it works better for protecting against negative influences than for removing them. It is also sometimes used as a bath herb for protection. In ancient times, it was said to wash nine times with Cinquefoil in order to remove hexes and curses. Cinquefoil was also hung around the doors and windows to protect the house from evil.

  Cinquefoil can be carried into court in order bring about eloquence when asking favors of officials (and usually ensures that the requests will be granted). Cinquefoil is sometimes used for hexing when combined with soot.

Figure 1.200. Clary Sage
(Salvia sclaria)

Figure 1.201. Clove
Ding Xiang (Syzygium aromaticum)

- **Visions:** Cinquefoil strengthens psychic powers and helps to induce prophetic dreams.
- **Prosperity:** Cinquefoil is sometimes used in spells and charms for prosperity. In fact, most money incenses don't seem to work as well without it.

Clary Sage

A close relative of common Sage, the leaves of Clary Sage are fuzzy, slightly purplish, with small blue flowers (Figure 1.200). Clary Sage is traditionally associated with the magical workings of the eyes, giving the individual clarity of sight and other subtle forms of vision. Clary Sage is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter.

Clove (Ding Xiang)

Clove is a strong, forceful, compelling herb. It acts as a catalyst when combined with other herbs and can be used to get someone to do your bidding, especially when commanding and controlling force (or overcoming power) is required (Figure 1.201). Clove is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter. Clove stimulates the stomach and liver channels.

- **Purification:** Clove produces strong spiritual vibrations that protects and cleanses the body, aura, and Wei Qi fields. It is commonly burnt as an incense and used to dispel negativity, cleans the altar space, and purify sacred and magical spaces.
- **Protection:** Clove is worn as an amulet or carried as a protective charm in order to dispel negativity and to stop and prevent (bind) those who spread gossip or speak ill of the priest. Clove is sometimes burned as an incense when performing magical rituals used to stop others from gossiping about you.

  Clove is used in exorcism to banish evil and drive away hostility and negative forces. In ancient times, it was said to protect babies in their cribs (especially if the Clove were strung together on a red thread and hung over them).
- **Visions:** Clove can be ingested as an elixir to help the priest remember his or her dreams, to also consciously work within them, and even to experience lucid dreaming and soul projection. It spiritually attunes the priest to the strengthening energies constantly flowing from the center of our galaxy. Clove can be combined with Chicory and Cinquefoil and then burned as an incense in order to increase psychic powers and induce visions.

  Clove can also be of some value in memory stimulation, when the priest wishes to remember something that transpired long ago, or even from a past life. This can be enhanced to some extent by the aroma. The primary effects stimulated by the flower essence occur at the higher chakra levels (i.e., particularly between the Eighth and Tenth Heavenly Transpersonal Chakras). However, most of the lower energies tend be concentrated in the Fifth and Sixth Chakras.

- **Prosperity:** Clove can be burned as an incense in order to help attract riches, or added to magical formulas used in changing bad luck into good luck.
- **Love:** Worn or carried, Clove can be used to attract the opposite sex and can be used as an aphrodisiac to induce passion. There are many energetic vortices that can be noticed associated with this magical flower in the wild. Observing and feeling these subtle energetic pulses (i.e., by putting your hands next to the flowers), can be a powerful way for the priest to enhance the energetic capacity of its delightful scent, and allow the priest the ability to receive and ingest the energy of its magical oils.
- **Healing:** When using Clove for healing, a great deal of the energy is concentrated in the upper part of the body, particularly in the top of the head. As this energy gradually moves, almost like a liquid down through the body, it then begins to make itself more physical, entering more clearly into the Sixth and Fifth Chakras.

It is said that Clove balances Second (Navel) and Fourth (Heart) Chakras, and is calming and comforting to the emotions. It strengthens the eyesight and protects one from disease and infection. Clove is very antiseptic, and it is therefore good for oral infections, toothache pain, and as an ingredient in external healing liniments. It also assists with digestive, muscular, and bronchial ailments.

Clove influences the entire neurological system (especially stimulating the autonomic nervous system). It can be used to treat diseases such as multiple sclerosis and any form of general deterioration caused within the neurological system. Clove also stimulates regeneration of the cellular tissues in the neurological system.

Because of its impact on the body's channel system, most acupuncturists and color therapists should use this magical essence in treatment as a painkiller. When this magical essence is used, the energy body is strengthened.

Figure 1.202. Coltsfoot
Kuan Dong Hua (Tussilago farfara)

COLTSFOOT (KUAN DONG HUA)

Coltsfoot is characterized by downy white scaly stems topped with large yellow flowers that spring up from a creeping rootstock (Figure 1.225). This plant grows mostly in damp places. Coltsfoot is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Visions:** Coltsfoot is a visionary plant, it energizes various aspects of consciousness, and its leaves are used in many smoking blends in order to heighten the priest's visionary experiences (i.e., Coltsfoot combined with Angelica {Yuan Dang Gui}). It can also be used to assist him or her in magical dream work.
- **Love:** Coltsfoot leaf is add to love sachets and is use in spells for creating peace and tranquility.
- **Healing:** Coltsfoot has a calming effect, and its leaves are sometimes used in spells and in healing herb formulas to induce peace and tranquillity. When smoked, Coltsfoot is a soothing expectorant and antispasmodic that can be used to treat bronchitis, whooping cough, asthma, and chronic emphysema.

Figure 1.203. Comfrey
He Sheng Hua (Symphytum officinale)

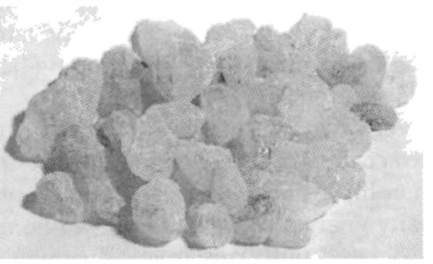


Figure 1.204. Copal Resin
Tou Ming Shu Jiao (Bursera odorata)

COMFREY (HE SHENG HUA)

Comfrey is also known as Boneset, Miracle Herb, and Knit Bone (Figure 1.203). Comfrey is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

- **Protection:** Comfrey leaf is a strong magical herb that is used for protection against any type of negativity, especially when traveling, and particularly for protection in the spirit world (i.e., astral realms).
- **Prosperity:** Comfrey leaf is sometimes used as an ingredient in money spells. It is said to bring financial success in gambling and new business ventures.
- **Healing:** Because Comfrey is easily absorbed through the skin, it is used for treating sprains, strains, fractures, and bruises. When applied externally as a poultice (i.e., grind fresh leaves with a mortar, and simmer with water into a sticky paste) it is beneficial for healing connective tissue, bone, and cartilage. It can be used as a plaster to treat diseases such as shingles (associated with the nervous system), and help to restore the energetic capability of the nervous system after it has been in an atrophied state (i.e. muscular degeneration or being in a wheelchair after an accident). Because it heals nerve endings, Comfrey can be used clinically to ease phantom limb pain, allowing greater strength and control over the healing process.

  When taken internally, Comfrey leaf is very nutritive and building. Comfrey is a powerful tonic for the nervous system, particularly the autonomic nervous system. Because it helps the body to stimulate unused portions of the brain, it can also be used to treat brain tissue, especially after the tissue has become damaged or destroyed through alcohol or trauma. Comfrey is also a good tonic for the endocrine system, particularly the adrenal glands and spleen, and can be utilized to treat tension-caused ulcers. As an infusion, Comfrey can also be used to soothe an upset stomach.

  Comfrey helps release tensions stored in the nervous system and the subconscious mind. It increases physical coordination by balancing the left and right halves of the brain, and enables one to gain better control over the body processes such as heart regulation and glandular functions. It also allows for quicker reflex responses.

COPAL RESIN (TOU MING SHU JIAO)

Copal Resin is the recent of fossilized resin of certain tropical trees (Figure 1.204). Copal Resin is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun. The finest quality has an intense resinous-citrus odor.

- **Purification:** Copal Resin can be used for making incenses, and it is burned in love and purification rituals.
- **Visions:** Copal Resin can be used as a meditation incense to increase psychic sight.
- **Exorcism:** In exorcisms, Copal Resin can be burned as an incense in order to contact the spirits of the dead or to remove evil.
- **Hexing:** A piece of Copal Resin can be used by a priest to represent the heart of an individual when constructing a hexing doll.

Figure 1.205. Coriander
Yan Sui (Coriandrum sativum)

Figure 1.206. Costus Root
(Mu Xiang)

- **Love:** Copal Resin can be used in magical rituals to attract love.

CORIANDER (YAN SUI)

Coriander is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.205).

- **Protection:** Coriander works mostly in the psychospiritual realms. It allows the baser attributes within an individual to evolve to a higher energetic form. The energetic signature lies in the bitter aromatic smell of the plant. Plants with pugnacious smells or penetrating odors usually have a tendency to affect more the subtle bodies and manifest higher spiritual qualities. Coriander merges the physical, energetic, and spirit bodies so that these three subtle bodies function more as a single unit.
- **Connection With the Insect Kingdom:** There is a strong energetic connection between Coriander, the spirit realm, and interaction with the Insect Kingdom. The Insect Kingdom is constantly evolving, and it has a powerful influence on agriculture, plants, and Man's interrelationship with the Plant Kingdom. By utilizing Coriander flower essence and energetically tuning into a specific insect species, the priest may more easily attract a spirit connection. Growing the plant can be quite helpful when one is able to more easily tune in and work with these hidden energies. It is generally within the dried seeds that the most pungent and powerful energetic connections can occur, especially at an emotional level. However, the flower essence will bring about a much higher vibratory energetic connection, drawing a powerful interconnection out of the priest. This will awaken the priest to an esoteric awareness of the inner natures that exist between the spirit world and the Insect Kingdom.
- **Love:** Coriander has long been used in love sachets and spells to initiate lust and desire It is very potent in high doses and is commonly used in ritual drinks consumed in Sex Magic (i.e. Coriander is sometimes ground in a mortar while speaking incantations and then mixed into a wine and drunk as a lust potion). Coriander is sometimes also stuffed into a mate's pillow in order to prevent wandering.
- **Healing:** Coriander is also used to promote tranquility, and it is said to protect the peaceful energetic ambiance of the home. Coriander oil has some unique astringent qualities, and natural capabilities to bring various energies of a cleansing and healing nature. It is rare amongst the leafy plants, in that, its juice has capacity to draw heavy metals out of the person.

  Coriander incenses are sometimes used in longevity spells. A charm of Coriander is said to protect against illness and disease. Coriander seeds are also used for easing headaches, and are sometimes worn for this purpose.

COSTUS ROOT (MU XIANG)

This magical herb is also known as Aucklandia lappa Dence and Costus Root (Figure 1.206).

- **Sex Magic:** Costus Root is used for heightening body awareness and acts as an aphrodisiac. It is commonly burned as an incense and used in Daoist Sex Magic.

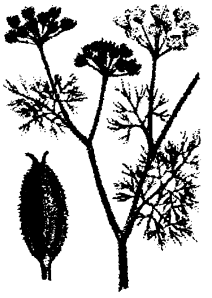


Figure 1.207. Cumin
(Cumimum cyminum)

Figure 1.208. Curry
Ke Li Yue Ju (Murraya koenigii)

CUMIN

Cumin is considered to bring protection and fidelity (Figure 1.207). Cumin is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** A combination of Cumin and Frankincense Resin is traditionally burned as an incense for protection. Cumin can also be scattered on the floor with sea salt and used to drive out evil spirits and bad luck.

  Cumin seeds are said to prevent the theft of any object in which they are placed. One magical tradition states that the priest should place Cumin seeds on, in, or near an object in order to prevent theft. For example, Cumin seeds may be placed into bread in order to keep the Nature Spirits from stealing household items. The seeds are also sprinkled across doorways each Sunday before noon in order to attract peace and tranquility.
- **Love:** Cumin is sometimes use in love spells, and when given to a lover, Cumin is said to control infidelity (in this way, it is said to have a gently binding effect over the mate). Cumin can also be steeped in wine in order to make an effective love potion and to induce passion and lust.

CURRY (KE LI YUE JU)

Curry is used for protection (Figure 1.208). Curry is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

Figure 1.209. Daffodil
Huang Shui Xian (Narcissus spp.)

- **Protection:** Curry is said to keep evil forces away. In magic, when countering a hex, Curry is commonly used in spells to increase the "reversible" power and send the curse back to its originator.

DAFFODIL (HUANG SHUI XIAN)

The Daffodil is a common decorative plant grows from a bulbous root and is known for its beautiful yellow flowers (Figure 1.209). This herb is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Summoning:** Place fresh flowers or dried petals on an altar in order to attract friendly spirits.
- **Protection:** This is a popular solar herb used to banish evil spirits from houses. It is sometimes used to exorcise spirit oppression. In ancient times a Daffodil bulb was carried in the priest's pocket for protection during the night. The Daffodil bulb holds the most

Figure 1.210. Damiana
(Turnera aphrodisiaca)

Figure 1.211. Dandelion
Pu Gong Ying (Taraxacum officinale)

concentrated form of the plant's magical energy, and it should always be gathered on the night of the Full Moon. The Daffodil bulb can also be used in an amulet for protection, or it can be grown in a garden in order to banish hostile energies and bring protection to the household.

- **Healing:** Daffodil can be used to energetically vitalize the body, strengthen the thymus, eases stress, reduces high blood pressure, and alleviate ulcerous conditions. Clinically, it can be used to energetically treat manic-depression, psycho-spiritual imbalances, extreme frustration, low intellectual capacities, and constant self-condemnation. It benefits transcendental forms of meditation and the capacity to hear voices from one's spirit guides or higher self. It assists the Seventh Chakra in organizing the conscious mind to receive information from the higher self, allows an individual to become more energetically sensitive, and brings about clarity of thought.

DAMIANA

Damiana is used in order to induce visions and in sex magic (Figure 1.210). Damiana is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Visions:** Because Damiana has hallucinogenic properties, it is sometimes burned in order to induce psychic visions and facilitate lucid dreams. It can be highly useful in such activities as Soul Projection (astral travel), deep meditation, and spirit quests. Damiana is sometimes burned in order to assist with divination. It also produces a euphoric state when smoked. Excessive or long term use of Damiana may be toxic to the liver.
- **Love:** Damiana is often used in lust infusions, as well as lust spells. It acts as a powerful aphrodisiac, and is sometimes used by female priests (i.e., extract is added to red wine or the herb is brewed into a tea) for enchanting a male lover. It can be ingested in either a hot or iced tea in order to increase sexual stamina and fight impotency. Damiana is often used in sex magic, and it may be infused in bath water, or used in love spells.

DANDELION (PU GONG YING)

Dandelion commonly grows as a weed. It has a rosette of dark green leaves growing off a milky taproot and is easily recognized by its bright yellow flowers (Figure 1.211). Dandelion is mainly used for divination and calling upon spirits. Dandelion is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter.

- **Protection:** The flower and root of the Dandelion is gathered as a protective herb and is used as a charm against hostile magic.
- **Visions:** Dandelion is said to have visionary powers, and the dried root can be used in rituals to facilitate visionary experiences, as well as to amplify the priest's telepathic ability. Dandelion root, when dried, roasted, and ground, is used to make a tea. This infusion will enhance psychic powers (i.e., increase clairvoyance). This same tea, placed steaming

beside the bed, will summon spirits. To send a message to a loved one, blow at the seed head in his or her direction and visualize your message. Dandelion root is sometimes burned with Acacia gum or Frankincense Resin and used as an incense in order to promote visions or spirit communications. Dandelion can also be used in dream pillows and sachets.

- **Healing:** Dandelion leaves and flowers can be used in tea for healing. This tea can be used in order to aid the digestion, and can be taken each day for a week as a general "pick me up." Dandelion root is a powerful cholagogue and is often used to purify the blood and remove toxins from the liver.

  When used as a liniment, Dandelion creates tremendous relaxation throughout the entire muscular structure. It can be used as an elixir to treat ulcers, fevers, leukemia, and muscular degeneration. It is an excellent elixir when fasting to relieve cancer symptoms. It can be used to strengthen the Liver Qi, and energetically influence the energy body and spirit body.
- **Weather Magic:** Dandelion may be buried under the northwest corner of a house in order to bring favorable winds to the property and its inhabitants.

DILL

Dill is a one to three foot high plant. It has a green and white striped hollow stem, and it is often cultivated in rural gardens (Figure 1.212). Dill is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury.

- **Purification:** Dill was used in ancient times to bring blessings to people, places, and things.
- **Protection:** Dill is a strong protective herb used to break the powerful magic of hostile enchantments, curses, and obsessions. Bundles of Dill are commonly placed above windows and doors to keep hostile entities out. It is said that if you place Dill over the front door, no-one ill-disposed towards you or envious of you can enter your house. This herb is also carried in protective sachets.

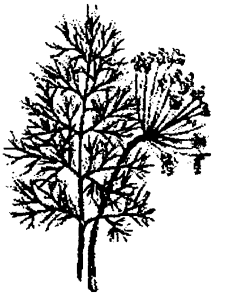


Figure 1.212. Dill
(Anethum graveolens)

Often used to calm children, Dill may also be hung in a child's room to protect him or her from evil spirits. In ancient times, Dill was placed in cradles to protect small children from night terrors.

- **Prosperity:** Dill is sometimes used in money spells; because the plant produces plentiful seeds, it represents wealth and abundance.
- **Love:** Used in love charms, Dill stimulates passion and lust if it is eaten or smelled. It is sometimes added to a bath in order to envelop the skin, making the priest irresistible.
- **Healing:** Its seeds and essential oils are especially useful for developing mental clarity and enhancing the ability to think rationally. It reestablishes a proper balance between the energetic and spirit bodies.

Dill can be used to assist digestion. In ancient times, it was said that sniffing fresh Dill would cure the hiccups. Clinically, it can be used to energetically treat tonsillitis and diseases involving the degeneration of the brain tissue (i.e., cerebral palsy).

Figure 1.213. Dittany of Crete
Long Dan Zhang (Origanum dictamnus)

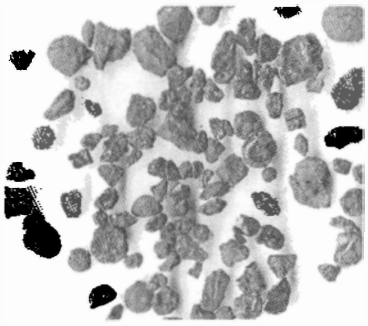


Figure 1.214. Dragon's Blood Resin
Long Xue Shu (Daemonorops draco)

DITTANY OF CRETE (LONG DAN ZHANG)

Dittany of Crete is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.213).

- **Visions:** Dittany of Crete can be mixed with equal parts of Vanilla, Benzoinum, and White Sandalwood in order to make an incense used to induce Soul (Astral) projection. To use, burn a small amount just prior to attempting astral projection.
- **Summoning:** When burned, Dittany of Crete is an excellent base for aiding and inducing the manifestation of spirits, as it has the power to enable spirit beings to take on physical form (e.g., the spirits appear in the smoke rising from the incense burner). Because of this powerful materializing effect, Dittany is commonly used as incense in rituals of evocation, when the spirit being summoned is requested to appear in full manifestation (as opposed to scrying in a crystal ball or magic mirror). Dittany can also be used in any ritual directed towards manifesting things on the physical realm.
- **Protection:** The smell of Dittany is said to drive off venomous beasts. Therefore, in certain magical traditions, priests would smear the juice of Dittany on their bodies before venturing out into the wilderness.

DRAGON'S BLOOD RESIN (LONG XUE SHU)

Dragon's Blood Resin is the common name given to the resin from the plant Dracaena Draco (Figure 1.214). Dragon's Blood Resin is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Protection:** Dragon's Blood Resin dispels negativity and is burned in exorcisms in order to remove evil spirit entities. It can be carried, sprinkled in the home, or used as an incense to drive away all forms of negativity and evil intentions. It is said that, when added to other incenses (i.e., Frankincense and Myrrh), just a pinch of Dragon's Blood Resin will make the magical powers of the other herbs stronger. Dragon's Blood Resin may also be dissolved with sea salt in the bath for strong protection.

  Combine Dragon's Blood powder with alcohol and gum arabic in order to create a powerful magical ink. This powerful ink can be used for creating magical talismans.
- **Love:** It is said that a stick of Dragon's Blood can be placed under the bed, mattress, or pillow in order to restore male potency and cure impotency. The dried resin may be burned to entice errant lovers to return to you.
- **Healing:** Dragon's Blood Resin is said to "burns" out illness and infection. It helps heal bones, teeth, blood disorders, and reproductive organs.

Figure 1.215. Elecampane
Tu Mu Xiang (Inula helenium)

Figure 1.216. Eucalyptus
Lan An (Eucalyptus spp. globulus)

Elecampane (Tu Mu Xiang)

Elecampane is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.215).

- **Visions:** Elecampane is smouldered on charcoal to sharpen psychic powers, especially when scrying. It is also used to draw out spirit entities and to aid in meditation.
- **Love:** When worn, Elecampane protects and attracts love. To make a love pouch sew some of the leaves or flowers into pink cloth.
- **Healing:** An elixir made from Elecampane will aid the digestion and assist in the proper assimilation of protein. It is commonly administered to patients with diseases that have a high imbalance in protein, such as in hypoglycemia (it also stimulates the production of HCL acid, and it strengthens the immune system, particularly involving the white corpuscles). Psychological states indicating a possible use of this essence include anxiety, hypochondria, and basic mood fluctuations classical to hypoglycemia (i.e., when the patient has food cravings).

Eucalyptus (Lan An)

Eucalyptus is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon (Figure 1.216).

- **Purification:** Eucalyptus is used to purify and cleanse any space of unwanted negative energies.
- **Protection:** In ancient times, Eucalyptus leaves were carried for protection.
- **Visions:** Eucalyptus is considered to be useful in dream and sleep pillows. Its cent is sometimes used to stimulate the brain and increase concentration.
- **Healing:** Eucalyptus is considered to be highly protective, and it is used in many types of healing. It kills germs and infections and is used to ease lung congestion and stimulate the heart (Eucalyptus activates the balancing capacities of the heart chakra). In ancient times, pods of Eucalyptus were placed under a pillow to protect against colds. Additionally, a small branch or twig of Eucalyptus was sometimes hung over the bed of a patient in order to initiate healing. The leaves were also used as stuffing in hexing (healing) dolls, and the leaves were also carried in order to maintain good health and ensure protection. Eucalyptus is used in healing spells, charms, and amulets.

Eucalyptus can be used to stimulate the thymus gland, and ease inflammation in the kidneys, liver, lungs, and nasal passages. It can be used clinically to treat asthma, jaundice, malaria, kidney deterioration, and any form of radiation sickness (particularly plutonium poisoning). It can be used to activate the entire circulatory system, and strengthen and cleanse iron and hemoglobin so that parts of the body that are lacking oxygen are replenished. Eucalyptus also oxygenates and improves the lungs and can be used to treat patients who are recovering smokers, have problems breathing, or who suffer from smoke inhalation due to fire.

Figure 1.217. Eyebright
(Euphrasia officinalis)

EYEBRIGHT

Eyebright is Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.217).

- **Visions:** In ancient times, priests would anoint their eyelids with an infusion of Eyebright daily in order to induce clairvoyant visions and psychic dreams. It was also believed to allow the priest to see Nature Spirits.

  Eyebright is excellent for increasing clairvoyant skills. It heightens the physical sensitivity of the retina, rods, and cones, activates the pituitary gland, and stimulates the pineal gland. It also heightens the dormant eyelike qualities of the pineal gland which was once believed to be a third eye. This energetic stimulation affects all aspects of visual phenomena. It improves the priest's ability to see auras and chakras, stimulates telepathic responses, strengthens intuition and psychic abilities, and provides the priest with a greater sense of his or her internal nature and awareness.

FENNEL SEED (XIAO HUI XIANG)

Fennel Seed is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.218).

- **Purification:** Fennel Seed is sometimes burned as an incense and used for clearing altar space. It is often used in purification sachets and healing formulas.
- **Protection:** Fennel Seed is burned as an incense and used for removing or banishing evil spirits and hexes. It is sometimes worn in order to ward off evil spirits. When grown around the home,

Figure 1.218. Fennel Seed
Xiao Hui Xiang (Foeniculum vulgare)

Figure 1.219. Feverfew
(Tanacetum partheium)

Fennel Seed is considered to be protective. In Midsummer, it is sometimes hung around the doors and windows in order to ward off evil spirits and negativity. Because it's energetic action is unpredictable, certain magical traditions consider Fennel Seed to be better for removing hexes than for protecting against them. Fennel Seed is also used when a priest wants to effect an energetic shift and change a situation.

FEVERFEW

Feverfew is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.219).

- **Divination:** Feverfew balances the electromagnetic qualities within the energy body. It increases the body's attunement to the electromagnetic fields existing within the priest's physical body and within the Earth. It therefore can be very useful for Dowsing and Feng Shui. The elixir is an excellent remedy for those priests working with the law of opposite expression, examining antagonistic forces within the psyche or environment.

Figure 1.220. Flax
Yu Zhi Ya Ma (Linum usitatissimum)

Figure 1.221. Fleabane
(Inula dysenterica)

- **Healing:** Feverfew is a strong herb for health and spiritual healing. It stimulates the Qi of the Ninth and Tenth Chakras and enhances the flow of blood across the blood/brain barrier. It strengthens the liver channel and energizes the energy body.

  Feverfew is also excellent for the treatment of migraine headaches (i.e., it eases inflammation and constriction of the blood vessels in the head, and reduces the patient's sensitivity to light and nausea). An elixir of Feverfew is sometimes used to ward off sickness and bolster immune system. It is sometimes carried in charms or sachets for protection against colds, fevers, and accidents.

Flax (Yu Zhi Ya Ma)

Flax is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.220).

- **Purification:** Flax powerfully cleanses the body's channels and eases emotional stress. It also aids in the assimilation of information, improves the memory, and improves reading skills.
- **Memory:** Flax aids in the assimilation of information, improves the memory, and improves reading skills. It also cleanses the body's entire channel system and prepares it for receiving information. The energy of Flax focuses mostly within the isolated section of the spirit body that concentrates around the area of the intestinal tract, where esoteric information is either assimilated or rejected.
- **Protection:** The blue Flax flowers are used to protect against dark sorcery. One ancient formula used to protect oneself while sleeping, required the priest to mix equal parts of Flax Seed with Mustard Seed and place them in a bowl, The bowl was then placed next to the priest's bed. On the other side of the bed was placed a pan of cold water. This combination of Fire and Water energy was believed to guard the priest while he or she slept.
- **Prosperity:** Flax seeds are traditionally used in money spells. It is believed that a few seeds can be placed inside a purse or wallet in order to attract wealth.
- **Healing:** Flax can also be used in healing spells and formulas. It can also be sprinkled on the alter while performing healing rituals in order to enhance their magical power. Flax is sometimes placed in a bowl inside a house in order to absorb negative energy.

  Clinically, Flax can be used to strengthen the Sixth and Seventh Chakras, strengthen the acupuncture points in the hands (specially the backs of the hands), strengthen the heart channel, and cleanse the bladder channel.

Fleabane

Fleabane is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.221).

- **Protection:** Fleabane has been used since ancient times to exorcise evil spirits. It also protects against any unwelcome entry of a person or spirit entry into the priest's home. In order to ward off evil spirits, mix Fleabane, St. John's Wort, Wheat, and a few Capers into a sachet and hang it above the door.

Figure 1.222. Frankincense Resin
Ru Xiang (Boswellia carterii)

Figure 1.223. Fumitory
He Bao Mu Dan (Fumaria officinalis)

FRANKINCENSE RESIN (RU XIANG)

One of the oldest forms of incense in the world, Frankincense Resin is a tree sap once priceless to the Middle Eastern area thousands of years ago (Figure 1.222). Frankincense Resin is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun. Frankincense Resin is used in countless formulae and different incense blends. However, it is particularly common in incense blends that are used for consecration, exorcism, and protection. Frankincense Resin is considered to be a good magical base to receive other herbs or oils.

- **Purification:** When burned, Frankincense Resin dispels negativity and raises the spiritual energy of a place. It is therefore commonly used in consecration and cleansing rituals. As an incense, Frankincense Resin is said to purify the altar space and invoke a spiritual frame of mind. The sacred, purifying scent of Frankincense Resin is used to cleanse the body, aura, and environment of all negative influences. Frankincense Resin also aids in meditation, is used to obtain blessings, and has long been used as a divination offering.
- **Protection:** Frankincense Resin is commonly used in all forms of exorcism. When burned, it releases a powerful energetic mist that drives away all forms of evil and negativity. Frankincense Resin is also added to magical sachets and used for luck, protection, and spiritual growth.
- **Visions:** When burned, Frankincense Resin is said to induce visions and aid in meditation. It is used in order to enhance psychic vision and to attract good spiritual influences.

FUMITORY (HE BAO MU DAN)

Fumitory has a semi erect stem and alternate gray-green leaves; its flowers vary in color according to species (Figure 1.223). Fumitory is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

- **Protection:** Fumitory is associated with the underworld and with the deep energies of the Earth. It was believed in ancient times to grow from the vapors of the Underworld and its Latin name means "Earth Smoke." The whole plant can be used for exorcism (to banish hostile spirits) and purification (to purify a ritual space).

Figure 1.224. Galangal Root
Liang Jiang Shu (Alpina officinalum)

GALANGAL ROOT (LIANG JIANG SHU)

Galangal Root (also known as Low John the Conqueror) is highly versatile in its magical ability, and is only slightly less powerful than High John or Jalap. Galangal Root's energetic action never proceeds in a straight line, but always takes on unexpected twists and turns (i.e., it accomplishes its functions through devious and unpredictable means). Galangal Root is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.224).

- **Protection:** Galangal Root is used for breaking hexes and for adding power to spells. Traditionally, powdered Galangal is burned on charcoal as an incense in order to break spells and curses. Galangal Root creates a powerful force for effecting change and is often used in legal difficulties.
- **Visions:** Galangal Root is considered to be a mild hallucinogen (priest's will eat about three inches of the root in order to induce this altered conscious state). Worn as a talisman, Galangal Root aids psychic development.
- **Prosperity:** When worn or carried, Galangal Root is said to protect the bearer from legal problems. When placed in a sachet of leather with silver, it is said to draw good luck and bring money.
- **Love:** It is sometimes carried or sprinkled around the home to promote lust.
- **Healing:** When worn, Galangal Root guards the health of the bearer.

GECKO (GE JIE)

Chinese Leopard and Tiger Gecko (Goniurosaurus luii & Goniurosaurus araneus) average about eight to nine inches in length (Figure 1.225).

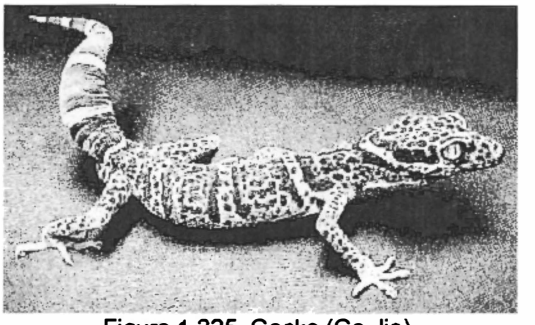


Figure 1.225. Gecko (Ge Jie)

Chinese Tiger Geckos are attractively banded in browns and golden tans, while Chinese Leopards are clad in purplish gray with numerous tiny dark spots and bands of yellow or orange. An a "healing herb" Gecko is used as a general health tonic for the Kidney energy.

- **Protection:** In ancient China, one popular defense used against an evil sorcerer's curse involved placing a Gecko (used to represent the evil sorcerer) in a small glass or clay jar. The jar was then placed on the Celestial Altar, and a magical ritual was performed.

  After burning petitions and offering Gold Foil Spirit Money, the priest would then use the burning tip of an incense stick to make seven small spots on the lizard's underbelly. These small spots represent the magical celestial power of the Seven Stars of the Big Dipper. The magical power released from this type of defensive ritual was believed to be so powerful, that it could sometimes damage the spirit of the attacking evil sorcerer.

  Once this celestial power was released, the attacking evil sorcerer would only be able to negate its magical effects by stopping the magical attack and immediately pouring large quantities of Holy Water over his head.
- **Love:** An Aphrodisiac Tea can be created by dry-roasting two tails of a Red-Spotted Leopard Gecko (a male and female), between two pieces of pottery tiles. Then add 1.5 ounces of Epimedium Sagittatum (Horny Goat Weed), and ground both ingredients into a powder. Mix the powder in tea or wine to enhance sexual desire.